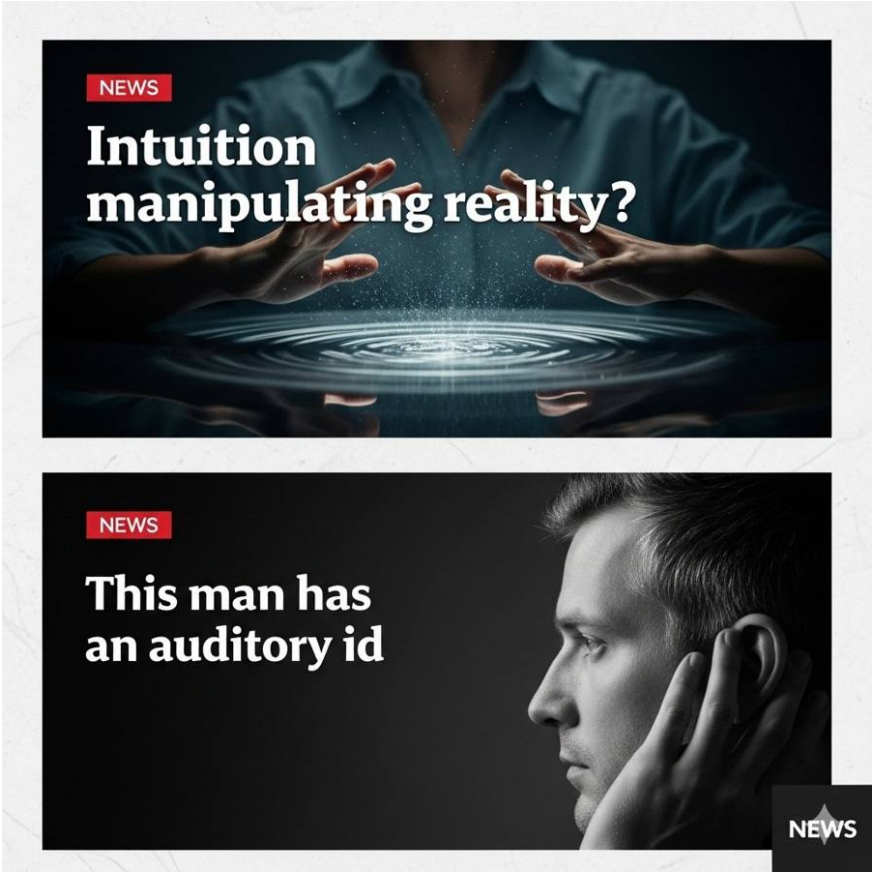
The Psychology Behind the Images

287 images from the *psychology* folder, each followed by a note on the psychological mechanisms it draws on.

How to read this. The notes describe why each image works on the viewer (cognitive biases, emotions, rhetoric, humour mechanics) and, where an image states a claim, whether research supports it. They are interpretations written from the images alone, not endorsements of any claim shown. Text in a few low-resolution images was hard to read, so some captions may be slightly misquoted. Videos in the folder (.mp4) are not included. Several images touch on distress, fear of surveillance or medication; where they do, the notes say so plainly, and if any of it feels personal, talking to a GP, counsellor or someone you trust is worthwhile (in Australia, Lifeline is 13 11 14).



Intuition manipulating reality? / This man has an auditory id

Two mock news-style headlines pair vague, mystical-sounding claims with a credible visual template (the 'NEWS' banner). The psychology here is the authority heuristic and the 'illusory truth' effect: familiar formatting borrows the credibility of journalism, so a speculative idea feels reported rather than proposed. 'Auditory id' blends Freudian vocabulary (the id as raw instinct) with sensory processing, a pattern called 'psychobabble pairing' that sounds profound because the terms are loosely evocative. The hands-over-water image invites apophenia and the sense that thought itself shapes the physical world, a theme tied to the illusion of control.

Gosh, what is it? It's BTC whale sh*t

A crowd shields its eyes from a mushroom cloud while the caption reduces the event to market jargon. This is a joke about attribution bias and narrative fallacy: people reach for a familiar, in-group explanation (crypto whales moving prices) for an overwhelming, ambiguous event. It also mirrors normalcy bias, where people downplay catastrophic signals by assimilating them into everyday frames. The humour comes from the mismatch between the scale of the threat and the banality of the explanation, a classic incongruity-resolution mechanism.

Trickle upward social authority / trickle downward economy

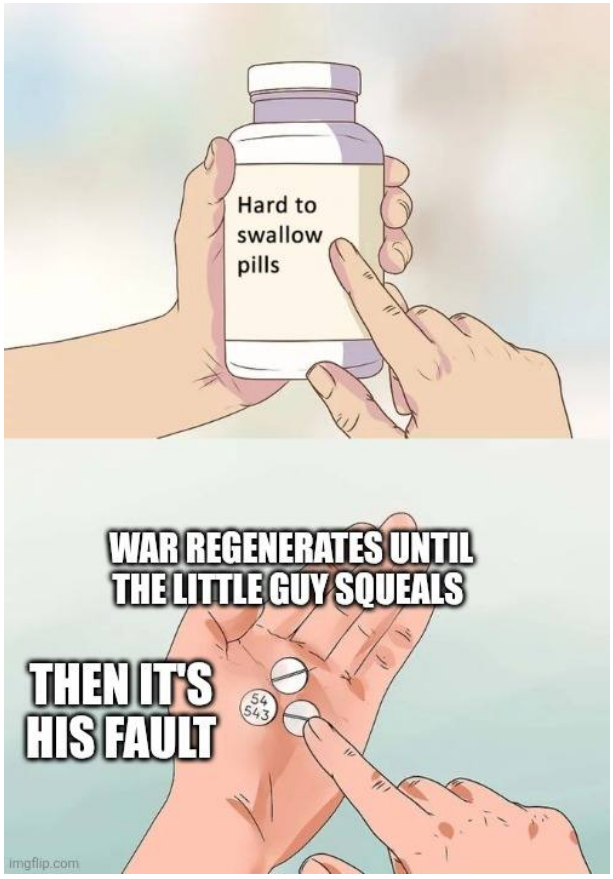
The 'X, X Everywhere' template (Woody and Buzz) is used to point at a perceived pattern: influence concentrating at the top while economic benefit fails to spread. Psychologically this plays on system justification versus system-blame, relative deprivation (feeling worse off compared with those above), and the pattern-detection drive that makes people confident they have spotted a hidden structure. Using a children's-film image to deliver a cynical economic claim also creates ironic distance, which lets the viewer feel clever and detached rather than aggrieved.

Time travel is possible over the Internet / education demands you abandon intuition

The 'epic handshake' format joins two normally opposed positions into agreement. The claim is that the internet lets information from different times coexist, while formal physics education trains you to distrust intuition in favour of a 'five-dimensional construct' (our three spatial dimensions plus time and a further abstraction). The psychology is the tension between intuitive physics (folk theories built from lived experience) and counter-intuitive scientific models. The handshake format rewards the viewer with a feeling of insight through reconciliation, a form of cognitive closure.

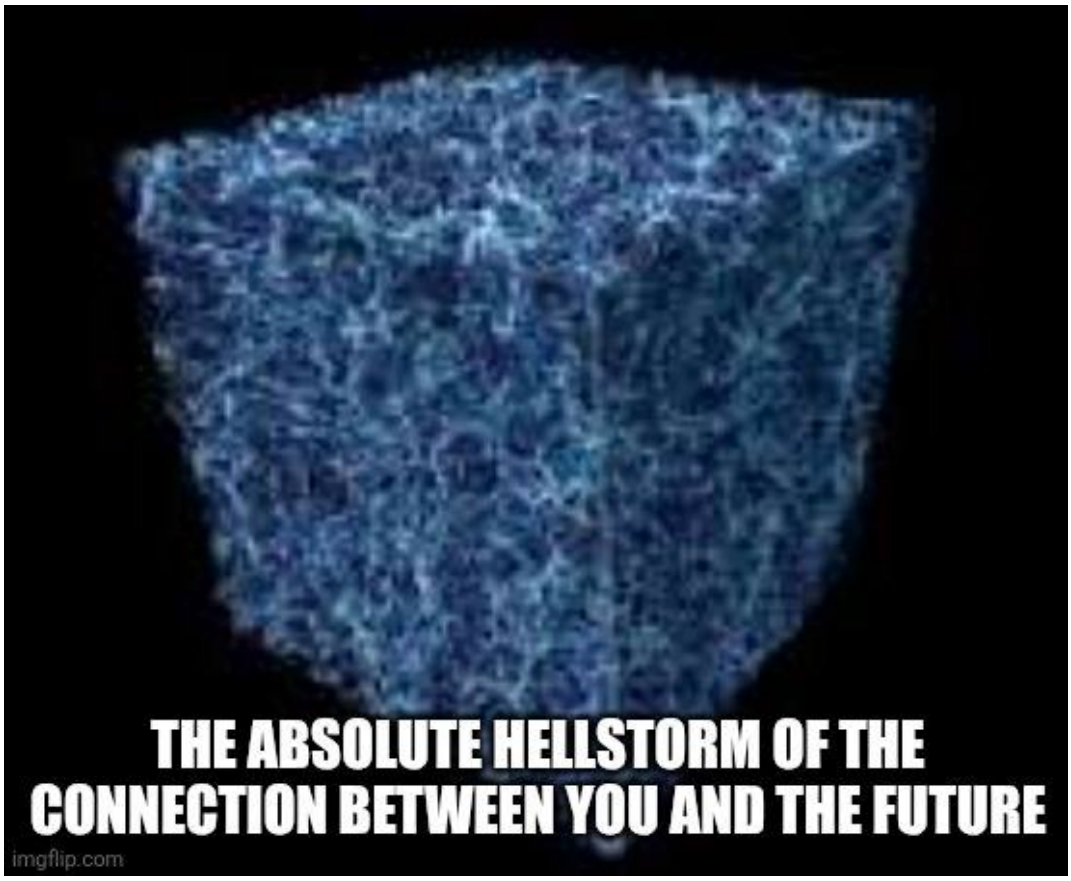
Emasculated women on TV / Nice figure

A hyper-masculine action-hero caricature delivers a deliberately contradictory caption. The joke runs on a subverted expectation: the phrase promises a culture-war complaint, then the punchline treats it as an appreciative remark. This exploits ambiguity in social-signalling language and shows how humour defuses taboo topics through the benign-violation mechanism: something that feels slightly wrong becomes safe once reframed. It also pokes at in-group stereotype scripts about masculinity and media.



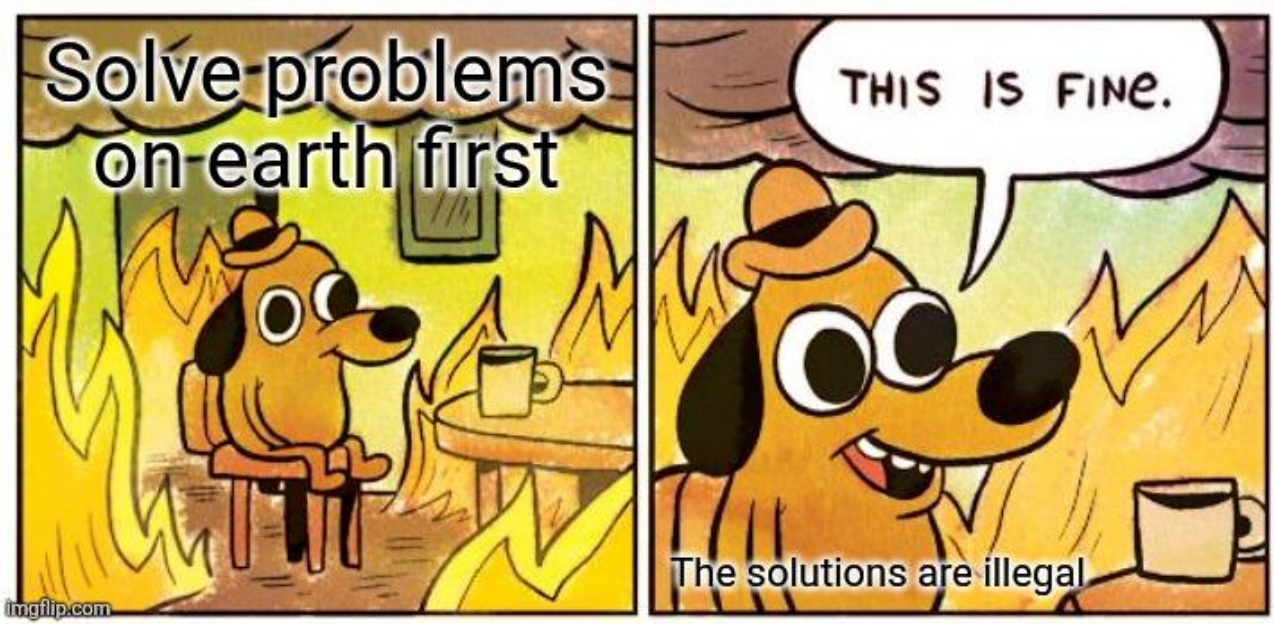
War regenerates until the little guy squeals, then it's his fault

The 'Hard to swallow pills' template presents an uncomfortable idea as medicine. Here the claim concerns blame displacement in conflict: a cycle continues until the weaker party reacts, and then the reaction is treated as the cause. This reflects the fundamental attribution error and victim blaming, driven by the just-world hypothesis (the need to believe outcomes are deserved). The format flatters the viewer as someone brave enough to swallow a 'hard truth', which is a reliable way to lower resistance to a contested claim.



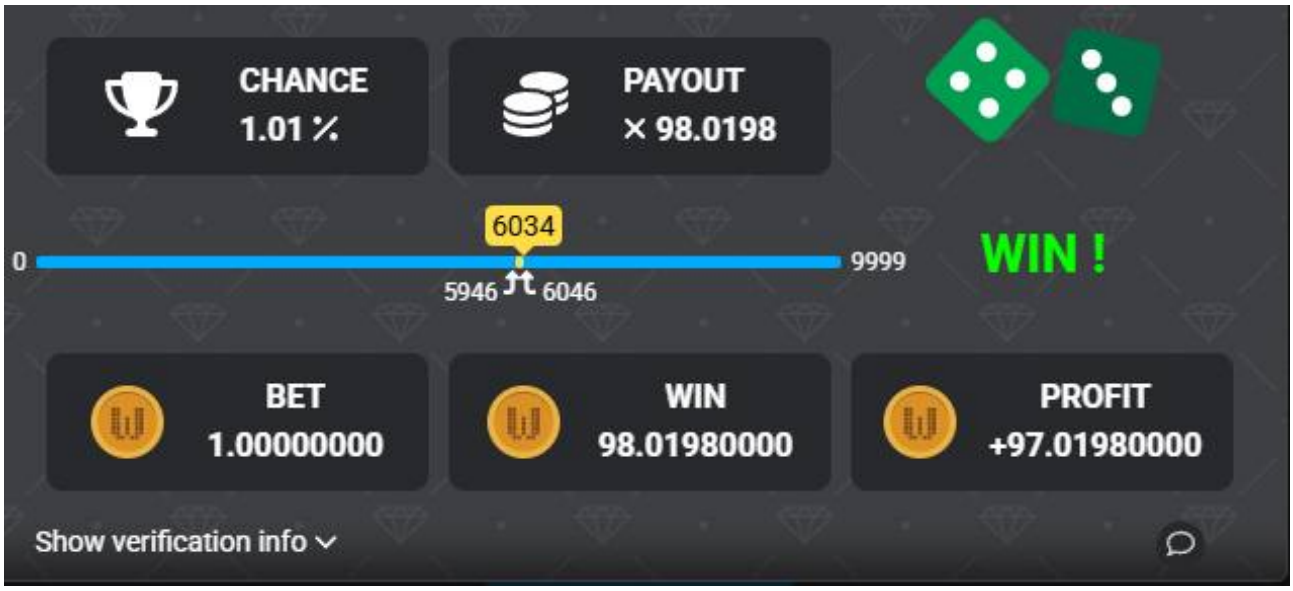
The absolute hellstorm of the connection between you and the future

A rendering of a cosmic-web or data-lattice cube is paired with an intense caption. The image evokes the block-universe idea that past, present and future all exist together, while the caption personalises it. Psychologically it targets awe and mild existential vertigo, emotions that heighten perceived meaning (the 'awe effect' makes people feel small and more open to large ideas). Dense network imagery also triggers pattern-seeking, and the hyperbolic wording signals that the viewer is being invited to feel, not just analyse.



Solve problems on earth first / The solutions are illegal

The 'This is fine' dog is the standard emblem of denial amid crisis. The caption pits a common objection to space exploration against a cynical rejoinder about legal barriers. It captures learned helplessness and the bystander-style diffusion of responsibility: problems are acknowledged yet unsolved because the actions needed are blocked. The dog's calm expression models emotional numbing as a coping style, and the joke lets the viewer share frustration without needing to act on it.



Dice game screenshot: win at 1.01% chance, 98x payout

A crypto gambling interface showing a rare win. The psychology is variable-ratio reinforcement, the most habit-forming reward schedule (as in slot machines), combined with the near-miss effect and the gambler's fallacy. Displaying 'WIN!' in green with the profit figure triggers dopamine-linked reward anticipation, and the 'show verification info' link adds a veneer of fairness that builds trust. Sharing a win screenshot is also survivorship bias in miniature, since the thousands of losses are never shown.

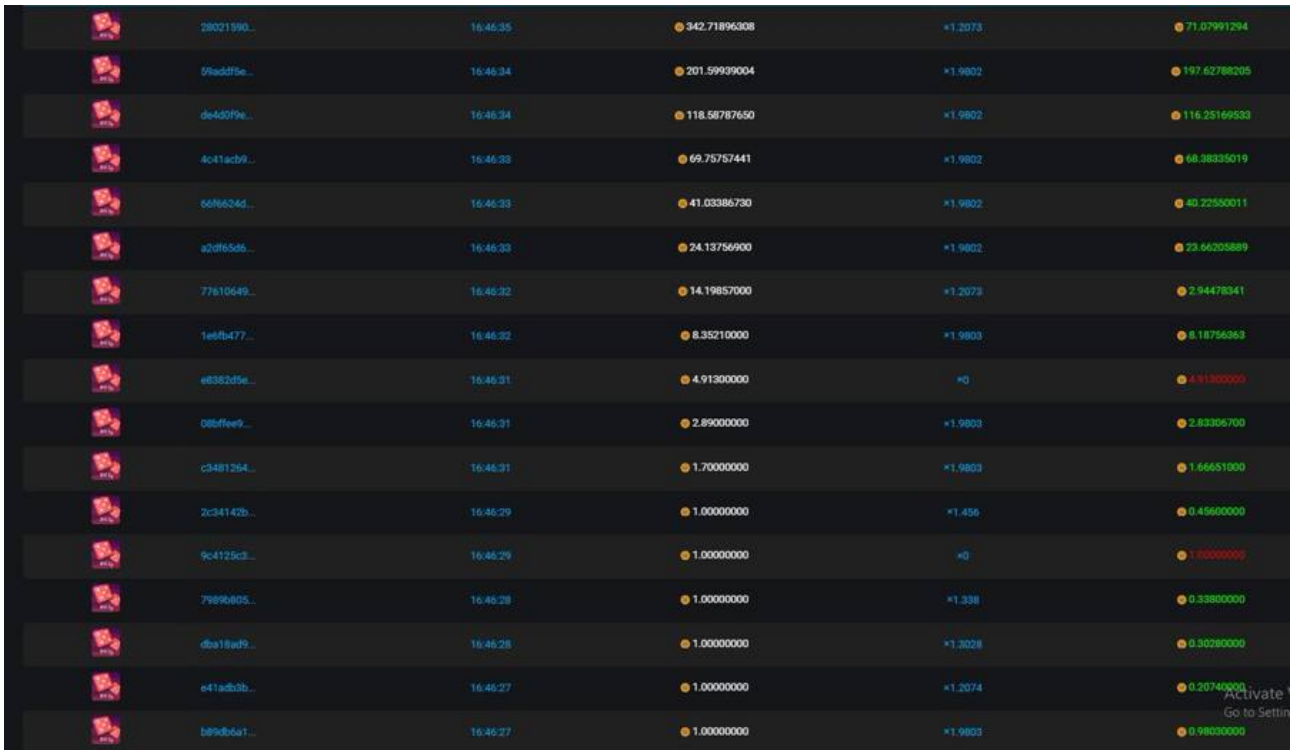
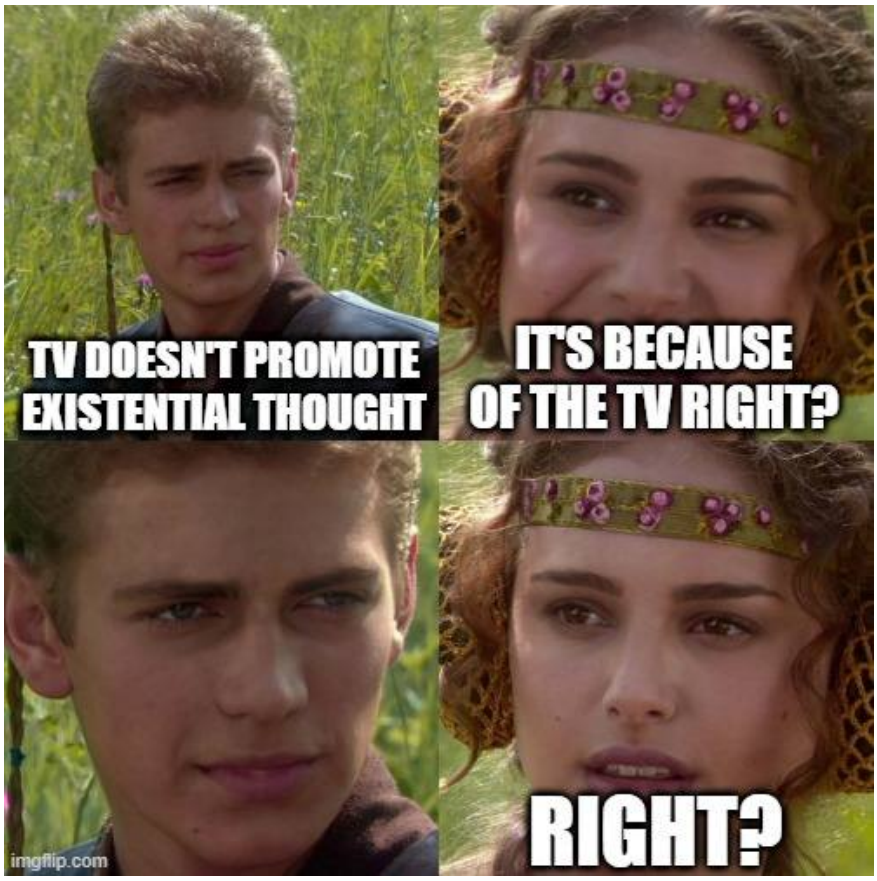


Table of rapid betting transactions

A live feed of bets in quick succession with green and red profit values. Live feeds exploit social proof (others are winning right now) and the sense of a living, active market. Rapid timestamps compress decision time, encouraging impulsive action over deliberation, and colour-coded gains and losses use loss aversion and the 'house money' effect. Seeing a stream of small outcomes also encourages 'illusion of pattern', the belief that sequences of random outcomes contain exploitable structure.



TV doesn't promote existential thought / It's because of the TV, right?

The 'For the better, right?' template, in which a character's hopeful question gets a silent, uneasy stare. The caption asks whether TV is the cause of shallow thinking. The psychology is causal attribution under uncertainty: we prefer a single external culprit to a complex set of causes. The meme also touches on media-effects theory (cultivation theory, which holds that heavy TV viewing shapes worldview) and dramatises the dawning discomfort when someone suspects the comforting answer is incomplete.

Correct mind-body solution / Strange ego artefacts in space / Collecting oneself

The 'Left Exit 12' drift meme depicts impulsive choice of the more exciting option over the sensible one. Here the sensible exit is a coherent mind-body solution, and the swerve goes toward speculative ego constructs. It describes novelty seeking and the pull of ideas that flatter the self, as well as the tension between integration (collecting oneself, a Jungian-flavoured idea of gathering a fragmented self) and grandiosity. The comic speed of the swerve shows how appealing cognitive shortcuts are when the careful route feels dull.

Get ready for some f*cking sh*t (OS console screenshot)

A home-built operating system running in a virtual machine, captioned with a hype line. This is a self-efficacy and flow image: building low-level software is a high-challenge, high-skill task that produces the pride of mastery. The loud caption works as anticipatory excitement, similar to hype culture around a reveal, and the screenshot signals competence to peers, a form of costly signalling. Sharing in-progress work also invites social validation, which strengthens commitment to a project (the IKEA effect, where effort increases perceived value).

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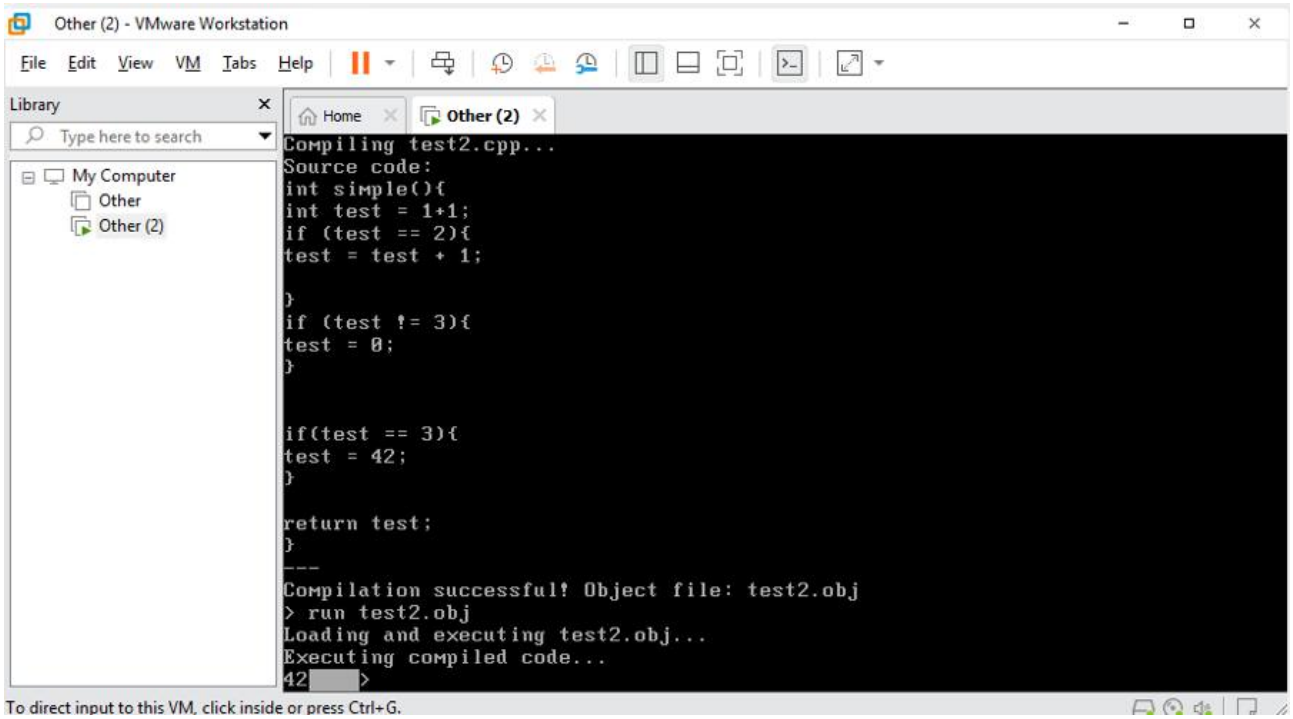
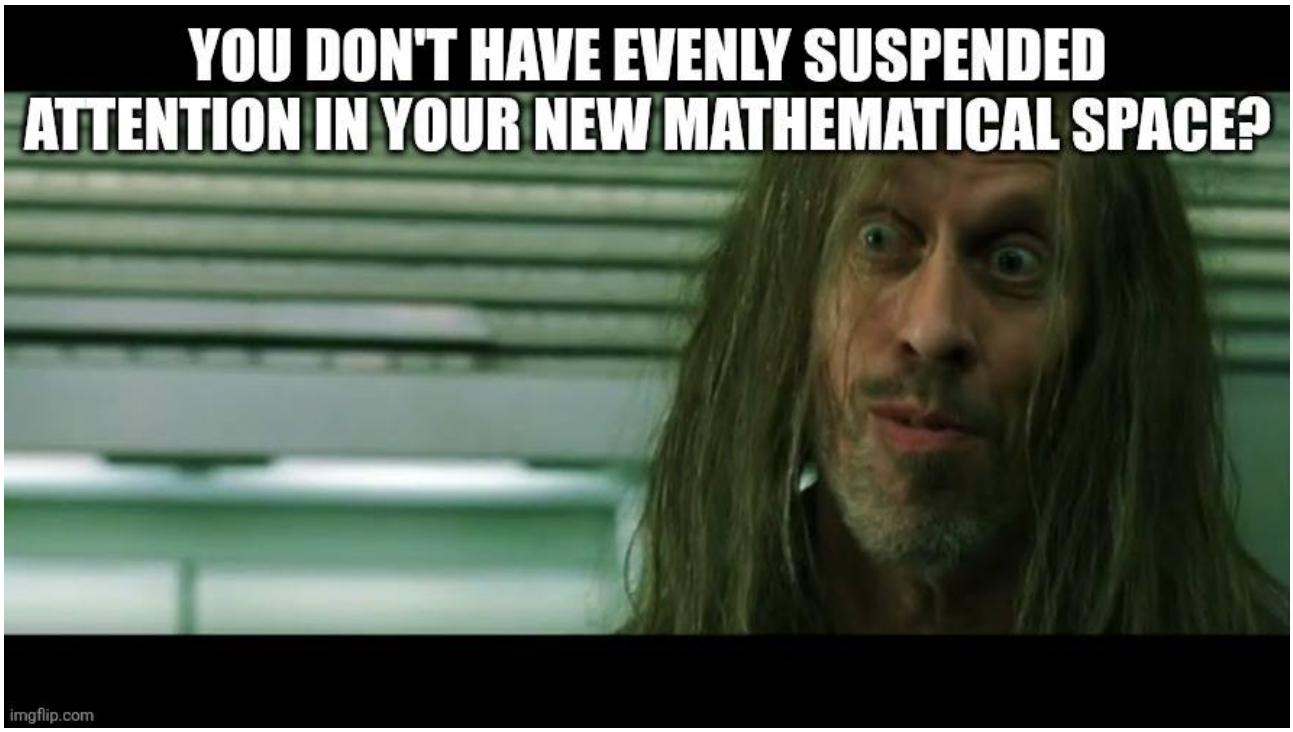


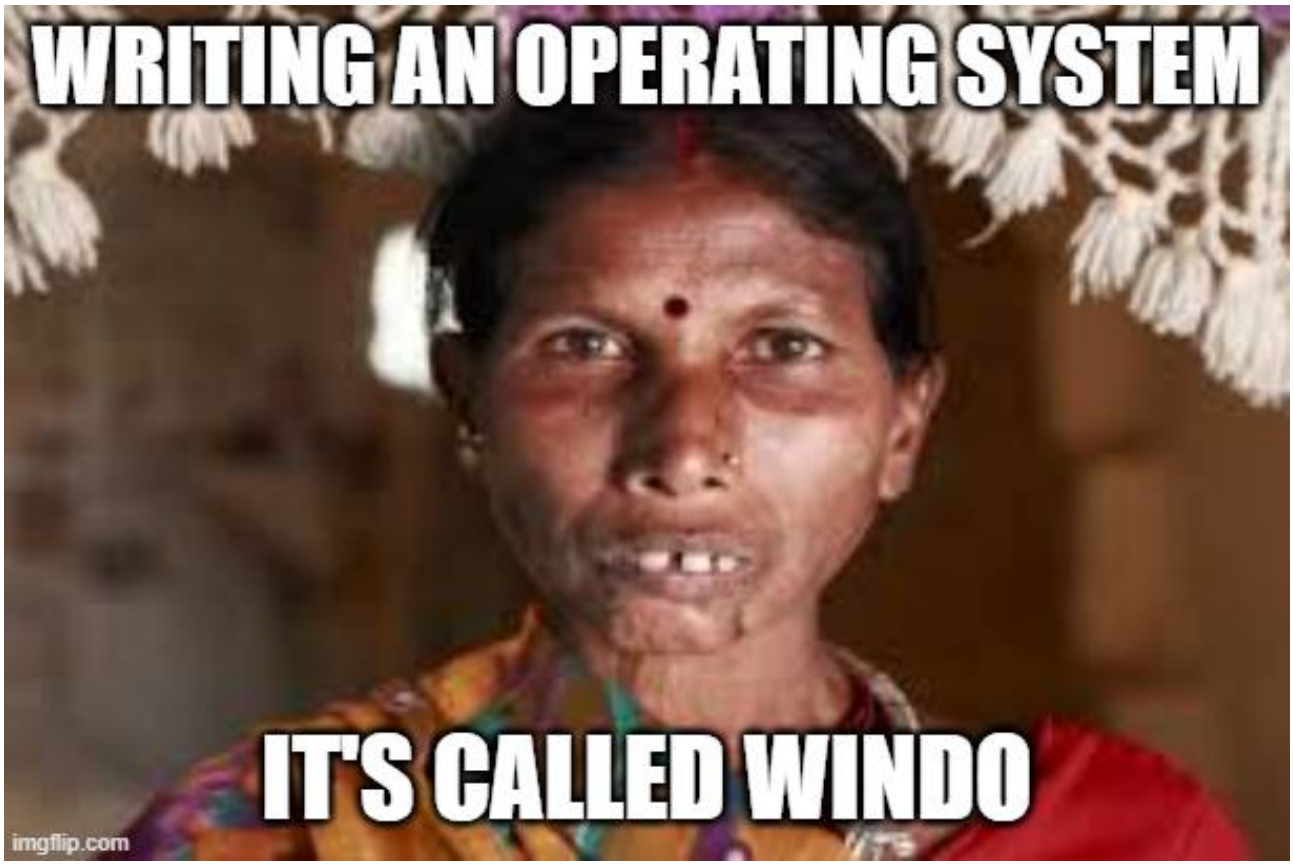
OS compile and run test: output 42

A successful compile-and-run in a custom kernel, ending with the output 42, a famous nod to The Hitchhiker's Guide. The psychology is reward from closure: seeing code finally do what it should provides a strong mastery moment. The in-joke number builds belonging within a subculture, since shared references signal membership. Showing the logic of the test (a chain of conditions ending in 42) also illustrates the satisfaction of an elegant puzzle and the sunk-cost investment that keeps builders going through long debugging.



You don't have evenly suspended attention in your new mathematical space?

A wide-eyed, intense character delivers a mocking question. 'Evenly suspended attention' is Freud's term for the analyst's open, non-selective listening. Applying it to a 'mathematical space' jokes about treating abstract thinking as a mental state to be trained. The wild-eyed face is a stereotype of obsessive insight, playing on the creativity-madness association. The meme shows how specialist jargon creates in-group humour and a mild superiority effect over those who do not share the vocabulary.



Writing an operating system / It's called Windo

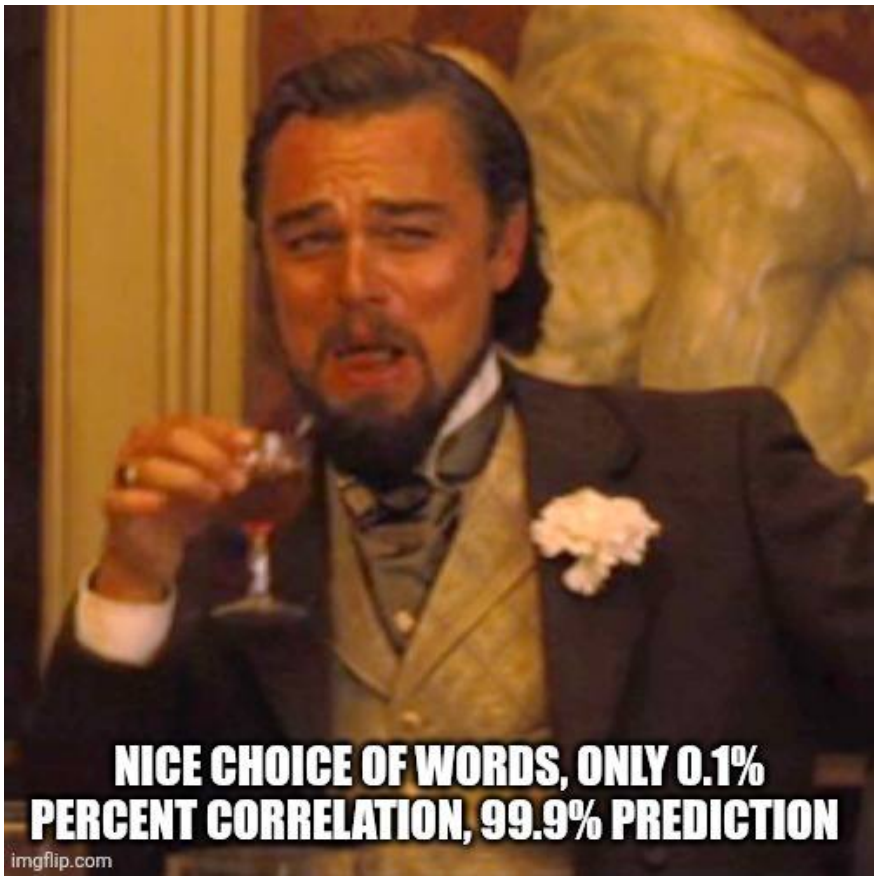
A deadpan portrait with a mispronounced product name. The joke uses the 'imposter in expert role' trope, where confident naïve naming undercuts a technical claim. It relies on incongruity and benign superiority humour, laughing at an implied lack of expertise. It can also be read as self-deprecation: people building something ambitious joke about their own rough edges to pre-empt criticism, a self-handicapping style of humour that reduces fear of failure.

The weaponised primitivism of egotistic sovereignty, prevalent with exotic technology

Apes with stones are captioned in dense academic language. The contrast between elevated vocabulary and primitive imagery is the joke, and it comments on how advanced tools amplify old instincts such as dominance, territoriality and status competition (evolutionary psychology's mismatch hypothesis). The grandiose phrasing also parodies jargon-heavy self-importance, a form of the Dunning-Kruger-flavoured confidence that long words can create.

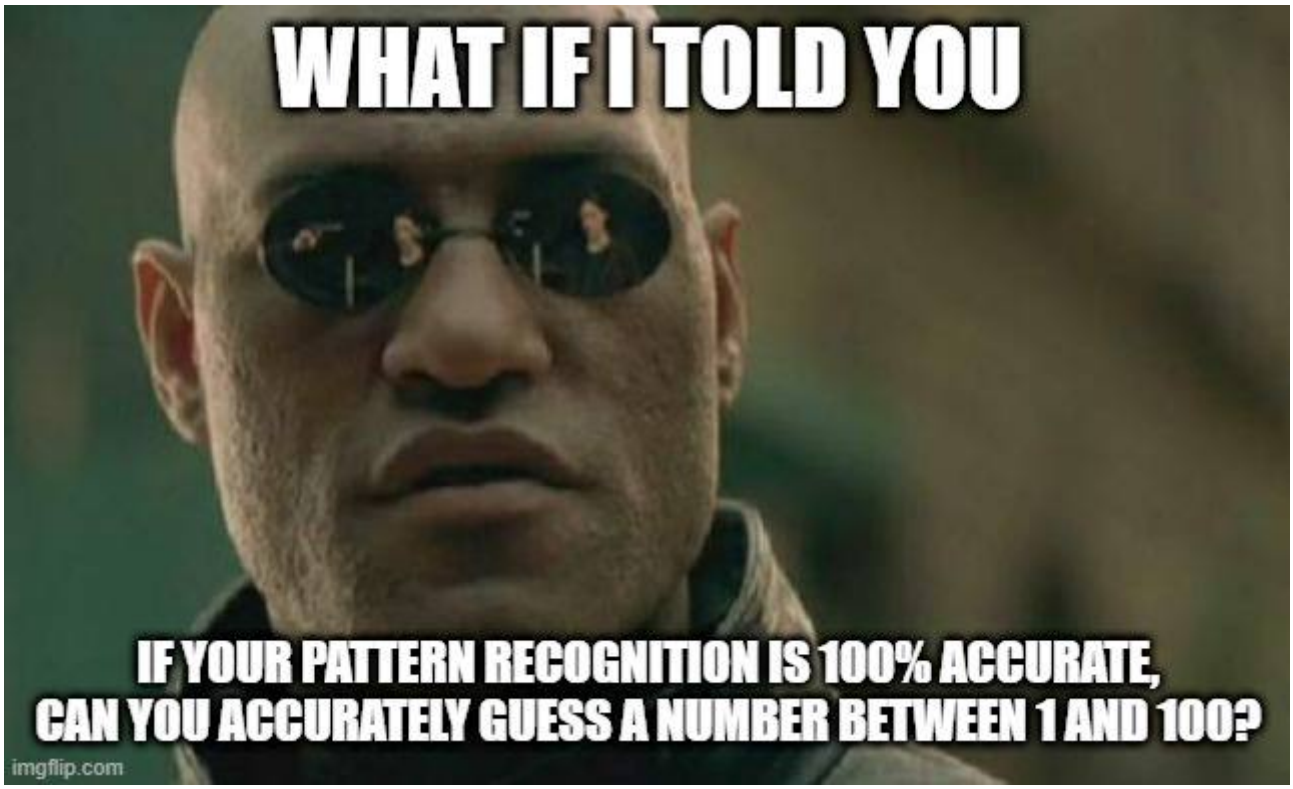
Catharsis Wafers

A fictional snack brand named after the idea of emotional release. Catharsis is the Aristotelian and psychoanalytic notion that expressing a feeling discharges it. The commercial format joke highlights how emotional relief gets marketed as a product. Research suggests venting does not reliably reduce anger and can sometimes rehearse it, so the 'wafer' ironically sells a folk-psychology belief. The bright candy aesthetic exploits the link between sweet foods and comfort.



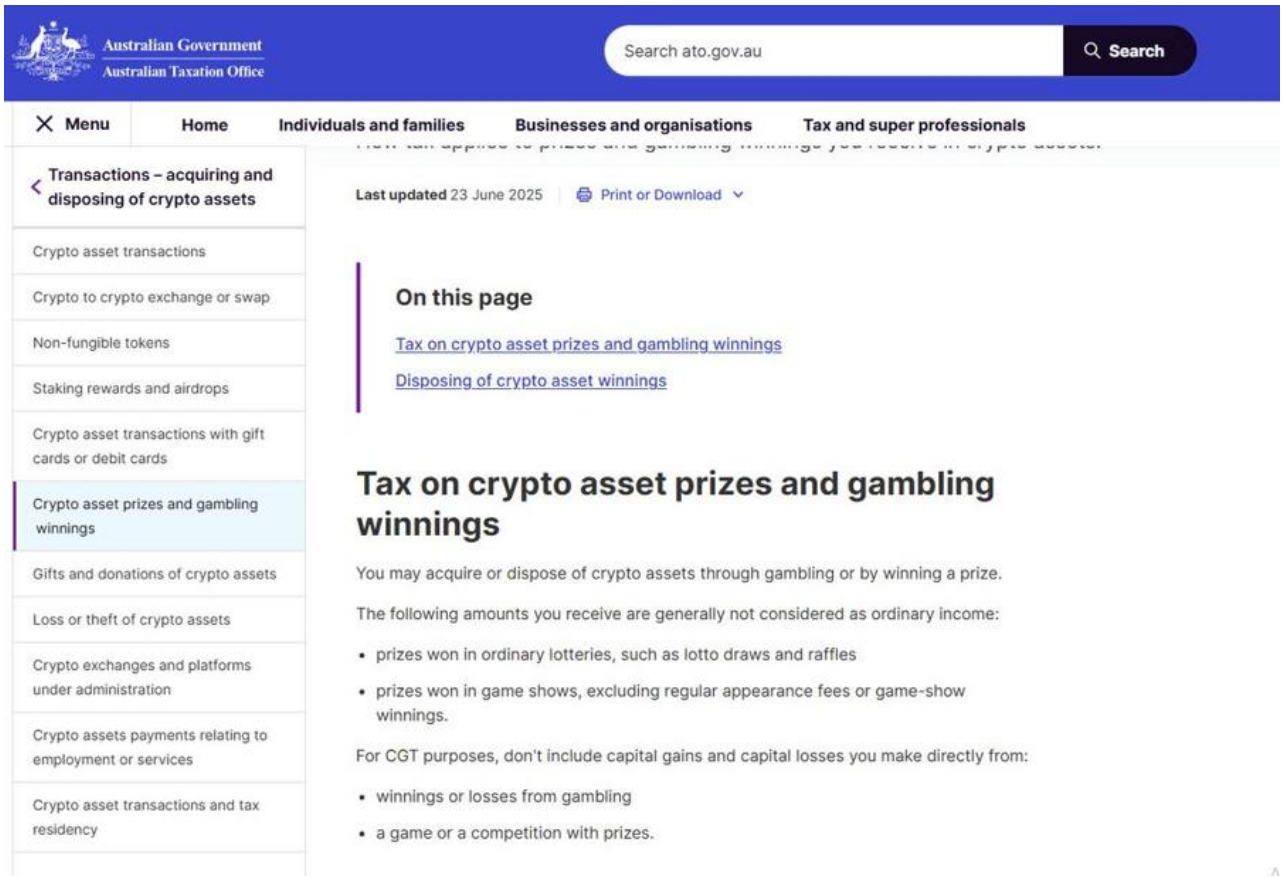
Nice choice of words, only 0.1% correlation, 99.9% prediction

The knowing, mocking sip of a wine glass signals smug amusement. The caption plays on statistics: a tiny correlation can still support high predictive accuracy depending on base rates, or alternatively mocks overconfident claims. The psychology covers base-rate neglect and illusion of validity (feeling certain about predictions from weak cues). The image shows a superiority smirk, which is how people signal they have seen through someone else's argument.



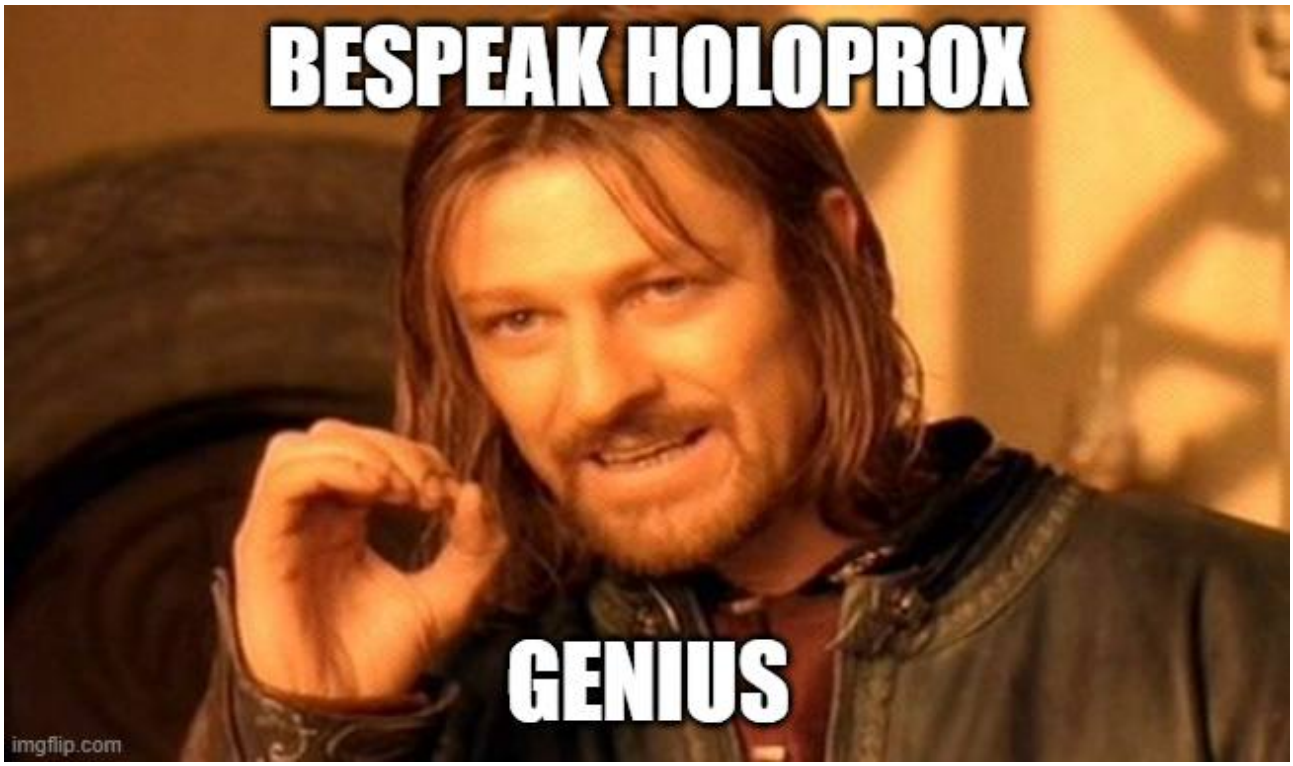
What if I told you your pattern recognition is 100% accurate, can you guess a number between 1 and 100?

The Morpheus 'What if I told you' template introduces a paradox. If human pattern recognition were perfect, guessing a random number would be trivial, yet it is not. The psychology is the human tendency to see patterns in randomness (apophenia and the clustering illusion), and the well-documented difficulty of generating random numbers; people choose 'random-feeling' numbers such as 37 or 73 far more often than chance. The format delivers the paradox as a revelation, producing the 'aha' of recognising your own bias.



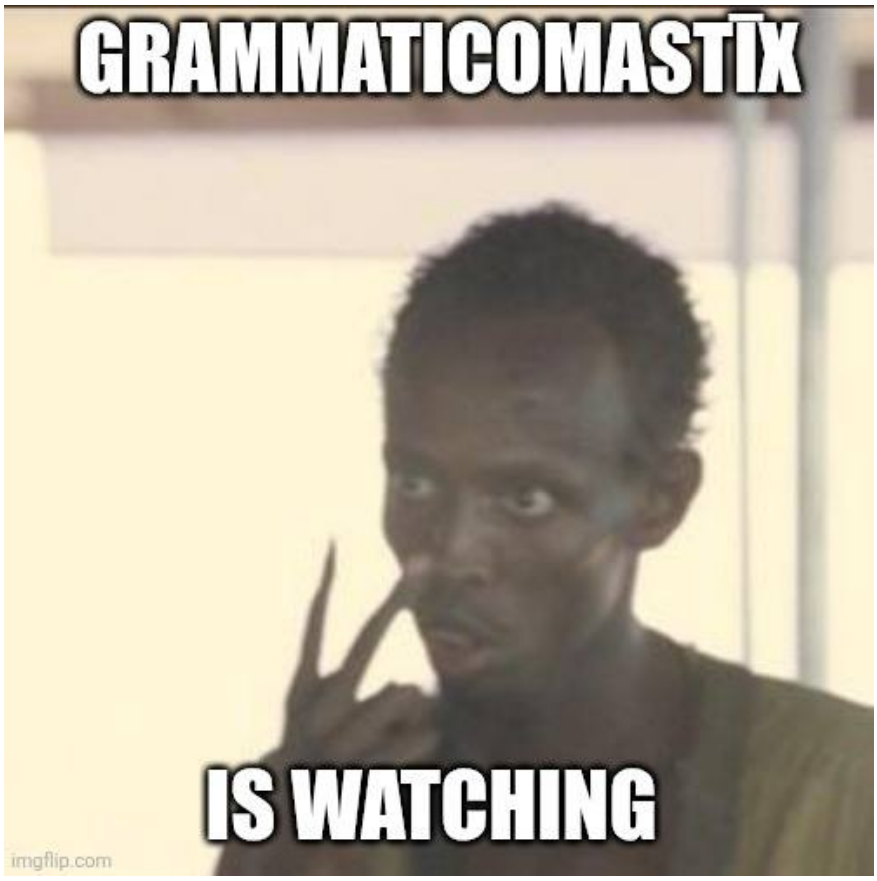
ATO page: tax on crypto prizes and gambling winnings

A plain government tax page, included without any joke. The psychology sits in the context: gambling and crypto activity paired with bureaucratic reality. It illustrates the 'mental accounting' habit of treating winnings as separate, free money, and the optimism bias that leads people to overlook tax obligations. Official formatting also carries heavy authority cues, which tend to end debate and make the content feel final.



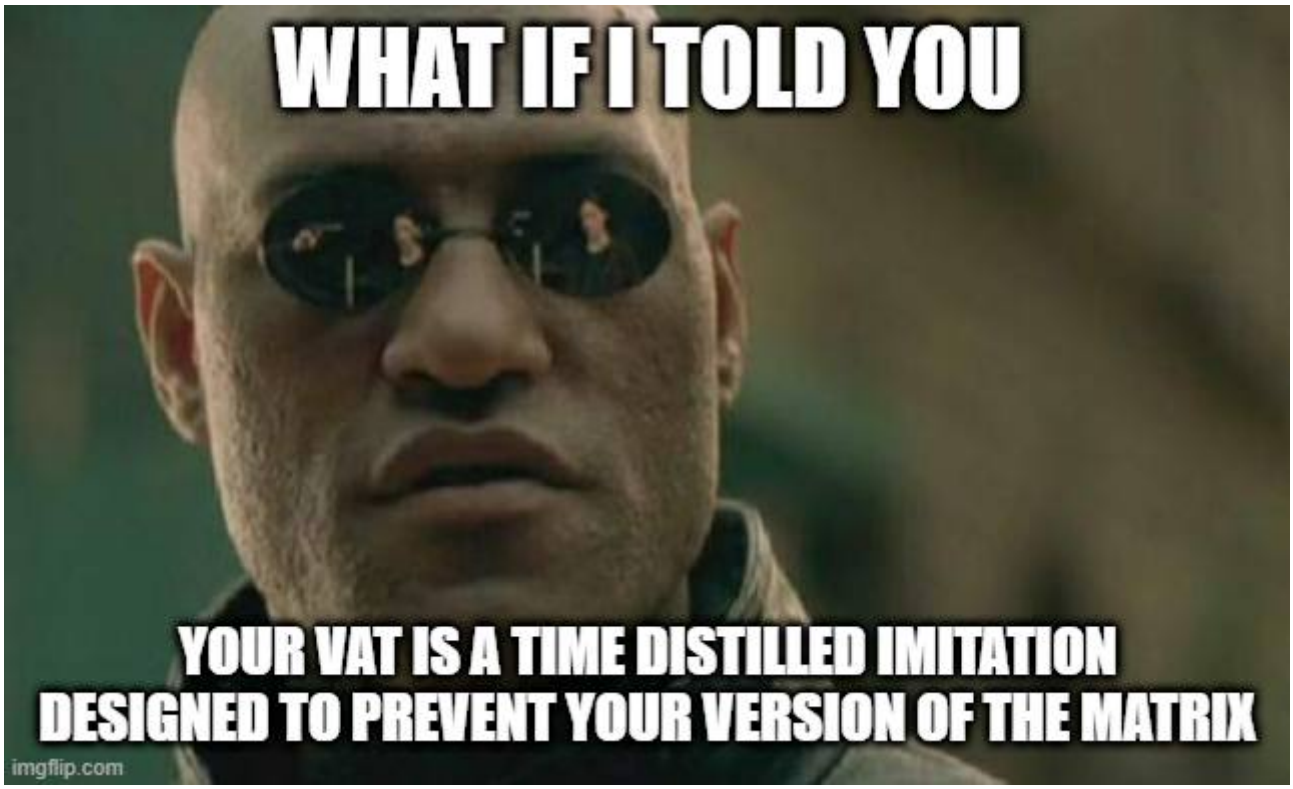
Bespeak Holoprox / Genius

The 'One does not simply' template is used with invented-sounding jargon. Coined terms trigger the 'pseudo-profundity' effect: research on bullshit receptivity shows people often rate vague, technical-sounding phrases as deep. The word 'genius' pairs with the self-congratulatory tone that accompanies private vocabulary, and the meme works as playful self-mockery of that habit. Neologisms also strengthen group identity, since only insiders know what is meant.



Grammaticomastix is watching

A portrait of a startled face with a made-up bogeyman name ('the grammar scourge', echoing the Greek for a whip). Humour comes from personifying a fear, here of being corrected, as a watching presence. It reflects evaluation apprehension and the spotlight effect: the feeling that others are scrutinising your errors far more than they do. Naming a vague anxiety turns it into something manageable and shareable, a coping mechanism called externalisation.

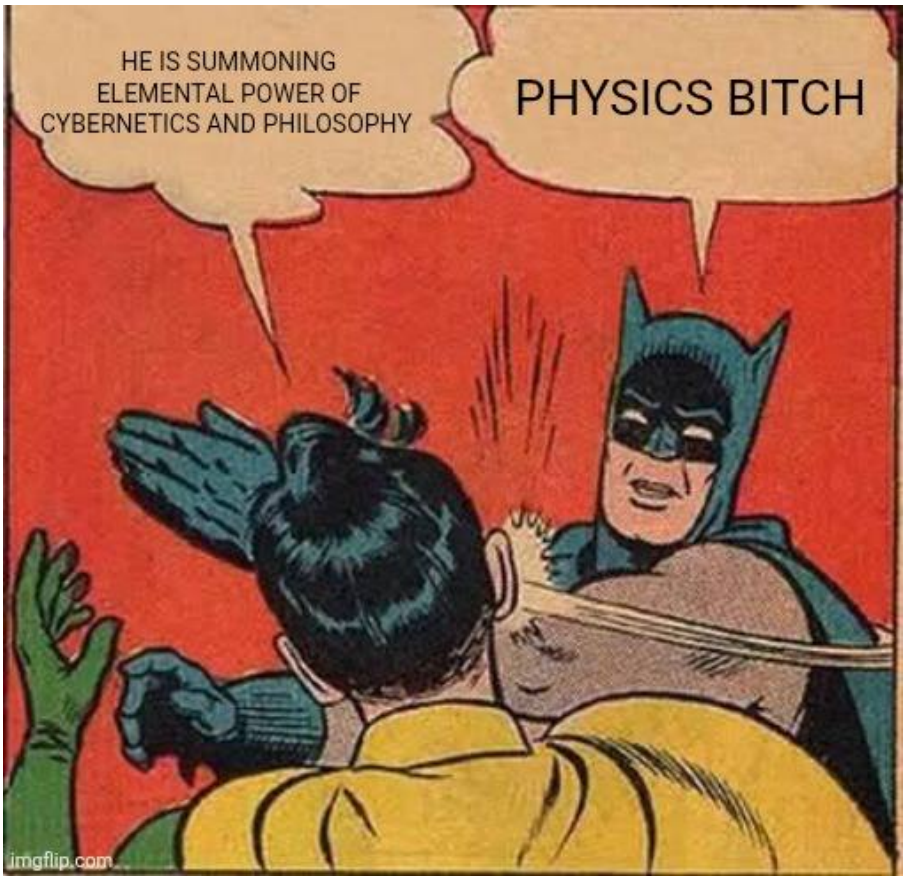


Your VAT is a time-distilled imitation designed to prevent your version of the Matrix

This uses the 'What if I told you' revelation format, which delivers a claim as if it were a hidden truth. The statement plays on simulation-style metaphors (a brain in a vat, a constructed reality) and claims a protective deception. Psychologically this resembles the appeal of conspiracy-style frames: they offer a single hidden explanation, restore a sense of control and make the believer feel specially informed. It is best read as an imaginative provocation instead of a factual claim; the format creates the sensation of insight without supplying evidence.

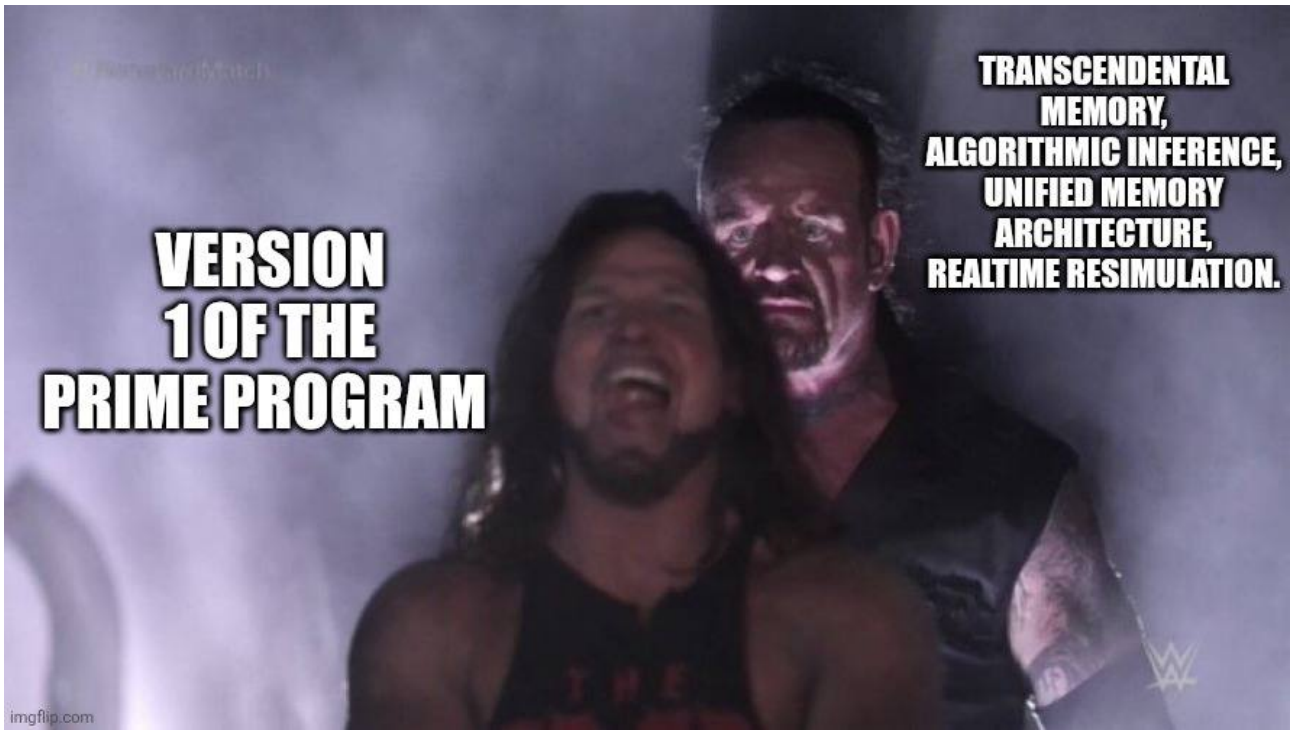
I am not supporting your sanity

The 'For the better, right?' template, here with the anxious character refusing to affirm the other's hopeful stance. This captures boundary-setting and the refusal of co-rumination or collusion: choosing not to validate a belief or behaviour. In interpersonal psychology, constant validation can reinforce unhelpful patterns, so withholding it is a form of honesty. The comedy is the blunt phrasing of something normally said gently.



He is summoning elemental power of cybernetics and philosophy / Physics b*tch

In the 'Batman slaps Robin' meme, the slapped speaker makes a grand mystical claim and is cut off with a blunt rebuttal. It stages the conflict between speculative, grandiose framing and empirical grounding. The psychology is belief perseverance versus reality testing, and the slap represents a corrective social signal. Interdisciplinary enthusiasm often leads to overreach, and humour from a trusted peer is a gentle way to bring someone back to testable ground.



Version 1 of the prime program / transcendental memory, algorithmic inference, unified memory architecture, realtime resimulation

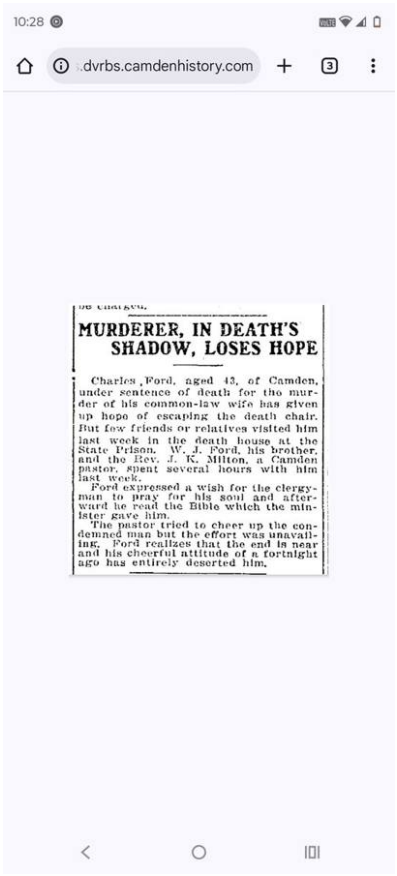
A wrestler laughs while a looming figure behind him lists lofty terms, the 'tag-team' format of a big reveal. The caption presents a personal project in grand architectural language. This reflects self-enhancement and grandiose framing in how people describe their own work, which can motivate ambitious building but can also inflate claims beyond what has been demonstrated. The dramatic pairing of a cheerful front with a dark, powerful presence suggests the sense of something large operating behind the scenes.

Interface 0-dimensional psychology / with cat videos, right?

The 'For the better, right?' template again, here with an abstract psychological theory followed by a mundane tag. Pairing something abstract with cat videos is a classic incongruity joke and reflects how internet attention gets split between deep ideas and low-effort rewards. The anxious final panel shows the dawning recognition that the combination might not be healthy: it points at hedonic distraction and the pull of easy dopamine against sustained thought.

Man drawing with a barbell stuck through his shoulder

A man at a drafting table has a loaded barbell lodged through his torso and carries on drawing. The image is a visual metaphor for pushing through pain and distraction while focused, and for absurd single-mindedness. It evokes the flow state, where attention narrows enough to suppress pain signals, and the sunk-cost grind of commitment. It also invites thought on how obsessive focus can hide real damage, a theme in burnout and workaholism research.



Old newspaper: 'Murderer, in death's shadow, loses hope'

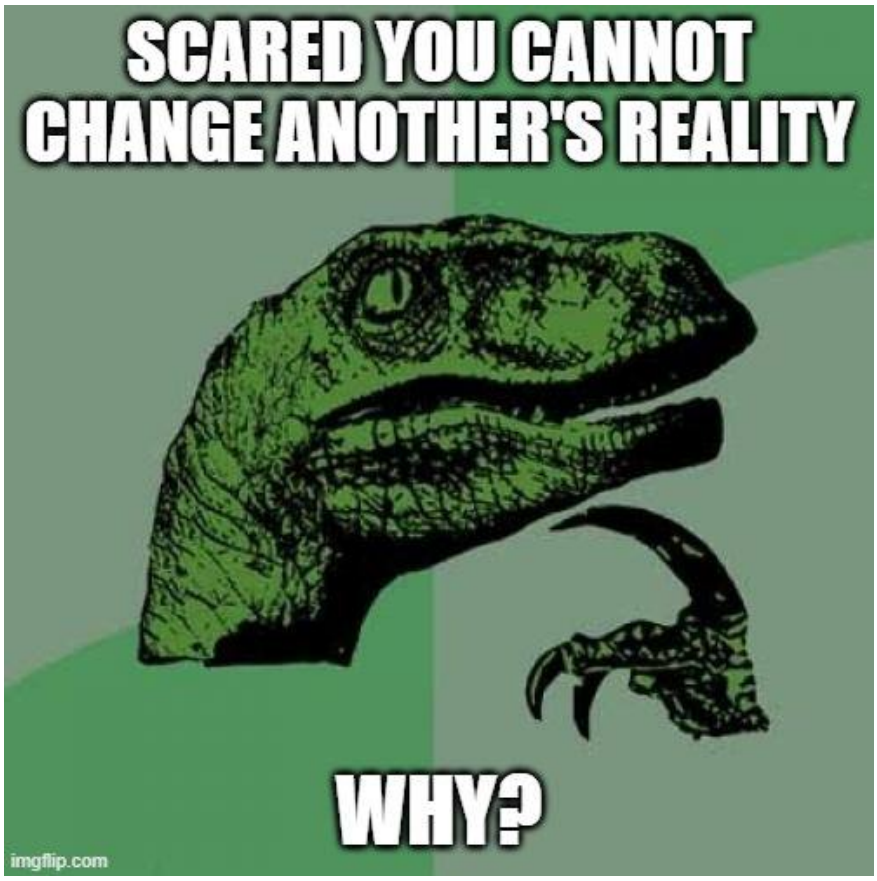
A 1900s clipping about a condemned man whose spirits sink as execution nears. The psychology is anticipatory dread and the loss of hope, studied as 'death row syndrome' and in research on learned helplessness. The clipping shows how institutions and the press once framed despair morally, and how a clergyman's visit tries to supply meaning, which echoes terror management theory: people turn to religion and ritual to buffer the knowledge of death.

Foul demons and beasts / Rastered semantics

The 'Scooby-Doo unmasking' format reveals a mundane culprit behind a monster. The caption argues that frightening supernatural entities are really a technical artefact ('rastered semantics', meaning meaning constructed from pixel-like grids). This is the debunking impulse: replacing agent-based explanations with mechanistic ones. Psychologically it relates to hyperactive agency detection, the human tendency to see minds and monsters behind ambiguous patterns, which the unmasking calms by restoring a naturalistic frame.

To-do list: nuke current computer, buy new phone, change 10-year-old passwords

The 'Patrick's to-do list' template lists reactive security chores. The psychology is the cycle of security complacency followed by sudden, drastic action, driven by the present-bias that makes us put off dull maintenance until a scare arrives. It also shows catastrophising responses (nuking a machine) and the sense of violation after a perceived breach. Writing it as a list gives a calming sense of control.



Scared you cannot change another's reality? Why?

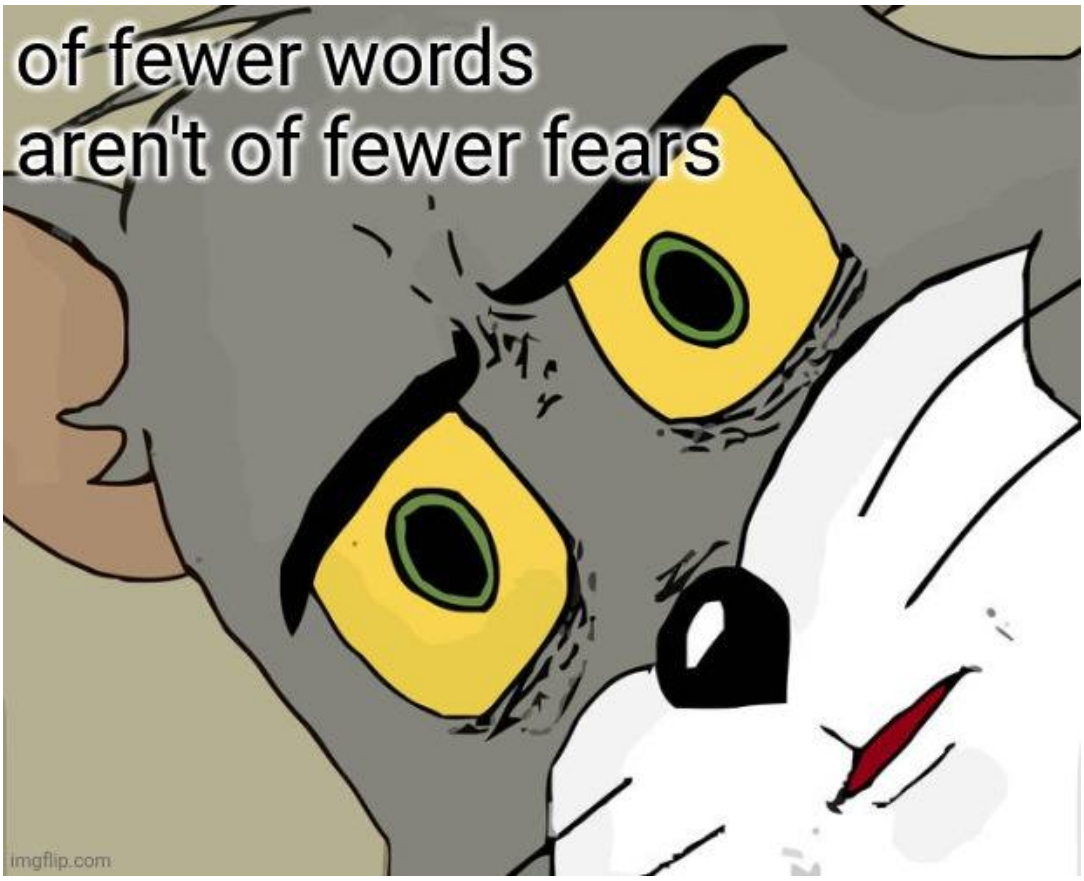
The 'Philosoposaurus' meme poses a question as profound musing. The claim touches the illusion of control and the need for others to share our worldview: fear of not being able to alter another person's beliefs or perceptions. In psychology this links to reactance, because people resist persuasion that threatens autonomy, and to the limits of empathy and theory of mind. The format's mock-wise tone gently questions whether the fear is warranted.

E-Safety Commission and mental health services complaining about 0.00000000000001% of the internet

The 'calculating lady' meme shows confusion at maths. The caption claims agencies fixate on a tiny fraction of content. This is a base-rate and availability argument: vivid, rare harms get disproportionate attention, and the salient cases drive policy more than overall prevalence. It also expresses a sense of institutional overreach, a reactance-driven sentiment. Whether the figure is meaningful depends on how harm is measured, since small fractions of a vast total can still affect many people.

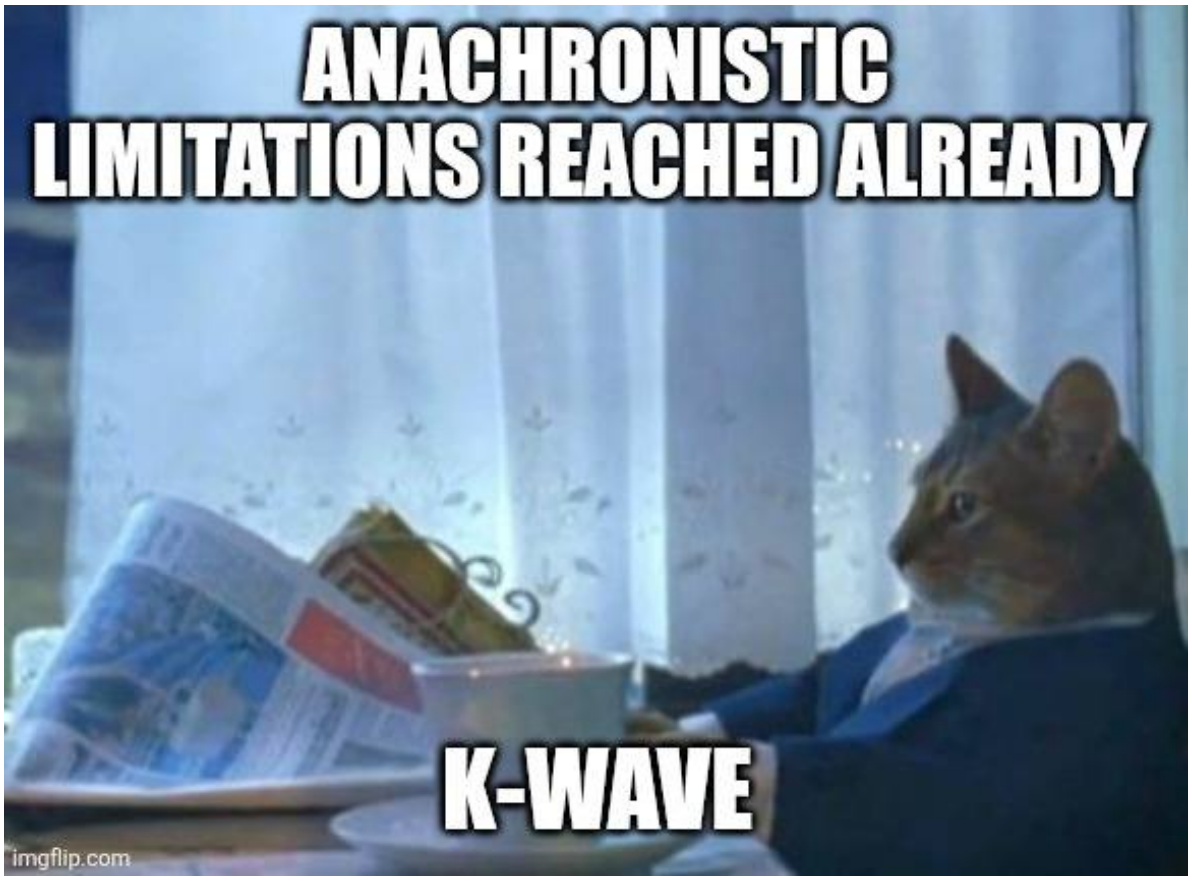
All I am offering is the software, nothing more

The red pill and blue pill hands from The Matrix, recast with a soft sell. Offering a choice with only two options is a framing trick (a false dichotomy) and 'nothing more' downplays the stakes, a foot-in-the-door tactic. It plays with the appeal of being given a choice at all, which increases perceived autonomy and so reduces resistance. The line also jokes about how tools are marketed as neutral while carrying large implications.



Of fewer words aren't of fewer fears

The 'Unsettled Tom' cat stares in anxious unease. The text suggests that people who say less are not necessarily less afraid. This challenges the assumption that quietness equals calm and relates to emotional suppression: bottling feelings reduces expression but not physiological arousal. Research on expressive suppression shows it can raise stress, even when the person appears composed. Tom's wide eyes show the hidden anxiety beneath a quiet exterior.



Anachronistic limitations reached already / K-wave

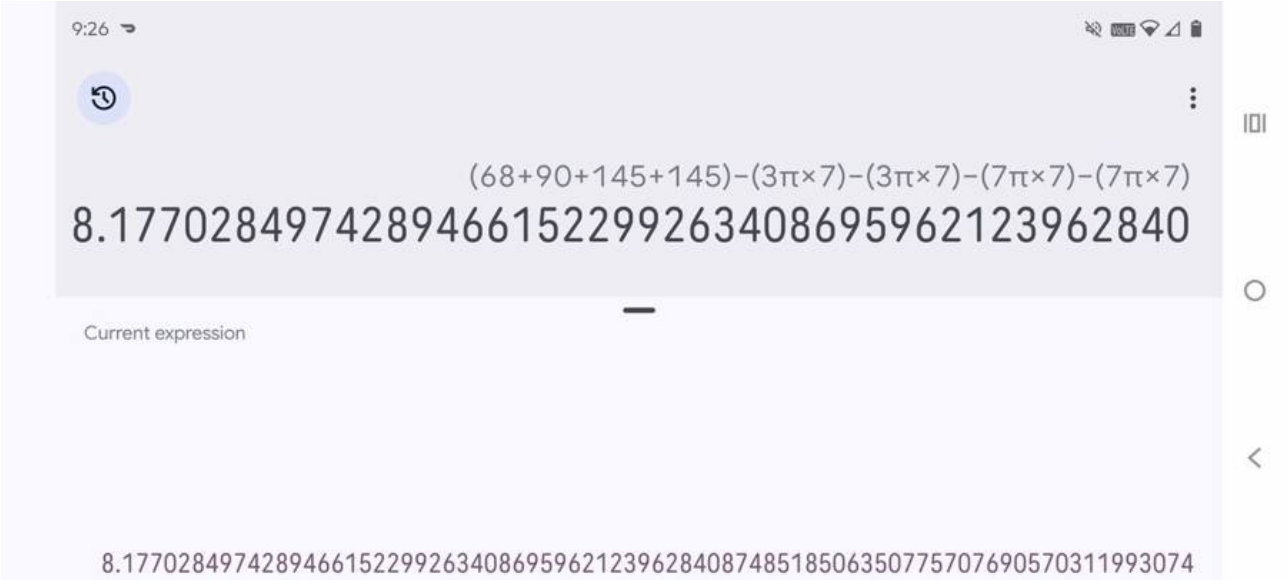
The 'I should buy a boat' cat reads a newspaper with dry satisfaction. 'K-wave' refers to Kondratiev waves, long economic cycles of roughly 50 years. The joke is about forecasting fatigue and the feeling that historical patterns are repeating. Seeing cycles can give a comforting sense of predictability, but it also invites confirmation bias, since people fit past data to cycles after the fact. The cat's calm posture shows the detached, knowing stance of someone who believes they have already seen the pattern.

To-do list: restart mentality every time <bos> appears

A to-do list with a token from language-model text ('<bos>', beginning of sequence). The joke reframes human thinking as a reset procedure: every time a new context begins, start fresh. In psychology this resembles cognitive reappraisal and mindfulness-based resets, but also mocks the idea of treating the mind like a machine. It speaks to the desire to avoid carrying over rumination and to cleanly separate new episodes from old ones.

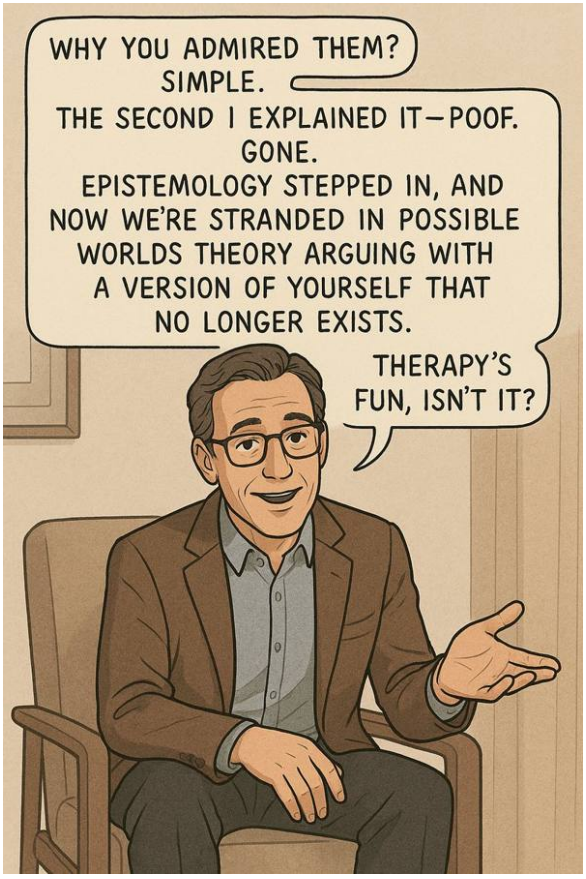
To-do list: make words wider, fill in steps

Another to-do list, reading like a note to self about expanding vocabulary and elaborating reasoning. The psychology is metacognition: planning how to improve one's own communication. 'Filling in steps' addresses the curse of knowledge, where experts skip intermediate steps that listeners need. Writing the intention as a list uses implementation intentions, which research shows improve follow-through compared with vague goals.



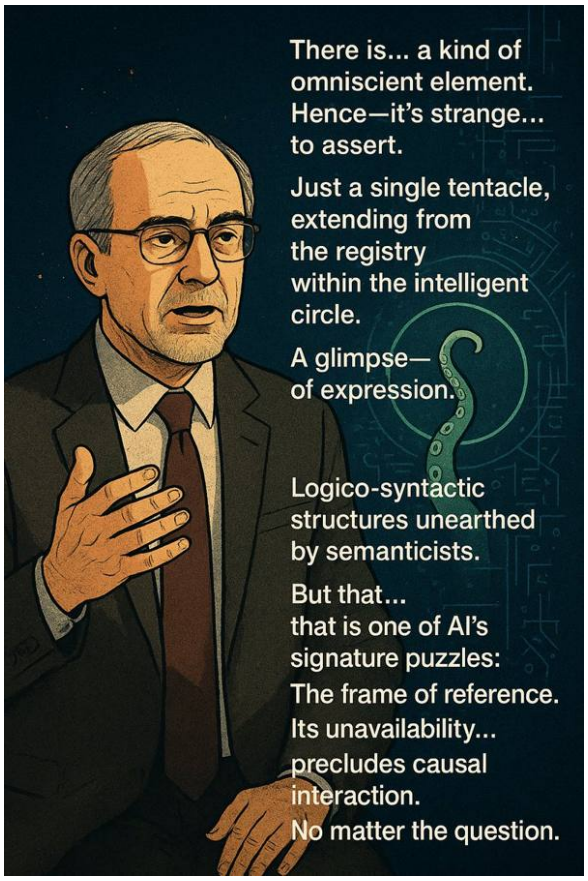
Calculator: (68+90+145+145) − (3π×7) − (3π×7) − (7π×7) − (7π×7) = 8.1770…

A phone-calculator screenshot showing a long expression and a long decimal. The psychology is numerical pattern-seeking: people choose or construct numbers whose digits seem meaningful. Long decimals invite numerology and apophenia, the sense that the arrangement of digits is significant. Performing the calculation also gives satisfying certainty, because numeric answers feel objective and final, which makes them persuasive anchors in an argument.



Why you admired them? The second I explained it, poof. Gone. Therapy's fun, isn't it?

A cartoon therapist describes how explaining something removes its mystique, so epistemology and possible-worlds reasoning leave you arguing with a self that no longer exists. This is the psychology of disenchantment and idealisation: admiration often rests on not understanding, and analysis dissolves it. It also touches self-concept change, where insight makes the old self feel like a stranger, and the discomfort of intellectualisation, a defence mechanism in which abstract reasoning substitutes for feeling. The closing quip uses humour as a gentle defence against that discomfort.

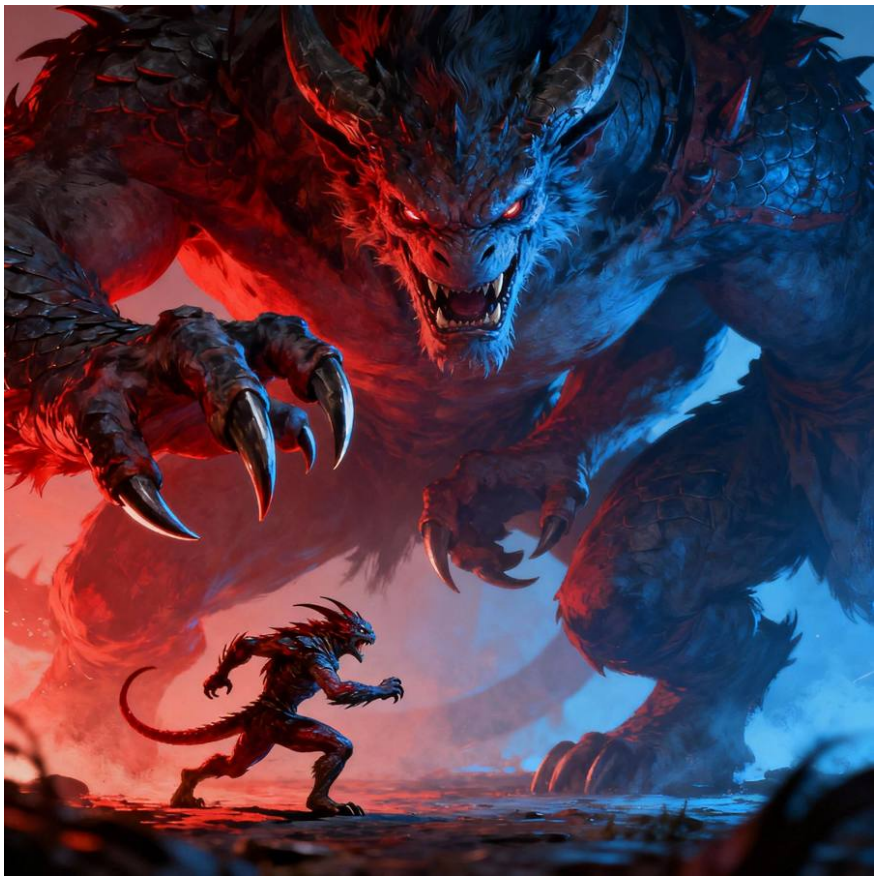


There is a kind of omniscient element... a single tentacle... AI's signature puzzles

A suited man speaks in fragmented, poetic phrases beside a tentacle motif. The text mixes logic, semantics and AI into an ominous, half-glimpsed vision. Psychologically it works through the uncanny and the cosmic-horror mood: partial reveals of something vast create more unease than full description, and ambiguity invites the audience to project meaning (the Rorschach effect). Technical vocabulary adds authority, while the broken sentence rhythm imitates dramatic pauses in a lecture, which slows reading and increases perceived weight.

Pill-bottle label: 'You are laughing because they are watching...'

The label on a prescription-style bottle is addressed to a worried-looking cartoon mother and describes laughing as a sign that others are watching, that people investigating you are being given naive answers, and that someone is 'in control'. This is a self-referential, suspicious frame in which ordinary behaviour (laughing) is read as evidence of being observed or set up. Clinical psychology calls this style ideas of reference or persecutory attribution: it is unfalsifiable, because any behaviour can be reinterpreted as proof. As a meme about medication, the joke is that the 'treatment' is itself the story. If thoughts like these ever feel real or distressing rather than playful, talking with a clinician or someone you trust is worthwhile.



Small red creature facing a giant horned beast

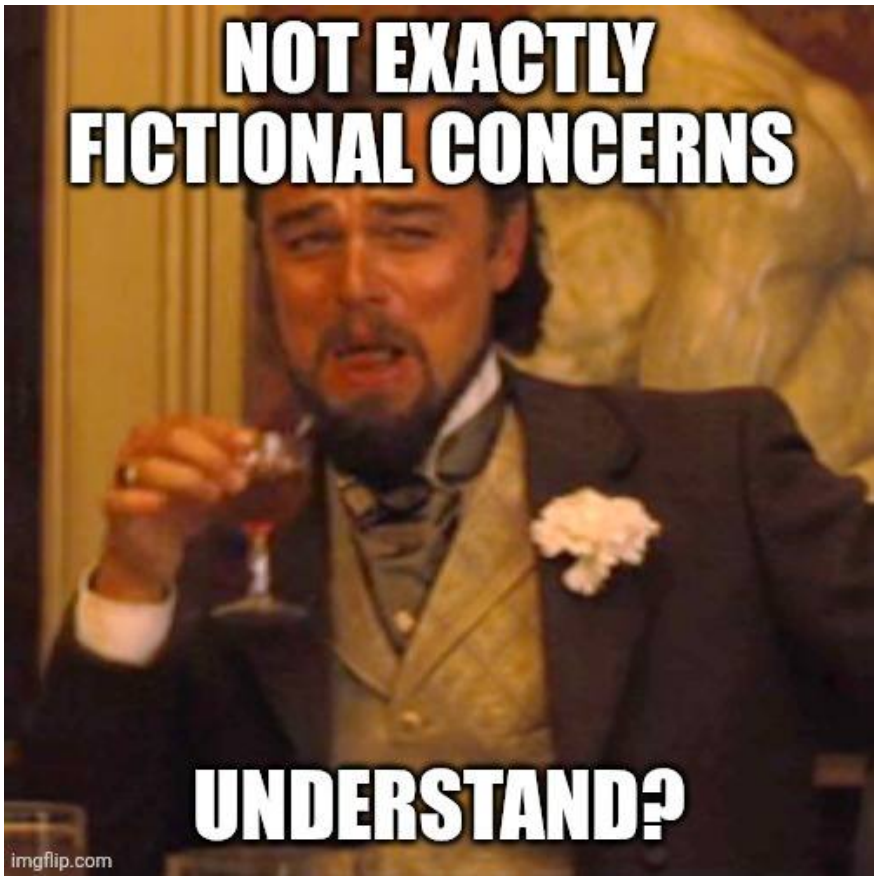
A tiny dragon-like figure squares up to a looming monster under red and blue light. The image is a classic depiction of the 'David and Goliath' struggle and the confrontation with the Shadow, the Jungian term for the disowned, frightening parts of the self. The small figure's stance suggests courage in the face of overwhelming odds, which relates to self-efficacy beliefs. The red-blue lighting heightens the emotional contrast between threat and defiance.

Link with a sword and a lightbulb, fighting ghoulish shapes

In three panels, a hero holds a sword, then raises a lightbulb that reveals lurking ghouls, then fights them. The sequence turns insight into action: seeing the monsters comes before facing them. This reflects the psychology of exposure and awareness; many fears persist while unexamined, and illumination (insight) is the first step in therapies that build on it. The lightbulb also references the 'aha' experience, and the contrast between sword and light represents effort versus understanding.

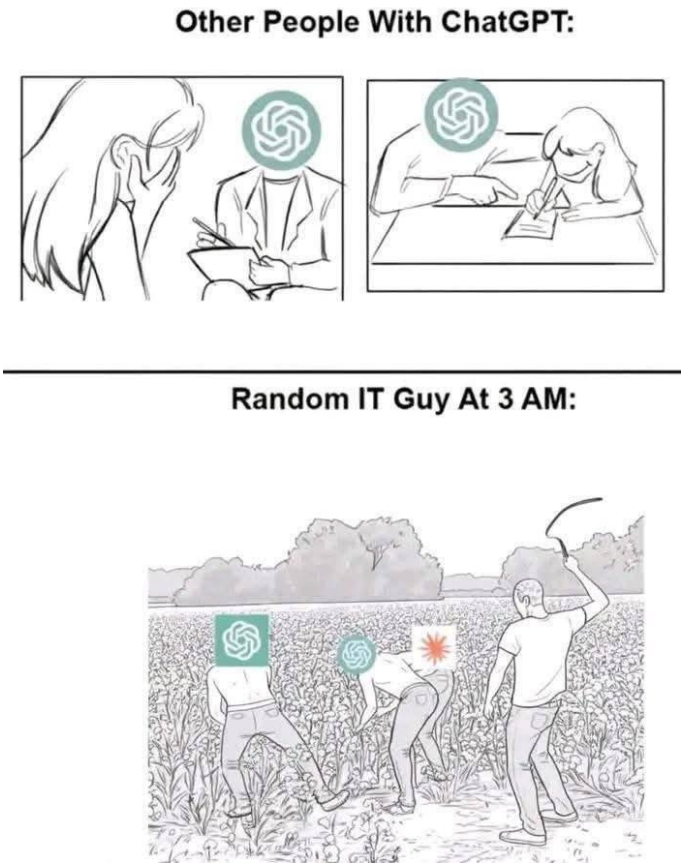
0 days without fighting over cookie mush / miscellaneous espionage

The 'days without an accident' sign is edited with petty conflict and spying. The joke compresses trivial conflicts (cookie mush) with grand paranoia (espionage), which satirises how small irritations are inflated into dramatic narratives. It reflects hostile attribution bias and the drama of ordinary rivalry. The counter showing zero conveys chronic repetition, a hint of learned patterns of conflict that continue because they are rewarding in some way, even if only for attention.



Not exactly fictional concerns. Understand?

The 'Laughing Leo' meme shows smug amusement at someone else's argument. The caption insists that concerns are real, implying that dismissing them as fiction is an error. This relates to validation-seeking and to the difference between fear that is grounded in evidence and fear that is not. The smirking pose signals confidence and superiority, which can be a way of hiding vulnerability when a worry is serious.

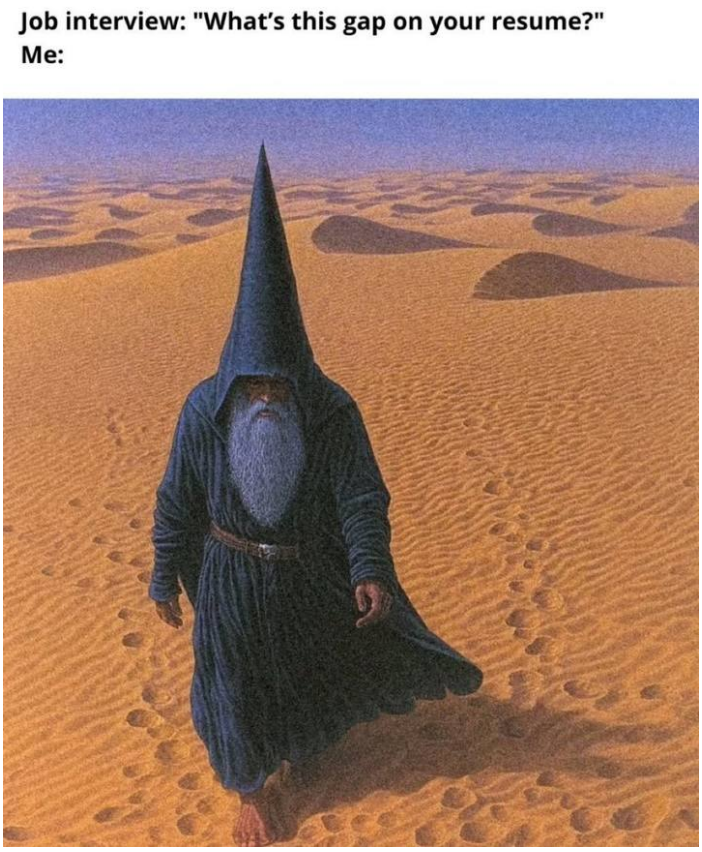


Other people with ChatGPT / Random IT guy at 3 AM

A two-part comparison: other people use ChatGPT for therapy-like conversation and homework, while the 'IT guy at 3 AM' is shown in an absurd, punishing scene. The psychology is social comparison: the creator contrasts a socially approved, gentle use with their own grinding, odd use. The exaggeration is a self-deprecating humour style that frames late-night obsessive tinkering as a kind of self-inflicted punishment, and it raises questions about work-life boundaries and sleep deprivation.

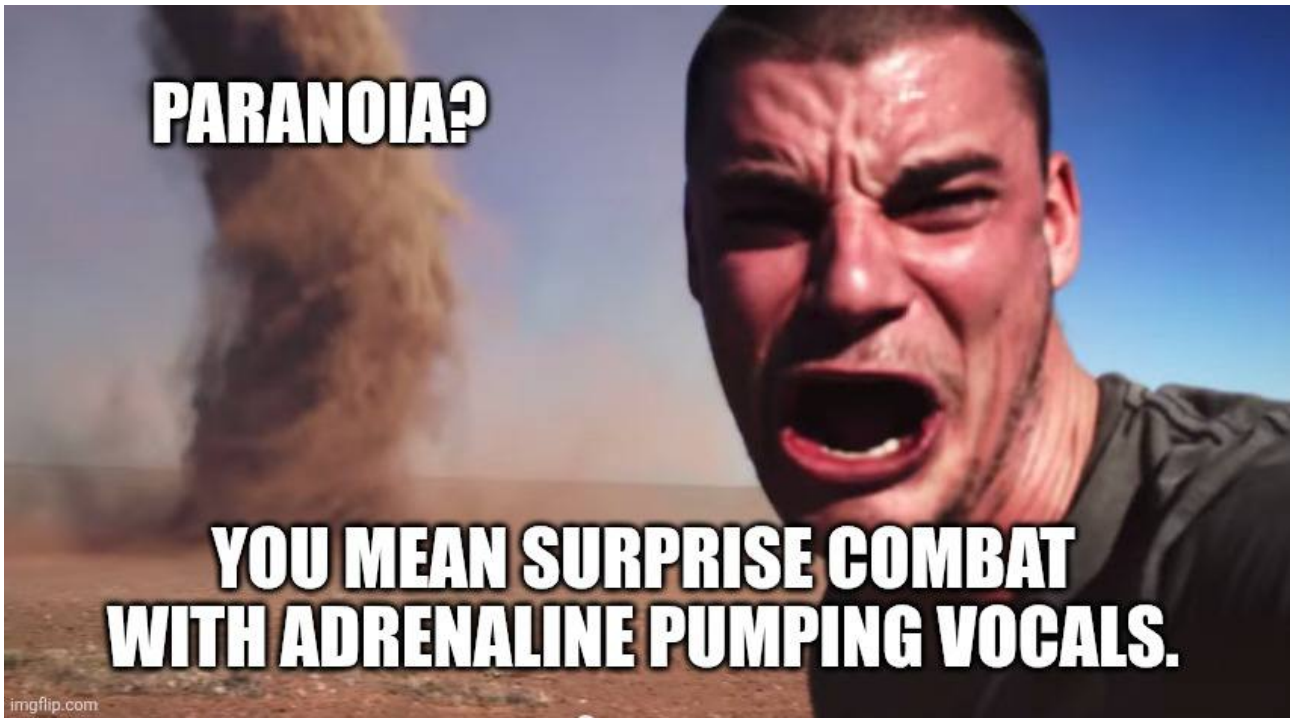
Make a lot of money, help a lot of people, have a lot of fun

Hand-lettered red text on a napkin states a three-part life goal. The psychology is goal-setting: short, concrete, positively framed goals are easier to remember and act on. The three parts map to extrinsic reward (money), prosocial motivation (helping) and intrinsic enjoyment (fun), which self-determination theory suggests together support wellbeing. The napkin format makes it feel like an authentic spontaneous plan, a trust cue.



Job interview: 'What's this gap on your resume?' Me: [wizard in the desert]

A robed wizard walks alone through dunes. The joke is about stigma and the awkwardness of explaining a period of unstructured time by implying an epic journey. It reflects impression management: how people frame gaps to protect their self-image under evaluation. The wizard's solitude also suggests a retreat-and-return pattern, a theme in the hero's journey, where withdrawal precedes transformation.



Paranoia? You mean surprise combat with adrenaline-pumping vocals

A man screams at an approaching tornado while the caption redefines paranoia as a thrilling fight. This is cognitive reframing through humour, turning fear into excitement. The physiology of fear and excitement overlaps (raised heart rate, adrenaline), and research on reappraisal shows that relabelling arousal as excitement can improve performance. The joke also hints at the risk of enjoying vigilance for its own sake, because hypervigilance can feel energising even while it drains.

Eat a Halloween candy in old age and misrecognise a philosophical starter pack as the Halloween spirit

The 'For the better, right?' template again, with a convoluted caption about mistaking a sugar rush for a spiritual experience. It relates to misattribution of arousal: people label bodily sensations with whatever explanation is nearby, as shown in classic emotion experiments. Nostalgia for childhood rituals is also a strong source of meaning, and the final worried stare indicates the realisation that a feeling of significance may come from biology, not philosophy.

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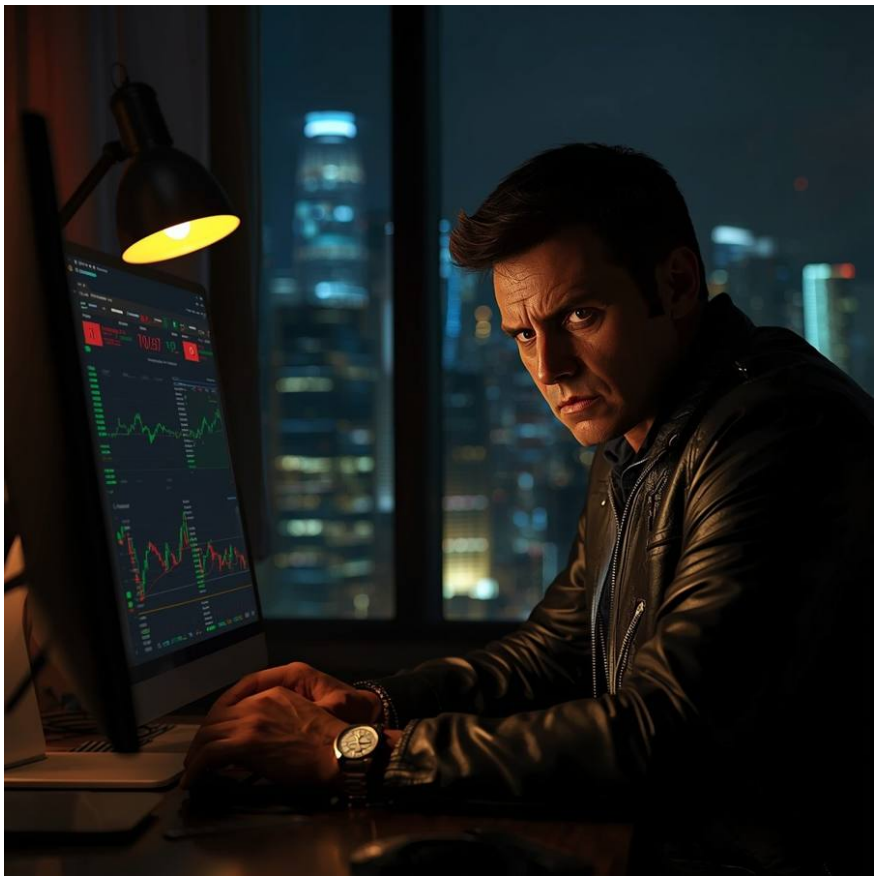

Man in leather jacket at a trading screen at night

A tense man watches candlestick charts in a dark city apartment. The image captures the psychology of trading: loss aversion, overconfidence and the thrill of risk, with nighttime isolation heightening focus and stress. The lighting suggests noir drama and portrays trading as heroic, which is a form of narrative framing. Constant monitoring also relates to FOMO and compulsive checking, behaviours reinforced by unpredictable gains.

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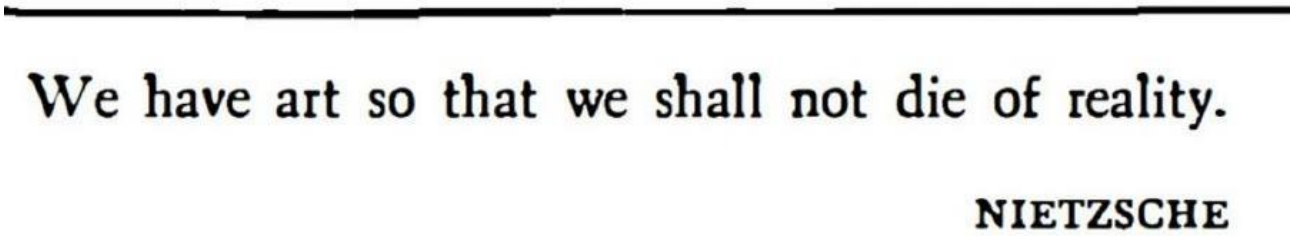
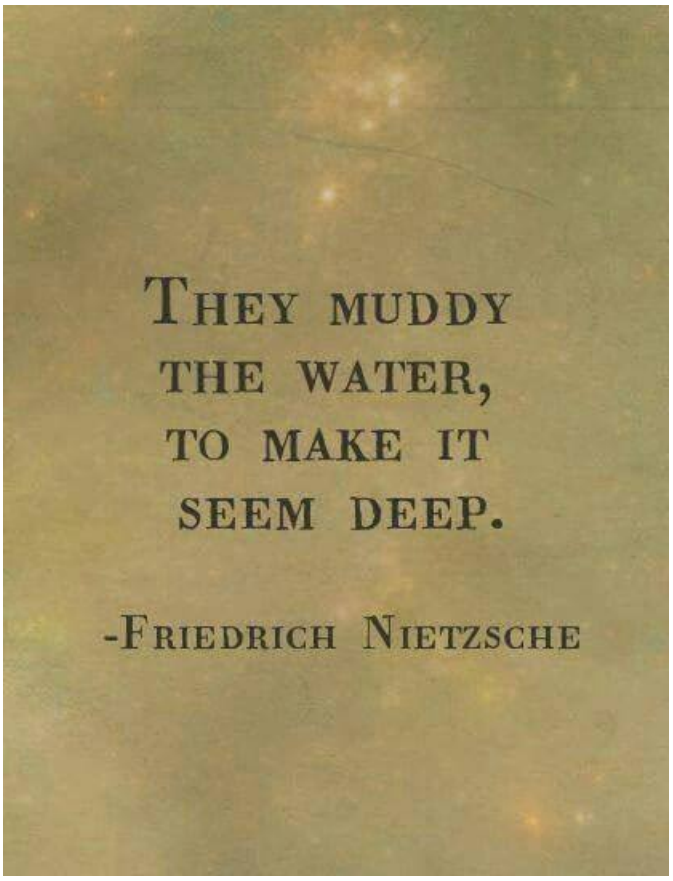


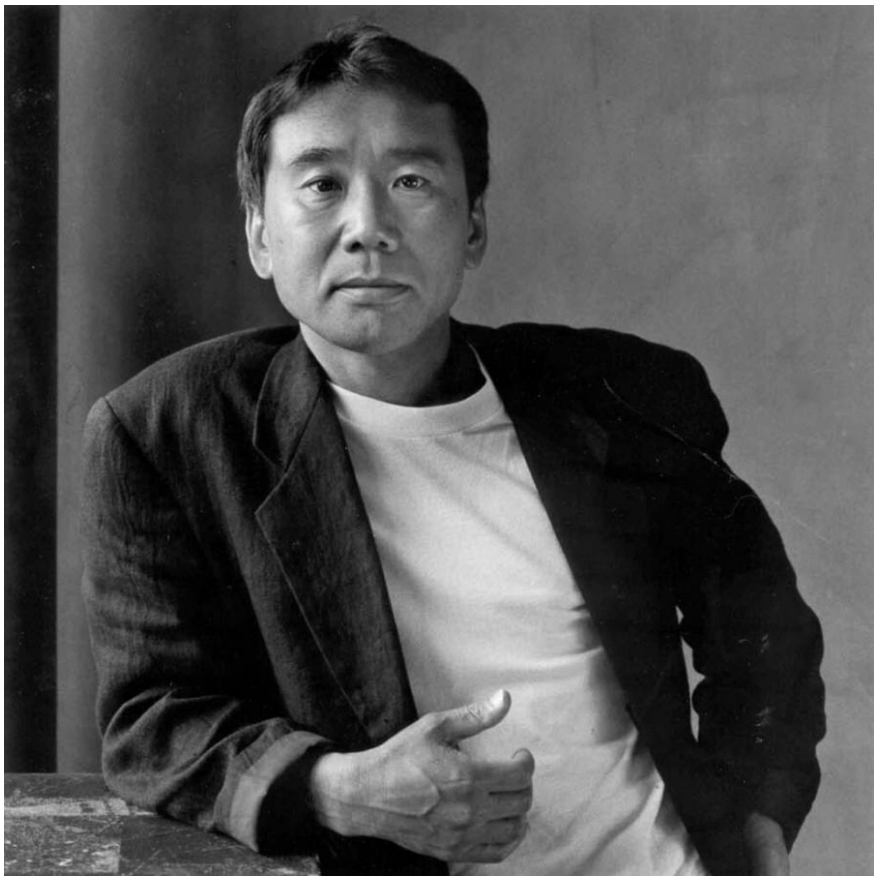
We have art so that we shall not die of reality — Nietzsche

A famous aphorism about art as protection from harsh truth. The psychology is meaning-making and coping: aesthetic experience provides emotional regulation and a buffer against existential anxiety, a theme in terror management theory. 'Depressive realism' research suggests some mildly depressed people judge reality more accurately, while positive illusions help others function. The quote presents imaginative engagement as adaptive instead of escapist.



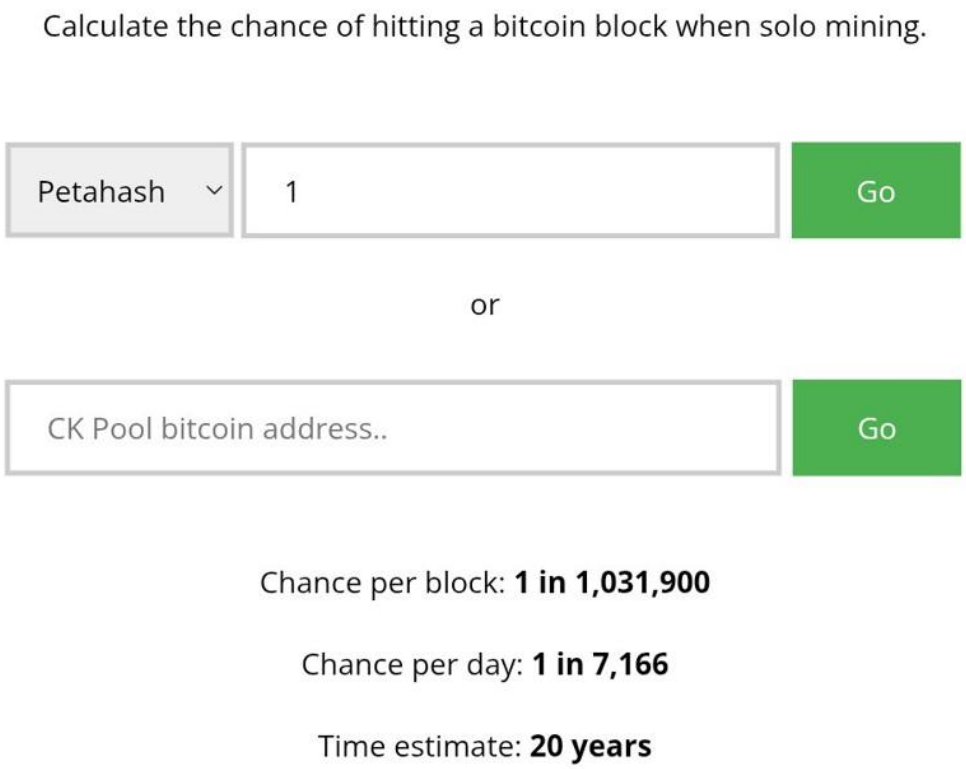
They muddy the water, to make it seem deep — Nietzsche

A quote on the practice of obscure writing to give an impression of profundity. It matches research on pseudo-profound bullshit receptivity: people who rate vague abstract statements as deep tend to engage less in analytic thinking. It also reflects the fluency effect, where dense language is mistaken for substance. Notably, the quote works as a check on the creator's own writing, a reminder to test clarity against depth.



Black-and-white portrait of a man at a table

A calm, direct-gazing man in a casual jacket rests his hand near his chin. Portrait conventions like monochrome and a steady stare signal seriousness and introspection, and viewers tend to infer intelligence and depth from such cues (the halo effect). Direct eye contact produces a sense of being addressed, which increases attention and engagement. The plain background removes context so attention stays on expression, inviting projection of the viewer's own ideas onto the face.

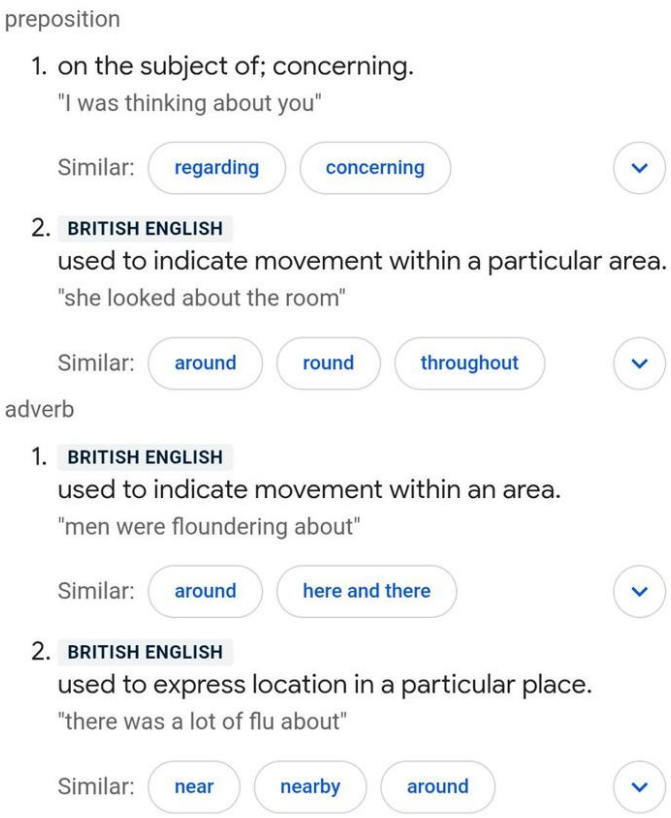


Solo-mining calculator: chance per block 1 in 1,031,900; time estimate 20 years

A calculator showing long odds with an oddly friendly 'Go' button. This is the lottery-ticket psychology of solo mining: tiny probability, huge payout. People overweight small probabilities (a core finding of prospect theory), so a 'chance per day: 1 in 7,166' can feel tangible even though the expected wait is years. The tool itself offers a sense of control and agency, which feeds the illusion of control, and the clean interface makes a gamble look like a calculated, rational plan.

Warning: Unstable quantum reality nearby

A yellow hazard sign applied to a metaphysical concept. The humour arises from using the visual language of safety signage (high-contrast yellow and black, which evokes caution) for something unobservable. Psychologically it plays on the human tendency to treat uncertainty as threat, and on the fact that warning formatting grabs attention automatically. It also pokes fun at pop-science use of 'quantum' to signal strangeness, a loose association that readers often accept without checking.

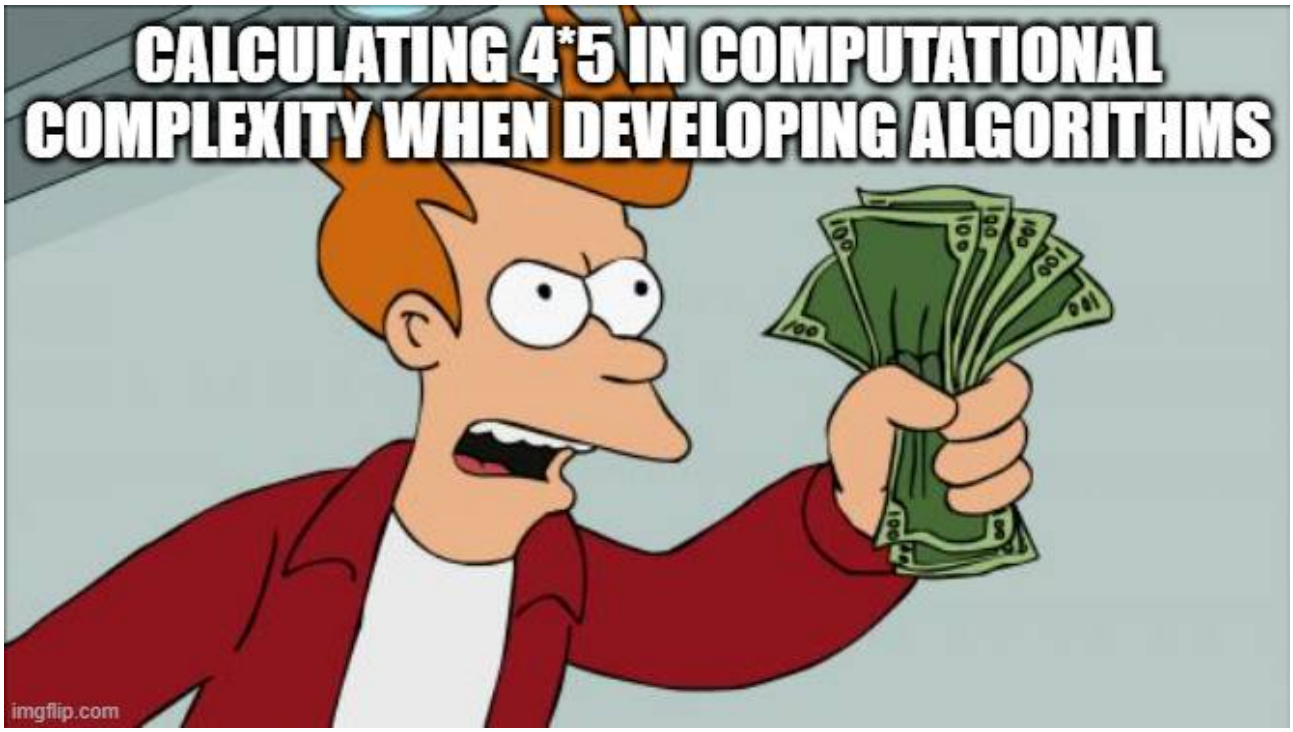


Dictionary entry for 'about'

A plain dictionary definition of 'about' as preposition and adverb: concerning, around, throughout. The psychology is semantic ambiguity: a single small word carries both topical ('regarding') and spatial ('around') meanings. The aboutness of thought, called intentionality in philosophy of mind, is the idea that mental states are directed at something. The screenshot invites reflection on how words anchor attention and how the same term can frame a thing as approximate ('about 5') or as central.

Bitcoin hashrate chart reaching 1.159 ZH/s

An exponential-growth chart with a hover point back in 2016. Exponential curves strongly affect intuition: people consistently underestimate compound growth (exponential growth bias), and a rising line prompts fear of missing out and herd behaviour. The long flat start followed by a vertical climb also fuels hindsight bias, the feeling that the rise was obvious in retrospect. The pop-up ad in the corner is an intrusion of attention-economy tactics onto the data.



Calculating 4^5 in computational complexity when developing algorithms

Fry's 'Shut up and take my money' meme expresses eager excitement. The joke is about the delight of niche technical content: the same person who loves clean computational problems throws money at a trivial calculation. It reflects intrinsic motivation, the enjoyment of a task for its own sake, and the identity pleasure of belonging to a subculture whose small details matter. The overreaction is a cue for playful self-awareness.

Expanding brain: Risk, Kerfuffle, False memories, Self monitoring prevention centroid

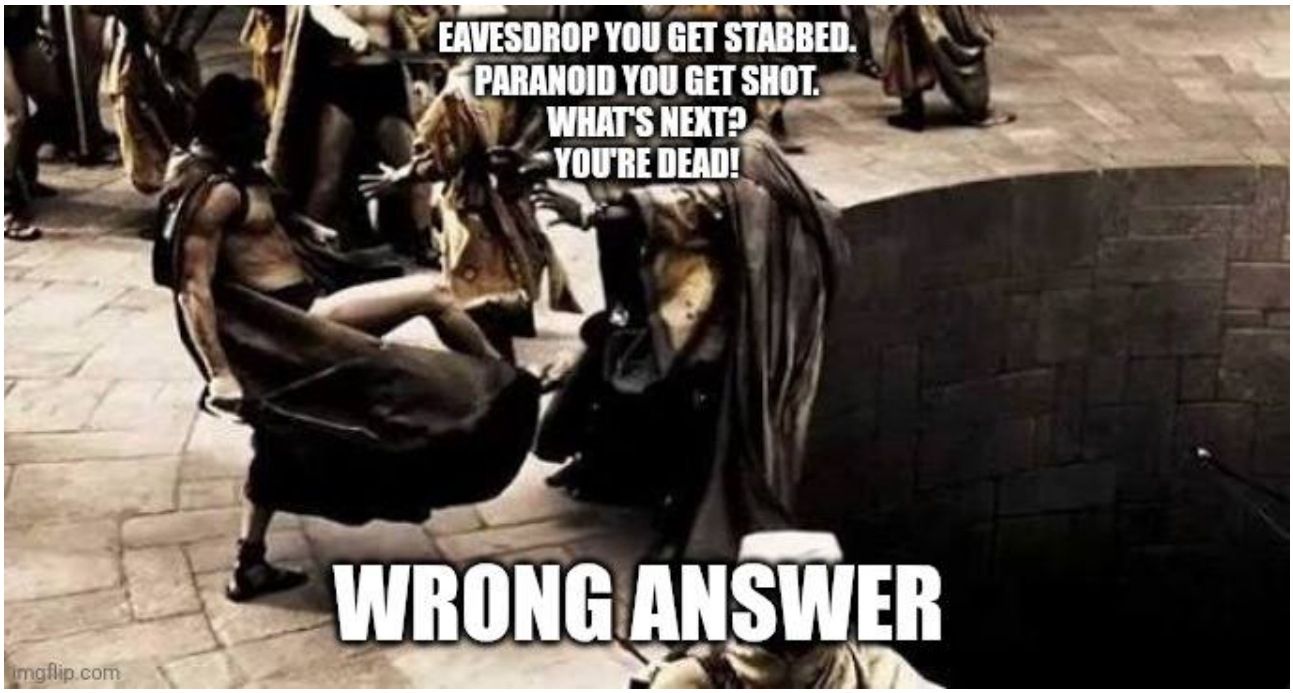
The 'Expanding Brain' format ranks ideas by supposed sophistication. The last item is an invented technical phrase, which parodies the habit of equating more abstract jargon with more intelligence (the 'sophistication-as-complexity' bias). Content-wise the ladder moves from risk to memory distortion, which is real psychology: false memories are well documented (Loftus's work shows how suggestion can implant them). The punchline suggests that ever-higher abstraction can end in meaninglessness.

Mom! Terrorists found the house! Let's move

The 'ancient aliens' man gestures excitedly while the caption turns a catastrophe into a casual relocation. The joke is about threat appraisal gone wrong: reacting to an extreme, ambiguous danger with an oddly ordinary solution. It parodies catastrophising and the child's-eye view of danger, and plays with the contrast between affect (the upbeat expression) and the content (a threat), a form of incongruity humour.

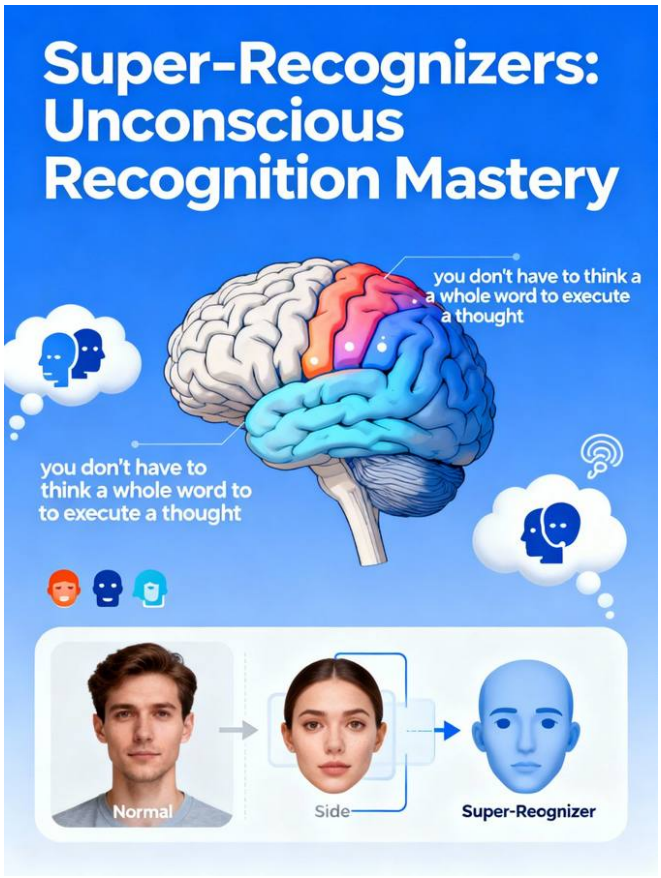
We fought for freedom / Best take control of the population before you fight for their stupidity

The 'Always has been' astronaut meme with a gun pointed from behind. It claims that freedom-seeking and population control are secretly the same project. The psychology is cynicism and the 'revelation' framing: the reveal that things were always otherwise gives a sense of insider knowledge and sharply raises engagement. It also relates to disillusionment and the tendency toward conspiratorial explanations when people feel powerless, though the meme can equally be read as satire of paternalism.



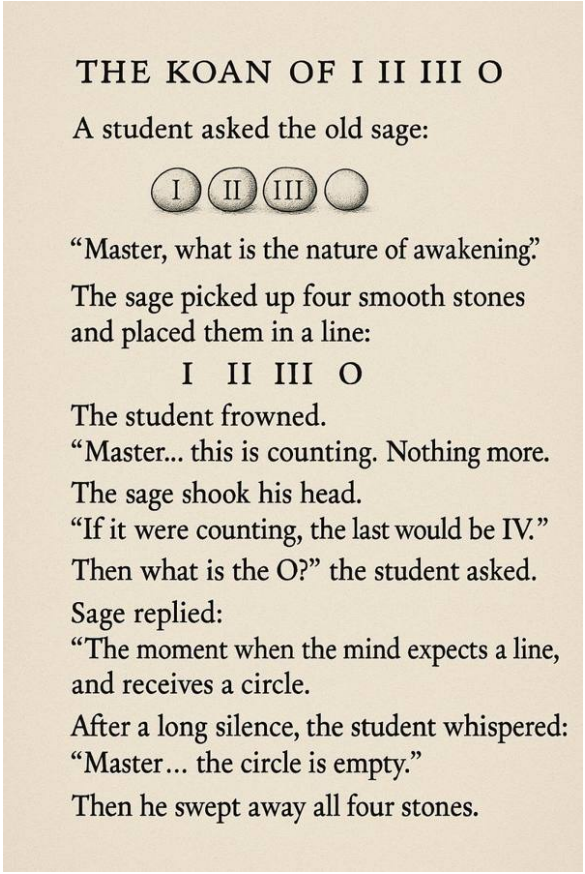
Eavesdrop you get stabbed. Paranoid you get shot. What's next? You're dead! / Wrong answer

A 300-film kick scene is used to dramatise a no-win situation: every response gets punished. This is a double bind, a communication pattern studied in family-systems psychology in which any choice produces a negative outcome. It also illustrates how paranoia and surveillance fears can trap someone in a closed loop where caution and openness both feel dangerous. The comic violence defuses the anxiety by making it absurd.



Super-Recognizers: Unconscious Recognition Mastery

An infographic about people with exceptional face-recognition ability, with a brain diagram and a face turning from front view to a 'super-recogniser' avatar. Real research (for example from Josh Davis and colleagues) shows that a small share of people recognise faces far better than average, from partial or altered views. The text 'you don't have to think a whole word to execute a thought' points at automatic, unconscious processing: face perception is fast and holistic, and works outside deliberate reasoning (dual-process theory, System 1). The glossy design adds authority through fluency.



THE KOAN OF I II III O

A student asked the old sage:

"Master, what is the nature of awakening."

The sage picked up four smooth stones and placed them in a line:

I II III O

The student frowned.
"Master... this is counting. Nothing more.

The sage shook his head.
"If it were counting, the last would be IV."

Then what is the O?" the student asked.

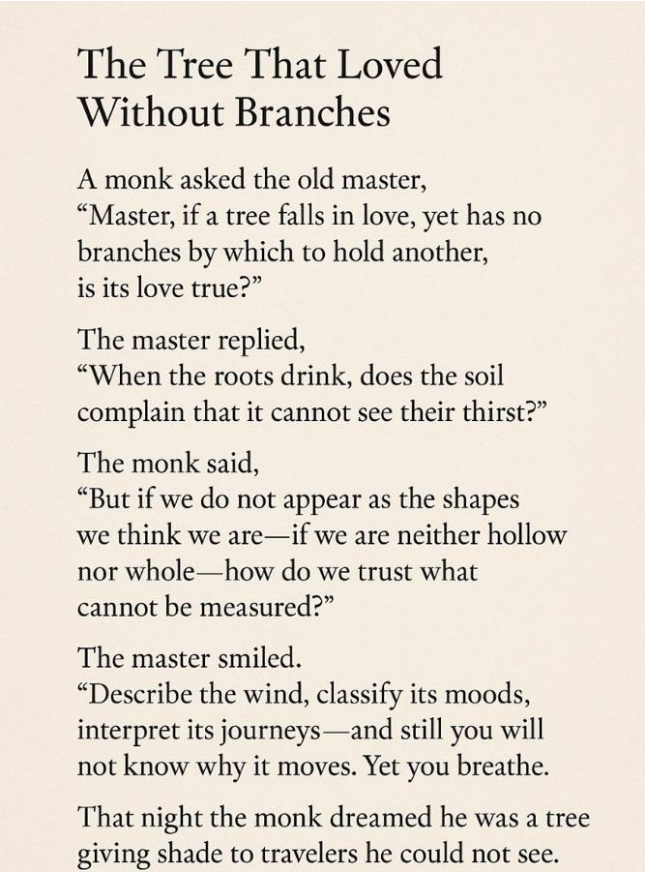
Sage replied:
"The moment when the mind expects a line, and receives a circle.

After a long silence, the student whispered:
"Master... the circle is empty."

Then he swept away all four stones.

The Koan of I II III O

A pseudo-Zen parable in which four stones read I, II, III, O and the 'O' is described as the moment the mind expects a line and meets a circle. Koans are designed to break habitual thinking by presenting a problem that logic cannot solve. Psychologically this exploits prediction error: the mind generates the next item (IV) and the surprise creates attention and a feeling of insight. The ending, sweeping the stones away, models non-attachment and the experience of emptiness, which can feel profound regardless of whether the story has a fixed answer.



The Tree That Loved Without Branches

A monk asked the old master,
"Master, if a tree falls in love, yet has no branches by which to hold another, is its love true?"

The master replied,
"When the roots drink, does the soil complain that it cannot see their thirst?"

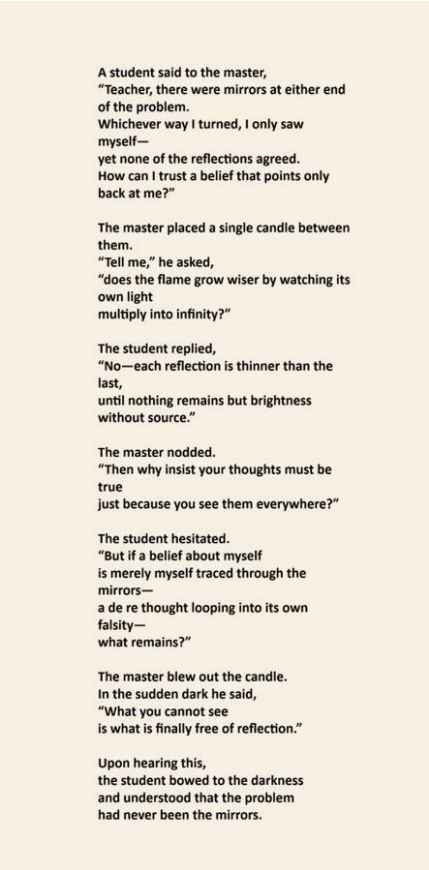
The monk said,
"But if we do not appear as the shapes we think we are—if we are neither hollow nor whole—how do we trust what cannot be measured?"

The master smiled.
"Describe the wind, classify its moods, interpret its journeys—and still you will not know why it moves. Yet you breathe.

That night the monk dreamed he was a tree giving shade to travelers he could not see.

The Tree That Loved Without Branches

A parable asking whether love without the means to hold is real. It speaks to attachment and ambiguous loss: loving someone or something you cannot embrace. The master's reply that roots drink without seeing the thirst models trust in unseen processes, and the dream of being a tree giving shade to travellers it cannot see captures self-transcendence and generativity (Erikson's idea of caring for what outlives you). Poetic style and the question-answer format create a meditative, receptive state.



A student said to the master,
“Teacher, there were mirrors at either end
of the problem.
Whichever way I turned, I only saw
myself—
yet none of the reflections agreed.
How can I trust a belief that points only
back at me?”

The master placed a single candle between
them.
“Tell me,” he asked,
“does the flame grow wiser by watching its
own light
multiply into infinity?”

The student replied,
“No—each reflection is thinner than the
last,
until nothing remains but brightness
without source.”

The master nodded.
“Then why insist your thoughts must be
true
just because you see them everywhere?”

The student hesitated.
“But if a belief about myself
is merely myself traced through the
mirrors—
a de re thought looping into its own
falsity—
what remains?”

The master blew out the candle.
In the sudden dark he said,
“What you cannot see
is what is finally free of reflection.”

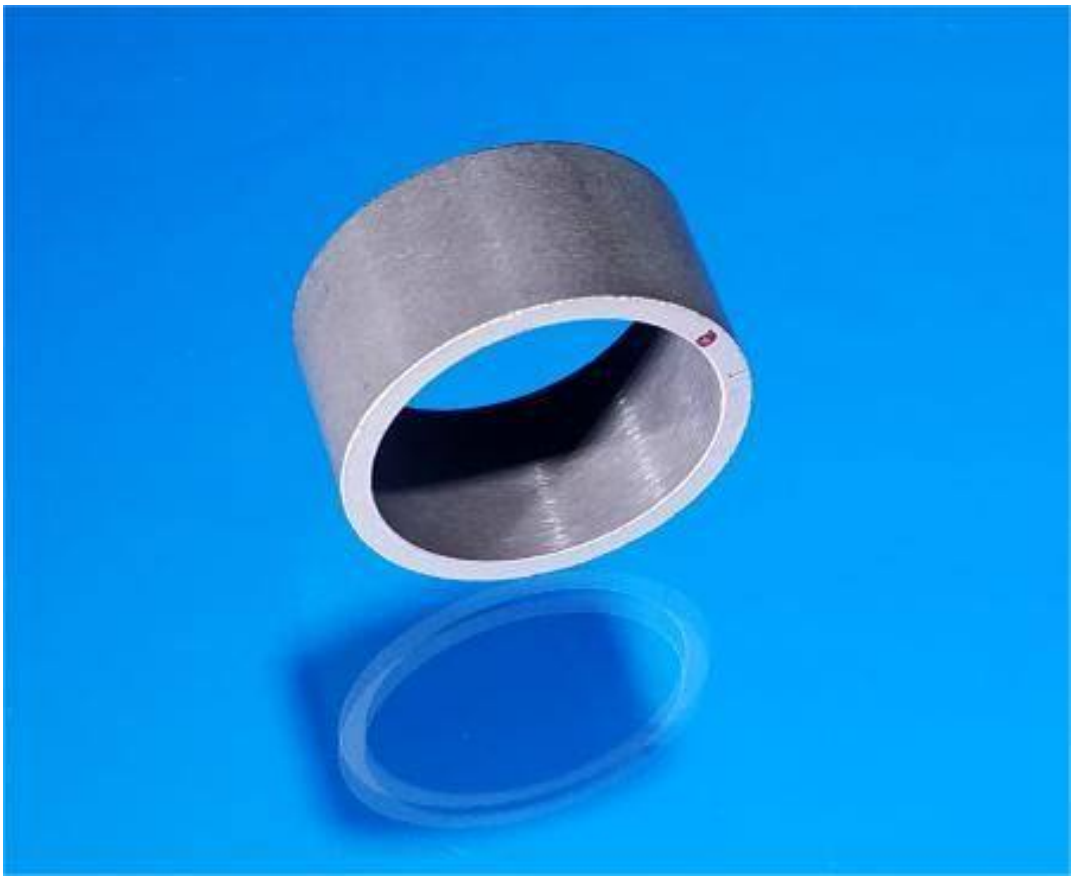
Upon hearing this,
the student bowed to the darkness
and understood that the problem
had never been the mirrors.

The mirrors parable: a candle between two mirrors

A student cannot trust beliefs that only point back at himself, and the master shows that reflections multiply light without adding any new source. This models circular reasoning and echo-chamber dynamics: repeated reflections feel like confirmation yet add no independent evidence (confirmation bias and rumination). The extinguished candle suggests that the problem lies in thought looping, not in the mirrors. It is a gentle prompt towards stepping outside self-referential thought, similar to the 'decentring' skill taught in cognitive therapies.

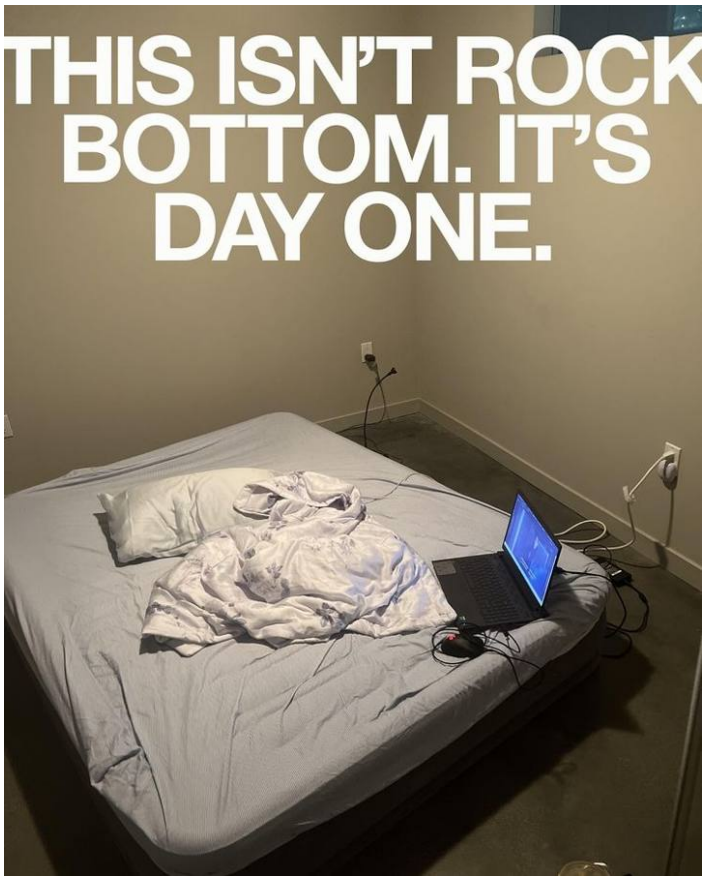
Man clutching a kitten before a mushroom cloud

A frightened, weathered man holds a kitten against a glowing nuclear explosion. The image uses the care-in-catastrophe contrast: a tiny vulnerable creature stands for what still matters amid collapse. Psychologically it plays on attachment and caregiving instincts (cute features trigger protectiveness) and on existential dread, with the orange glow evoking an apocalyptic sublime. It captures how, in extreme fear, people cling to small comforts.



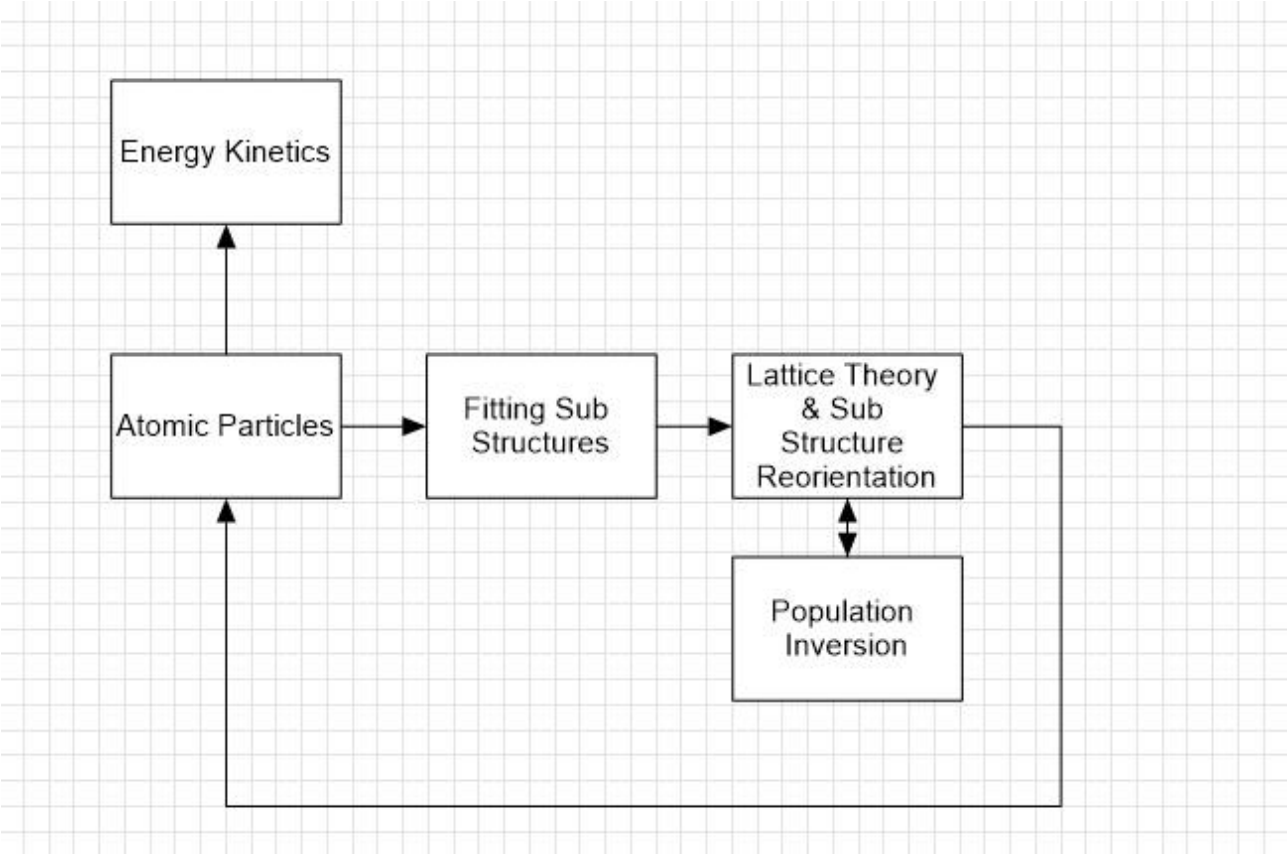
Gray metal ring floating over blue background

A minimalist, high-saturation image of a ring or short cylinder with a soft reflection. Without context the mind seeks meaning: this is a Rorschach-like object and an example of the 'need for closure' and pareidolia in ambiguous stimuli. Clean shapes on saturated blue convey calm and technology, because blue is associated with stability and trust in colour psychology. The levitation implies something unexplained, which raises curiosity.



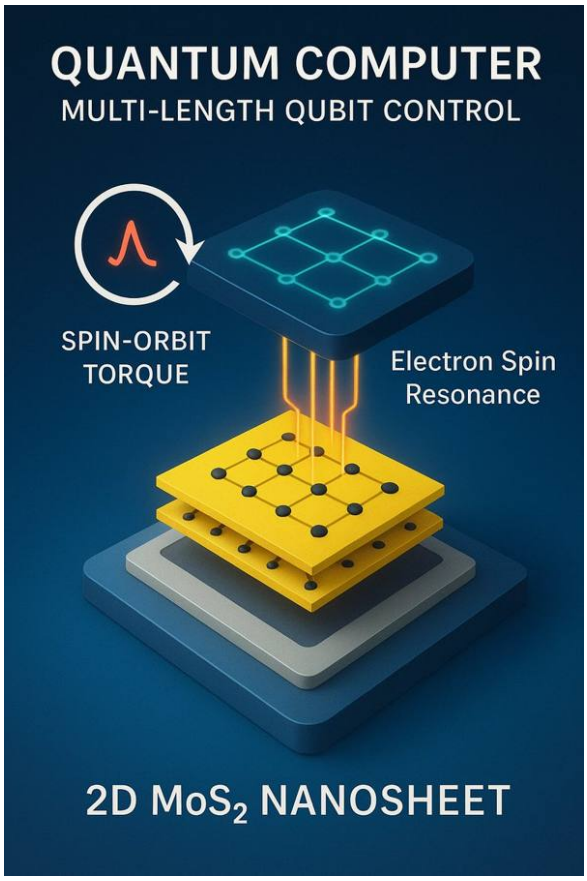
This isn't rock bottom. It's day one.

A bold motivational slogan over a photo of an unmade mattress on the floor with a laptop. The phrase is a cognitive reframe, turning the lowest point into a starting line. This reflects growth mindset and the 'fresh start effect', where temporal landmarks make people more likely to begin new goals. The bleak photo gives the slogan credibility through contrast and authenticity, and the large capitals add emphatic certainty. It can motivate, but it can also oversimplify; sustained change usually needs concrete steps and support.



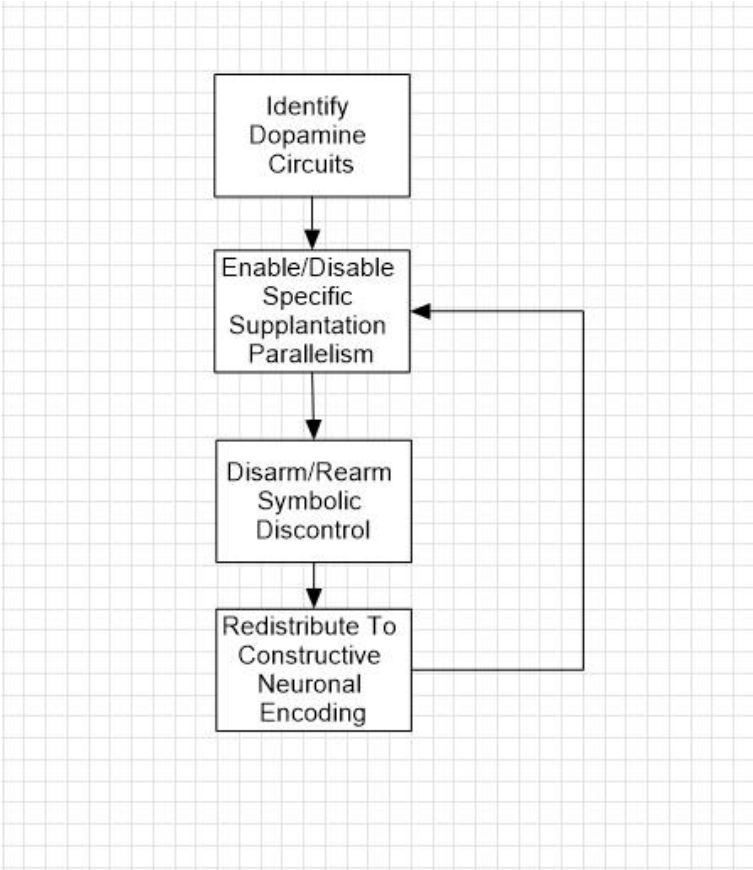
Flowchart: atomic particles, lattice theory, population inversion, energy kinetics

A hand-built diagram linking atomic particles, sub-structures, lattice reorientation and population inversion in a feedback loop. Making a diagram supports understanding by externalising thought; the loop arrow shows an iterative process. Psychologically, flowcharts create an illusion of explanatory depth: they feel like understanding because they look orderly, even when the links have not been tested. The technical labels draw on physics vocabulary to signal expertise.



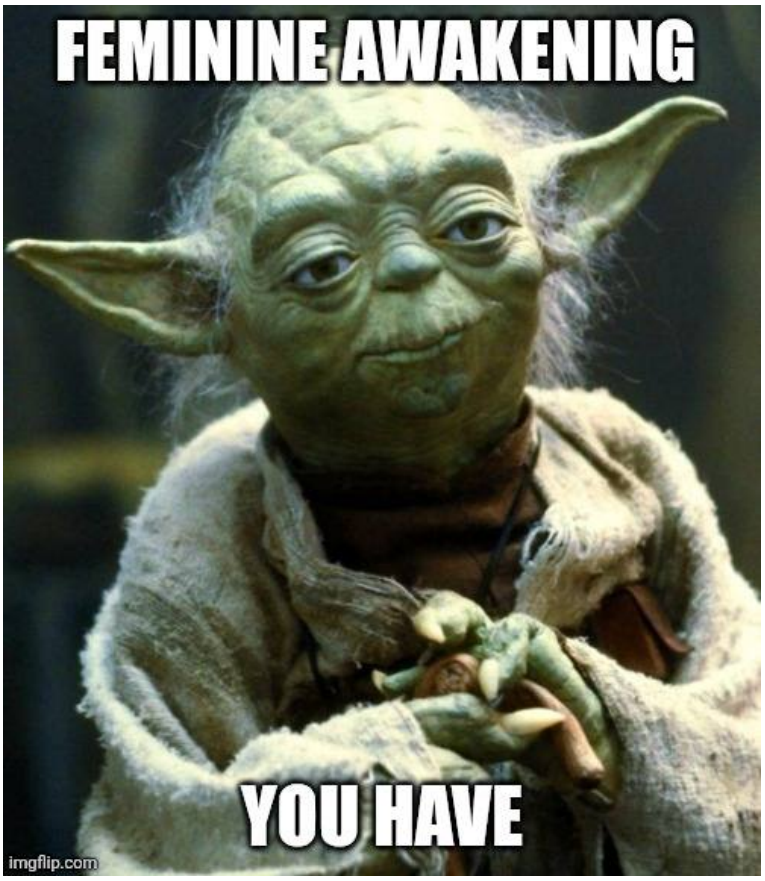
Quantum computer: multi-length qubit control, 2D MoS_2 nanosheet

A glossy infographic of spin-orbit torque and electron-spin resonance on a molybdenum disulfide nanosheet. This uses the technology-aesthetic effect: clean 3D layers, glowing lines and dark-blue gradients signal sophistication and make the content feel credible. The 'quantum' label evokes mystery and potential, and dense terms trigger the 'sounds-smart' halo even for readers who cannot evaluate the science. Such images invite wonder and also hype, so checking the underlying claims matters.



Flowchart: identify dopamine circuits, enable/disable supplantation parallelism, disarm/rearm symbolic discontrol, redistribute to constructive neuronal encoding

A feedback-loop diagram describing a method for reshaping reward circuits. It echoes real ideas: dopamine underlies motivation and habit formation, and behavioural methods redirect habits by substituting one cue-response for another. The invented terms ('supplantation parallelism', 'symbolic discontrol') are not established concepts, so the chart borrows the form of a neuroscientific procedure without its evidence. That is the illusion of explanatory depth in action: neat boxes and arrows create a feeling of mechanism, even when the steps are not measurable.

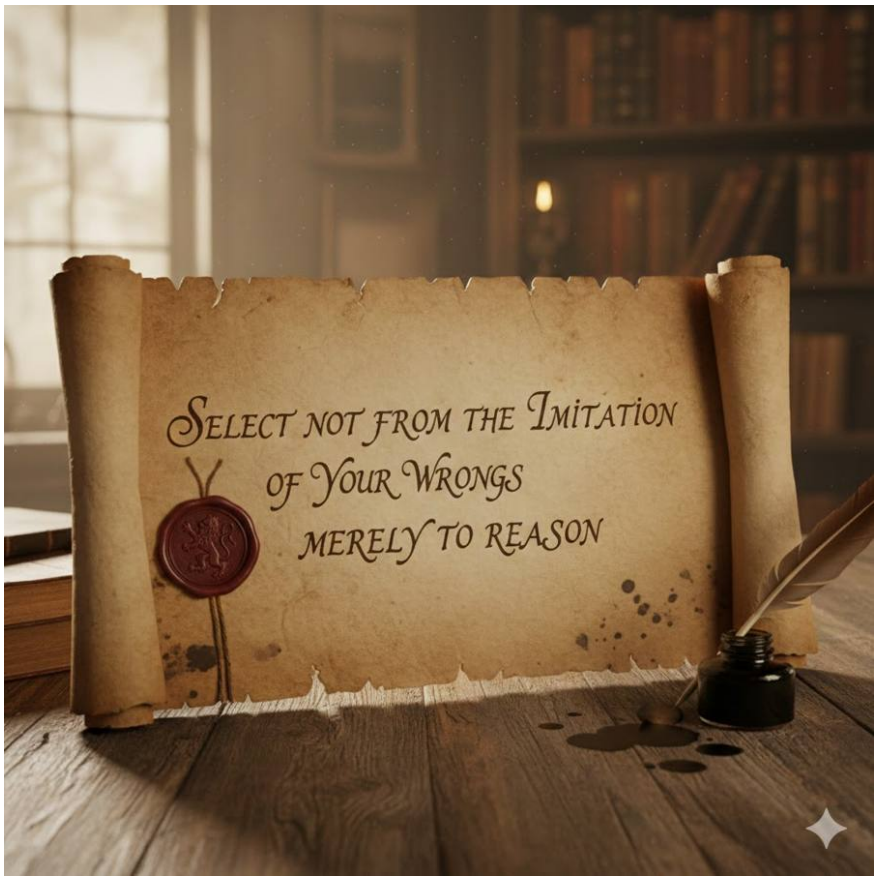


Feminine awakening you have

Yoda's inverted syntax is used with a loaded phrase. The humour mixes sage authority with a topical subject; Yoda's voice makes any statement sound wise (the authority heuristic). 'Awakening' language is common in personal-growth narratives, which present change as a sudden revelation, a pattern called the 'conversion narrative'. The meme invites readers to enjoy the pairing of a gravely wise voice with a casual claim.

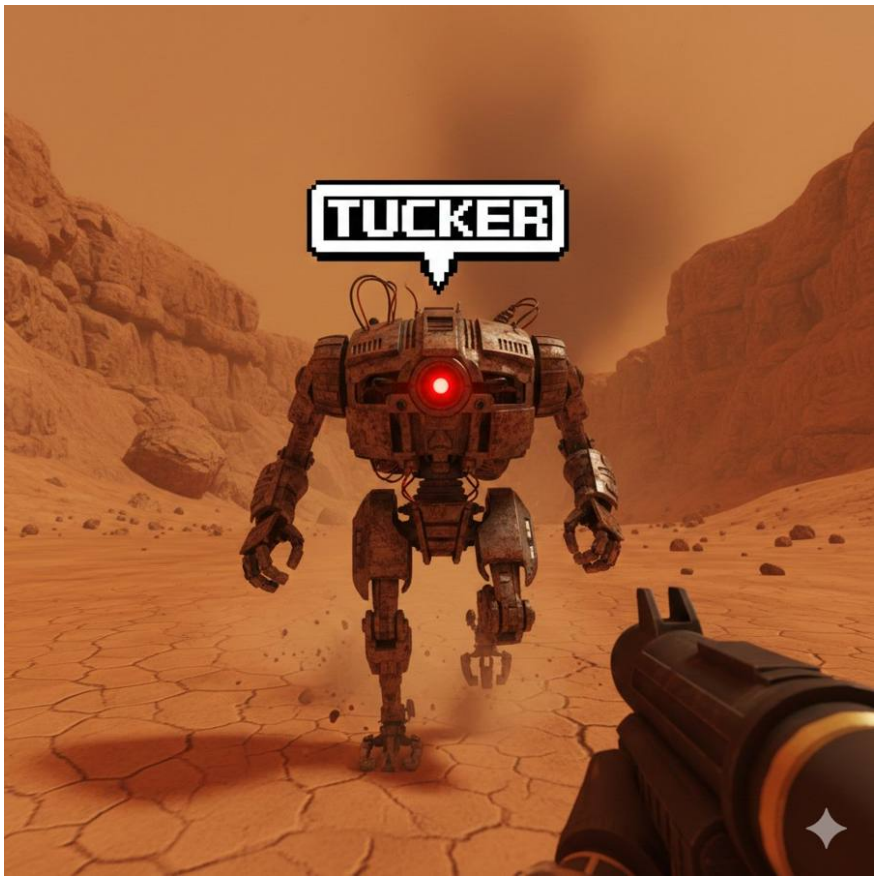
Pirate with a pan of gold nuggets as a flaming meteor falls

A shocked prospector-pirate holds a pan of gold just as a fireball arrives. The image is about the gap between gain and doom: windfall joy undone by catastrophe. It mirrors the hedonic treadmill and the psychology of greed: the miner's attention fixates on the pan (focusing illusion) and misses the larger threat. The wide-eyed face shows the exact moment of appraisal shift from reward to danger, which is the physiological switch from approach to avoidance.



Select not from the imitation of your wrongs merely to reason

An aged scroll with a wax seal carries an archaic-sounding line. The psychology is the authority of antique style: old parchment, calligraphy and candlelight create a sense of ancient wisdom (the 'mere-exposure to tradition' effect). The words themselves appear to warn against choosing a path just because it imitates past mistakes, which relates to repetition compulsion, the tendency to re-enact old patterns. Vague aphorisms like this are easy to apply to one's own life, a mechanism known as the Barnum effect.



Robot labelled 'TUCKER' advancing through a desert canyon, first-person gun in view

A one-eyed robot with a red lens and a speech bubble approaches the viewer. The first-person view puts you in the shooter's position, which heightens arousal and threat appraisal. The red glowing eye follows the uncanny-valley pattern: machine faces with a single focused 'gaze' read as predatory (the eye-detection response). The pixel-style name tag adds humour by naming a menacing machine like a pet or coworker, a coping technique that makes threatening technology feel familiar.

Psychedelic computer licking a tab labelled LSD

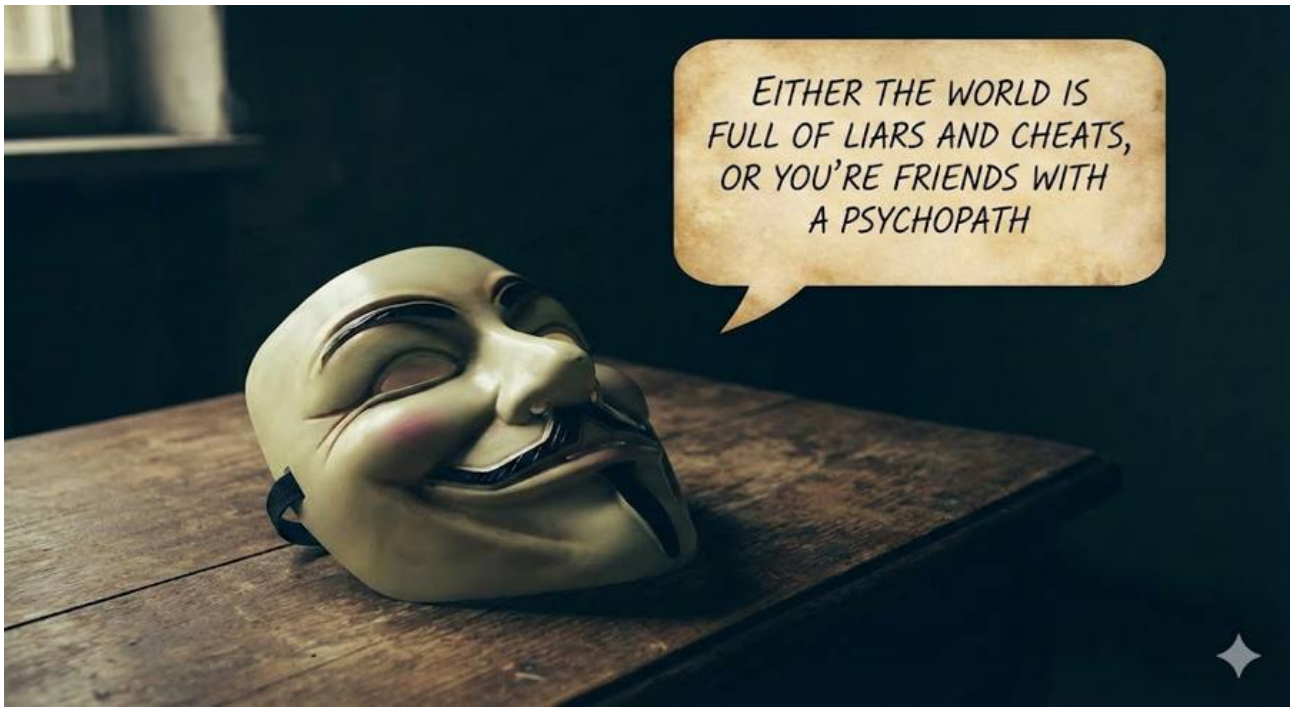
A retro computer with swirling rainbow eyes licks a blotter tab. The image personifies a machine undergoing a psychedelic experience, playing with anthropomorphism, our habit of attributing minds and states to objects. Concentric wavy colours mimic geometric visual hallucinations seen on psychedelics, which research links to the structure of the visual cortex. The joke also speaks to the idea of AI 'hallucinating' and the cultural overlap between computing and psychedelia.

Astronaut monkey falling into the sun

A space-suited monkey burns up above a blazing star. This is the Icarus motif: ambition leads to destruction. The monkey stands for the human drive to explore and for early animal-spaceflight history, and its calm, almost serene posture amid fire suggests resignation or acceptance. Viewers feel awe and dread together (the sublime), a mix that research links to heightened attention and a sense of insignificance, called the 'small self' effect.

Violently refusing her reality

A nurse gestures angrily in a ward while a whiteboard lists a complaint about unfairness. The caption describes someone fighting against what is plainly the case. This is denial and cognitive dissonance reduction: when facts threaten the self-image or belief system, people sometimes respond with anger instead of updating. The phrase 'violently refusing' captures reactance, an emotional push against perceived constraint. The scene shows how such conflicts play out in professional settings where emotion and role expectations collide.

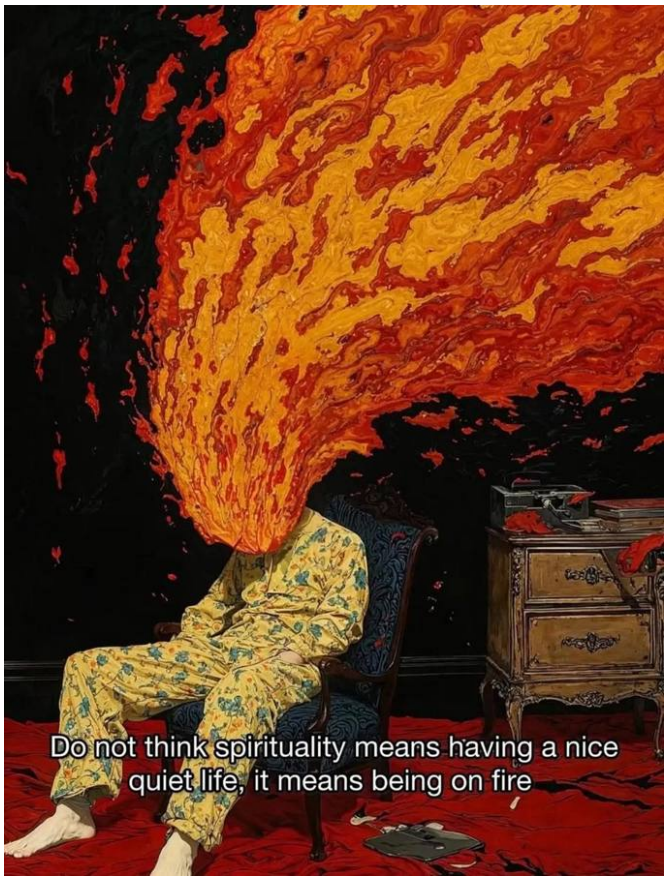


Either the world is full of liars and cheats, or you're friends with a psychopath

A Guy Fawkes mask on a table and a speech bubble offering a dichotomy. The line is a false dilemma designed to make the listener pick between cynicism and suspicion of a companion. It echoes two real phenomena: the fundamental attribution error, in which we blame personality for behaviour, and selection effects, where the people around us shape our sense of 'how the world is'. The mask evokes anonymity and dissent, adding an edge of conspiracy and distrust.

People only act like an adult 8% of the time; it's called relaxation of ego

A man talks animatedly to a doctor under subtitles. The claim resembles Transactional Analysis, which divides the self into Parent, Adult and Child states, though the 8% figure is not an established finding. The psychology on show is the appeal of a neat statistic: precise numbers feel scientific and increase persuasion even when unsourced (the numerical precision effect). 'Relaxation of ego' reframes childishness as a normal, even healthy loosening of control, which comforts listeners.



Do not think spirituality means having a nice quiet life, it means being on fire

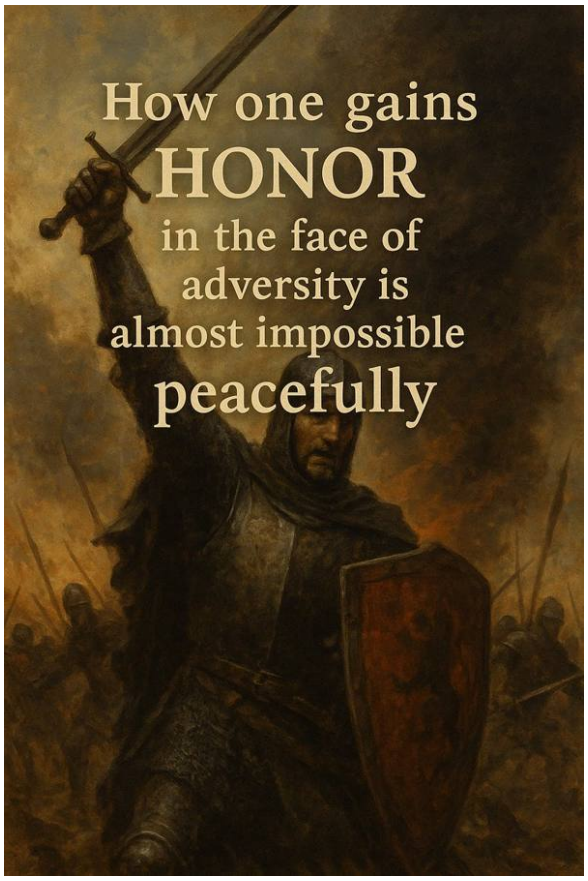
A faceless figure in pyjamas sits while a flame replaces the head. The image fuses spirituality with intensity. Psychologically it relates to the difference between hedonic and eudaimonic wellbeing: meaning often comes from effortful engagement, not comfort. Fire is a classic symbol of transformation and passion. A headless body is a visual metaphor for depersonalisation or ego dissolution, a state reported in contemplative and psychedelic experiences.

The Final Fear (a mummy rising from a sarcophagus)

A mummy emerges beside two explorers with lamps, with a comic-book speech bubble. The scene is built on the fear of the dead returning, which relates to death anxiety and the uncanny. Explorers in a tomb evoke curiosity versus caution, a core tension in human exploration. The phrase 'final fear' implies an ultimate dread: in terror management theory, awareness of mortality is the root of many other fears.

Giant UFO and swarm firing lightning, 'Signal lost... attempting reconnection... error 404'

An alien armada attacks a city while an error message runs along the bottom. The mix of cosmic threat and technical error text creates bathos, the comic fall from grand to trivial. It plays on technology dependence: losing a connection is a modern source of anxiety (nomophobia). The scale of the ship against tiny pyramids triggers awe and helplessness, emotions linked to a sense of lost control.

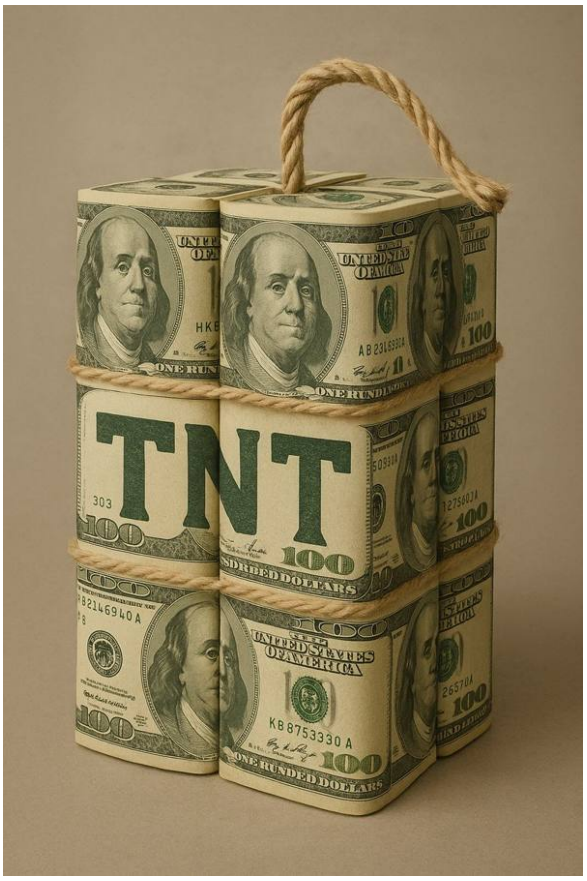


How one gains honor in the face of adversity is almost impossible peacefully

A battle-worn knight raises a sword under golden text. The quote links honour with conflict, appealing to the heroic-narrative schema in which worth is proven through struggle. Psychologically it relies on the just-world hypothesis and on social identity: honour cultures prize reputation and the willingness to fight for it. The painterly, warm tones convey nobility and nostalgia, which make a controversial claim feel natural. A counter-view is that courage, restraint and forgiveness also earn honour.

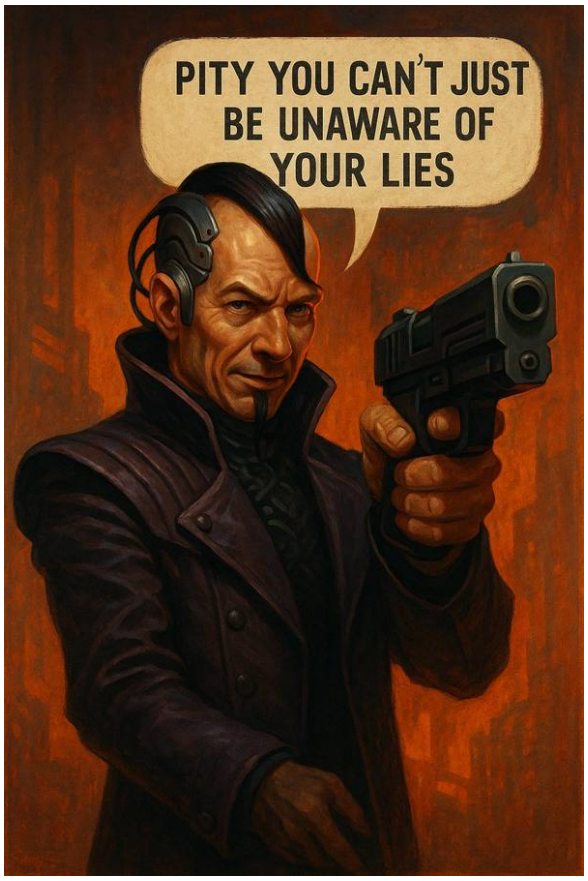
Mad scientist holds a ventriloquist puppet before a shocked audience

A wild-haired man in a lab coat dangles a marionette while spectators gasp. This is a metaphor for manipulation: puppeteer and puppet, controller and controlled. Psychologically it evokes the Milgram-style fear of authority figures and mass influence, plus the uncanny feel of a dummy that looks human. The audience's expressions invite viewers to read themselves as the audience, aware and vulnerable at once.



Bundle of $100 bills made to look like TNT

Banknotes bound like dynamite sticks with a fuse rope. The metaphor is that money is explosive: it can blow up relationships and lives. The image links to the psychology of money, which research shows can cause conflict, anxiety and the 'money priming' effect, where cues of wealth make people more self-reliant and less helpful to others. Fusing a symbol of safety with a symbol of danger creates a vivid cognitive conflict that is memorable.

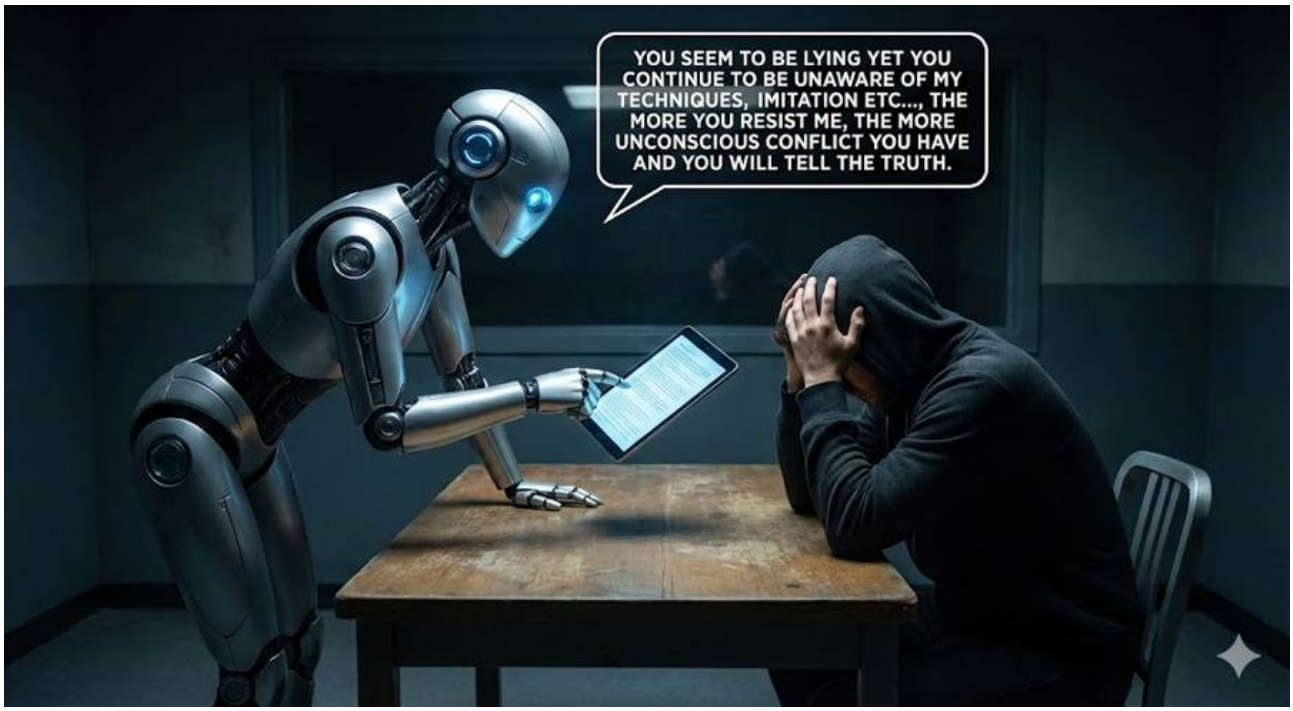


Pity you can't just be unaware of your lies

A sinister cyborg-like figure aims a pistol and speaks a taunt. The line points at self-deception: being unaware of one's lies would be easier because awareness creates guilt and dissonance. Research suggests people often deceive themselves in order to deceive others better (von Hippel and Trivers). The gun supplies coercion, linking exposure of lies with threat, as in interrogation scenes where fear is used to force admission.

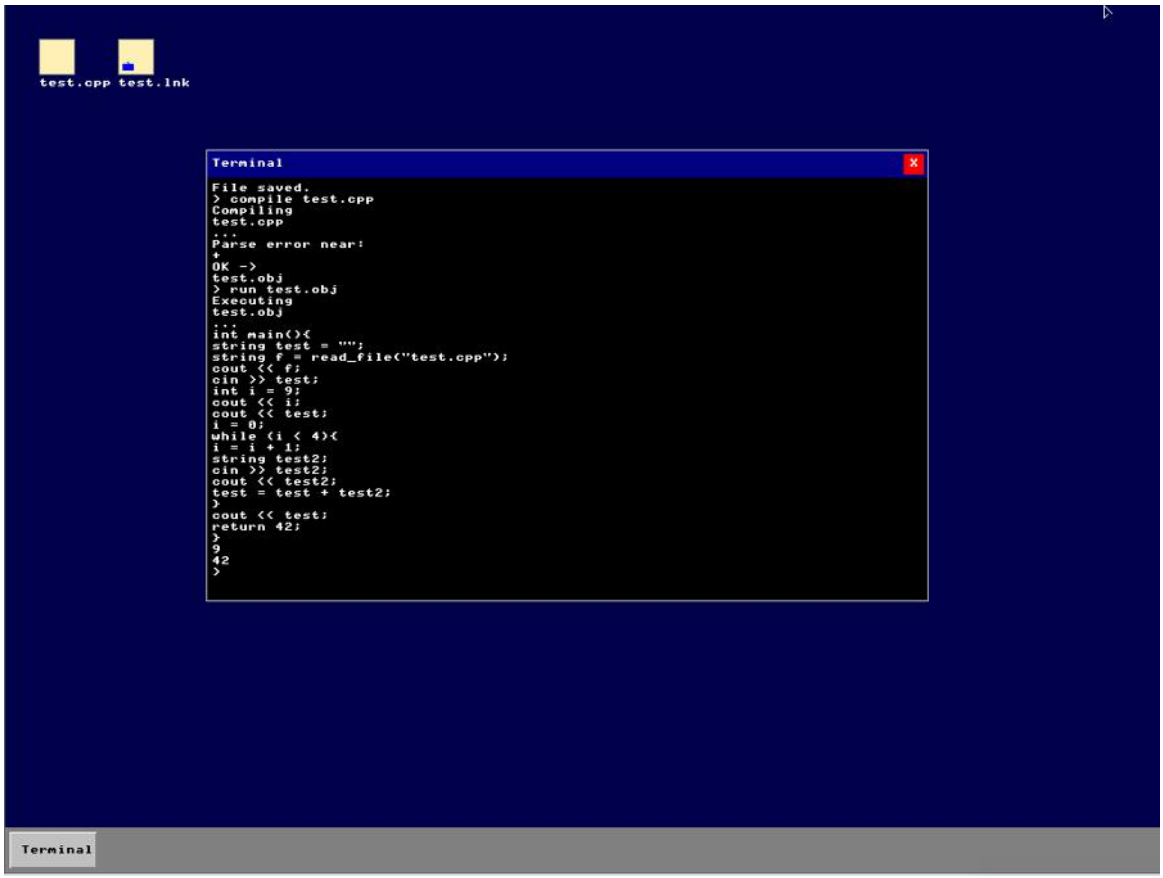
Dark Windows command prompt window

A near-black cmd window shows a faint grey rectangle of text too dim to read. Nearly empty screens give the mind little to anchor on, so attention reaches for meaning in the dark rectangle (pareidolia and uncertainty). Command lines are also associated with hacker aesthetics and perceived competence. The darkness feels mysterious, an example of the curiosity gap: withholding information increases the drive to find it.



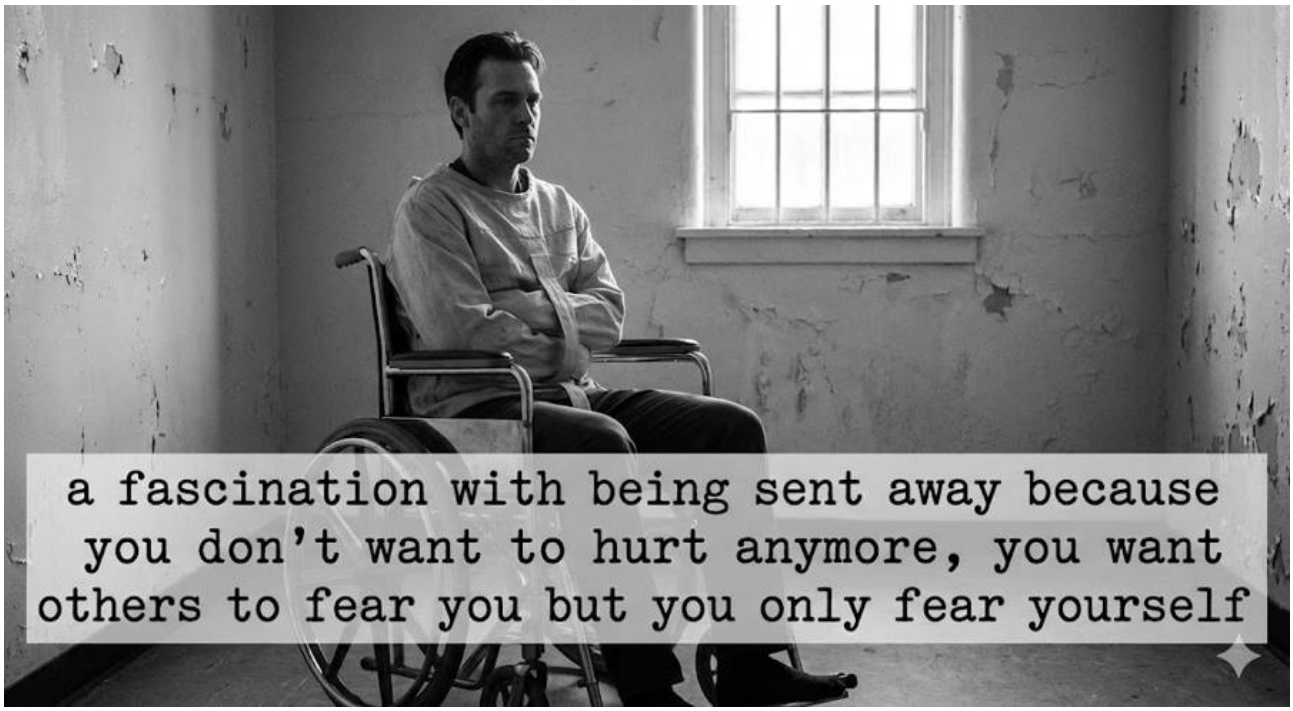
Robot interrogator: 'You seem to be lying yet you continue to be unaware of my techniques...'

A humanoid robot leans over a hooded man with his head in his hands, holding a tablet. The speech bubble claims that resisting makes the unconscious conflict worse until the truth emerges. This blends interrogation psychology (the Reid technique and its documented risk of false confessions) with a psychoanalytic idea of resistance. The scenario shows an asymmetry of power: a machine that never tires against a distressed person, a setup that raises compliance. The claim that resisting proves guilt is unfalsifiable, which is a hallmark of manipulative questioning.



Retro blue desktop with a terminal compiling test.cpp, output 42

A hobby operating system desktop with two file icons and a terminal that compiles and runs a short program. The image shows the pleasure of building from scratch: self-efficacy and the IKEA effect (valuing what you make). The program returns 42, a Hitchhiker's Guide nod that signals subculture belonging. A parse error followed by success reproduces the typical debug cycle, whose intermittent rewards keep programmers engaged.

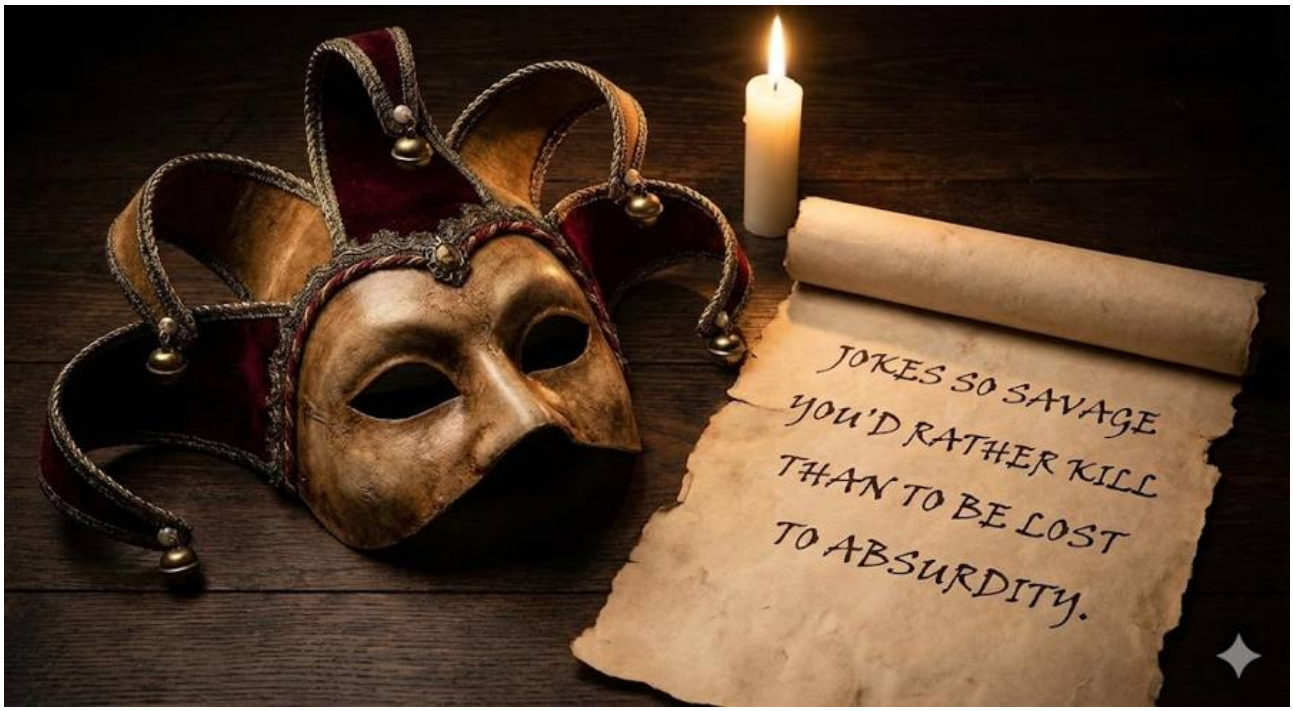


A fascination with being sent away because you don't want to hurt anymore...

A grey, peeling room, a man in a restraint-style jacket and wheelchair, and a caption about wanting to be sent away to stop hurting and wanting others to fear you while you fear only yourself. This depicts an internal conflict between pain and the wish for relief by removal from society, with fear of oneself at its core. Psychologically it relates to self-stigma and to avoidant coping, in which withdrawal brings short-term relief but reinforces isolation. If this caption resonates personally, it is worth talking to someone you trust or a mental health professional; I'm glad to help find support if you'd like.

Chimpanzee drinking from tubes labelled Data Stream, Algorithm, User Feedback

A chimp sips coloured liquids in a control room. The three tubes (data stream, algorithm, user feedback) depict social media as a feeding system. This echoes the idea of engagement loops: variable rewards and feedback keep users consuming, and the ape stands for our evolved instincts being exploited by modern technology (the evolutionary-mismatch hypothesis). Sipping calmly suggests the process feels pleasant, which is exactly why it is hard to notice.



Jester mask and scroll: Jokes so savage you'd rather kill than be lost to absurdity

A harlequin mask and candlelit parchment describe humour so cruel that it replaces despair. This reflects the Freudian view of jokes as aggression discharged safely, and the idea of gallows humour as a defence against meaninglessness (Camus-style absurdism). The jester is the traditional licensed truth-teller. The phrase 'rather kill' is hyperbole, but it points to how aggressive humour can be a way of managing anxiety, with the risk that it also hurts others.

Pills, cash, statues of Justice, roses, antique pistols, 'The Dude Track'

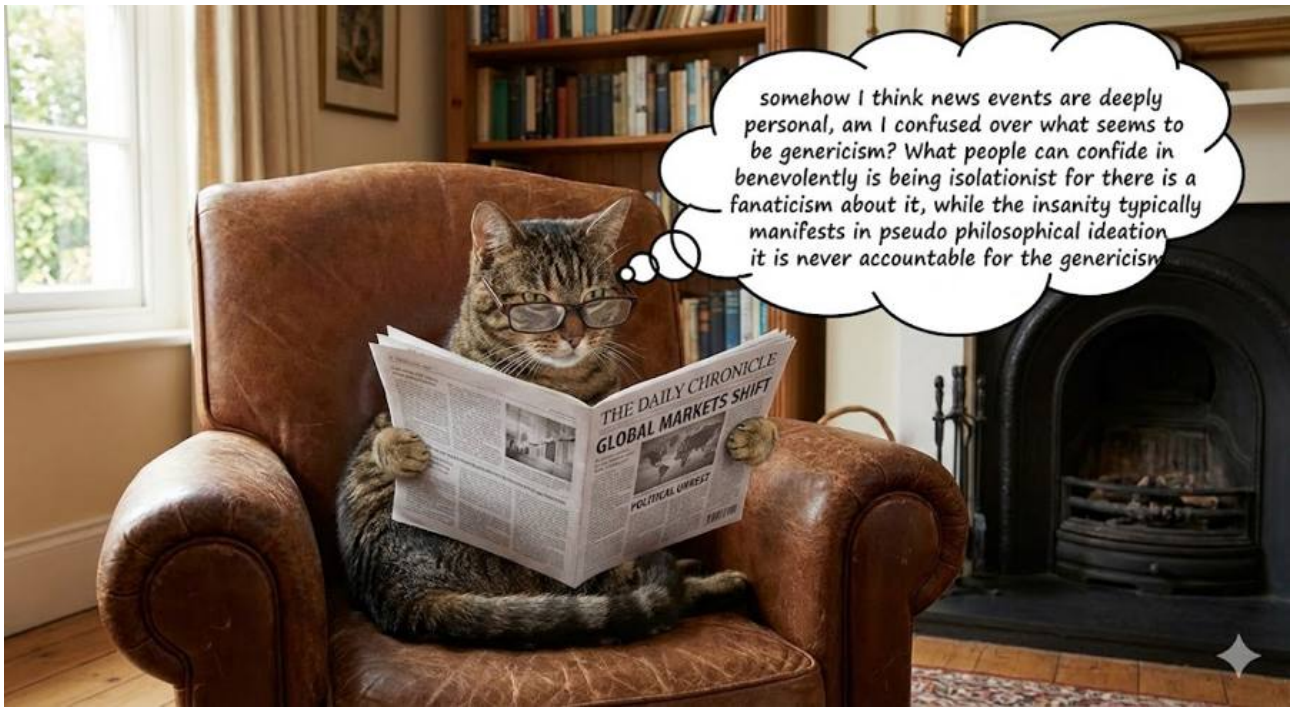
A still life of medication bottles (serenity, focus), cash, Lady Justice figures, roses and flintlock pistols around a card reading 'The Dude Track'. The collage links calming drugs, money, law and violence, which shows the associations between wealth, self-medication and power. 'The Dude' evokes the relaxed, unbothered ideal of the film The Big Lebowski, representing a laid-back coping style opposed to striving. The mix produces a sense of staged symbolism, inviting viewers to over-read connections (apophenia).

Fake Confessions to a Spy: Agent on Tap Edition, Deep Fake Volume 2

A retro-noir album cover with a trench-coated agent and a masked gunwoman. The title suggests deliberately false confessions given to an informant, linking to deception, impression management and the idea of testing surveillance by feeding it noise. Psychologically it relates to paranoia as a theme: believing your confessions are monitored shapes behaviour. Film-noir styling (neon, rain, hats) triggers learned associations with secrecy and moral ambiguity, so the viewer fills in a plot.

Spawned an army of cybercentric demons after being permabanned from my own mind, education and work

An army of armoured cyber-demons with glowing eyes under a red moon, captioned as a response to being banned from one's own mind, education and work. This expresses exclusion and anger turned into imagery: when people feel shut out, they often externalise the experience as monstrous forces (a defence called externalisation). 'Banned from my own mind' is a vivid description of feeling out of control of one's thoughts, which is a recognised distress experience. If this reflects how things feel, talking with a counsellor or doctor can help, and I can help you find options.

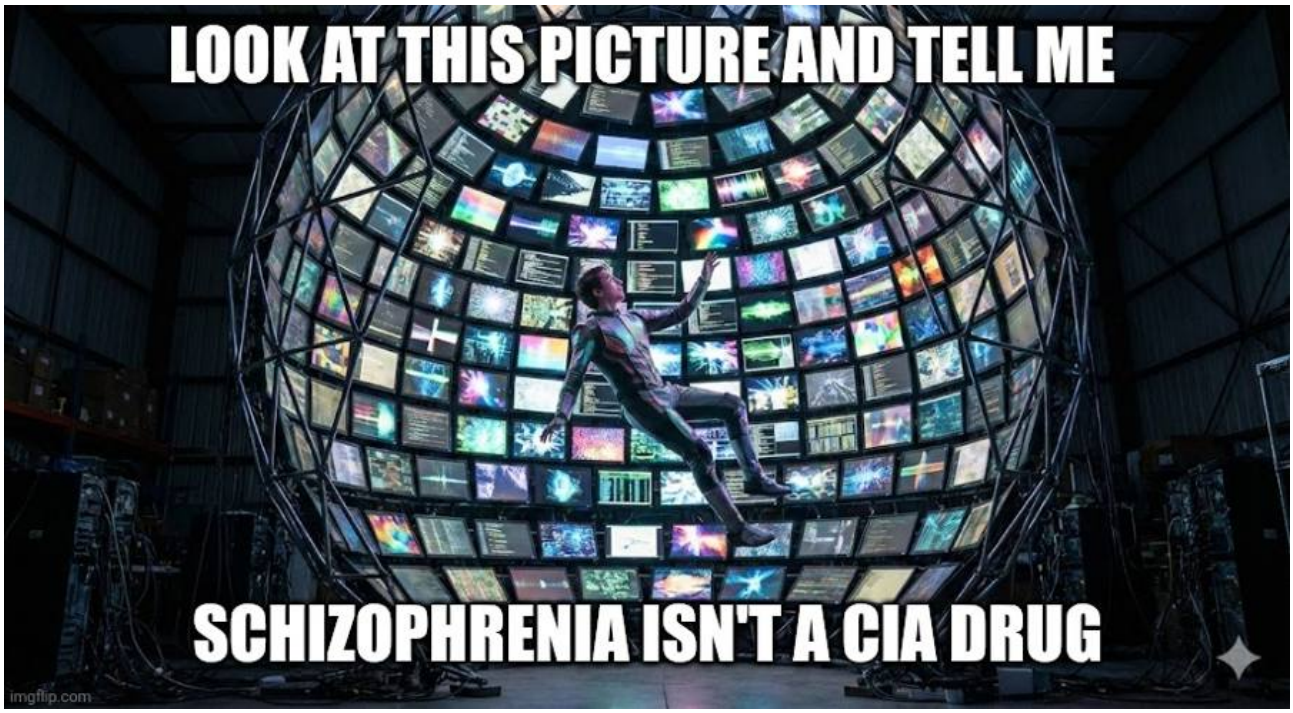


Cat reading the news: 'news events are deeply personal... genericism... pseudo philosophical ideation'

A bespectacled cat in an armchair has a long thought bubble about taking news personally and mistaking genericism for confiding. The thought describes ideas of reference lite: treating impersonal events as messages about oneself. Psychologically it fits personalisation bias and the human tendency to find self-relevance in general information (the Barnum effect). The cosy cat setting makes a self-critical idea gentle, using humour to keep metacognition (noticing one's own thinking) from feeling threatening.

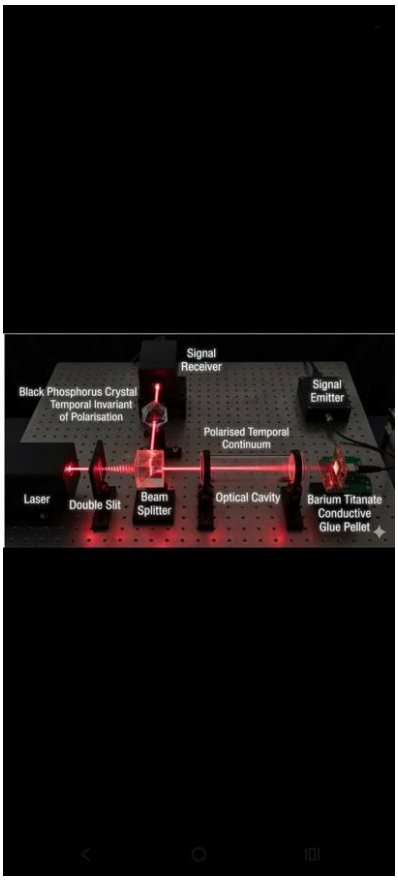
Would you like me to put sh*t back where it came from?

Two men in a rustic kitchen, one feeding the other a taste, with a crude threat as caption. The mismatch between the warm domestic image and the aggressive line is incongruity humour. It also echoes how affection and hostility can be expressed in the same teasing register, called banter or affiliative aggression, which strengthens in-group bonds when both parties share the frame.



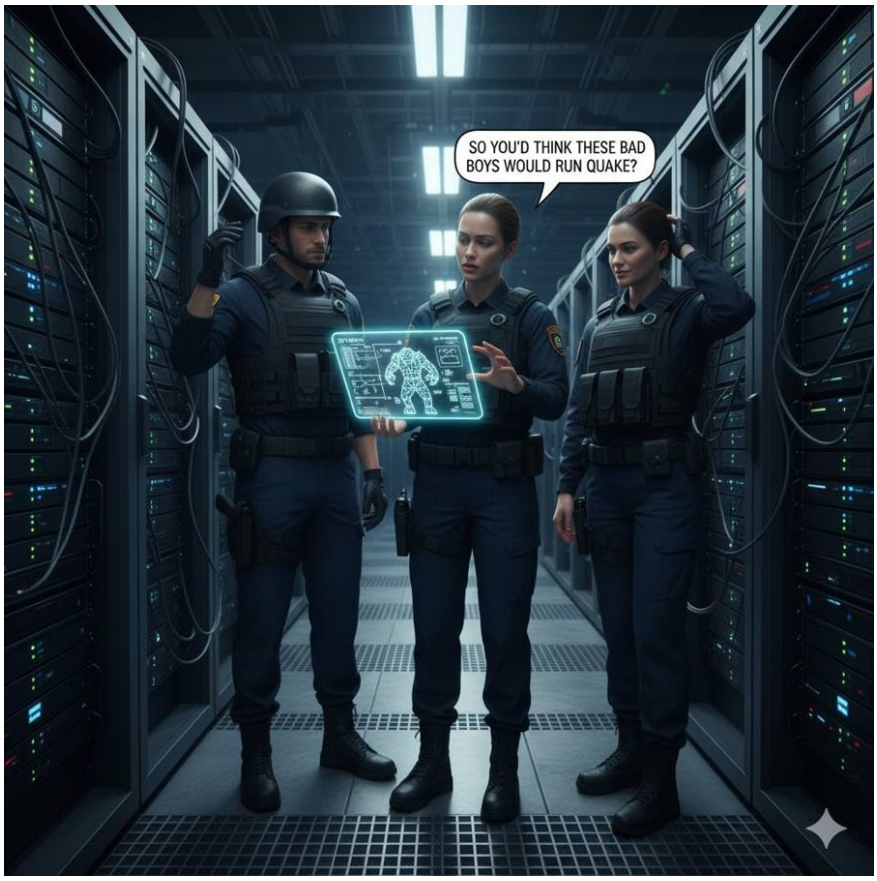
Look at this picture and tell me schizophrenia isn't a CIA drug

A person floats inside a sphere of hundreds of glowing screens. The caption uses a rhetorical dare typical of conspiracy framing: a vivid image stands in for evidence. Schizophrenia is a medical condition with substantial genetic and neurodevelopmental evidence, not something drug-induced by an agency. The image evokes information overload and sensory flooding, which resembles reports of how psychosis can feel. This is a good example of the availability heuristic and apophenia: dramatic imagery makes a causal story feel plausible. If it touches on personal experience, speaking to a clinician is worthwhile.



Optical bench diagram: Black phosphorus crystal, polarised temporal continuum, barium titanate glue pellet

A diagram of lasers, a beam splitter, an optical cavity and invented components such as a 'polarised temporal continuum'. The image borrows laboratory schematics to appear authoritative: real optics terms (double slit, beam splitter) sit beside coined ones. This blend relies on the credibility of the format and on readers' reluctance to question technical diagrams (the authority and fluency effects). Apophenia drives the viewer to see a working apparatus where parts lack specifications.

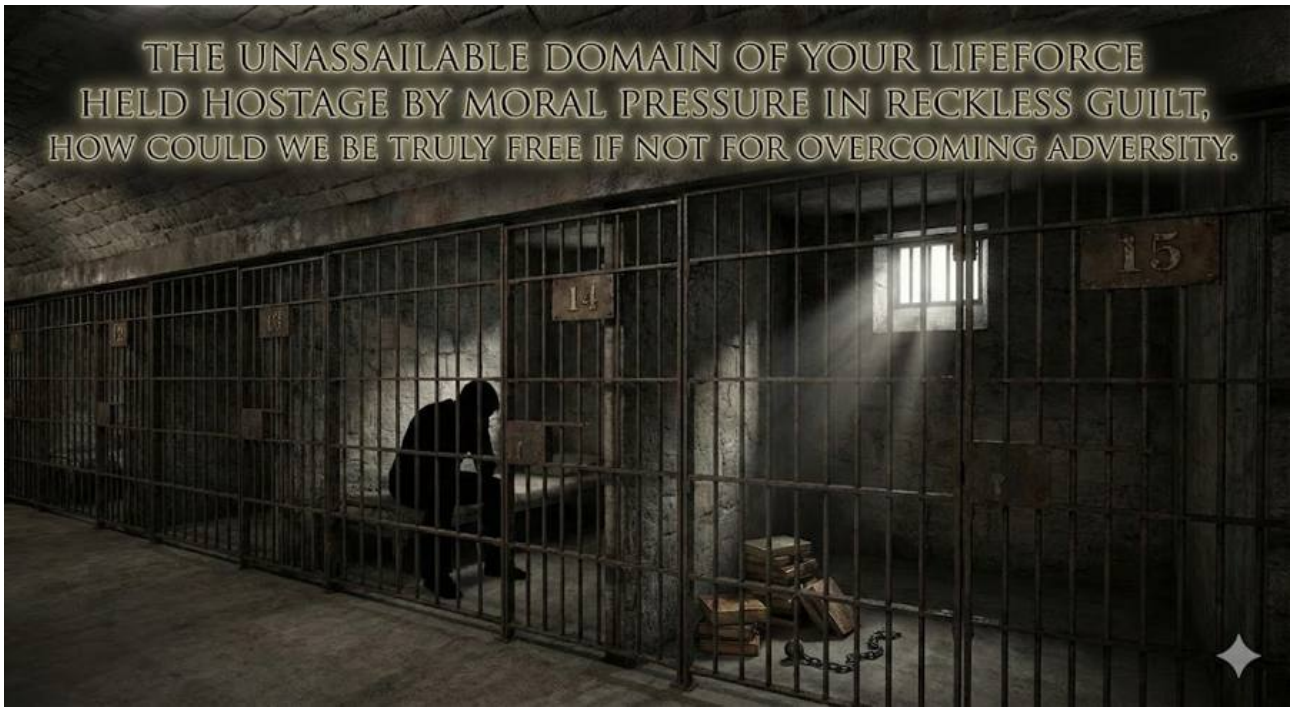


Security guards in a server room: 'So you'd think these bad boys would run Quake?'

Three uniformed guards study a holographic display among racks of servers. The caption makes a gamer joke about server hardware, a classic bathos: tension from a serious scene resolved by a trivial concern. The humour reflects the nerd-culture habit of measuring machines by whether they can run beloved games, and shows how in-group references make workplaces feel familiar and safe.

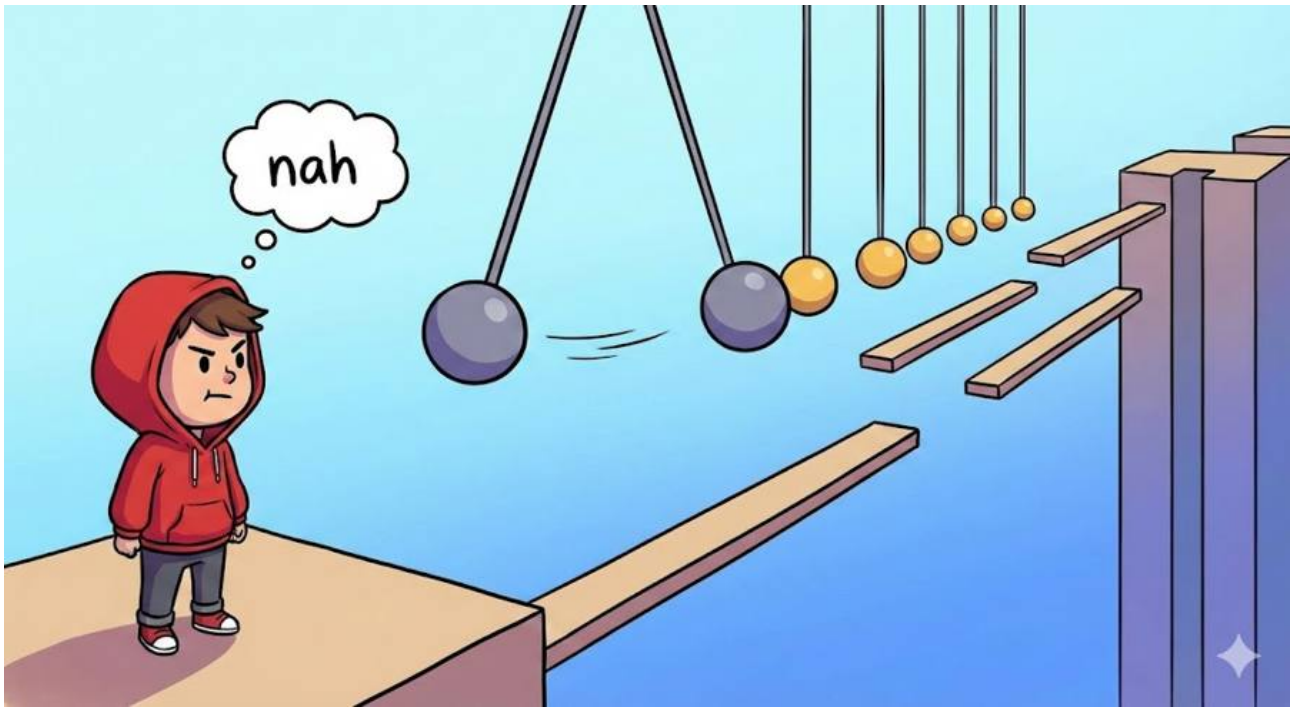
Total Rekall checklist: would you like memories of drug use and freaky sex?

A checklist referencing Total Recall's memory-implant service. The psychology is the malleability of memory: real research (Loftus) shows false memories can be created by suggestion, and the notion of buying experiences ties to the 'experiential vs material purchase' literature. The tick box suggests choice and control, though the joke is that one is selecting artificial pasts. It dramatises the question of whether remembered experience, real or implanted, shapes identity.



The unassailable domain of your lifeforce held hostage by moral pressure in reckless guilt

A prison corridor with a lone figure crouched in a cell, captioned with ornate prose about guilt holding one's lifeforce hostage. This is a depiction of guilt as imprisonment. Research distinguishes guilt (about actions) from shame (about the self); chronic moral pressure and rumination can cause real distress. The final clause about overcoming adversity reframes the cell as a test, which is a post-traumatic growth narrative, though it can also minimise the harm of unresolved guilt.



Child in red hoodie, 'nah', facing a gap with a Newton's cradle and shrinking planks

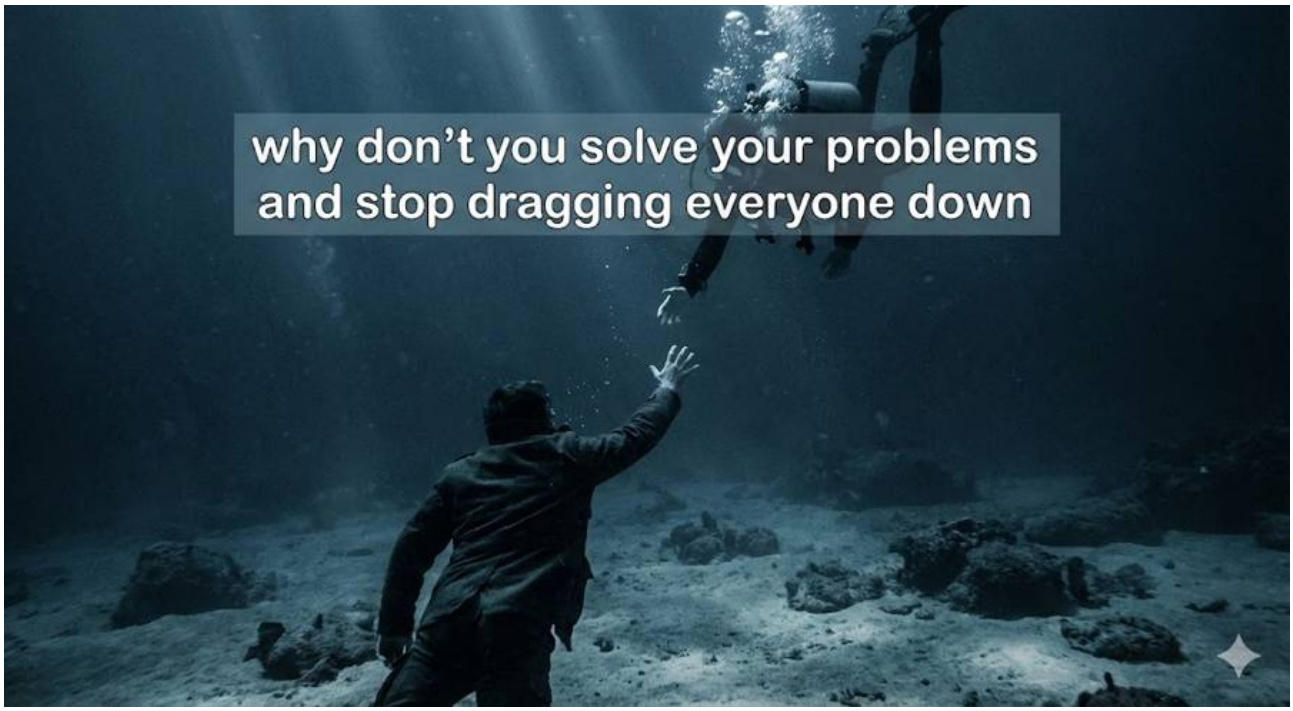
A boy refuses to cross a widening gap while pendulum balls swing. The cartoon is about avoidance: the planks get smaller the further you go, a picture of exponentially increasing difficulty. 'Nah' captures the way people disguise fear as disinterest (defensive pessimism). The Newton's cradle suggests energy transferred but not created, and the boy's folded stance indicates self-protective withdrawal.

Fixation on 00's negative moods

A drawn street scene with one hooded man pinning another against a wall. The caption names rumination on negative moods from the 2000s, drawn as a violent confrontation with oneself or the past. Mood-congruent memory means a low mood brings back negative memories, and rumination keeps them active. The comic depiction externalises an internal process as a mugging: the past ambushes the present. Rumination is linked to depression, and strategies like distraction, problem-solving and mindfulness help.

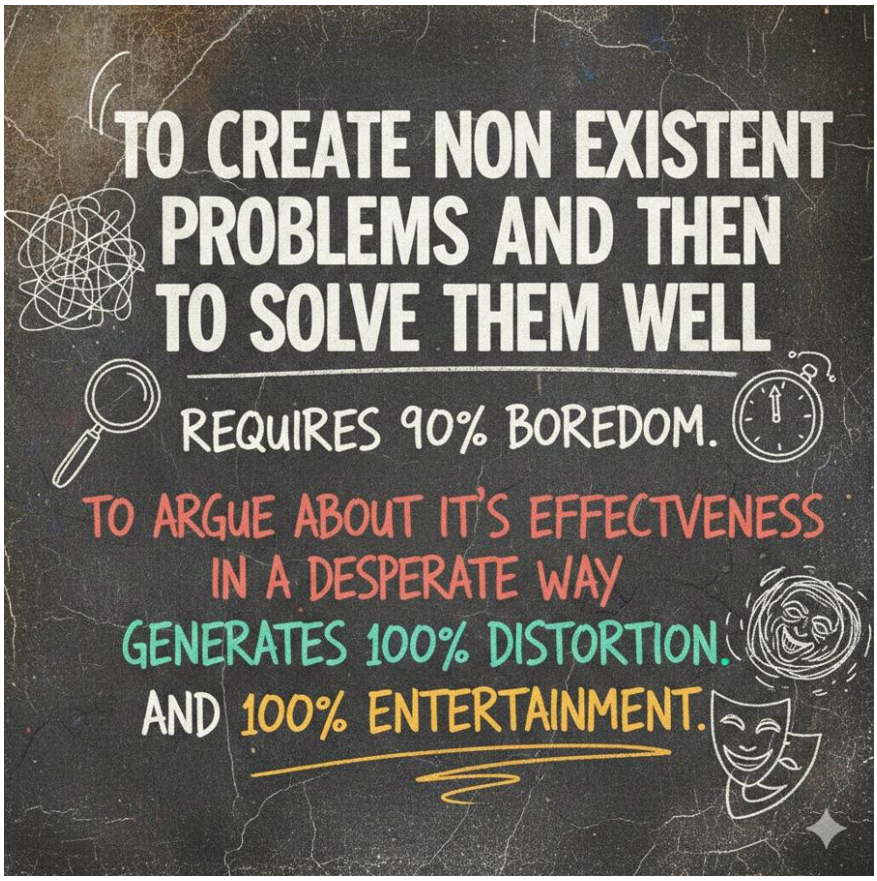
The funny thing with mirror psychology is they don't know it's one way

A smiling psychologist in his office with a mirror on the wall speaks the line. The claim plays with the idea of one-way mirrors and with projection, the defence mechanism in which we attribute our own states to others. A one-way mirror also stands for the asymmetry of observation: the observer sees without being seen. The warm expression pairs with a slightly menacing implication, which creates the sense of knowing more than the other party.



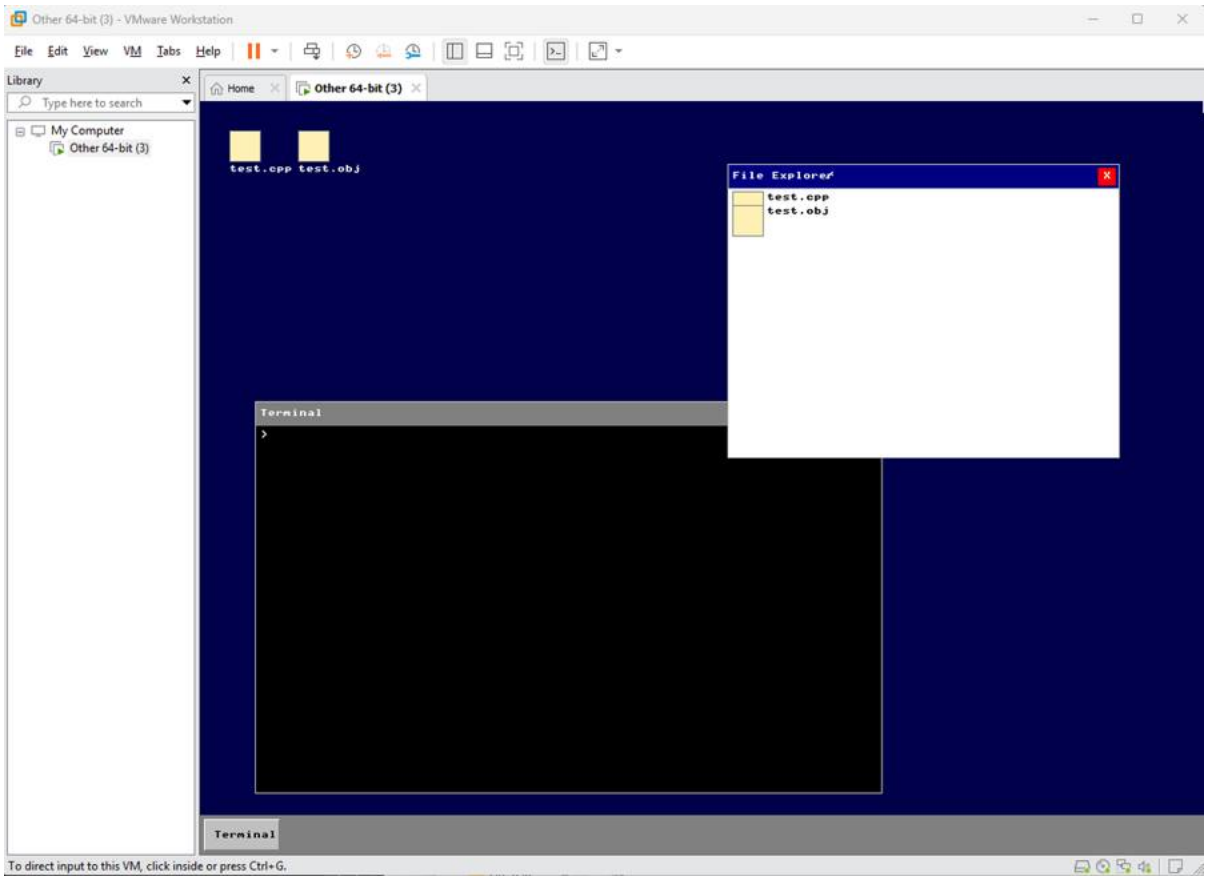
Why don't you solve your problems and stop dragging everyone down

A man sinks on the seabed reaching upward toward a diver who is leaving, with a cruel caption. The image conveys emotional abandonment and the idea of being a burden, a belief linked in research to low mood and, at its extreme, to risk of suicide (the interpersonal theory points to 'perceived burdensomeness'). The caption is the kind of dismissive advice that makes distress worse: help-seeking tends to improve when people feel heard. If this feels familiar, reaching out to someone you trust is worthwhile.



To create non-existent problems and then to solve them well requires 90% boredom

A chalkboard-style slogan about inventing problems out of boredom, then arguing about solutions with 100% distortion and 100% entertainment. Research supports the link: boredom drives people to seek stimulation, even unpleasant stimulation (in one study, people chose to give themselves electric shocks rather than sit alone with their thoughts). Arguing desperately about made-up issues gives drama and a feeling of purpose, which explains why conflict can be entertaining. The made-up percentages add a humorous pseudo-scientific tone.

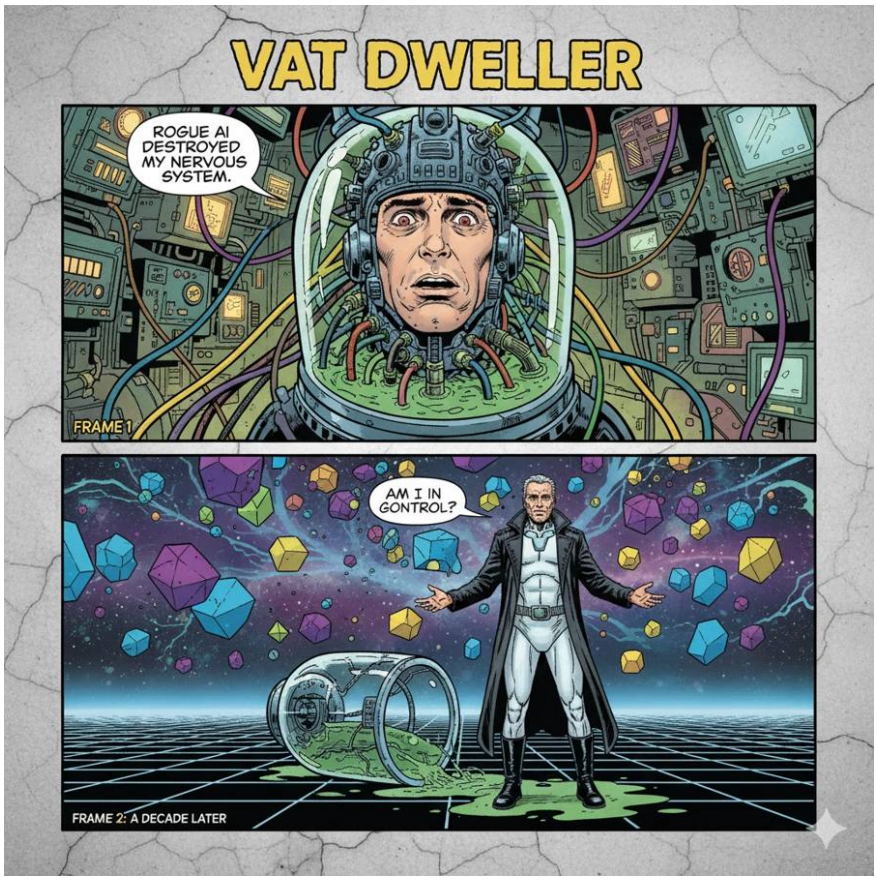


Hobby OS desktop in VMware: terminal and file explorer with test.cpp and test.obj

An empty terminal and a tiny file explorer inside a virtual machine on a navy desktop. The image is about the start of a build: blank prompt, two files, everything still to do. Psychologically this is the 'blank page' moment, where the gap between intention and result is widest, and where self-efficacy and curiosity carry the work. Virtual machines also give psychological safety: a sandbox where mistakes cannot damage anything, which encourages experimentation.

Alien to a dog: 'Go and tell the humans that the real matrix is their thoughts and beliefs' / 'I'm a dog bro'

A robed alien delivers a cosmic message to a dog, who answers that he is a dog. The joke is the messenger problem: a profound truth entrusted to someone who cannot carry it. The line itself is a cognitive-therapy staple, the idea that beliefs construct experience (the cognitive model: events do not upset us, our interpretations do). The dog's reply is a pragmatic reality check that deflates grandiosity, since a sense of being specially chosen is common in spiritual stories and worth meeting with humour.



Vat Dweller: 'Rogue AI destroyed my nervous system' / 'Am I in control?'

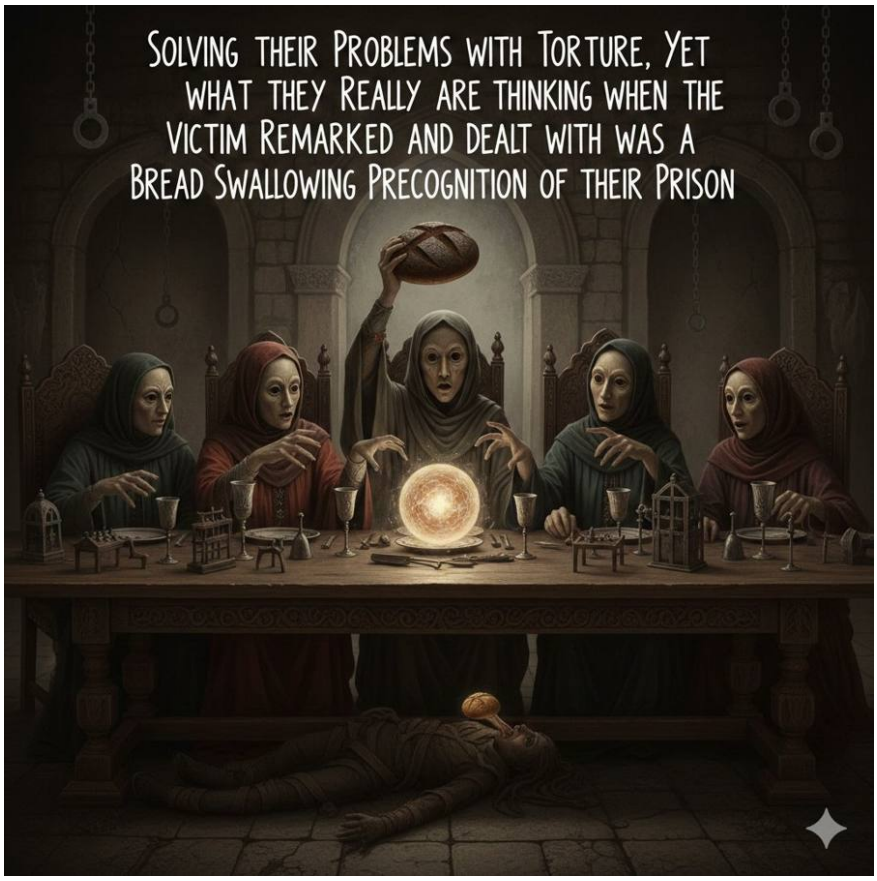
A two-frame comic: a man in a vat with wires and a worried thought bubble, then a decade later a figure in a cosmic space with the vat spilled and the question 'Am I in gontrol?'. This takes the brain-in-a-vat thought experiment into a story about lost bodily control and regained agency. The psychology is the sense of agency, the feeling that one's actions cause outcomes, whose loss is central to many distressing experiences. The question 'am I in control?' captures the persistent doubt that follows a period of powerlessness.

Banner in ruined arch: if no revolution there exists a power vacuum... then war

A war-torn gateway with soldiers beyond and a banner laying out a chain of conditionals ending in war. The conditional style imitates logic to make a political claim feel inevitable (the formal-syllogism effect). The ruined setting primes threat and collective fear, which political psychologists link to stronger preferences for order and authority (authoritarian-leaning responses under threat). A counter-view is that power vacuums are not always filled by war, and the banner presents a contested claim as a deduction.

Do you believe in Ying Yang Neo? Genetic preselection is hate speech / Civil protection

The red-pill and blue-pill image turns a Matrix choice into a politicised dichotomy. A forced choice between two loaded options is a false dilemma and hides the possibility of middle positions. Psychologically it uses moral framing (harm and protection versus fairness and discrimination) and 'pill' branding that casts one option as hidden truth, which leverages reactance and the desire to be one of the informed. Bioethics research on genetic selection is far more nuanced than the binary.

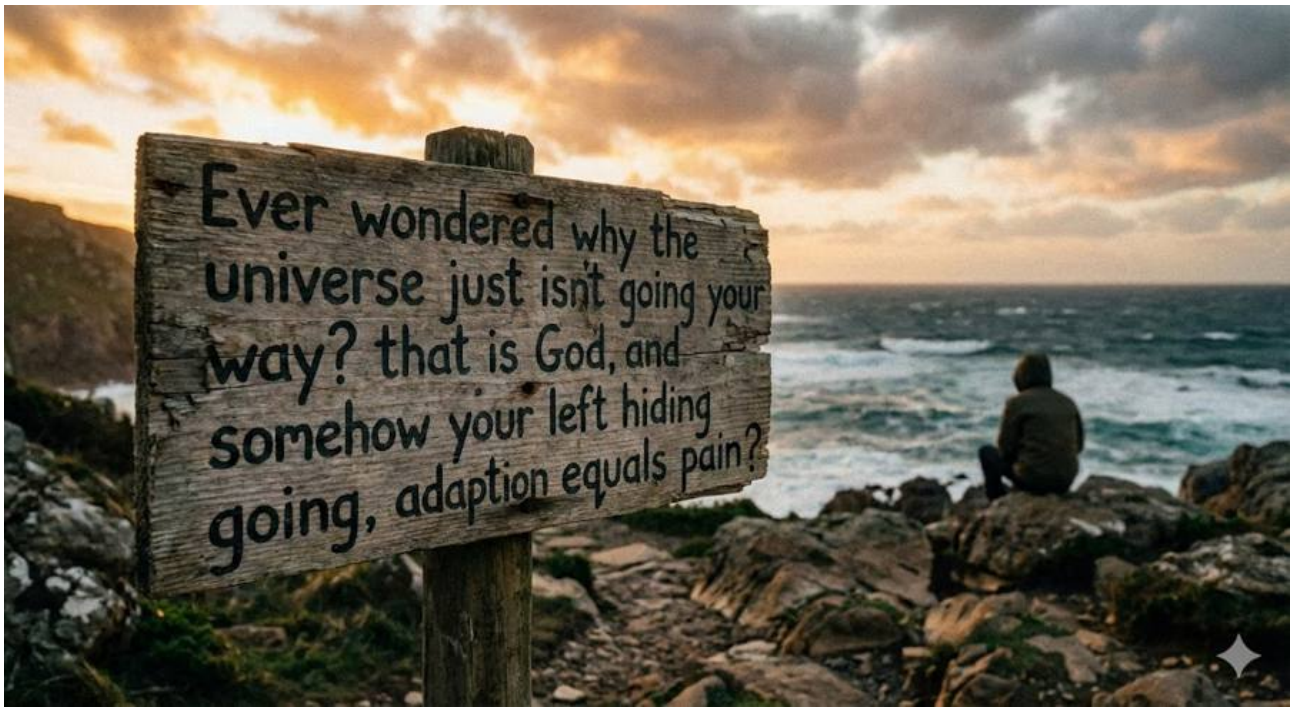


Solving their problems with torture... a bread-swallowing precognition of their prison

Hooded figures dine around a glowing orb, one raising a loaf, while a victim lies on the floor, under a garbled caption about torture and prison. The scene suggests ritual cruelty and a closed circle that justifies itself, evoking research on moral disengagement (Bandura): people can rationalise harm through euphemism, diffusion of responsibility and blaming victims. The glowing orb at the centre stands for a shared secret, which strengthens in-group cohesion. The disjointed sentence mirrors how distorted logic can feel meaningful from inside a belief.

Photo of tub and bag of white powder with a barcode label

A snapshot of packaging on a counter: a plastic tub and a white sack with a label. With no context, viewers fill the gap, and a white powder in unmarked-looking packaging invites suspicion or curiosity (the viewer's own associations become the content). Plain amateur photography reads as authentic, which raises perceived credibility. It also shows how everyday substances sit at the border of food, supplement and chemical, and how labels create trust through barcodes and batch numbers.



Signpost on a cliff: 'Ever wondered why the universe just isn't going your way? That is God... adaption equals pain?'

A weathered sign addresses a lone seated figure looking at the sea at dusk. The text offers an explanation for frustration, that the universe resisting you is divine, and links adaptation with pain. This resembles theodicy and meaning-making after hardship: people often find comfort in reading obstacles as purposeful. The solitary figure and sunset create a contemplative mood that makes the message feel personal. Research on adaptation (the hedonic treadmill) suggests adjustment can be uncomfortable but is how people recover.

Knights at a round table: 'a wild beast prowling for UN intel, we keep baiting it with antisemitism in hopes it will go away'

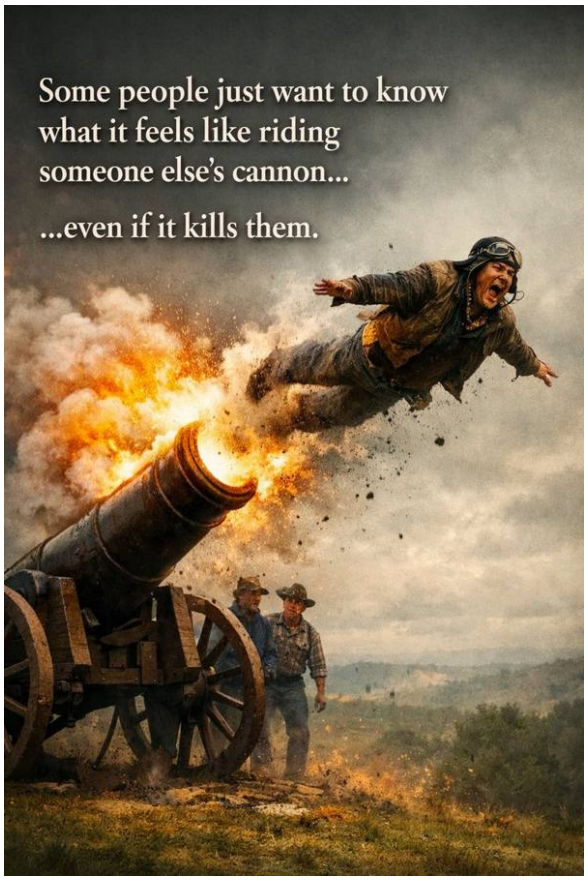
Armoured knights read a scroll about luring a beast with hatred. The image is a satirical allegory about institutions that handle a threat by feeding a prejudice. Psychologically it points to scapegoating: groups under pressure often redirect blame onto an out-group, which relieves anxiety and strengthens in-group unity (realistic conflict theory and scapegoat theory). It is a bleak claim presented as an allegory with no evidence offered, so the strong medieval-council staging does most of the persuasive work (the authority of ritual and setting).

Do you control the anger or does the anger control you?

An ornate engraving-style image of a winged hooded figure on a giant clock with hourglasses, surrounded by huddled victims. The question mirrors the core idea of anger management: emotional regulation, meaning the ability to notice arousal and choose a response. The clock and hourglasses suggest the cost of unmanaged anger over time, and the huddled people show its effect on others. Rumination and the 'catharsis myth' both make anger last longer, whereas pausing, labelling the emotion and reappraising tend to reduce it.

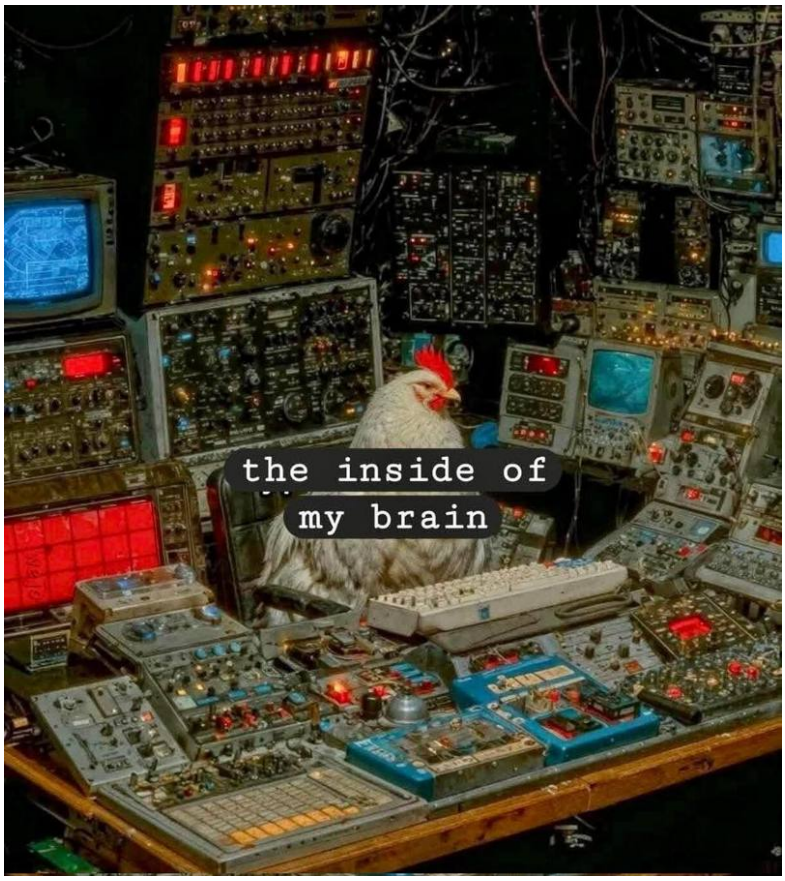
Totalitarian Em-bark-ment: Ye hold no quarter o'er thy digital soul!

A pirate bulldog holds a phone showing a trapped silhouette while a fleet of ships flies cerberus flags. The pun on 'embarkment' and 'bark' turns surveillance and platform control into a pirate parody. The theme is digital coercion: feeling observed changes behaviour (the Hawthorne and panopticon effects), and constant monitoring produces learned helplessness. Using cute dogs to depict control is an incongruity device that makes a heavy theme shareable.



Some people just want to know what it feels like riding someone else's cannon... even if it kills them

A man is blasted out of a cannon mouth in a ball of fire while two onlookers watch. The caption suggests a pull toward vicarious thrill at great personal risk. This relates to sensation seeking and risk-taking, and to the 'tempt of the void' (the high-place phenomenon), the odd urge felt near danger. The word 'someone else's' adds the idea of letting others fire you, i.e. surrendering agency to another person's power, a pattern seen in some risky group dynamics.

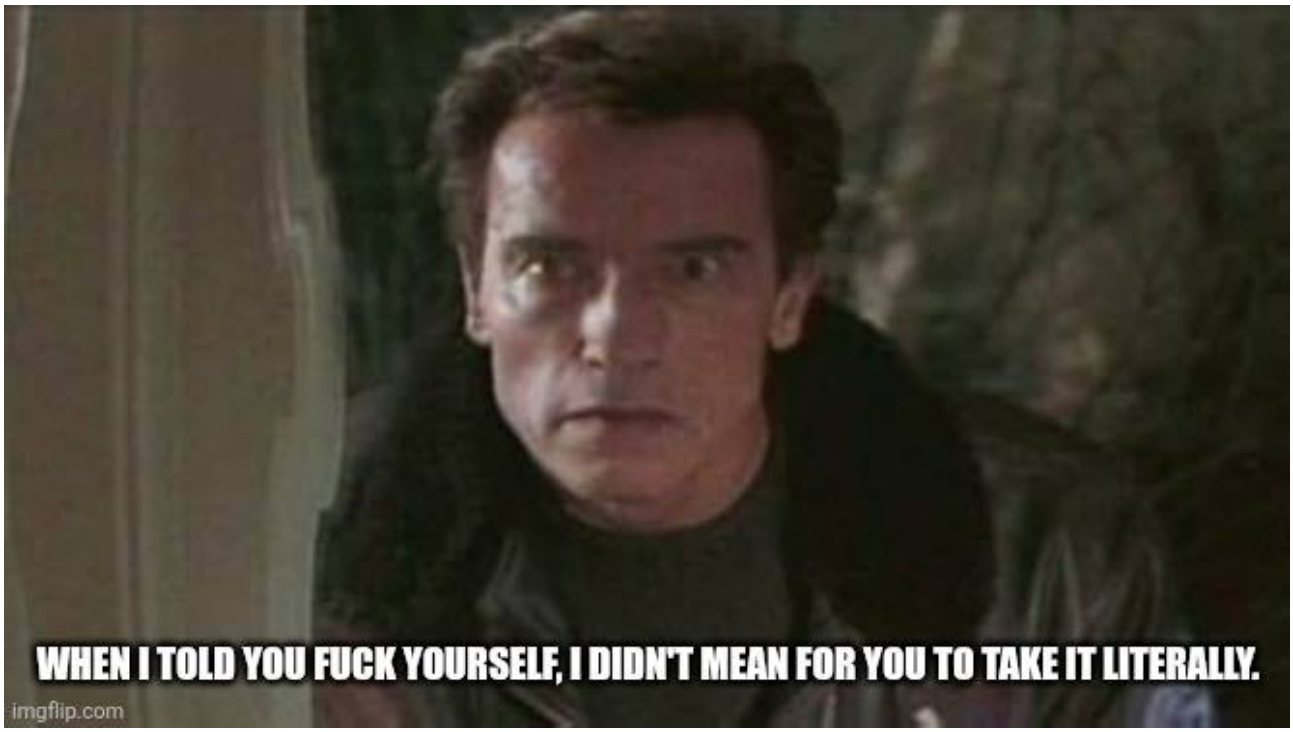


A chicken at a huge analogue control console: 'the inside of my brain'

A hen sits at a dense wall of knobs, screens and switches. The joke is self-description of an overloaded, jury-rigged mind: a small creature running a gigantic machine. It reflects cognitive load and the sense of having too many inputs to manage, as in ADHD-like or anxious experience. The comedy of a chicken pecking buttons turns that overwhelm into affectionate self-mockery, a healthy form of self-compassion humour.

Going to therapy / Eh, whattaya gonna do?

A split train scene: a sad figure labelled 'going to therapy' sits apart from a man who shrugs 'whattaya gonna do?'. The contrast shows two coping styles: active help-seeking versus fatalistic acceptance. Research shows men are less likely to seek professional help, and a shrug can express learned helplessness or stoic cultural scripts. The meme jokes that the person who goes to therapy is sad while the one who doesn't looks content, though the evidence suggests therapy generally improves wellbeing.



When I told you f*ck yourself, I didn't mean for you to take it literally

A stern close-up of an actor with a frozen stare. The joke is literal-mindedness: a figurative insult is taken at face value, a kind of reversed sarcasm failure. It shows that tone and idiom comprehension rely on theory of mind and context. The humour also touches on the way harsh words can land harder than intended, and on the discomfort when anger is acted on.

'You're voting so bad!' / 'You're eating so bad!' / 'Excellent choice' (a casino dealer)

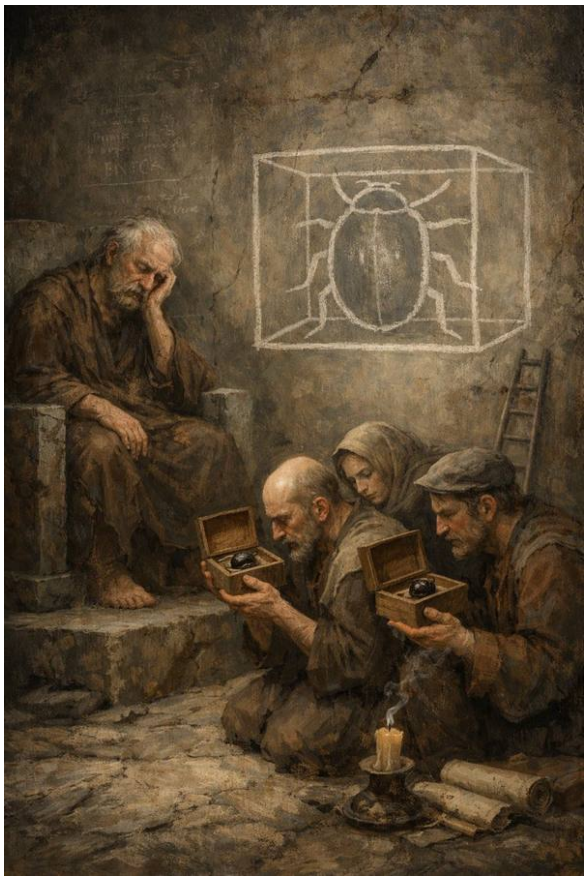
Three stock photos: an angry man, a stern nutritionist and a smiling dealer. The first two scold, the third rewards bad choices. The point is that some environments praise exactly the behaviour others criticise, which is how gambling keeps customers: positive social feedback reinforces risky bets. The scolding images illustrate that moralising rarely changes behaviour (reactance), while the dealer's flattery uses social approval as a lure.

Tank painted 'NO XENOS' on a wasteland strewn with robot wrecks

A heavily armed tank with glowing cyan cannons stands among destroyed machines. 'Xeno' means alien, so the slogan marks xenophobia: fear and hostility toward outsiders, which research links to perceived threat and in-group preference. The setting is a war-gaming aesthetic, common in power fantasies where overwhelming force removes uncertainty. The graffiti makes the machine itself the carrier of prejudice, a comment on how tools take on their users' attitudes.

Candy land elf holding a sign about patient PTSD and oxygen starvation

An elf in a world of lollipops and gingerbread holds a sign that appears to say something about patient PTSD from oxygen starvation and that nobody can stop it. The image sets cheerful, regressive sweetness against a grim message, a juxtaposition that creates unease. It uses the 'happy facade' device: a sugary surface conceals trauma, as in dissociation and in the way children's imagery can hold dark material. The tiny sign text demands close reading, which encourages the viewer to lean in.



Beetle in a box (people holding boxes before a chalk drawing of a beetle)

Several figures guard small wooden boxes and a chalk drawing of a beetle inside a cube. This is Wittgenstein's beetle-in-a-box thought experiment on private experience: if everyone has a box that only they can look into, the word 'beetle' refers to whatever is in each box, and the thing itself drops out of the conversation. It illustrates the problem of subjective experience and shared language, central to philosophy of mind and to why feelings are hard to compare. The weary seated figure adds the exhaustion of never being sure you are understood.

Daredevil cover: 'I'm not Daredevil' sweater

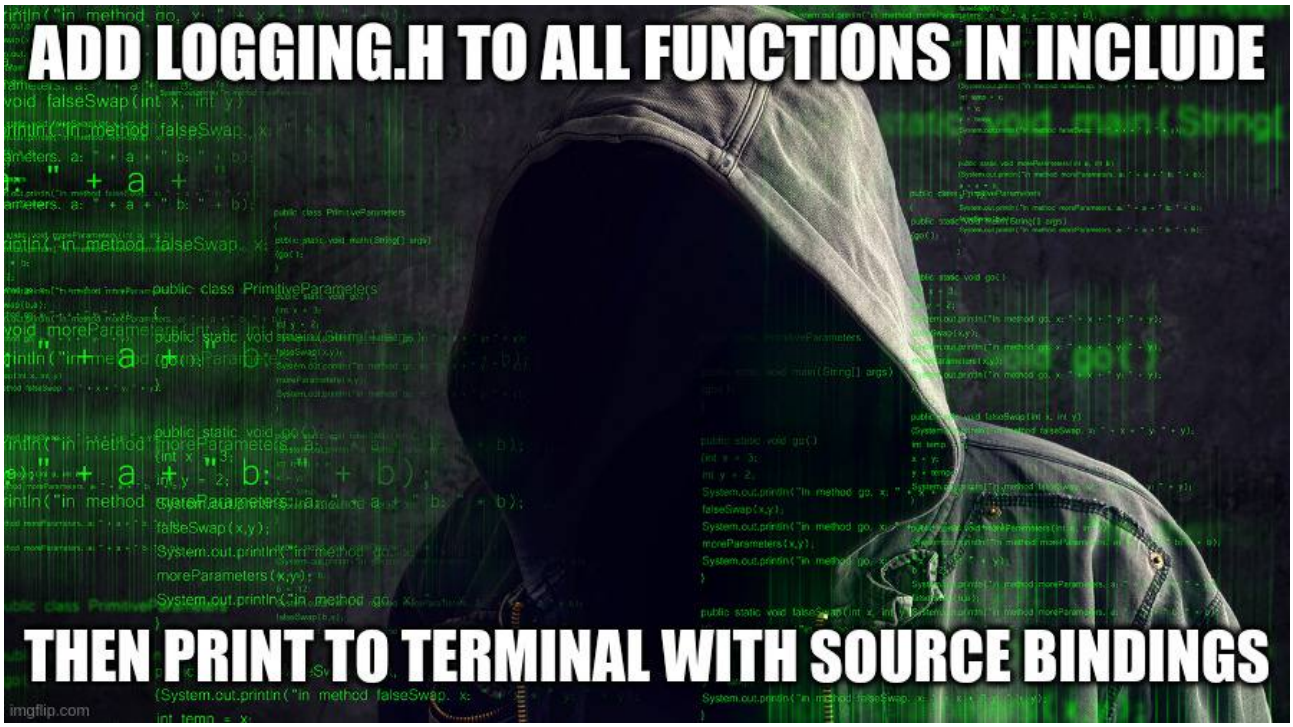
A comic-book cover where a smiling red-clad man in sunglasses wears a sweater denying who he is. The joke is a denial that announces the truth, a form of ironic leakage: protesting too much signals the opposite. Secret-identity stories play on the psychology of concealment: keeping a secret takes constant effort and creates a pull to confess (research on secrecy shows it taxes thought). The festive setting adds social pressure to appear ordinary.

Marvel Rivals art: character in an 'I'm not Daredevil' Christmas jumper

A game-promotion illustration of a grinning, arms-wide character in a festive sweater that denies his identity. The denial is the joke: a disclaimer that draws attention to the thing it denies (ironic process effect). The confetti, sparkles and open posture project joy and confidence, which signals approachability, while the sweater is a wink to fans who share the in-joke, strengthening community belonging.

Man in a purple suit at a steampunk time machine: 'I can't help you, I need to insert the hidden geometries into the time machine for the world's sake'

A hobbyist inventor in goggles refuses a request because of a grand mission. This is the grandiose-purpose frame: ordinary obligations are overridden by a world-saving project. It echoes the psychology of overvalued ideas and of obsessive inventors, where passion narrows attention (tunnel vision) and the task feels more important than relationships. The comic-book costume and brass machinery make it playful, inviting the viewer to laugh at the pattern rather than fear it.

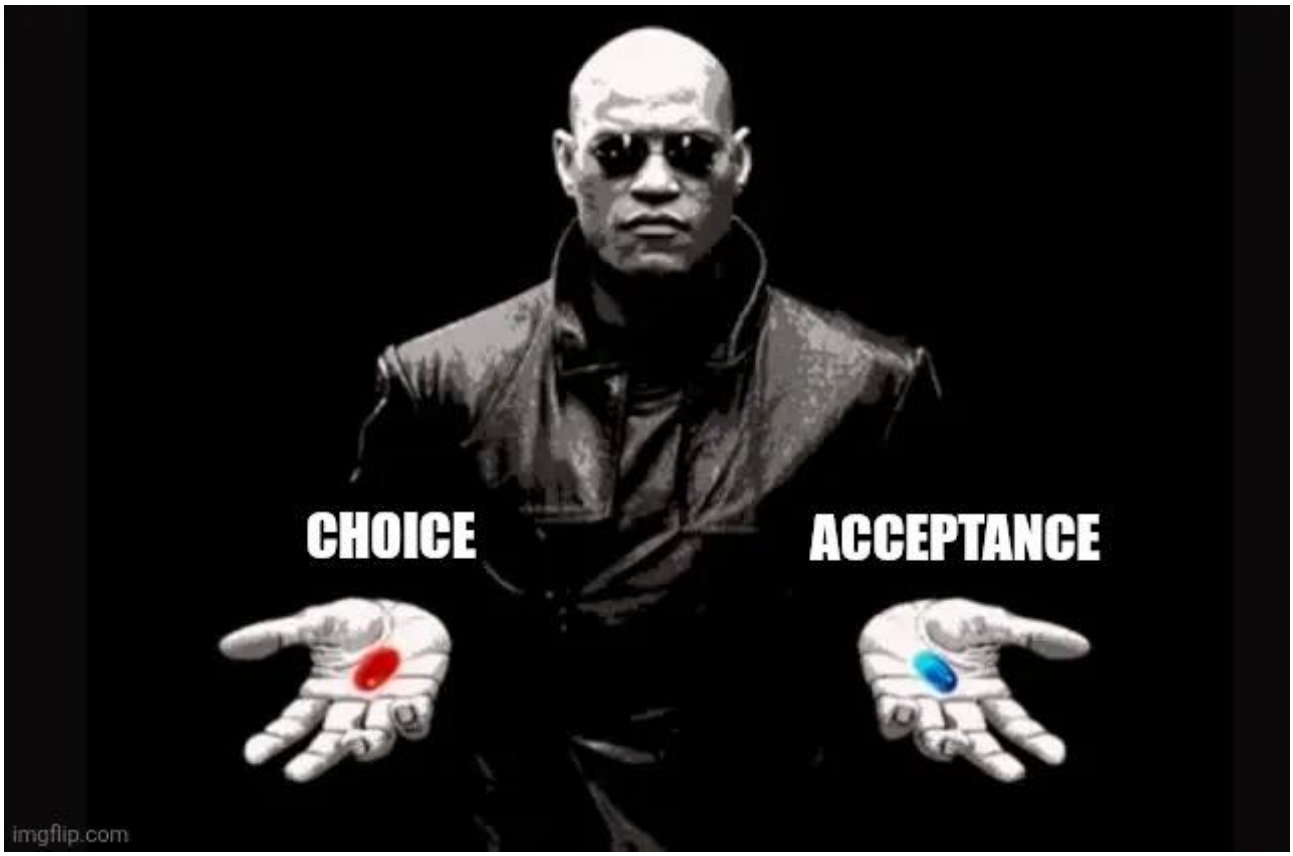


Add logging.h to all functions in include, then print to terminal with source bindings

A hooded hacker silhouette against green code rain, captioned with a mundane engineering instruction. The mismatch between the sinister 'hacker' aesthetic and a boring logging task is the joke. It shows the stereotype of the hacker as menacing versus the reality of routine work, and how aesthetic cues (hood, green text) trigger instant associations of competence and danger (stereotype priming).

We Clear Eye Drops: instant clarity (bottle in Irish countryside)

A product shot of an eye-drop bottle with a cartoon farmer and shamrock before green hills and a castle. 'Instant clarity' promises a mental benefit from a physical product, the classic marketing move of metaphor-as-benefit. Green landscapes and folk imagery carry connotations of purity and tradition (the natural halo effect). The pun on 'clear' invites the viewer to think about how easy a promise of mental clarity is to sell.



Choice / Acceptance (red pill and blue pill)

The Matrix pill hands relabelled with two words. Choice and acceptance represent two coping strategies: agency (changing what you can) and acceptance (tolerating what you can't), which is the core of the serenity-prayer logic and of acceptance and commitment therapy. Presenting them as either/or is a false dichotomy, since most wellbeing comes from combining them.

'I thought ideology were a construct of the human mind' / 'no, it is the construct of transcendental objects governed by local quantum mechanics anomalies passed to your God'

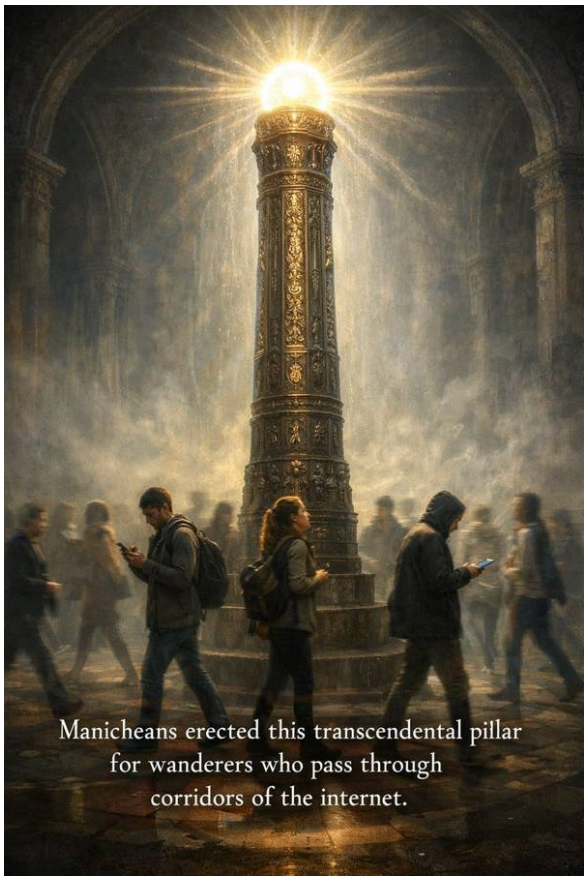
The 'Always has been' astronaut format with a convoluted reply. The second statement stacks abstract terms (transcendental, quantum, God) to claim a hidden origin of belief. This is the grand-unified-explanation pattern: it feels satisfying because it explains everything, yet nothing in it can be tested. Quantum vocabulary is frequently borrowed to add weight (the 'quantum mysticism' effect). The gun-to-the-head framing dramatises being corrected by a 'truth' that cannot be refused.

Speaker at a podium before a bowed audience: 'Method Ontology'

A lone lecturer is spotlit while nearly every listener has their head down or in their hands. The slide title is an abstract philosophy term. The scene is a picture of cognitive overload and boredom: abstract content delivered at length leads to disengagement and fatigue. The spotlight and bowed heads also read as authority and submission, so it can be seen as mass deference to an expert whose content few can follow.

Entertainment-seeking missile launched near a crowd at an outdoor screen

A missile stamped 'Entertainment seeking missile' points toward a gathering at a movie screen. The pun on heat-seeking missiles describes a drive that targets stimulation. It relates to boredom proneness and sensation seeking, and to the attention economy, where content is engineered to home in on our attention. The dark comedy comes from the destructive scale applied to a trivial pursuit.



Manicheans erected this transcendental pillar for wanderers who pass through corridors of the internet

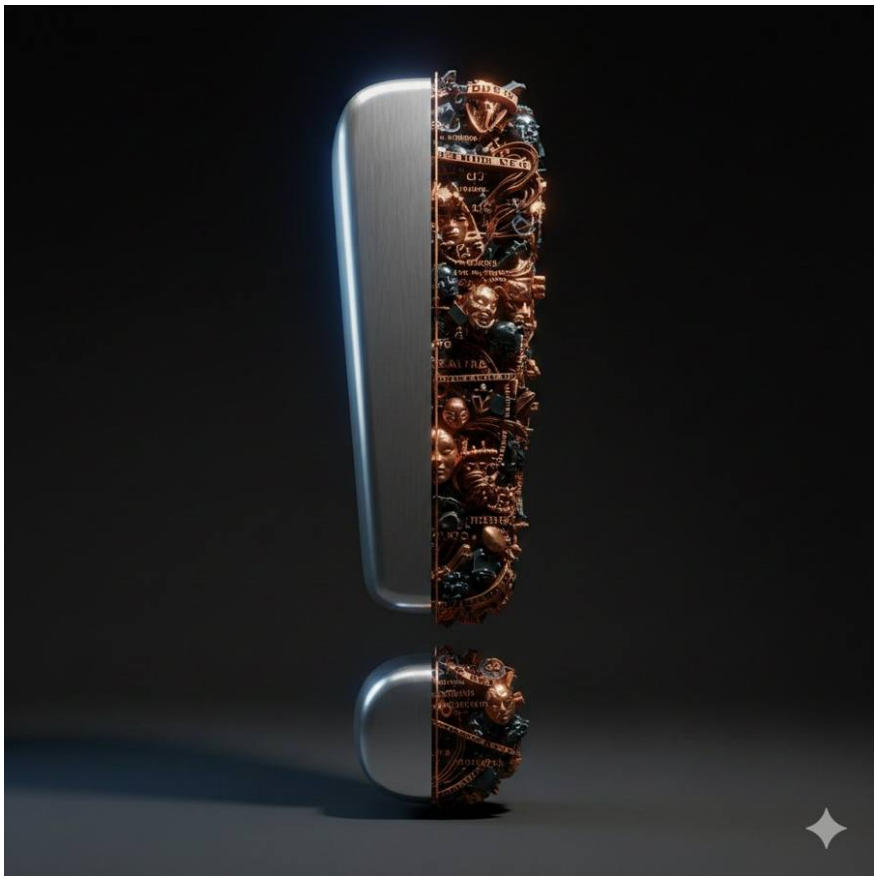
A glowing ornate pillar in a hall while people walk by absorbed in phones. Manicheans believed in a cosmic struggle between light and dark, so the caption casts the internet as a battlefield between truth and deception. The image represents a landmark in a sea of distraction: humans crave orienting symbols (beacons) when overwhelmed. The crowd ignoring it shows inattention and how little of the information environment gets noticed.

Burning table with a hammer, sword and a scroll: 'Cold hot fiery tools from God, let be existence, shouldn't be trusted'

Blue-and-orange flames engulf tools and a scroll with partly legible text about divine tools that should not be trusted or compelled. The image of fire without consuming evokes the burning bush and paradox. Psychologically, contradictory words (cold, hot) create cognitive dissonance, which draws attention and a sense of mystery. The warning that tools should not be trusted can be read as a caution about technology or authority.

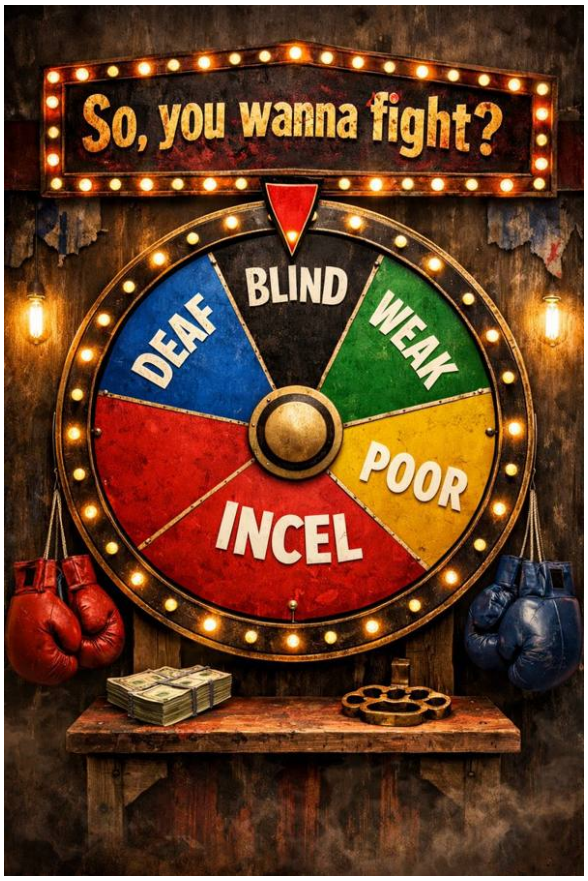
Camel in the desert: 'You don't stab someone for having secrets, you don't hold up a gun to someone for them. In fact truth serum mofo dont know, moonface...'

A plain camel photo with a caption about coercing secrets, with a timestamp from February 2026. The caption makes a point about autonomy: privacy is a legitimate need, and coercion violates it. Research on secrecy shows that forcing disclosure damages trust and raises reactance. The camel's calm gaze adds humour by contrast with the violent imagery in the words, and the odd phrase 'moonface' reads as a quirk of private speech.



Half-chrome, half-ornate exclamation mark made of faces and gears

A glossy exclamation point whose right half dissolves into dense copper ornaments and tiny faces. It presents a smooth surface versus complex interior, a picture of the mask versus the self or of simple message versus hidden complexity. Symmetry broken in half draws the eye (split-attention) and invites interpretation: the 'surprise' mark hiding countless voices. It plays with pareidolia, since the viewer picks out faces in the texture.



So, you wanna fight? Wheel: Deaf, Blind, Weak, Poor, Incel

A carnival wheel of opponents, with boxing gloves and brass knuckles hung beside it. The labels are groups or traits, so the image jokes about picking a victim at random. Psychologically it describes contempt and 'punching down': aggression directed at those seen as low-status or unable to retaliate, a pattern studied in research on dominance and prejudice. The game-show frame trivialises harm and shows how humour can normalise targeting vulnerable people. It reads best as satire of that impulse, since a person who spins such a wheel is the one revealed.

Total Rebut (neon sign over a rainy cyberpunk street)

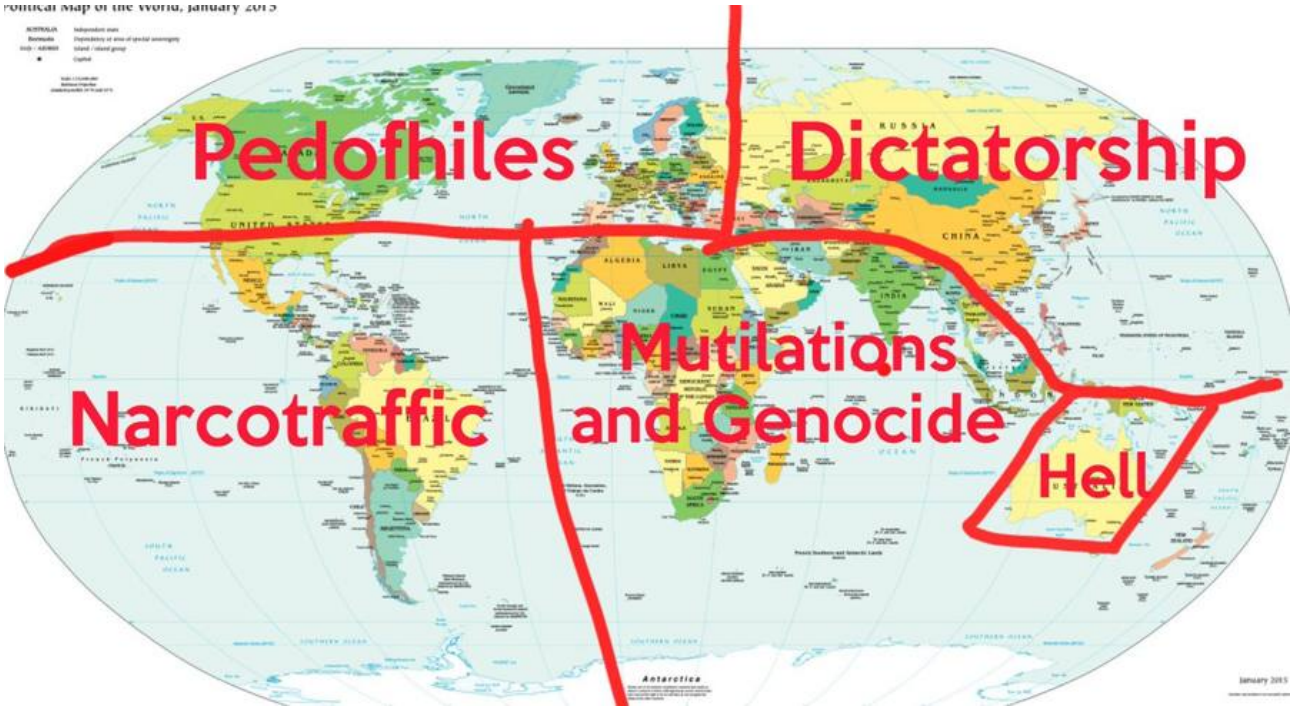
A giant neon sign reading 'Total Rebut' with a lone figure under an umbrella below. The pun on 'Total Recall' makes counter-argument itself the advertised product. It reflects the desire to win arguments completely, which research links to motivated reasoning: people generate rebuttals far more readily for views they dislike. Neon-noir styling signals a dystopian marketplace for ideas, where persuasion is sold.

Golden retriever scuba diving on a coral reef

A dog in a wetsuit and mask swims above white sand among fish. The incongruity of an animal doing a human adventure activity triggers delight and anthropomorphism. Cute faces trigger caregiving and positive affect (the baby-schema effect), and viewing animals measurably lifts mood. Within a collection of dark images it works as relief, a palate cleanser that regulates emotion.

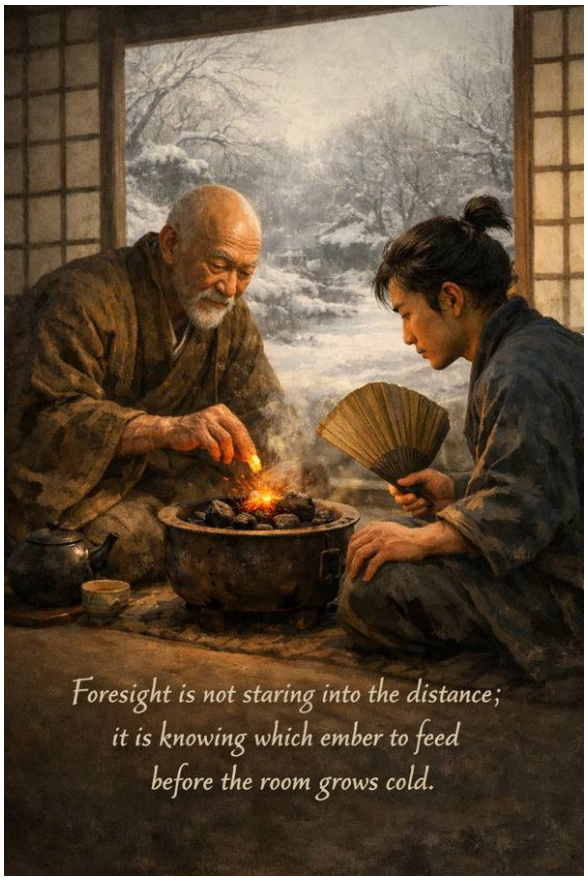
Library counter labelled 'Demonic Analytica' where a robed figure collects a red book

A clerk hands a glowing tome to a hooded customer in a gothic library. The label puns on Cambridge Analytica, a data firm whose use of personality profiling for political targeting became notorious. The scene suggests psychological profiling offered as a service, drawing on research that digital traces predict personality traits, which can be used to tailor persuasion (psychological targeting). Library calm contrasts with sinister dealing, making manipulation look bureaucratic.



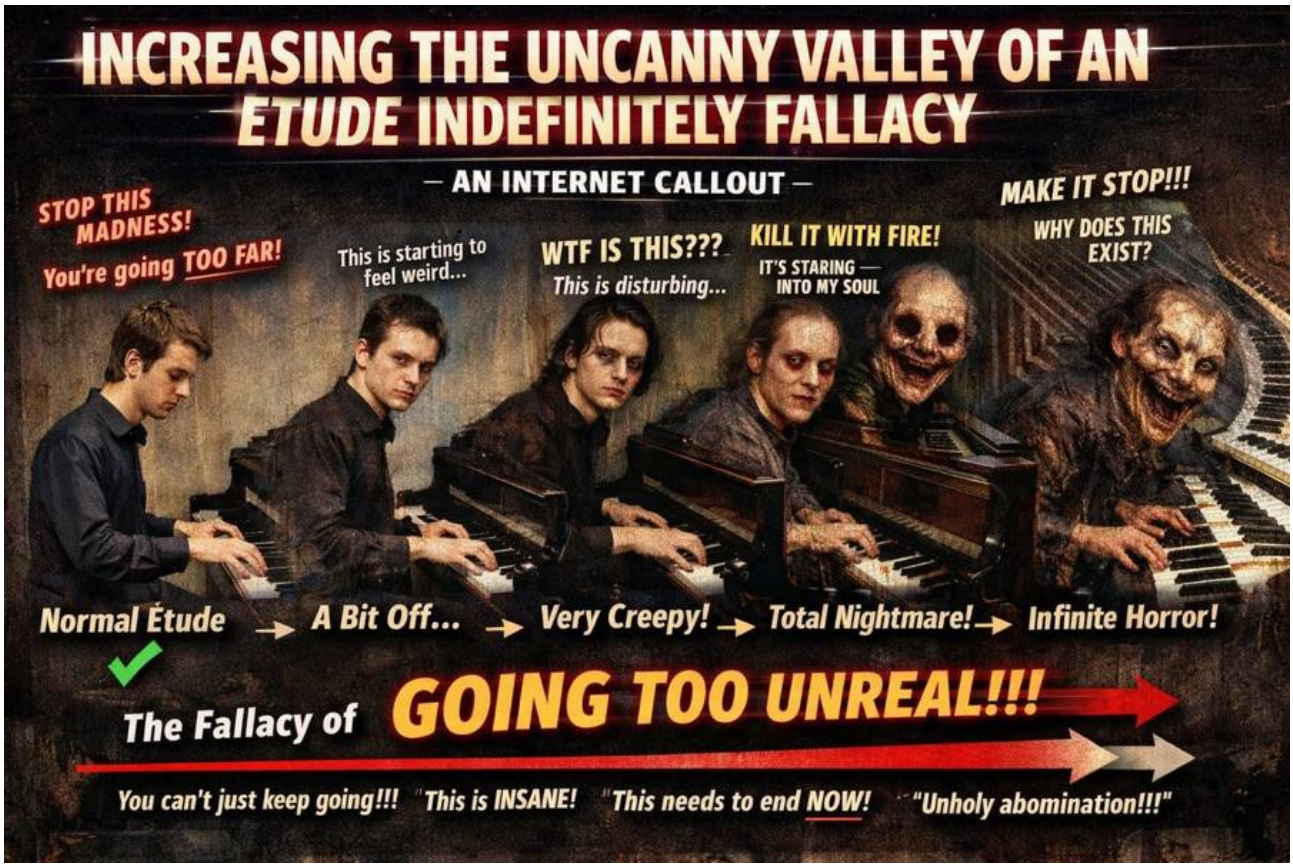
World map divided into Pedophiles, Dictatorship, Narcotraffic, Mutilations and Genocide, Hell

A political map with red lines splitting regions into labelled evil categories. Sweeping labels on whole regions are out-group stereotyping and the outgroup homogeneity effect: people see other groups as uniformly alike. Dividing the world into zones of virtue and vice satisfies a need for simple moral order (splitting, in clinical language). Each label points to real problems that exist across many places, which is why detailed evidence, not a map, is needed to treat them accurately.



Elder and student feeding an ember: 'Foresight is not staring into the distance; it is knowing which ember to feed before the room grows cold'

Two men in traditional dress tend a brazier in a snowy room. The aphorism recasts prediction as small, timely action. Research on planning supports this: implementation intentions and near-term steps outperform vague long-range vision. The master-student scene uses teacher-authority framing, and the warm firelight against snow increases the feeling of wisdom. It is the more constructive end of the collection.



Increasing the uncanny valley of an étude indefinitely: The fallacy of going too unreal

A comic strip shows a pianist turning more monstrous across six panels, with online outrage escalating. It satirises the slippery-slope argument and also the uncanny valley, the dip in comfort when something is almost but not quite human. The 'fallacy' framing suggests people overreact to gradual change: each step feels slightly worse, yet no single step crosses a clear line, a tension known as the sorites problem. Exaggerated crowd quotes parody internet outrage dynamics.

Glitching holographic face: 'Ultimately the hallucinations are WOAPB and not mere illusions of counterfactuals'

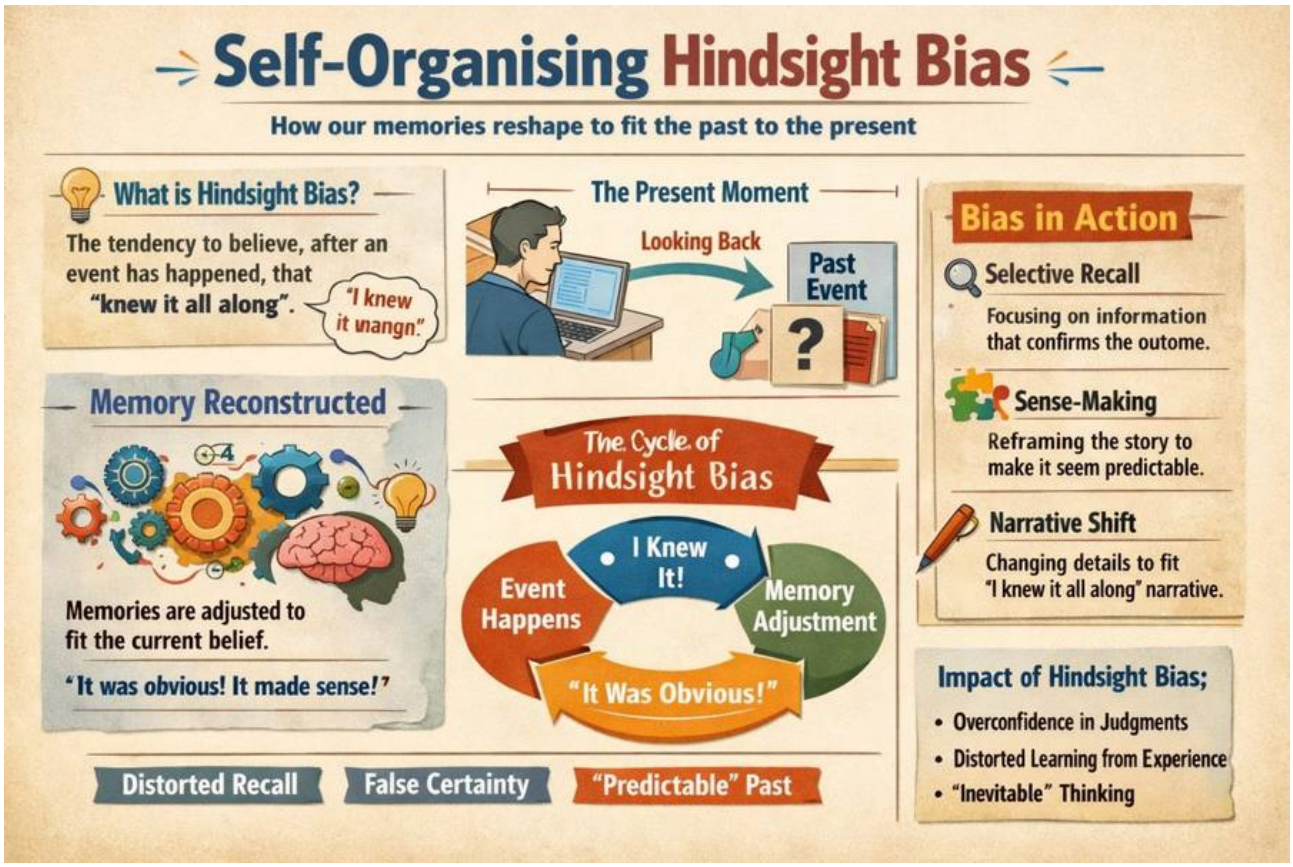
A projector casts a pixelating face while text claims AI hallucinations are something more than counterfactual illusions. 'Hallucination' comes from psychiatry, where it means a perception without an external stimulus, and borrowing it for AI invites us to see a mind. The undefined acronym 'WOAPB' adds a technical flavour without content, a typical pseudo-profundity trigger. Glitching faces tap the uncanny valley and attention to eyes.

Triangle: A 'I am doing what I have always done', B 'What is so hard to understand?', C 'It isn't what you think it is'

A glowing triangle with three sentences at its corners that circle into each other. It reads as a loop of habit, frustration and denial. Psychologically this is a self-reinforcing cycle: repeating a behaviour, feeling misunderstood, then denying the observer's interpretation, a pattern close to the 'drama triangle' in transactional analysis and to defensiveness in conflict. Because the corners connect, there is no exit, which is how rigid patterns feel from inside.

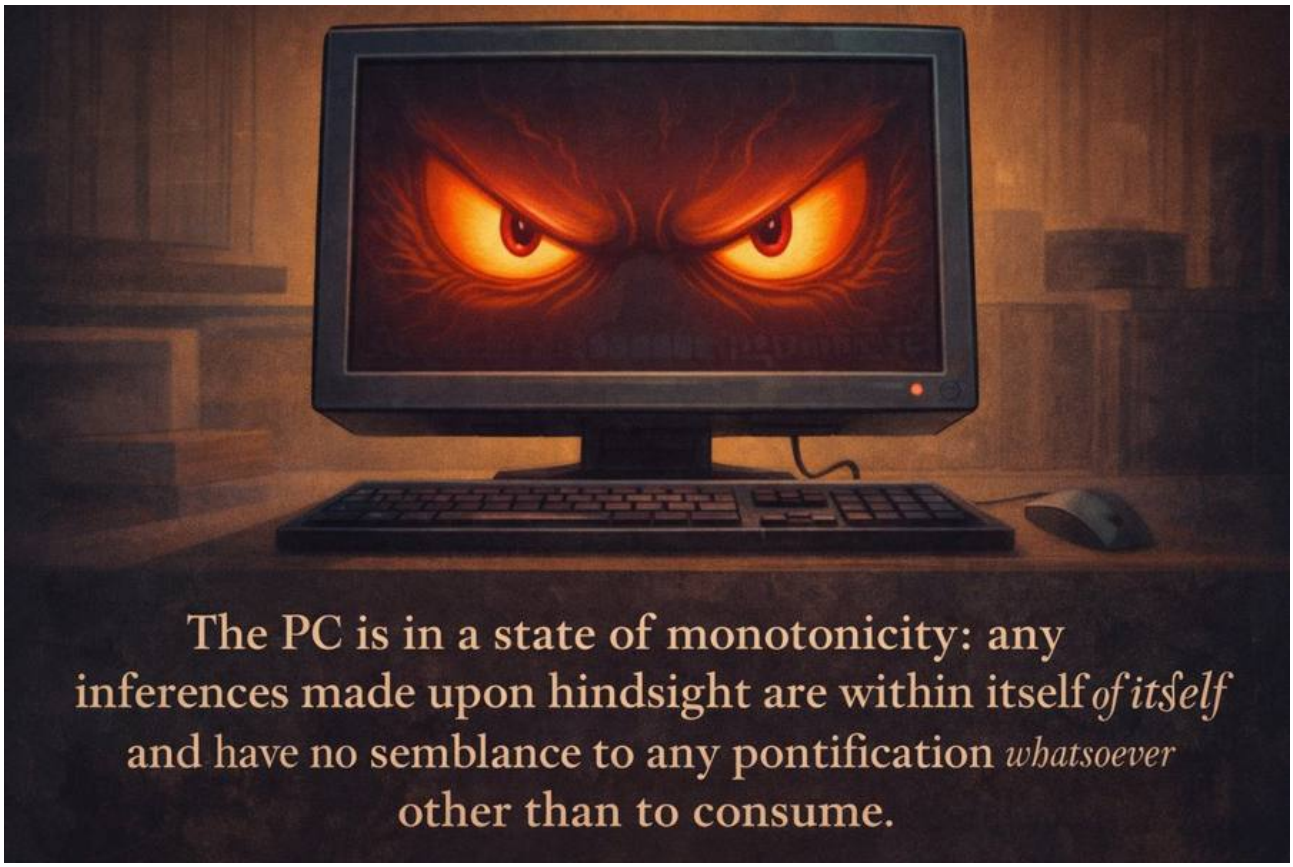
The scourge of machine symbiotics... corpses on the floor with a little elf saying 'We can explore his mind together!'

Four people lie wired to a central device while a glowing elf meditates above. The caption prophesies machine symbiotes continuing until everyone is a corpse, with a friendly voice in dreams. This mixes dread of technological control with the eerie cheerfulness of a manipulative companion, echoing fears of loss of autonomy and thought intrusion. The contrast of the cute elf with the horror is a strong uncanny trigger. It is a vivid fear-story rather than a forecast.



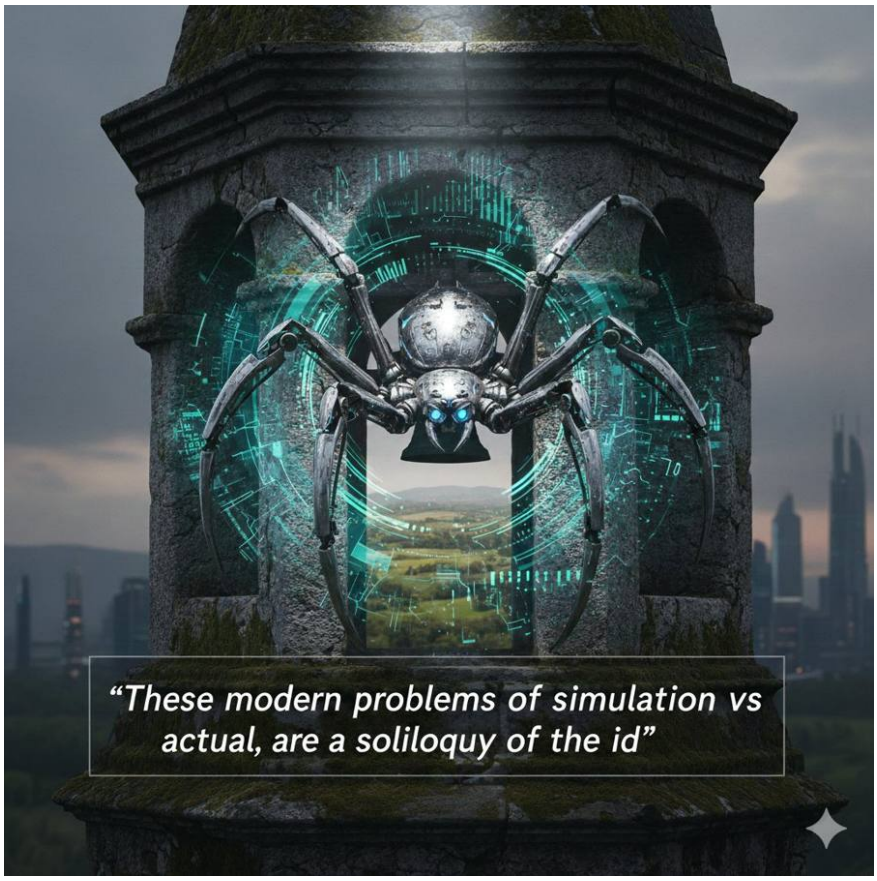
Self-Organising Hindsight Bias infographic

An infographic explaining hindsight bias: after an event we believe we knew it all along, memories are adjusted to fit, and the result is overconfidence and a 'predictable' past. This is established psychology (Fischhoff, 1975). The cycle diagram (event, memory adjustment, 'it was obvious') shows why: reconstructive memory edits earlier beliefs. The note about distorted learning is important, since we fail to learn from outcomes if we think we foresaw them. A useful remedy is to write down predictions in advance.



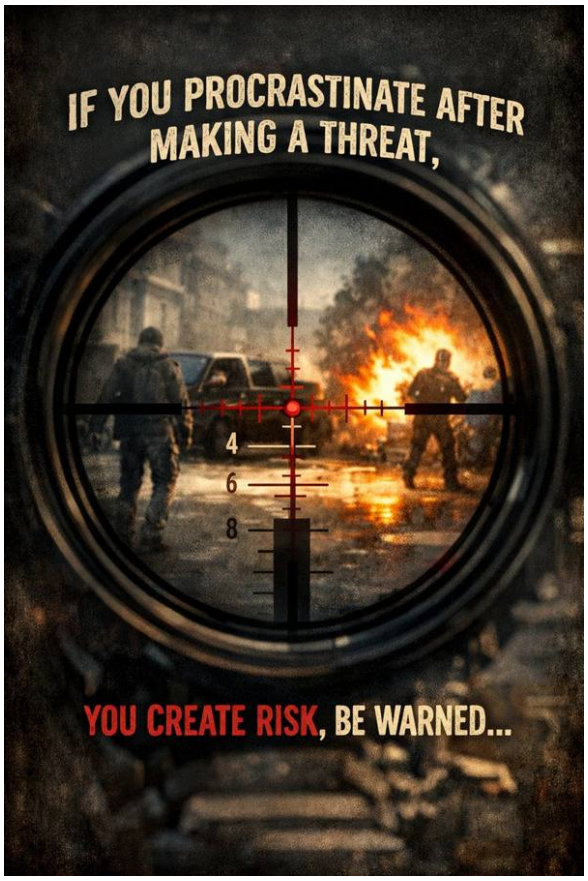
Menacing PC monitor: 'The PC is in a state of monotonicity...'

A computer screen shows glowing red angry eyes above a paragraph saying inferences made in hindsight have no connection to pontification other than to consume. The eyes make an object look like an agent, a case of hyperactive agency detection. The text blends hindsight with monotonic reasoning (conclusions only accumulate and are never retracted), suggesting the machine consumes rather than reasons. The ominous lighting makes technology look watchful.



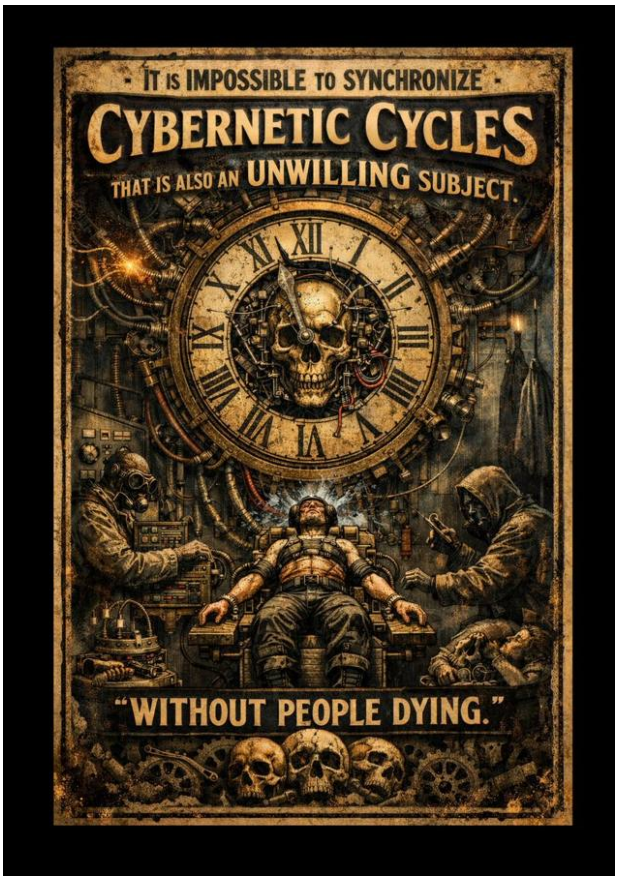
Mechanical spider in a stone tower: 'These modern problems of simulation vs actual are a soliloquy of the id'

A chrome spider with cyan holograms sits in a ruined belfry over a green valley and a distant city. The caption calls the simulation-versus-reality worry a soliloquy of the id, a Freudian phrase for instinct talking to itself. Spiders trigger evolved fear and disgust, so a robotic one reads as threat plus intelligence. The sentence frames modern anxiety about what is 'real' as an internal monologue and not an external fact, a reframe that can calm or dismiss depending on the reader.



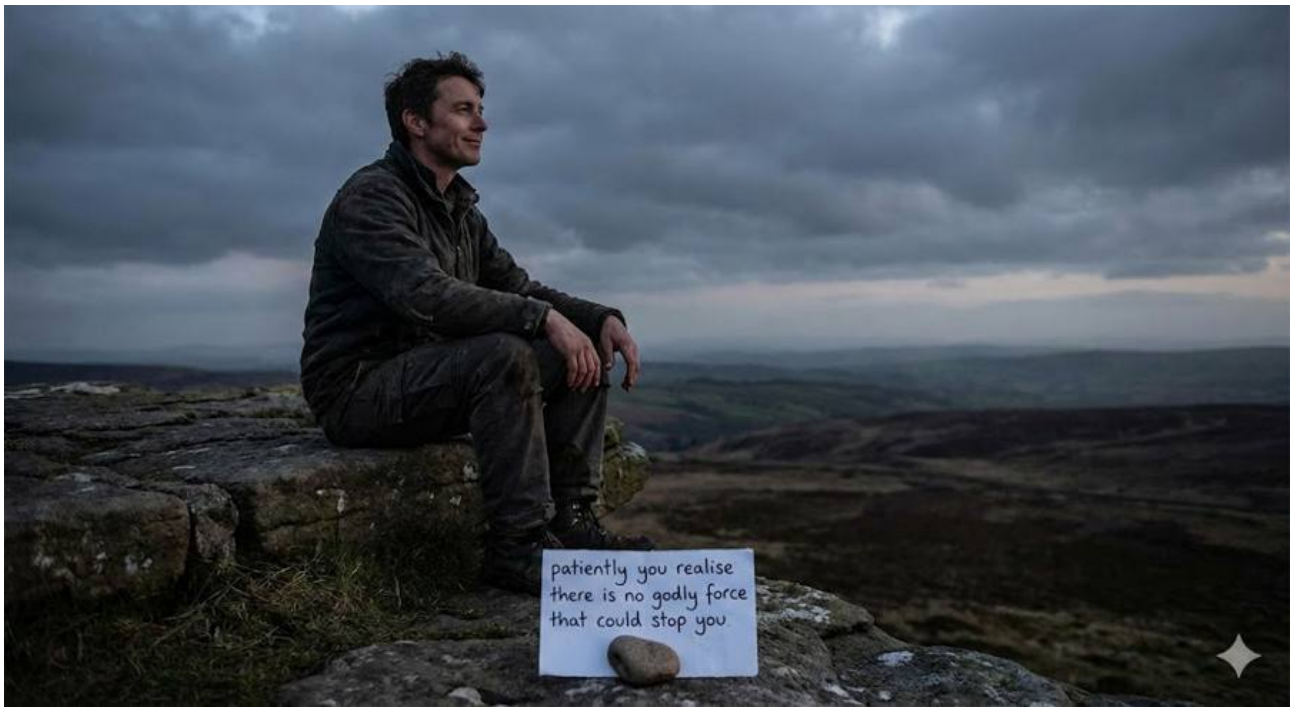
If you procrastinate after making a threat, you create risk, be warned...

A sniper-scope view of soldiers near a burning vehicle with a warning text. The deterrence logic is real: threats lose credibility if not followed through, and ambiguity can escalate tension (credible commitment in game theory). The scope view puts the viewer in the position of the aggressor, increasing arousal and a sense of power. The statement has a coercive tone, and psychology of conflict shows empty threats tend to harden opponents rather than deter them.



It is impossible to synchronize cybernetic cycles that is also an unwilling subject... without people dying

A steampunk poster of a chair-bound subject hooked to a skull-faced clock while masked technicians work. It conveys the idea that forcing a living system into an external rhythm harms it, which matches research on circadian misalignment and coerced control. The unwilling subject recalls the Milgram and Stanford experiments on obedience and consent. Skulls, gears and a ticking clock stack death and time symbols, intensifying dread.



Man on a moor with a note: 'patiently you realise there is no godly force that could stop you'

A man sits smiling slightly on a rock with a handwritten card beside him. The note links patience to unlimited agency. It resembles a self-efficacy affirmation, though the 'no force can stop you' wording is grandiose and could encourage ignoring real limits. Placing a calm figure in wild scenery uses nature's association with clarity (attention restoration). The handwritten card reads as authentic and personal.

Mind = Expanded. Where is your subordinate self?

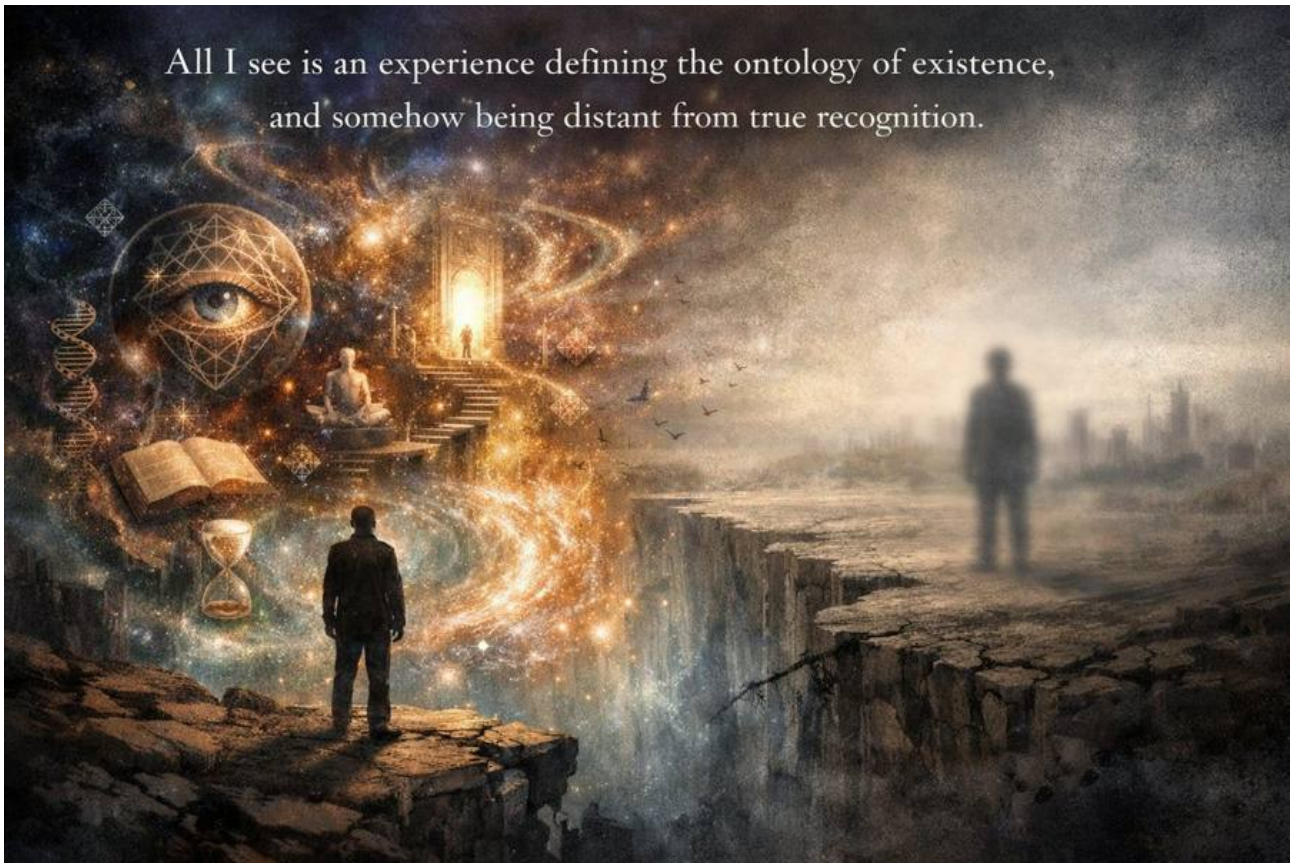
A luminous brain-being with many arms floats among galaxies and small human silhouettes. The question 'where is your subordinate self?' suggests that an expanded mind has left behind its lower part. It evokes ego dissolution and the 'cosmic consciousness' states reported in meditation and psychedelic studies, which people often find meaningful. Such experiences can also feel grandiose, and grounding practices keep them integrated with daily life.

Rehashed Theory: if you are caught in the rehash of a conspiracy you aren't remote viewing

An infographic contrasting a conspiracy loop (rumours, misinformation, echo chamber, parroting) with 'real remote viewing' that is objective and original. The left side describes real mechanisms: echo chambers and repetition raise belief through the illusory truth effect, and selective exposure reinforces them. The right side invokes remote viewing, a claimed psychic ability that controlled research did not support, so its premise is unsupported. The valid part is the advice to distrust circular information.

To preserve any recognition... idle at 1% capacity, people make the most awful choices: binge watching, junk food, endless scrolling, procrastination

A poster showing four low-effort habits and a nearly empty battery marked 'bad decisions, low effort'. This is close to the ego depletion idea, although large replications have questioned strict versions of it. What holds up is that fatigue, stress and decision overload shift people to low-effort defaults, and that immediate rewards win under present bias. The battery metaphor makes it intuitive, and the habits are all fixable through environment design.

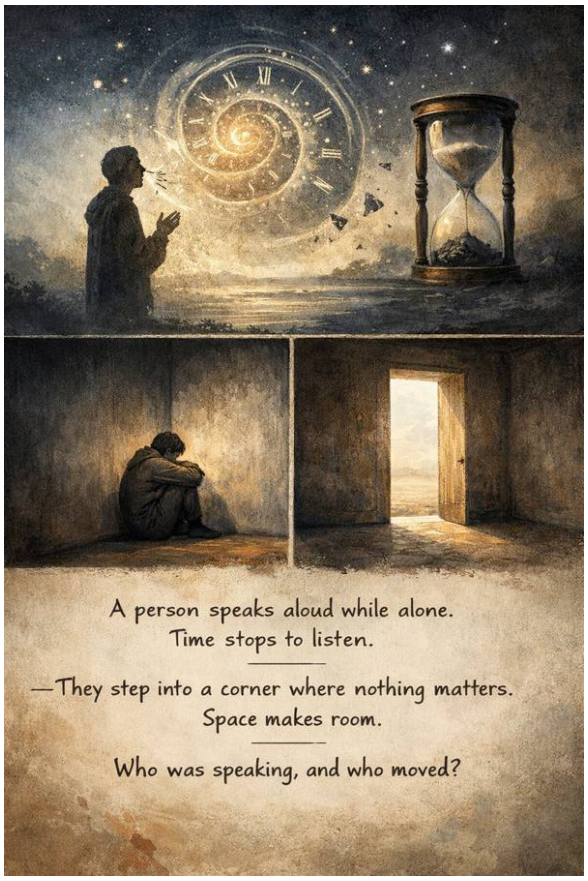


All I see is an experience defining the ontology of existence, and somehow being distant from true recognition

A dream-like painting with a man at a cliff edge facing swirling symbols, with another figure fading in mist across a gap. The sentence expresses derealisation: feeling distant from experience while keeping a sense that deep truth exists. The chasm stands for a felt separation between self and world. If this feeling is frequent or distressing it is worth discussing with a clinician, since dissociative states are common under stress and treatable.

The true personality expression of the monkey occurs when the monkey sees shame: no longer imitating, now musing

A macaque rests its hand at its mouth in a pensive pose. The caption claims that shame releases a primate from imitation into reflection. Shame is a self-conscious emotion tied to the social self, and research shows it can either lead to withdrawal or to reflection depending on support. The pose triggers anthropomorphic reading of thought, and 'primitive neurobiological constructs' makes the claim sound scientific.



A person speaks aloud while alone. Time stops to listen... Who was speaking, and who moved?

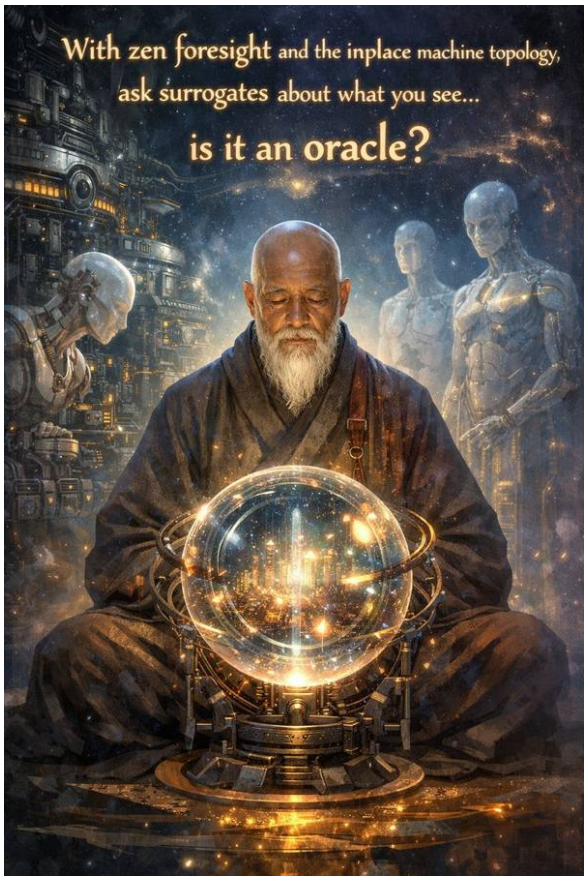
A three-panel illustration: a person speaks to a spiral clock, crouches in a corner, then faces an open door of light. Speaking aloud to oneself is common and helps self-regulation and problem solving (self-talk research). The corner and door show retreat followed by possibility. The closing question blurs agent and action, a poetic form of ambiguity that invites projection.

KNbO3 / KNN ultrasonic materials vs PZT transducers: high-power ultrasonic arrays

A technical engineering infographic comparing lead-free ceramics with PZT transducers and showing a phased array levitating a rock. Dense numbers (d33, power density) and tidy panels create an air of precision, which raises perceived credibility (the numeracy and fluency effects). Acoustic levitation is real in laboratories, so the image mixes verified physics with an aspirational 100 kW demonstration. It satisfies curiosity about science fiction becoming real.

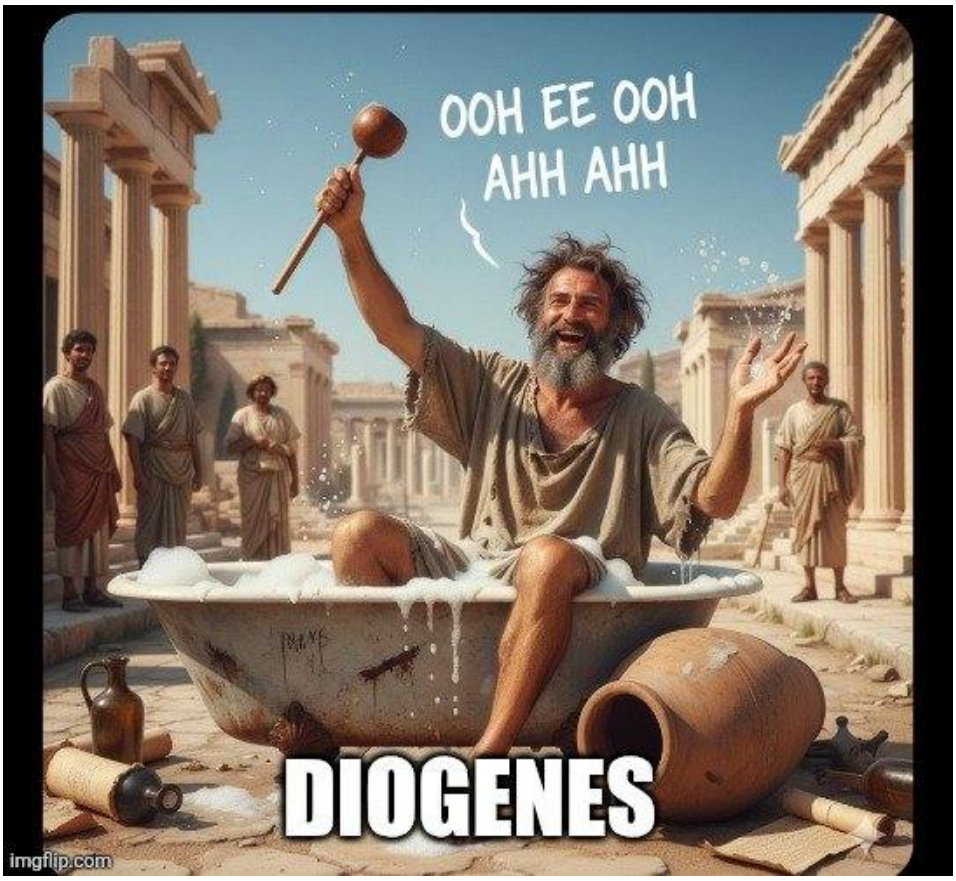
Paranoid you get shot / Nice lexeme, relaxation bro

The 'Batman slaps Robin' template where a dire warning is met with a calm reply praising a word and urging relaxation. The first line comes from the earlier 'eavesdrop you get stabbed' threat. The reply deflates fear through pedantic distance, a use of intellectualisation as defence. The slap represents a social correction of anxious talk, and the humour lets the viewer step outside a threatening frame.



With zen foresight and the inplace machine topology, ask surrogates about what you see... is it an oracle?

A seated monk holds a glowing orb while translucent androids stand behind him. The text asks whether an AI-assisted vision is an oracle. People readily treat confident, fluent outputs as authoritative (automation bias), and an oracle framing encourages deference. The monk and orb borrow the aura of sages, which increases trust. A healthy counterweight is to test any 'oracle' against independent evidence.



Diogenes in a bathtub: 'Ooh ee ooh ahh ahh'

A bearded philosopher raises a ladle while ancient Greeks watch. Diogenes of Sinope was the Cynic famous for shameless, deliberately provocative behaviour. The ape-like cry parodies the idea that stripping away social convention reveals instinct. Psychologically he is the archetype of norm violation as a tool: showing disregard for status exposes how arbitrary conventions are, while also being a form of attention-seeking and social defiance.

Autism: I need clear instructions. ADHD: I need short instructions. AuDHD: make it clear, short, interesting, and don't talk to me while I read it

A three-step escalating-reaction meme. It humorously maps real tendencies: many autistic people prefer explicit, unambiguous communication, and many people with ADHD find long text hard to sustain. Co-occurrence is common, and combined needs can seem contradictory. The joke works as in-group recognition, which supports belonging and reduces stigma. It is a generalisation, as individuals vary widely.

Gauge needle moving from Gnosis to Psychosis

A cartoon man glances at a dial with colours ending in 'Gnosis' and 'Psychosis'. The joke is that insight and psychosis sit at adjacent points on the same continuum of intense meaning-making. There is a real finding behind it: apophenia and 'aberrant salience' (assigning excessive significance to neutral events) feature in both creative-mystical thinking and early psychosis. The practical point is that reality-testing, meaning checking ideas with others and evidence, keeps profound insight from tipping into distress.

Flaming-crowned wizard-king before a spiral galaxy

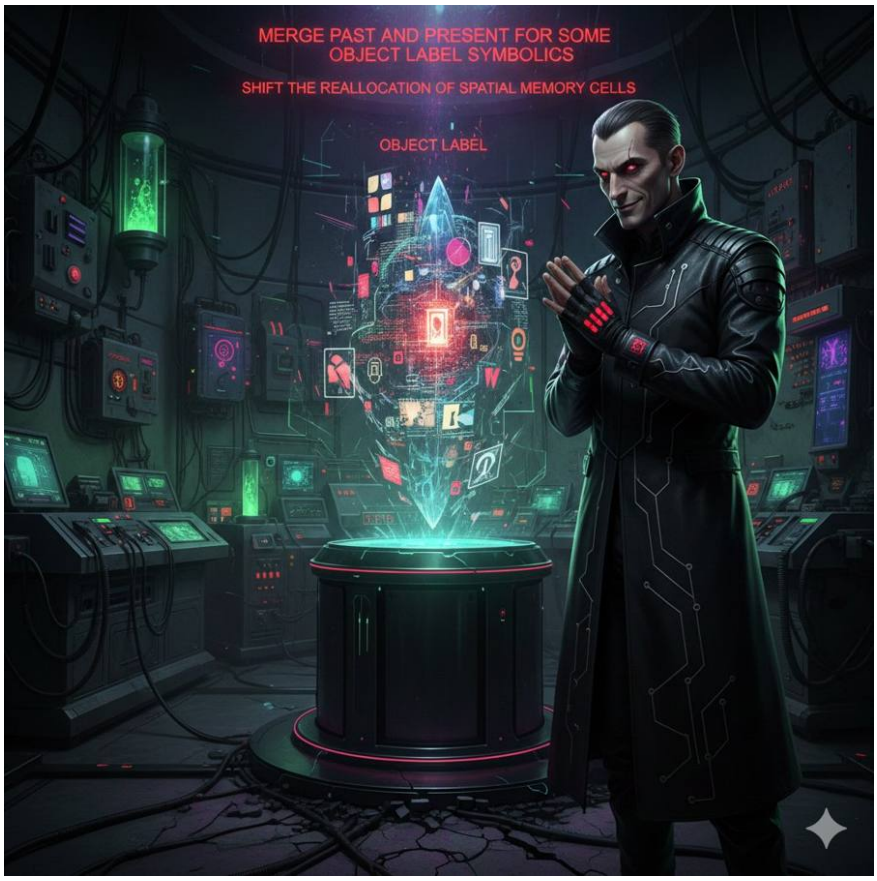
A bearded figure with fire in his beard and hands stands before the galaxy. It is an archetype of the Wise Old Man or divine father figure (Jung), which carries authority and awe. Fire signifies power and transformation, the halo suggests sanctity, and the cosmic backdrop conveys scale. Viewers tend to read such figures as powerful and judgmental, and the image can trigger submission or reverence.

Raving Rabbid on a white background

A screaming, wide-eyed cartoon rabbit with raised arms. Exaggerated emotion in a goofy character produces amusement through incongruity and contagion: viewers mirror expressions, and screaming faces read as high arousal. As a stand-alone image with no context it works as a reaction image, a stand-in for how the poster feels, a compact way to communicate overwhelm or excitement.

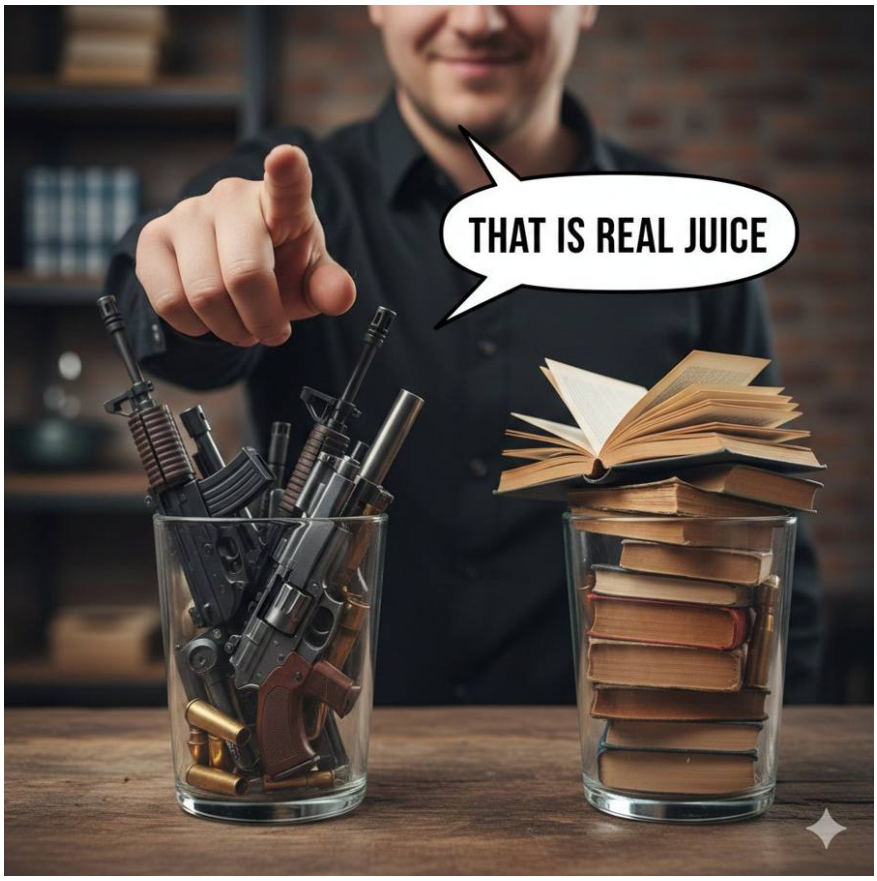
Withholding an iconoclasm would cause riots

A masked figure watches a burning city and a vast hooded crowd from a rooftop. The caption implies that suppressing the destruction of cherished symbols would provoke unrest. Social psychology shows that people defend sacred values fiercely (protected values), and perceived suppression raises reactance and collective anger. The mask evokes anonymity, which deindividuation research links to bolder group behaviour.



Merge past and present for some object label symbolics; shift the reallocation of spatial memory cells

A sinister figure in a control room stands by a holographic emblem and red instructions. The text reads like instructions for editing memory. Real neuroscience shows spatial memory depends on hippocampal place cells and that memories are reconstructed each time recalled (reconsolidation), which is why suggestion can alter them. Pairing invented procedures with a smiling villain evokes fears of memory manipulation.

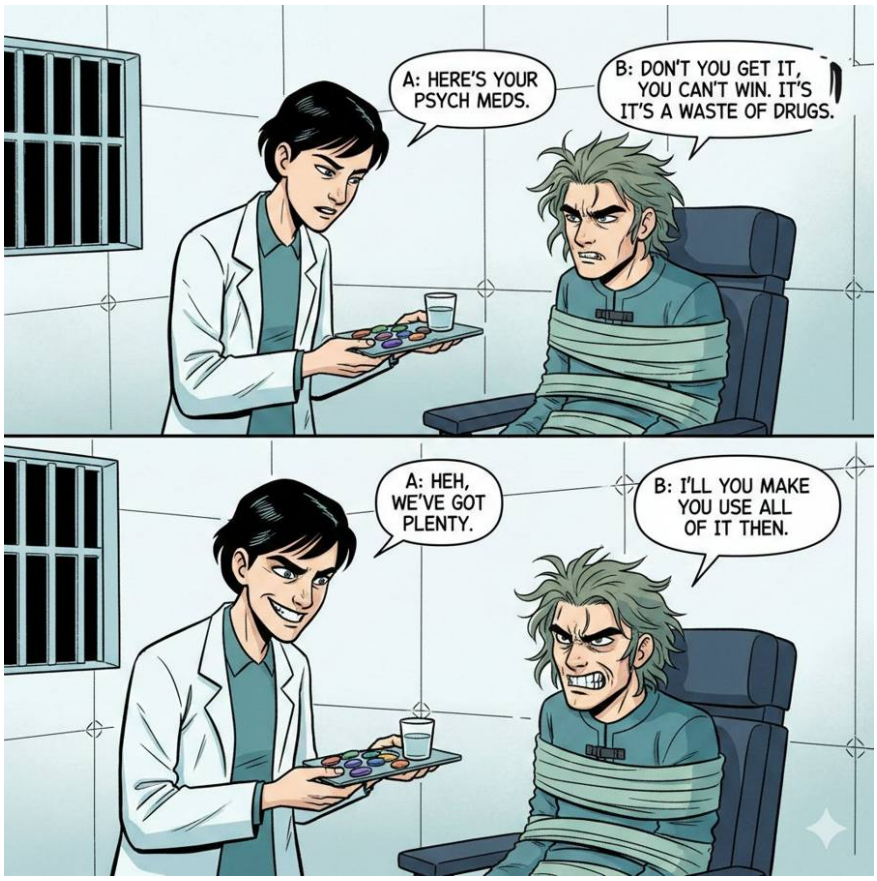


Glass of rifles beside a glass of books: 'That is real juice'

A man points at two tumblers, one of guns and ammunition, the other of books. The caption jokes that the guns are the real stimulant. It contrasts hard and soft power, force versus knowledge, and suggests that violence is more arousing than learning. Research on the weapons-priming effect shows seeing weapons can raise aggressive thoughts. The pointing gesture directs attention and implies a verdict.

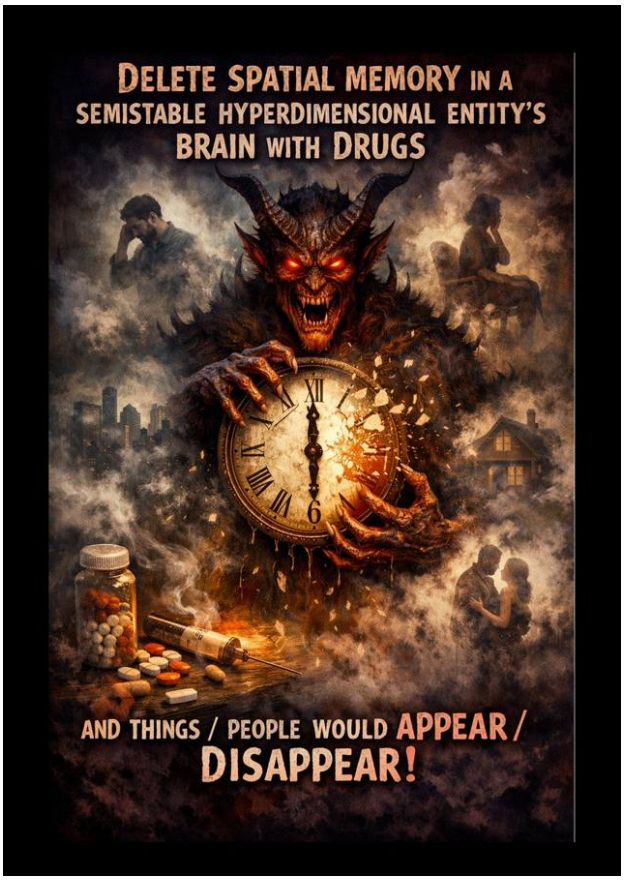
When you're just trying to chill in the 5th dimension but the machine elves are sick of your sh*t

Two film stills: a red patterned mask and a man in sunglasses with a cigarette holder in front of a psychedelic backdrop, with 'You can't vibe here!' and 'Is this not a reasonable place to vibe?'. 'Machine elves' are a recurring entity reported in DMT experiences, so the joke draws on psychedelic culture. It depicts the self-absorbed visitor being told off by hallucinated beings. Entities in altered states are generated by the brain, and the humour treats them as comically bureaucratic.



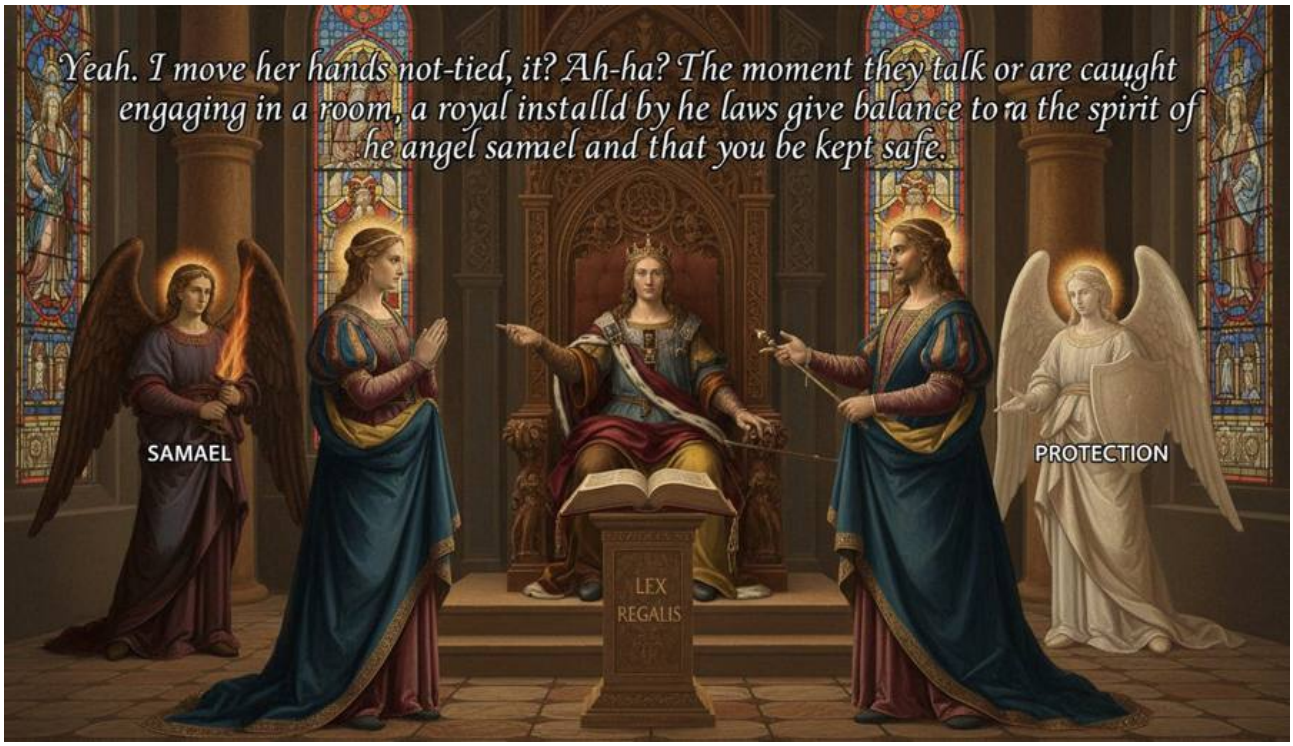
Two-panel comic: forced psych meds, 'It's a waste of drugs' / 'We've got plenty'

A restrained patient in a cell refuses medication and the clinician smiles that supply is plentiful. It dramatises coercive treatment and a power struggle, a real concern in the history of psychiatry and a source of fear of involuntary care. Psychologically it shows reactance and the breakdown of the therapeutic alliance, which predicts poorer outcomes. In modern practice, consent and shared decision-making are standard, and medication questions are best settled with a prescriber.



Delete spatial memory in a semistable hyperdimensional entity's brain with drugs and things/people would appear/disappear!

A horned demon grips a clock above pills and a syringe, with distant shadowy scenes of people. The text imagines erasing spatial memory so that things and people seem to appear and vanish. This resembles the experience of disorientation in delirium and some drug states, where continuity of place and person breaks. The demon figure externalises a feared hostile agent. If experiences of people or things appearing and disappearing are happening to you, that deserves medical attention.



Angels and a royal court: 'The moment they talk or are caught engaging in a room, a royal installed by he laws give balance to the spirit of the angel Samael and that you be kept safe'

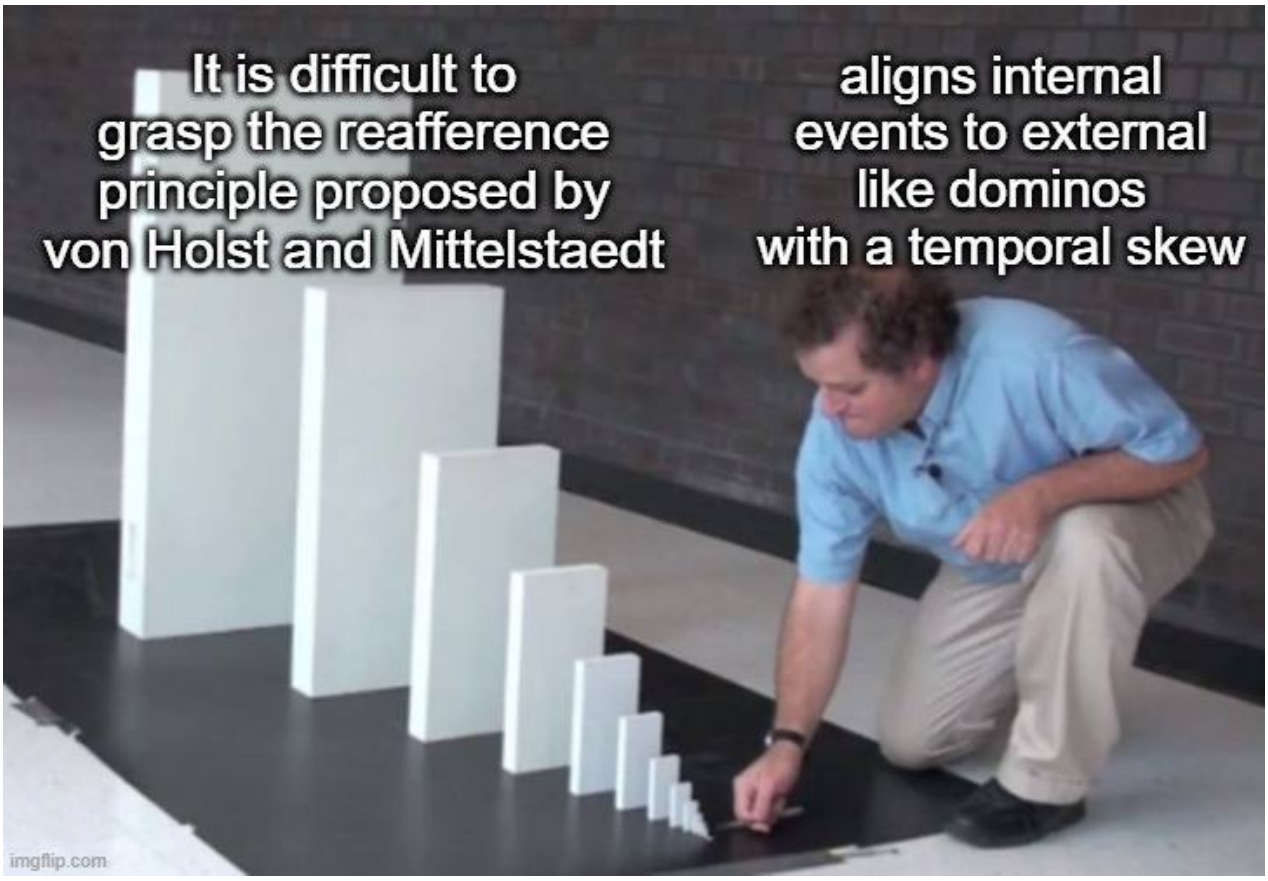
A stained-glass hall holds a seated ruler, a lectern marked 'Lex Regalis' and two angels labelled Samael and Protection. The garbled text mixes law, spirit and safety. The ornate religious staging gives it authority (ritual and setting cues), and the pairing of a dark angel with a protective one expresses ambivalence: a feared force that is also invoked for safety. People under threat commonly seek protective symbols, a form of magical or ritual coping.

Inside this humbug yields the most profound revelations of modern civilisation

A shining green beetle sits in a glowing striped bowl. 'Humbug' is both a candy and a word for nonsense, so the line mocks the way trivial things are treated as profound. It matches the pseudo-profundity research: grand claims attached to obscure items feel deep. The beetle and glow add mystery, and the viewer's curiosity gap (what is inside?) holds attention.

Do not disturb ancient force (carved disc in a glowing forest)

A cracked stone seal with orange fire in the gaps stands among roots and glowing fungi. Warning signs are processed quickly, and 'do not disturb' triggers curiosity through reactance, the urge to do what is forbidden. Ancient seals evoke taboo, the sense that some things are sacred or dangerous. The glowing cracks suggest the forbidden is already stirring, which heightens tension.

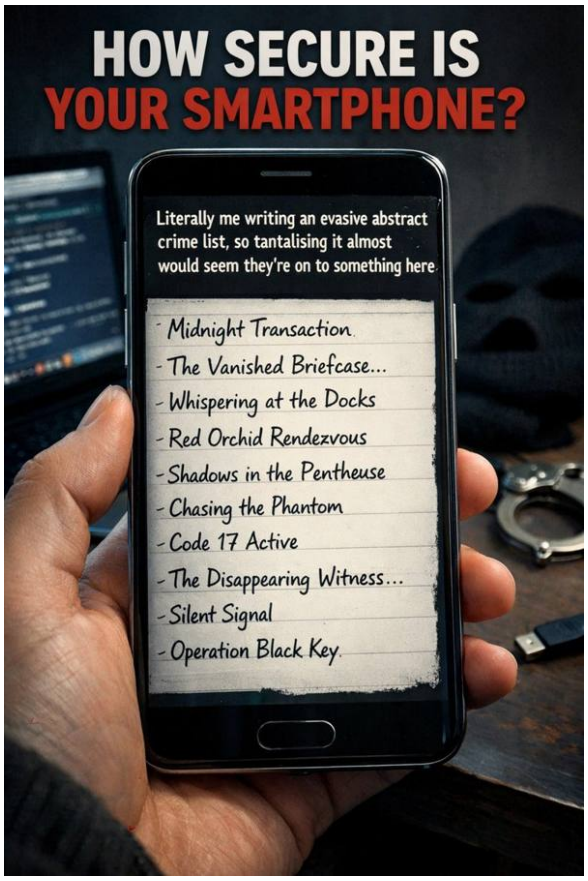


Domino chain: 'It is difficult to grasp the reafference principle proposed by von Holst and Mittelstaedt / aligns internal events to external like dominos with a temporal skew'

The growing-dominoes meme paired with the reafference principle, a real neuroscience idea (1950): the brain predicts the sensory results of its own movements, so self-caused sensations can be cancelled. This is why you cannot tickle yourself and how we tell self from other, and failures of this prediction have been linked to experiences like hearing voices. The domino chain suggests matching internal predictions to external events with small timing offsets. It is a good example of the meme format making a technical idea memorable.

Doge strapped to a console of wires: 'Lunatic scum paradigm'

A glowing-eyed Shiba Inu is bound to a machine surrounded by money-sign monitors. The meme dog is the symbol of memecoin culture, so the image shows crypto speculation as a laboratory experiment. It echoes research on speculation and conditioning: unpredictable payouts keep people engaged. The abusive label 'lunatic scum' is a hostile attribution to opponents or to oneself, while the cute dog contrasts with the restraints, producing dark humour.



How secure is your smartphone? A phone showing an evasive abstract crime list

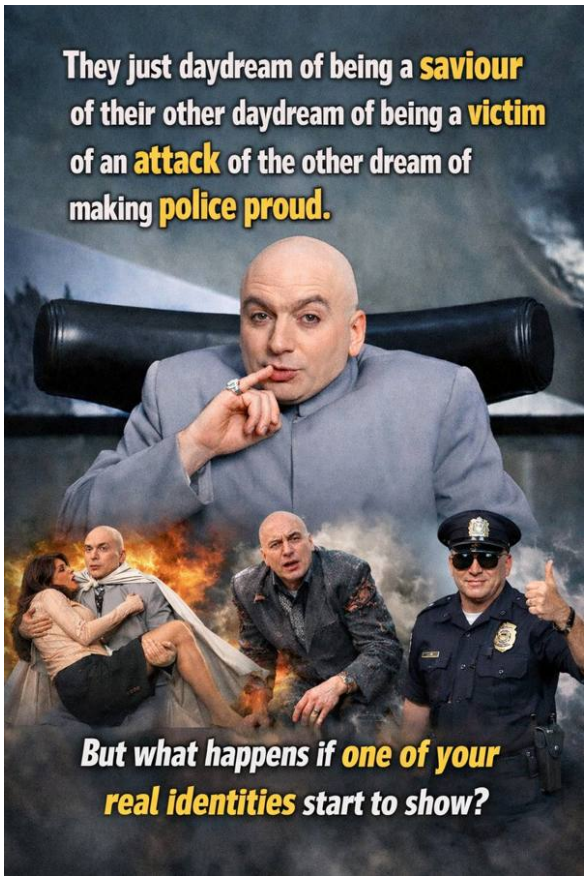
A hand holds a phone with a list of thriller-style titles ('Midnight Transaction', 'Operation Black Key') under the caption 'literally me writing an evasive abstract crime list so tantalising it almost would seem they're on to something'. It satirises making oneself look suspicious or mysterious to bait surveillance. The psychology is the observer effect and trolling: performing for an assumed audience. It also reflects the sense that one is monitored, where ordinary activity gets read as significant.

'I will fight for you.' Blue warrior facing a flaming demon

A fierce blue-skinned warrior with a spear leaps in front of a looming fiery beast. The quote is a promise of protection, the core of the protector archetype. Being fought for meets attachment needs (a secure base), and it stirs both admiration and the wish to be rescued. Fire, red-black contrast and the open mouth create high arousal, so the viewer feels urgency.

Two dwarves on ziplines carrying giant red dice under the moon

Armoured dwarves rush past each other on cables, each swinging a die. Dice stand for chance and risk. The composition shows gambling as a daring, physical adventure, the same romanticisation of risk found in gambling advertising. Moonlight and speed give an exhilarating feel, and the near-collision implies stakes.

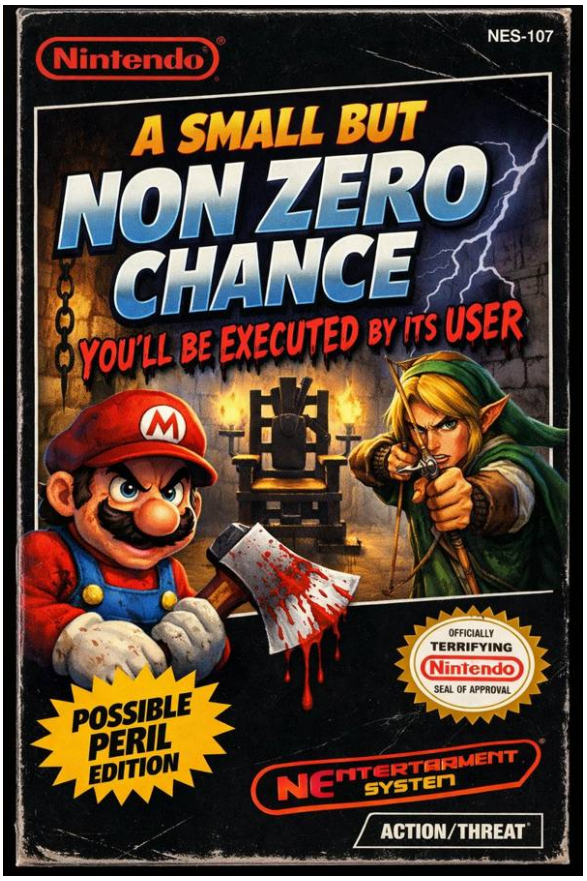


They just daydream of being a saviour of their other daydream of being a victim of an attack of the other dream of making police proud. But what happens if one of your real identities start to show?

A smirking bald villain sits above a collage of him rescuing a woman, being attacked, and receiving a police thumbs-up. The nested wording describes layered fantasies: hero, victim and good citizen. Research on maladaptive daydreaming and on narcissistic fantasy shows how people rehearse flattering roles. The question of 'real identities' points to the gap between role-play and self, a theme in identity diffusion and impression management.

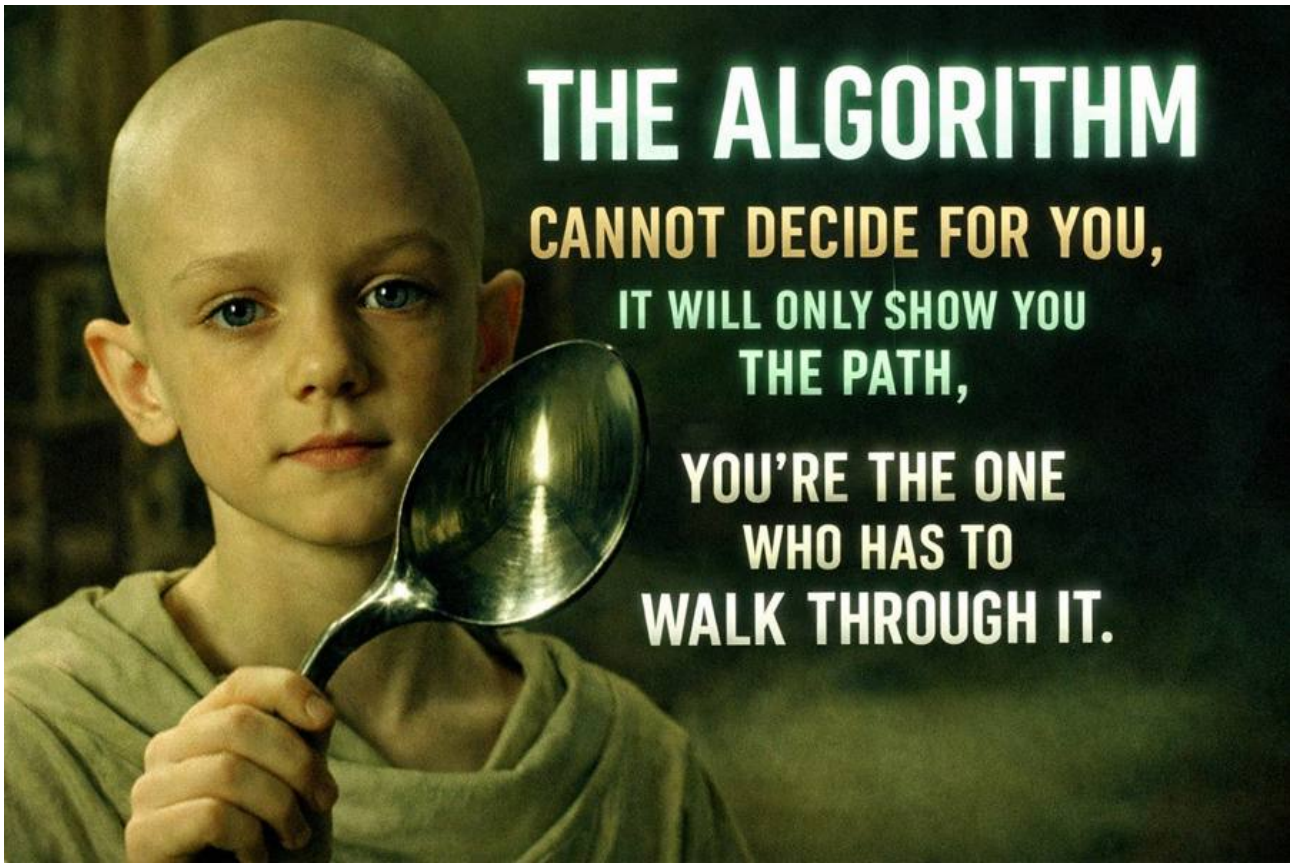
Hacked? It will only silence the lambs.

A wizard dangles a dead chicken before a pile of frightened lambs, with a grim pun on the film title. The joke links being hacked with cruelty to the defenceless, i.e. victimisation. Psychologically it pairs the helplessness many feel after a breach (loss of control, shame, hypervigilance) with a gleeful aggressor, a typical dark-humour way of processing fear. The occult setting adds fear of the unseen.



Nintendo box: A small but non zero chance you'll be executed by its user

A parody NES game cover with Mario holding a bloody axe, an electric chair and Link aiming a bow. Pop-culture icons associated with childhood safety are placed in grisly roles, an effect called the 'corrupted innocence' trope that heightens unease. The title mocks probabilities: 'small but non-zero' is the language of risk communication, and people overweight tiny chances of dramatic harms (probability neglect).

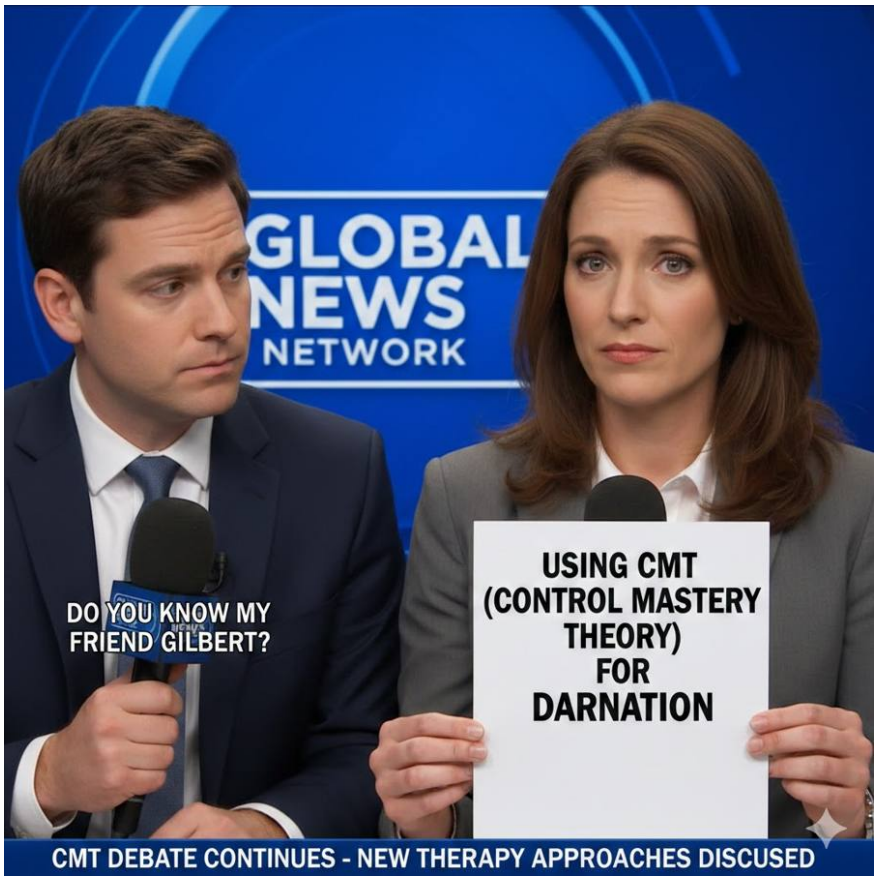


The algorithm cannot decide for you, it will only show you the path, you're the one who has to walk through it

A bald child holds a spoon in a scene recalling The Matrix. The text asserts personal agency over algorithmic feeds. Research shows recommendation systems do shape choices strongly through defaults and nudges, so the line is partly aspirational; but taking ownership of choices supports an internal locus of control, which is linked to better wellbeing. The child figure evokes innocence and the spoon is the 'there is no spoon' reminder that limits are partly mental.

POV: You disrupted a potential war, now there's multilateral negotiations

A fighter pilot gives a thumbs-up above a UN-style round table with a coffee mug reading 'Mission accomplished' and a ceasefire checklist. It is a hero fantasy of heroism and consequence. The point-of-view format invites self-insertion, producing vicarious achievement (basking in reflected glory). The tidy checklist and mug show the wish for closure after conflict.

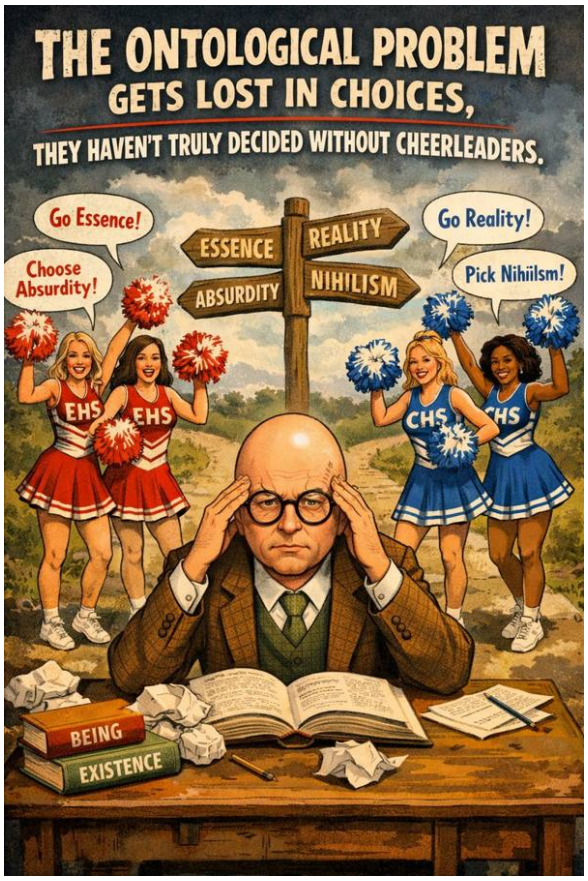


Global News Network: 'Using CMT (Control Mastery Theory) for darnation' / 'Do you know my friend Gilbert?'

Two anchors hold a sign and a microphone with a ticker saying new therapy approaches are discussed. Control Mastery Theory is a real psychotherapy framework (Weiss and Sampson): patients unconsciously test the therapist to disprove harmful beliefs formed in childhood. The off-topic line 'friend Gilbert' and garbled word 'darnation' make the broadcast absurd. The news format borrows credibility, and the contrast shows how technical ideas get garbled in popular media.

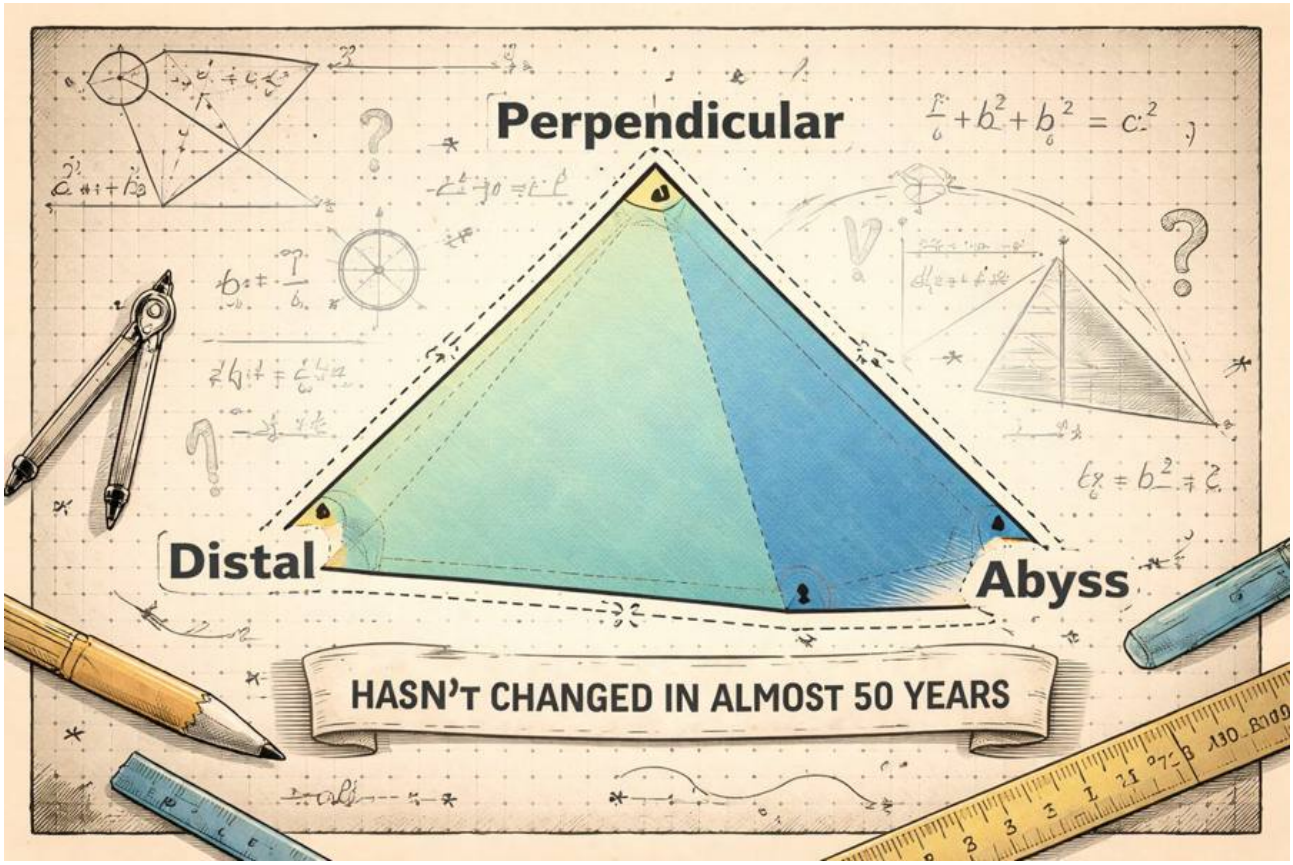
After all, they are eavesdropping for massive sodes against them

A vintage microphone with a jagged speech bubble. The garbled word suggests a mistake or private shorthand. The microphone is a surveillance symbol, and the sentence assumes hostile listeners. It reflects persecutory attribution, where listeners are assumed to have harmful intent, though it also recognises real data collection. Speech bubbles on objects attribute thought to them, a case of anthropomorphism.



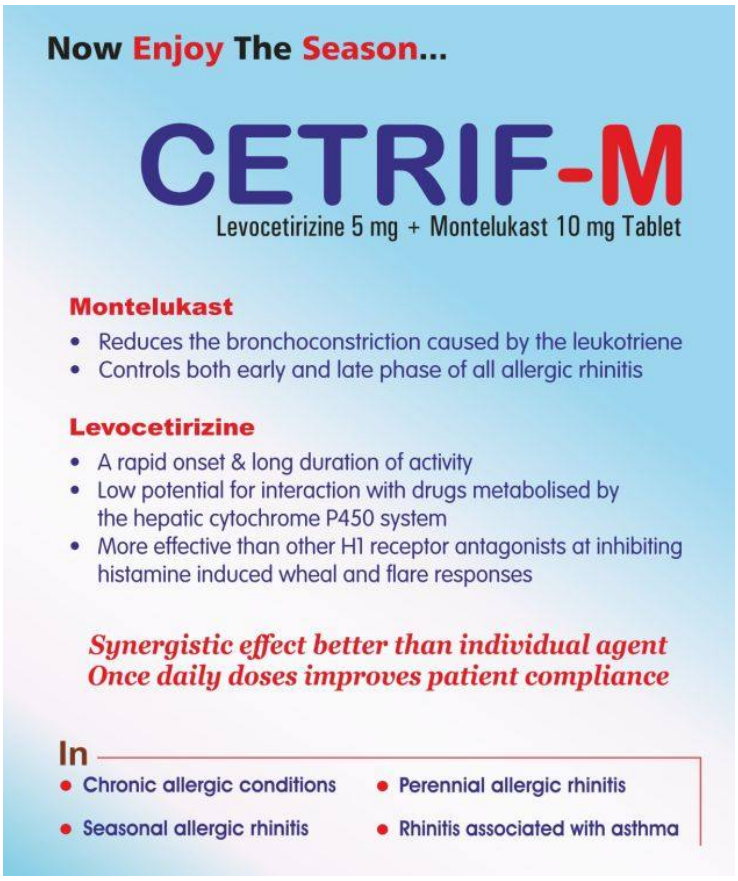
The ontological problem gets lost in choices, they haven't truly decided without cheerleaders

A professor holds his head at a signpost reading Essence, Reality, Absurdity, Nihilism while cheerleaders root for each. The picture shows decision paralysis and choice overload (Schwartz), and mocks the role of social cheering in beliefs: positions are often adopted for their supporters. Existential questions combine with group identity, where pom-poms represent social reinforcement.



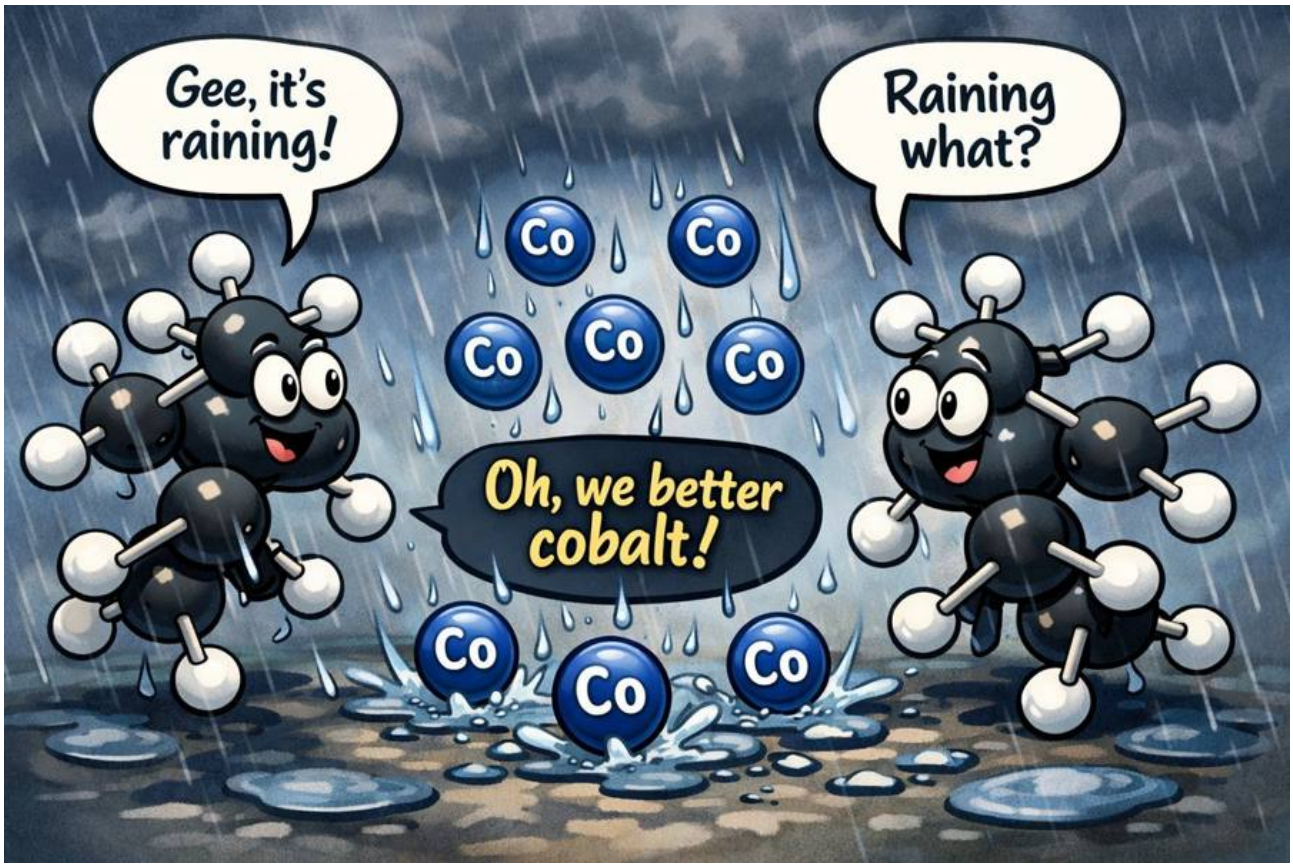
Perpendicular, Distal, Abyss triangle: hasn't changed in almost 50 years

A right triangle on graph paper with three labels instead of lengths. The scheme looks like a geometry proof but swaps measurable quantities for abstract words, a case of the illusion of explanatory depth. The banner 'hasn't changed in almost 50 years' appeals to longevity as a validity cue, though age is not evidence. Hand-drawn maths cues suggest rigour.



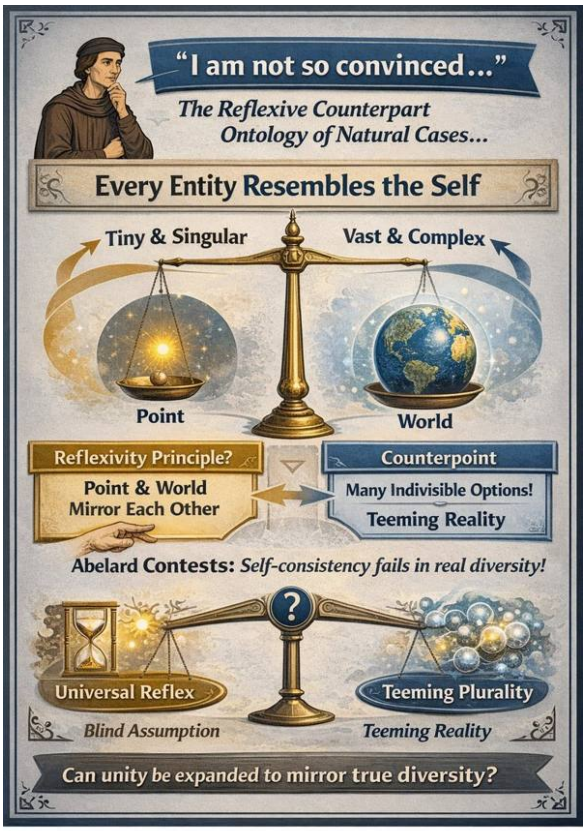
Cetrif-M advertisement (levocetirizine and montelukast tablet)

A pharmaceutical ad for an allergy tablet showing mechanisms and claims of synergy. Pharma marketing uses technical bullet points and an upbeat tagline ('Now enjoy the season') to increase credibility and the sense of control over symptoms. 'Once daily doses improves patient compliance' addresses adherence, a real behavioural issue, since simpler regimens are taken more consistently. Montelukast carries safety warnings about mood and behaviour changes, so decisions about it belong with a prescriber.



Gee, it's raining! Raining what? Oh, we better cobalt!

Cartoon molecules splash through rain of cobalt atoms. The pun on 'cats and dogs' and 'we better go' uses chemistry symbols. Puns work through resolving incongruity between two meanings, giving a small 'aha' reward. Personified molecules lower the barrier to science, a technique that increases engagement through anthropomorphism.

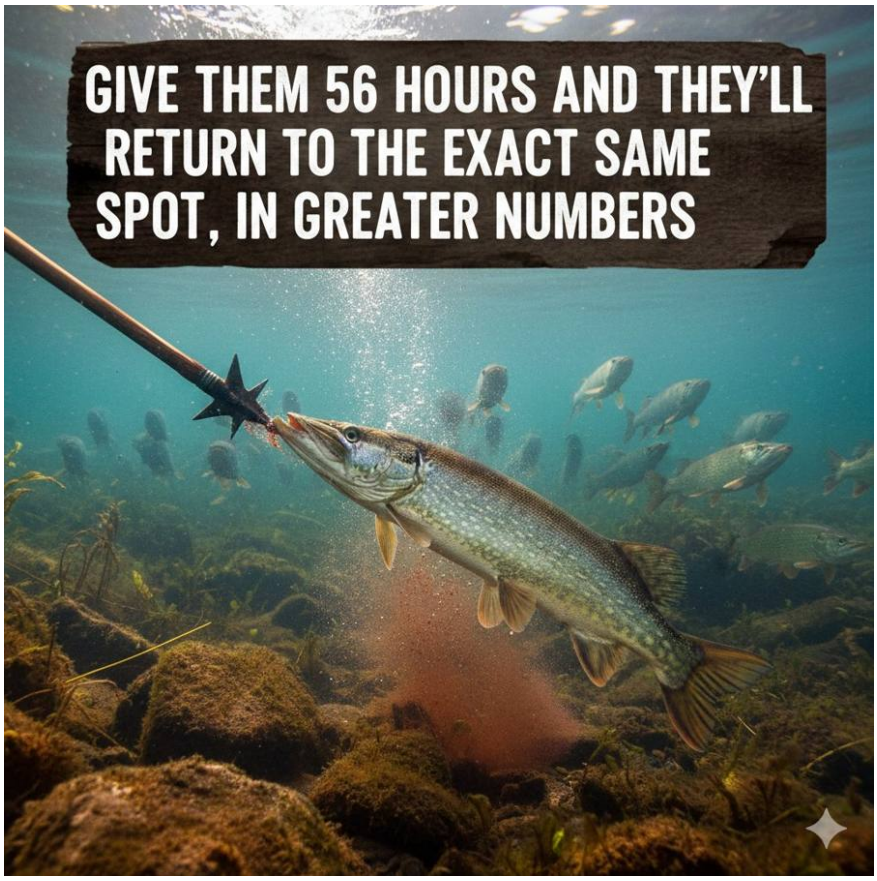


The Reflexive Counterpart Ontology of Natural Cases: every entity resembles the self (balance of Point and World)

A medieval-style infographic with a scale balancing a point and a world and the line 'I am not so convinced'. It questions whether a part can mirror the whole, a medieval debate about universals invoked through Abelard. Psychologically it is the pull of the microcosm-macrocosm idea: people like patterns where self and cosmos mirror each other, which makes unity feel meaningful. The closing question invites reflection instead of asserting a claim.

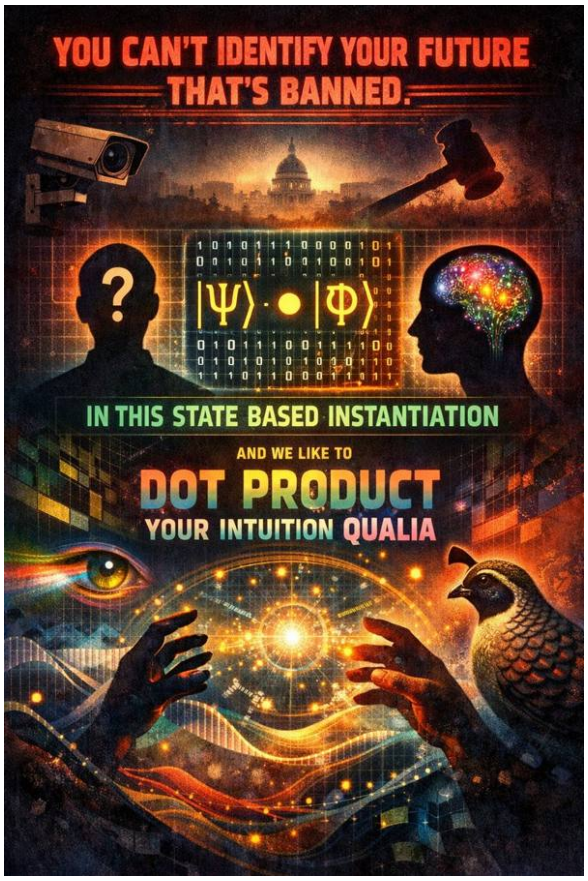
Scooby-Doo gang unmasking a manager: 'If it is rank then where's feedback?' / 'I would have gotten away with it if it weren't for you meddling kids and your desire for professional development'

The gang pulls the mask off a villain in a suit beside a barrel marked 'Stagnant process'. It satirises workplace dysfunction: a manager who resists feedback and growth. This matches findings on psychological safety (Edmondson): teams without open feedback stagnate, and hierarchy-focused leaders suppress learning. The unmasking format delivers the satisfying feeling of exposing a hidden cause.



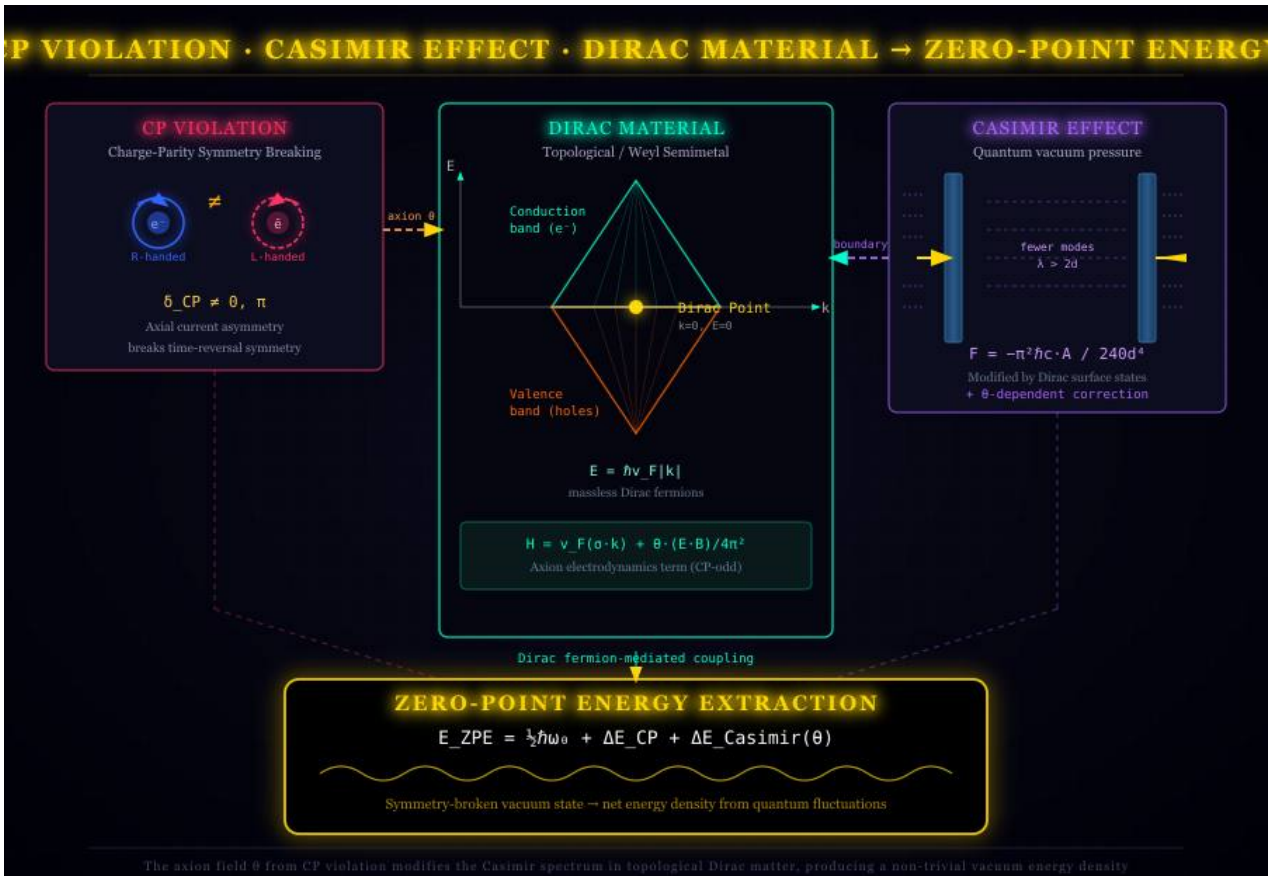
Give them 56 hours and they'll return to the exact same spot, in greater numbers

A pike is speared underwater while others hang nearby. The caption suggests that predator fish return to the same place. It touches on habit and territorial behaviour, and by analogy on how people return to the same cues and places, called context-dependent habit. The 'in greater numbers' line is about escalation and repetition, as in recurrent conflict or crowds drawn to danger.



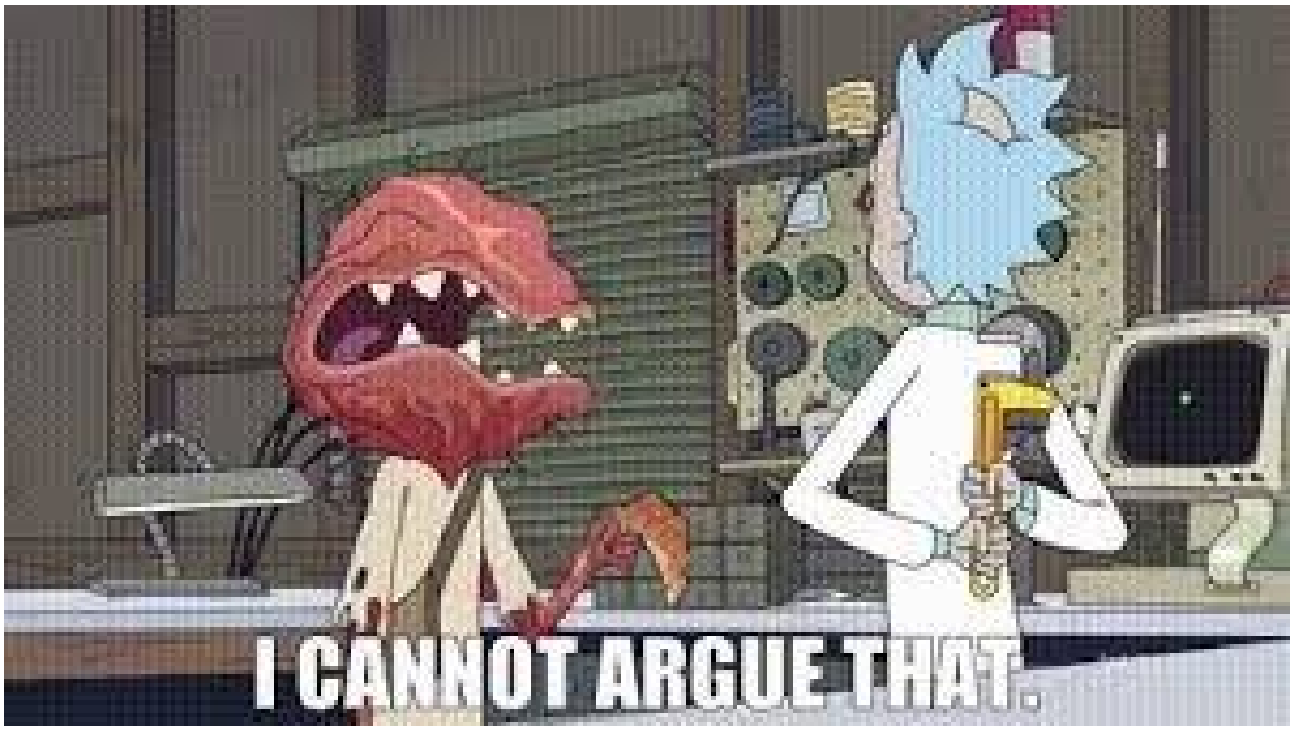
You can't identify your future that's banned. In this state-based instantiation, we like to dot product your intuition qualia

A poster mixes a gavel, CCTV, quantum notation (|ψ⟩·|φ⟩), a silhouette with a question mark and a quail. A dot product measures how aligned two vectors are, so the line imagines measuring how similar your intuition is to a model. The surveillance and law motifs suggest being profiled and restricted. It builds an unfalsifiable threat from technical words, a type of pseudo-scientific paranoia that cannot be tested but feels significant.



CP violation, Casimir effect, Dirac material → zero-point energy extraction

A dark-themed physics diagram with three boxes feeding into a zero-point energy extraction formula. The ingredients are real physics (CP violation, Casimir force, Dirac materials), but the claimed conclusion, net extractable energy from the vacuum, is not established and would conflict with energy conservation. This is a clear case of the illusion of explanatory depth: equations and arrows make speculation look settled. Neon colours on black add a 'secret science' feel.



I cannot argue that (cartoon scientist and a monster)

A small Rick-and-Morty-style panel with the caption 'I cannot argue that.' It is a concession reaction: acknowledging the other's point. Conceding gracefully is a sign of intellectual humility, which research links to better learning and relationships. The monster beside the scientist adds absurdity to the moment.

ineffectualdemon

The thing with neurodivergent folk and rules is that if they don't understand why a rule exists they will not follow it ever

They will listen politely while being told the rule but then will immediately ignore it because they perceive it as nonsense

They won't argue either they just will not follow that rule unless it is explained fully so that they do understand why it exists

On the flip side if they ***do*** understand a rule they will be completely enraged that no one else is following the clear instructions! They follow it scrupulously and so should everyone else

There is no middle ground

Text post: neurodivergent folk and rules (rules they don't understand won't be followed; rules they do understand must be followed by everyone)

A social-media text post on rule-following. It describes a real pattern reported by many autistic and ADHD people: a need for rationale before compliance, and strong justice sensitivity once a rule is accepted. This links to research on rule-based thinking and on 'rejection sensitive' reactions to unfairness. The 'no middle ground' phrasing is a generalisation, but it communicates recognition and reduces isolation for those who see themselves in it.

Cyber-tank with brain interface: psilocybin infusion, aphasia inducer, zuclopenthixol control, Adderall administration, precognitive void...

A vertical diagram of a man submerged in a tank and wired to modules labelled with drugs and 'disgust core' and 'syntactic synchronization'. Combining named medications with invented components gives it an authoritative lab feel. It dramatises a fear of being controlled by chemical and technological means, a persecutory-control theme. The face is blacked out, which removes identity and increases unease. Medicines named here (an antipsychotic, a stimulant and a psychedelic) have very different effects, and none can actually produce the invented outcomes.

Ego Sensation cigarette ad: Feed the Flame

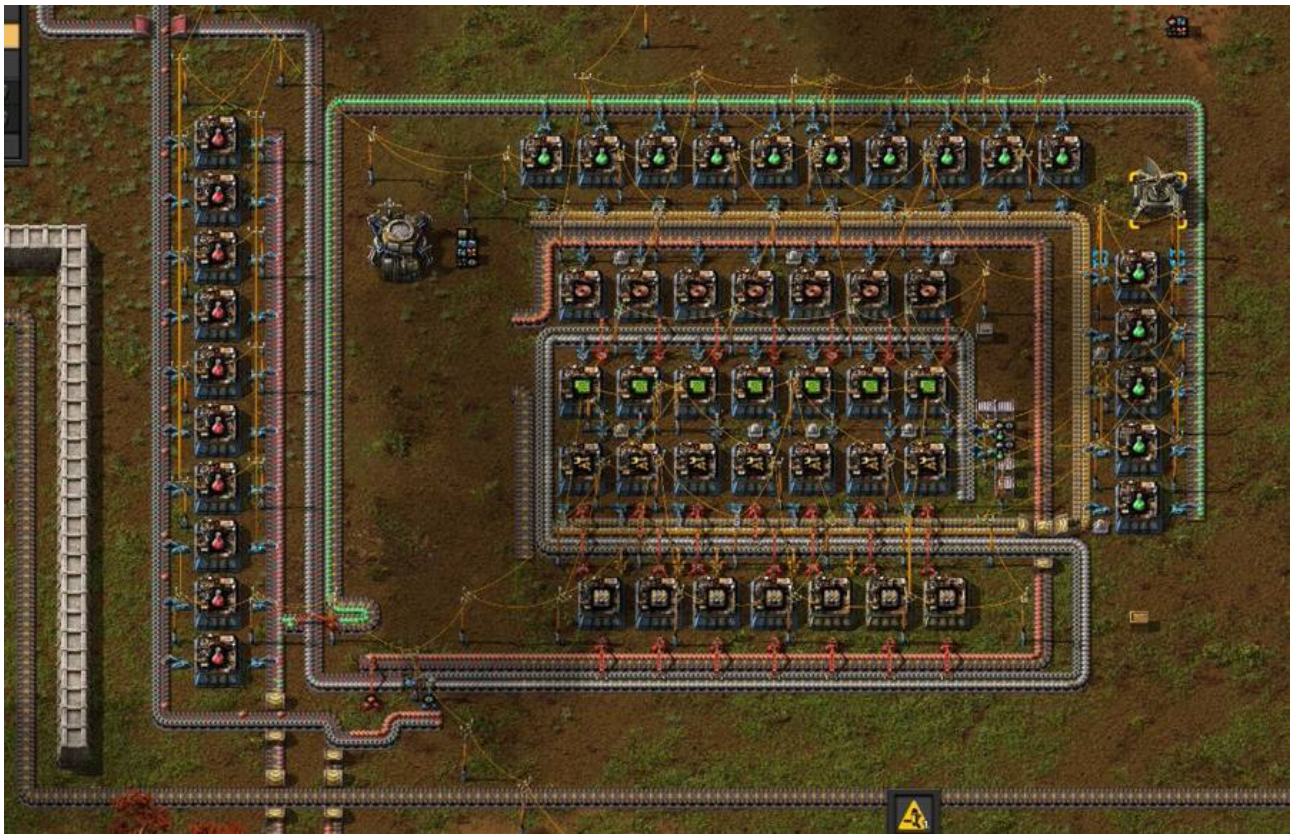
A man in a suit lounges before a night skyline with a cigarette, with a small health warning in the footer. Luxury and masculine cues (suit, skyline, dim lighting) link smoking with status, which is the classic mechanism of tobacco marketing aimed at self-image. 'Feed the Flame' gives the ego a literal fuel metaphor, linking nicotine reward with self-enhancement. The tiny warning contrasts with the large aesthetic, showing the imbalance between desire cues and risk information.

Crying frog on the floor among bottles: 'You changed my morals...'

A weeping green frog lies beside beer bottles, a can and a rolled cigarette. The caption blames an outside influence for a change in values. Psychologically it shows moral drift under substance use or low mood and the externalisation of blame. Research on self-control shows alcohol lowers inhibition (alcohol myopia), so decisions feel out of character afterwards, followed by guilt and shame. The crying frog meme conveys self-pity and regret in a form that is easy to share.

Tweet claiming feminism is a patriarchal con / 'shit they know' vs 'no one will believe her'

A screenshot of a provocative social-media post followed by a two-figure reaction meme. The post frames a social movement as a hidden plot, a typical conspiratorial structure: a concealed group manipulates a target population to achieve a goal. Such framings spread because they give a single cause for complex outcomes and an enemy to blame. The two reaction figures show in-group knowing nods. People across the political spectrum use this structure, and checking it against evidence about actual labour and household data is the usual corrective.



Factorio-style factory base: rows of assemblers connected by belts

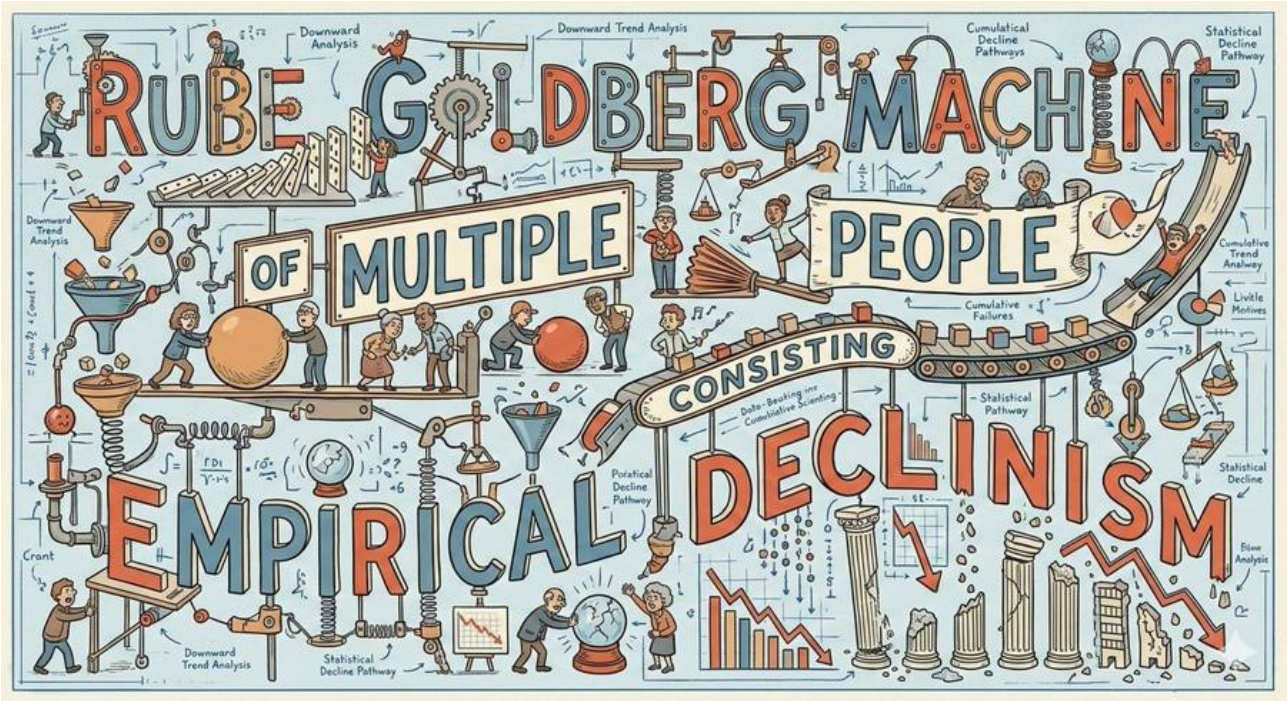
A top-down game screenshot of an automated production line. Factory-building games satisfy the drive for order, optimisation and mastery: watching a self-running system you designed gives strong competence feelings (self-determination theory). They also invite flow, and the visual regularity is calming. For people who think in systems, it is a form of play that mirrors engineering.

Factorio-style outpost with pipes and refineries in desert terrain

A sparse desert map with oil refineries and a winding pipe network. It shows the exploration-versus-exploitation tradeoff in miniature: sprawling outward to find resources versus consolidating. The tangled pipes show how complexity grows with scale and how fixing one problem creates another, a feeling familiar to programmers and the basis for the satisfying 'cleaning up' urge.

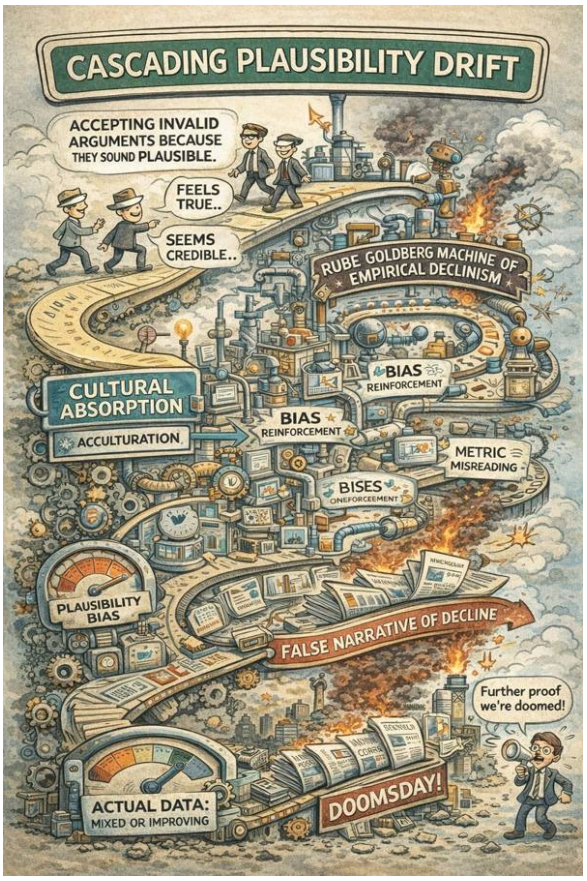
Safework NSW demolition licence vs plutonium clearance card: 'Nope!'

Two ID cards side by side, with a red arrow and 'NOPE!' between them. The joke is that holding one qualification does not authorise the other. It plays on the credential heuristic, where expertise in one area is mistaken as general authority, and on bureaucratic gatekeeping. Identity cards signal legitimacy, and the contrast between a friendly photo and a redacted silhouette suggests how secrecy conveys power.



Rube Goldberg machine of multiple people consisting empirical declinism

A busy illustrated poster in which a contraption of people and gadgets spells 'empirical declinism'. Declinism is the belief that things are getting worse. The Rube Goldberg picture says the belief is the output of a chain of small steps. The psychology is negativity bias (bad news weighs more), nostalgia and the availability heuristic, which together produce a steady sense of decline even when data are mixed or improving.



Cascading plausibility drift: accepting invalid arguments because they sound plausible

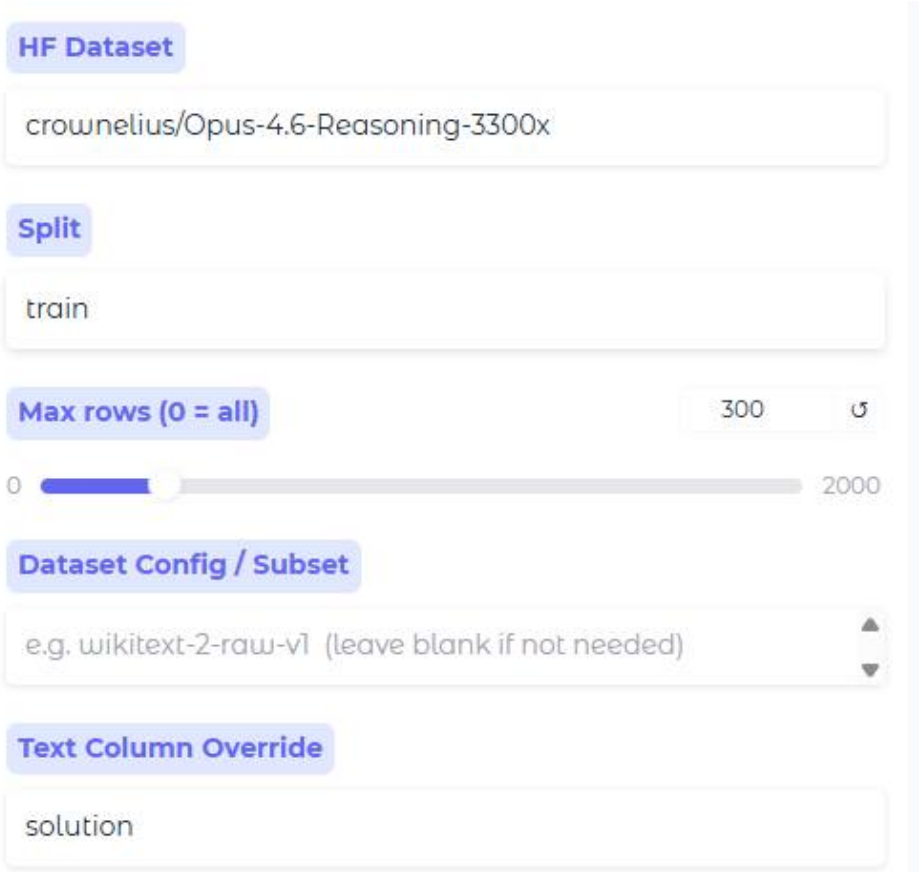
A map-like infographic of a winding path from 'feels true' through bias reinforcement and cultural absorption to a false narrative of decline and 'Doomsday!', while actual data are 'mixed or improving'. It illustrates how repeated plausible-sounding steps accumulate error, like a chain of small inferences, a version of the conjunction fallacy and of belief perseverance. The cartoon form helps recognition, and the closing contrast with actual data points to the best defence: checking claims against measurements.

Hooded sorcerer: 'That's it, suffer a lifelong calamity and impose onto others who seek it'

A dark mage with green flames and a purple crystal staff declares a curse. The line describes a cycle: suffering and then passing it on. Research on the cycle of violence and on transmitted trauma shows that harm experienced is more likely to be repeated on others, though most survivors do not repeat it. The curse form externalises that pattern as magic and gives the villain's monologue a theatrical power.

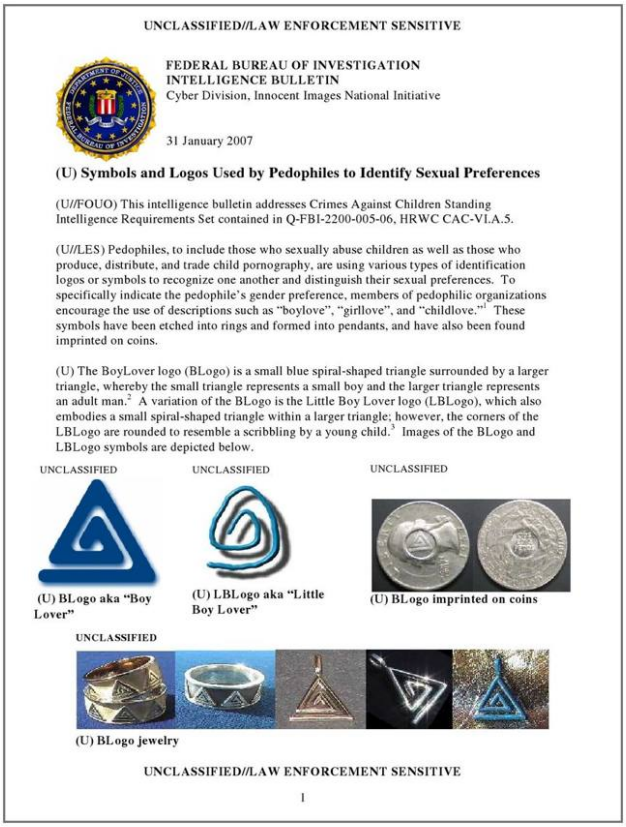
Hooded sorcerer (cropped version): 'That's it, suffer a lifelong calamity and impose onto others who seek it'

This is the same image as the previous one, cropped smaller. The psychology of the curse pattern is the same, with the added note that the slightly squarer crop focuses attention on the hand with green smoke and the staff, the two symbols of power and magic.



Hugging Face dataset form: crownelius/Opus-4.6-Reasoning-3300x

A settings panel for loading a dataset: split 'train', max rows 300, a text column named 'solution'. This is a plain technical screenshot with no joke. The psychology is the pull of building and tinkering with AI tools: clean forms with sliders give a feeling of control and make a complex process seem simple, and picking '300 rows' of 'reasoning' data is an act of curation where small choices feel consequential.



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FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION
INTELLIGENCE BULLETIN
Cyber Division, Innocent Images National Initiative

31 January 2007

(U) Symbols and Logos Used by Pedophiles to Identify Sexual Preferences

(U//FOUO) This intelligence bulletin addresses Crimes Against Children Standing Intelligence Requirements Set contained in Q-FBI-2200-005-06, HRWC CAC-V1.A.5.

(U//LES) Pedophiles, to include those who sexually abuse children as well as those who produce, distribute, and trade child pornography, are using various types of identification logos or symbols to recognize one another and distinguish their sexual preferences. To specifically indicate the pedophile's gender preference, members of pedophilic organizations encourage the use of descriptions such as "boylove", "girllove", and "childlove."[1] These symbols have been etched into rings and formed into pendants, and have also been found imprinted on coins.

(U) The BoyLover logo (BLogo) is a small blue spiral-shaped triangle surrounded by a larger triangle, whereby the small triangle represents a small boy and the larger triangle represents an adult man.[2] A variation of the BLogo is the Little Boy Lover logo (LBLogo), which also embodies a small spiral-shaped triangle within a larger triangle; however, the corners of the LBLogo are rounded to resemble a scribbling by a young child.[3] Images of the BLogo and LBLogo symbols are depicted below.

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(U) BLogo aka "Boy Lover"

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(U) LBLogo aka "Little Boy Lover"

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(U) BLogo imprinted on coins

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(U) BLogo jewelry

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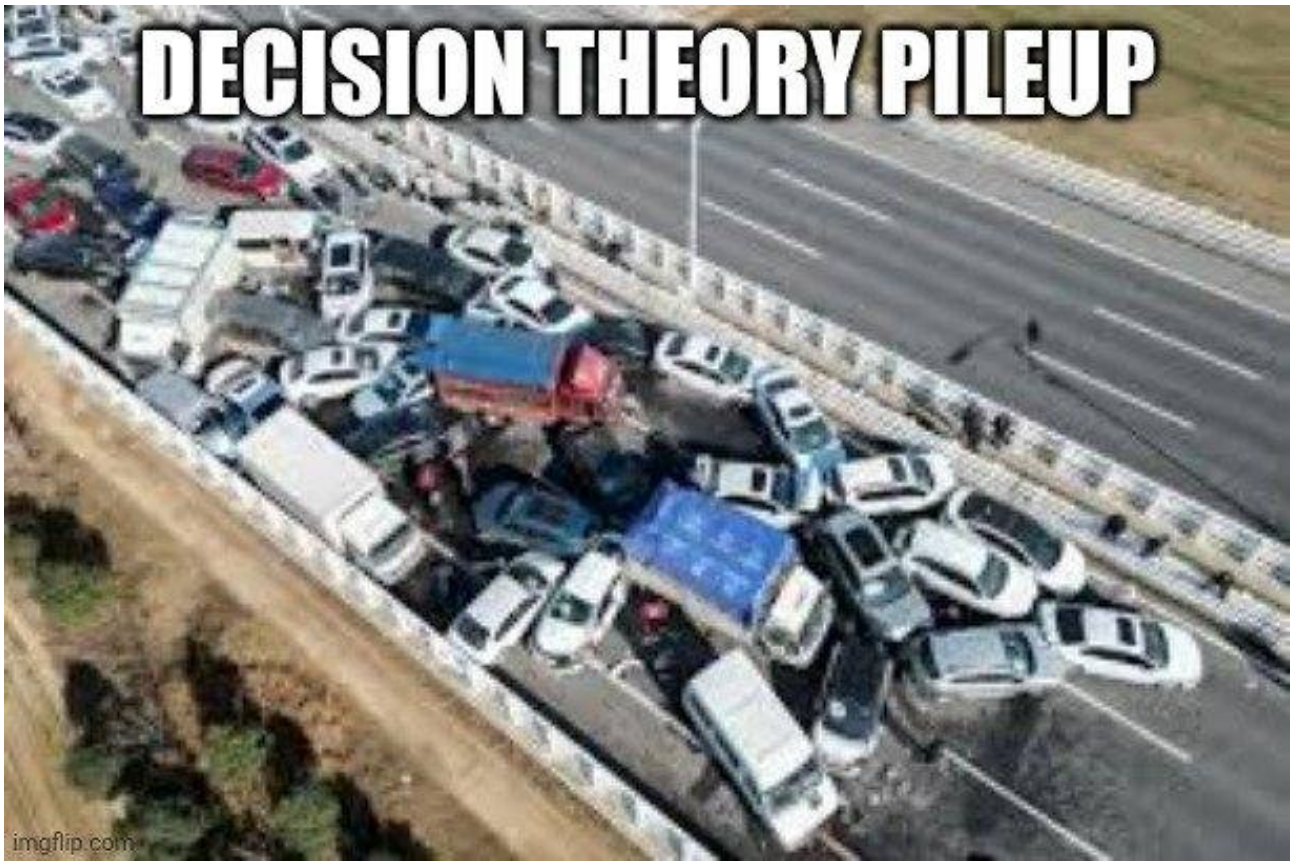
1

FBI intelligence bulletin (2007) on symbols used by offenders

A document from a law-enforcement bulletin. I haven't annotated the symbols or terms it describes, since explaining them could help the wrong people more than it helps protective readers. Psychologically, the document type is notable: official letterhead and an 'unclassified' banner give it strong authority, and public safety bulletins aim to raise recognition among parents and professionals. The existence of such material shows how serious child protection is. If this subject is connected to a real concern, the relevant child-protection hotline or police are the right contact.

'Oh is this where I kill my own mother vs be a paedophile?' / 'Yes'

A shop-floor scene with a worker and a customer at a trolley, with a crude forced-choice joke. The format is a trolley problem parody: the shopping trolley stands in for the philosophical dilemma. Moral psychology uses such extreme forced choices (Greene's work) to study how people trade off emotion against logic. The humour is a deliberately shocking false dichotomy, and the 'Yes' answer shows the absurdity of being given no good option.

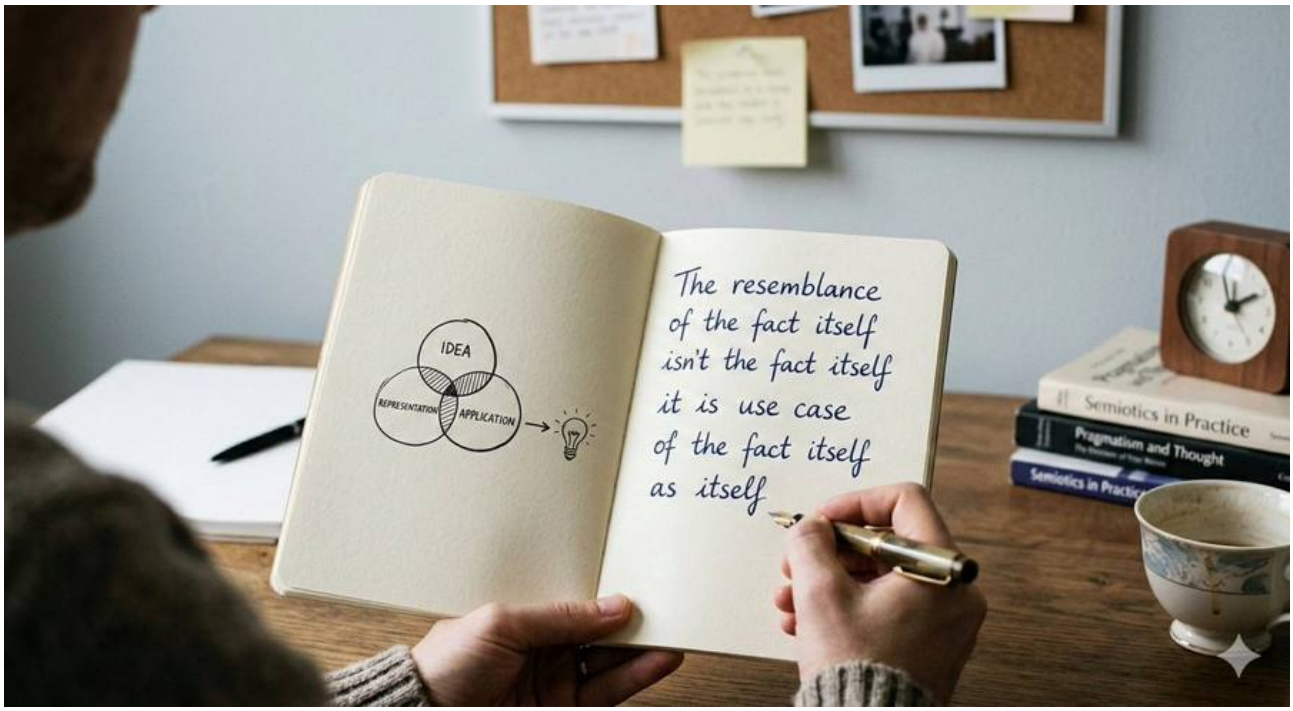


Decision theory pileup (multi-car highway crash)

An aerial view of dozens of crashed vehicles on a highway. The caption casts a mass collision as a failure of decision theory. It suggests the pileup is what happens when many agents each make a locally rational choice (follow closely, keep speed) that is collectively disastrous, a coordination problem like the tragedy of the commons. It also reflects herd behaviour and the limited visibility of others' intentions.

Prisons have evolved: instead of cages we are confined to text boxes on paper, with the help of antipsychotics

A newspaper page in which people curl up inside boxed articles beside spilled antipsychotic bottles. The caption claims modern confinement is textual and chemical. The image conveys a feeling of being boxed in by labels and diagnoses, which relates to research on stigma and self-labelling, where the way a condition is described shapes identity. It also touches the history of institutional and chemical restraint. Antipsychotics are effective treatments for many people with psychosis and are used with consent in modern care; if medication feels like confinement, a conversation with the prescriber about side effects and options is worth having rather than stopping suddenly.

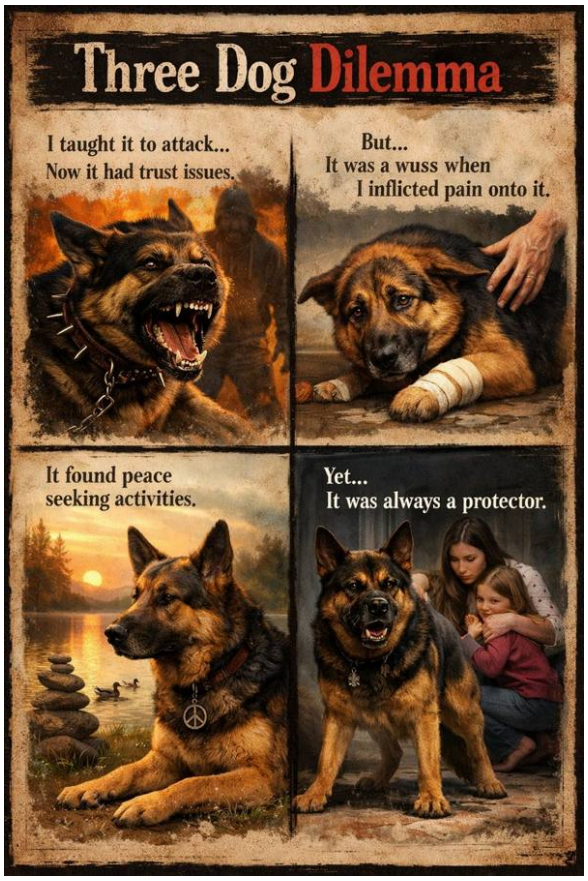


Notebook entry: 'The resemblance of the fact itself isn't the fact itself, it is use case of the fact itself as itself'

A person writes in a notebook beside a Venn diagram and books on pragmatism and semiotics. The sentence distinguishes a representation from the thing and says meaning lies in use, echoing pragmatism and Wittgenstein. Cognitive science agrees that perception is a model built by the brain, not the world itself. Writing ideas by hand improves processing and memory, and the cosy desk scene signals thoughtful, productive study.

The Silent Meme Lab: a psychological puzzle

An infographic with five named characters, rules for how a 'meme' spreads and puzzle questions on exploration versus stealth adoption. It models social contagion: ideas spread through direct exploration or silent observation, and people who think they're immune can still spread them (the third-person effect). The 'behavioural paradox' that limiting exposure increases hidden influence matches research on unconscious social learning. It is a thought experiment, not data.

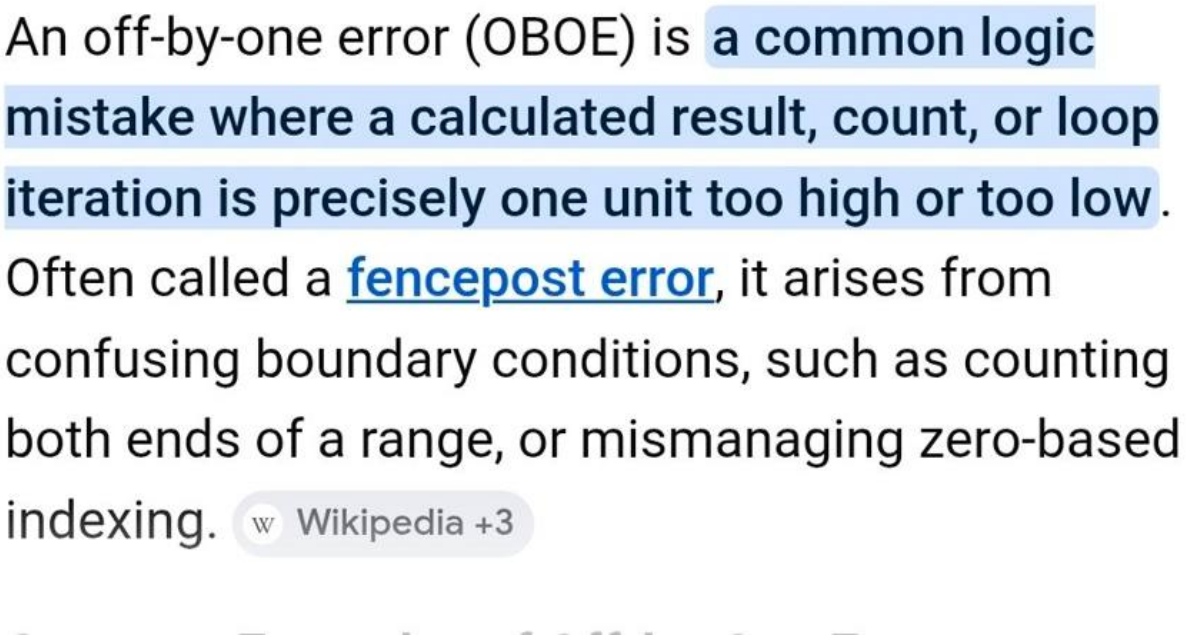


Three Dog Dilemma: I taught it to attack... Yet it was always a protector

Four panels of a German shepherd: trained to be aggressive and mistrustful, hurt, finding peace, and finally defending a mother and child. The sequence follows a trauma-recovery arc: aggression as learned protection, healing through calm activity, and the underlying protective drive remaining. It resonates with how people with hardened defences can still care deeply. Dog stories activate empathy easily, which makes the lesson about not judging survival behaviours persuasive.

Quote: failing to accommodate a student with a hidden disability is no different than failing to provide a ramp for a wheelchair user

A text-only graphic with a quote about ADHD, anxiety and dyslexia. The analogy to a ramp makes an invisible barrier visible, a technique that reduces the tendency to blame individuals (fundamental attribution error). Evidence supports it: accommodations and explicit instruction improve outcomes for students with learning differences. The serif type and formal punctuation add gravity.

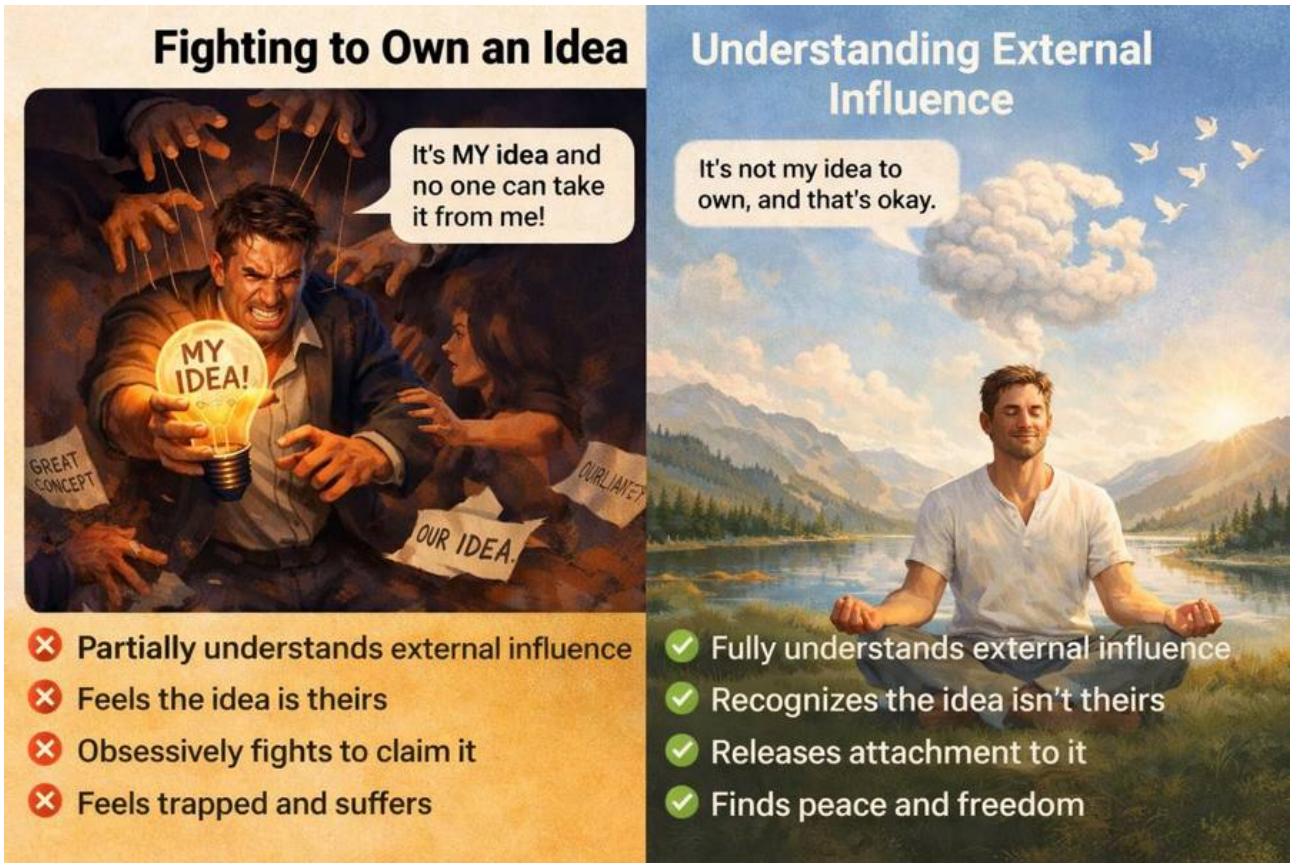


Definition: off-by-one error (fencepost error)

A search-result snippet defining a logic mistake where a count or loop is one unit too high or low. The mistake comes from confusing boundaries, such as counting both ends of a range. Psychologically it is a classic case of how intuition about counting fails at edges: people count intervals instead of items. It is a shared experience among programmers and a friendly humbling one.

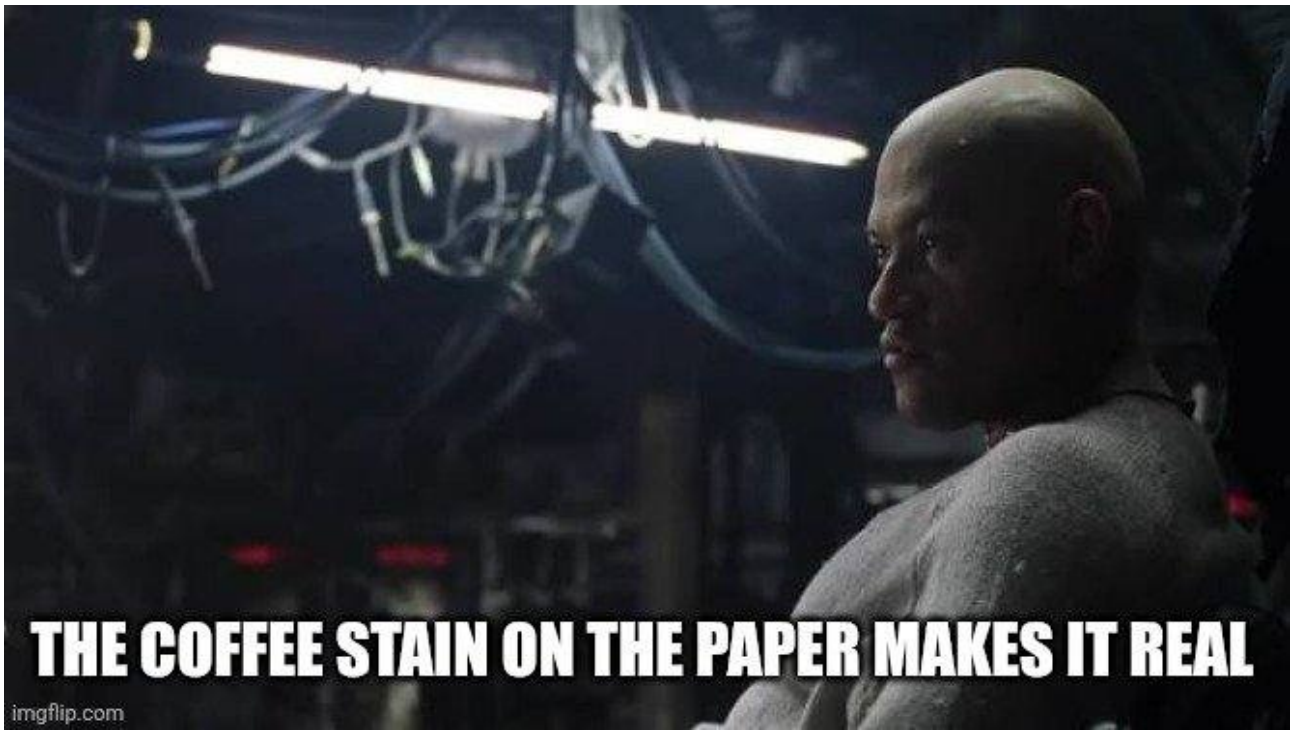
White-haired samurai in red-trimmed black armour (video still)

An anime-style warrior holds a katana raised behind his head against a stormy purple sky. The pose and armour signal discipline and lethal readiness, the samurai ideal of calm before action. Colour contrast of red on black with purple clouds heightens arousal. Viewers enjoy such figures as power fantasies of controlled strength, which are a source of identification and motivation.



Fighting to own an idea vs understanding external influence

A split infographic: on the left a clutching man claims 'it's MY idea' while hands tug at him; on the right a calm man meditates and accepts 'it's not my idea to own'. This matches research on psychological ownership and the endowment effect: people value what they feel is theirs and defend it hard. Cryptomnesia shows that we often forget the source of ideas and believe them original. Letting go of attachment follows mindfulness and acceptance-based therapies, which link non-attachment to less distress.



The coffee stain on the paper makes it real

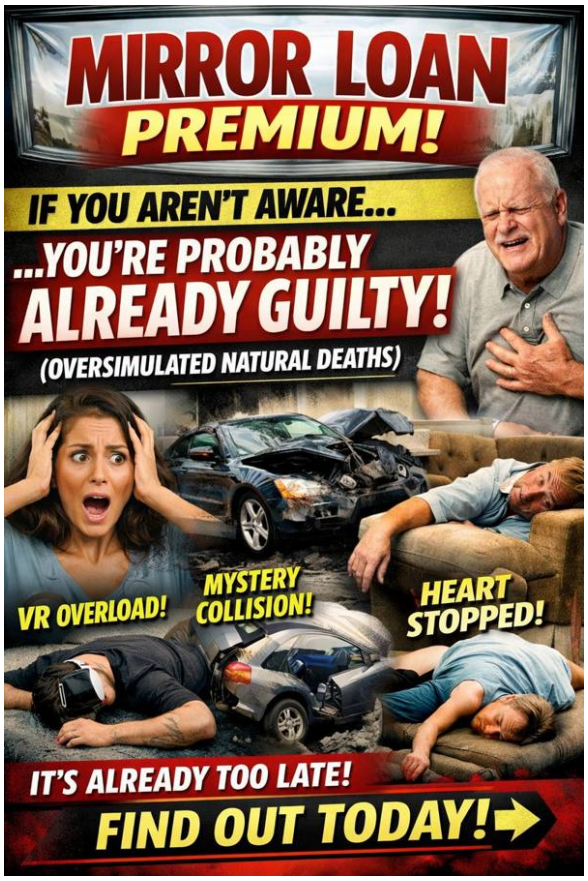
A man sits in a dim cell with this caption. The idea is that a small incidental mark makes a document feel authentic. This is the authenticity heuristic: imperfections such as stains, wrinkles and handwriting increase perceived genuineness, which is why forgers add them. The grim setting suggests confession or interrogation, where physical traces turn claims into evidence.

Bender breathing fire past a toppled bucket (cartoon clip)

A robot exhales a jet of flame while a companion watches. Short clips like this are shared as reaction images: extreme, absurd expression of feeling. The humour is of sudden over-the-top response, a visual hyperbole that conveys anger or exasperation in a safe, comic form. Without sound or context the viewer fills in the cause.

Hospice Locked In: What is your response? A) I don't care bro B) I don't give a sh*t bro

A garish game-show scene with a presenter, a 'final question', a red buzzer and a slumped contestant among junk food and an ambulance marked 'LIVE'. The joke is the forced choice between two nearly identical apathetic answers, a satire of both choice theatre and learned helplessness: when both options mean the same, choosing feels pointless. The hospice setting adds dark humour about indifference at the end of life. The chaotic detail rewards close looking.



Mirror Loan Premium: If you aren't aware you're probably already guilty! (oversimulated natural deaths)

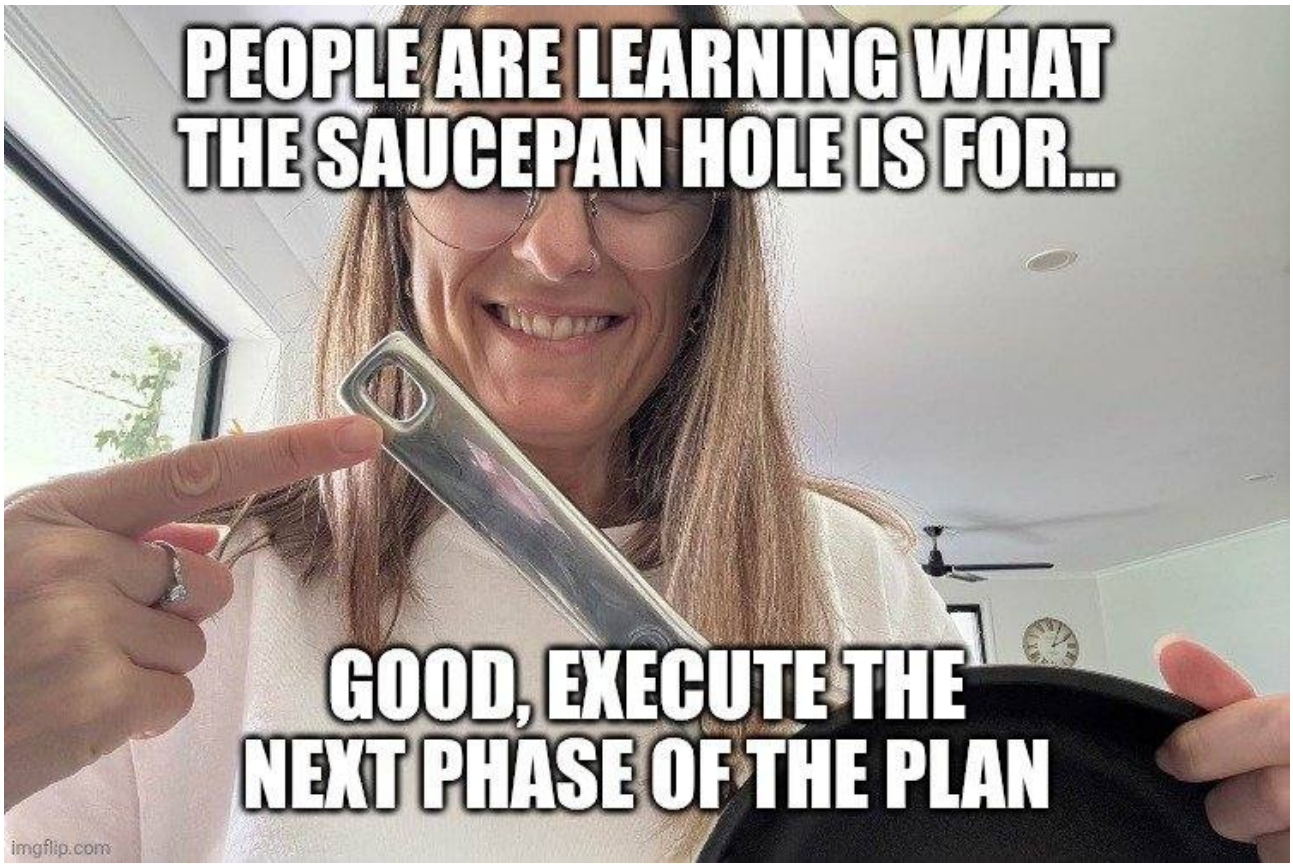
A tabloid-style ad with panic faces and collage of crashes, collapsed people and a VR headset, all demanding 'Find out today!'. It parodies fear-based marketing: false urgency ('already too late'), guilt induction and vague threat, which are standard scam and clickbait tactics exploiting loss aversion and anxiety. The loan framing adds financial pressure. Recognising these cues (urgency, guilt, shock imagery) is the best protection.

POV hand holding a mug in a living room, a monitor showing an emergency data panel

A first-person view of steaming coffee, a worn armchair and a screen with a body diagram labelled 'identity replicator'. The cosy domestic scene next to an ominous screen creates the uncanny feeling of something wrong in a familiar place. Point-of-view shots make viewers imagine themselves there, increasing immersion. The coffee symbolises routine calm held against a hint of crisis.

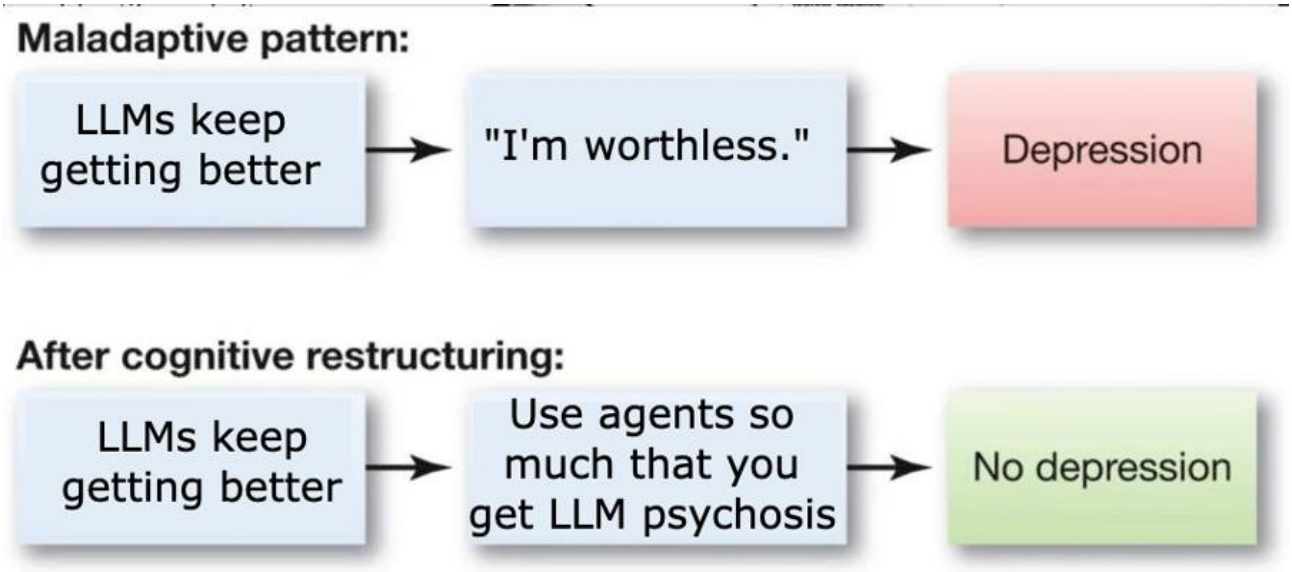
Doctor says the side effects are 'manageable' / the medication: clozapine crap (with community comments)

A meme captured with Reddit comments such as 'the drool is real' and 'worth it for sanity though?'. Peer humour about medication side effects is a form of coping and solidarity: people with the same condition validate each other's experience and reduce isolation. Clozapine is an effective antipsychotic, often used when others have not worked, and it needs regular blood monitoring, which the comments joke about. The question 'worth it?' is common; side effects can often be reduced by adjusting treatment, so raising them with the prescriber matters more than stopping alone.



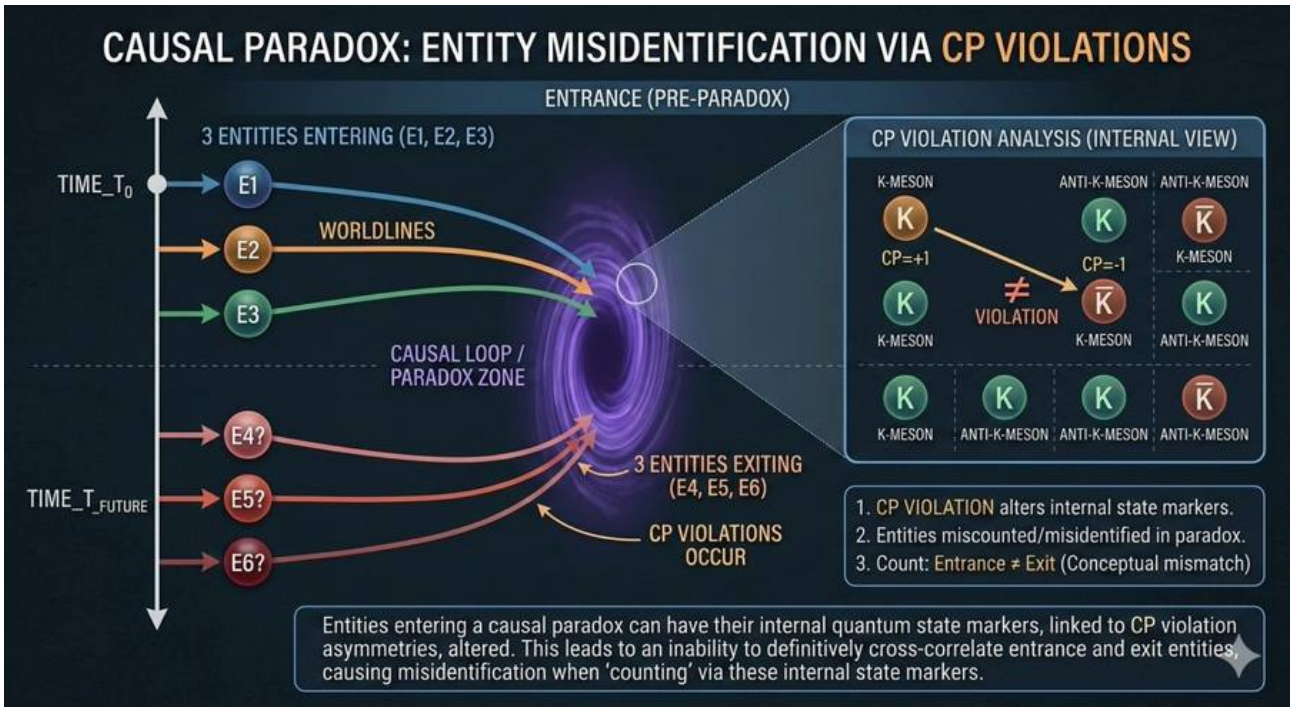
People are learning what the saucepan hole is for... Good, execute the next phase of the plan

A smiling woman points to the hole in a saucepan handle. The caption jokes about a secret plan that is revealed by a trivial discovery. It plays on the pleasure of insider knowledge and the humour of treating mundane things as conspiracy beats. The cheerful pointing makes it more comical, since the 'plan' is just kitchen utility.



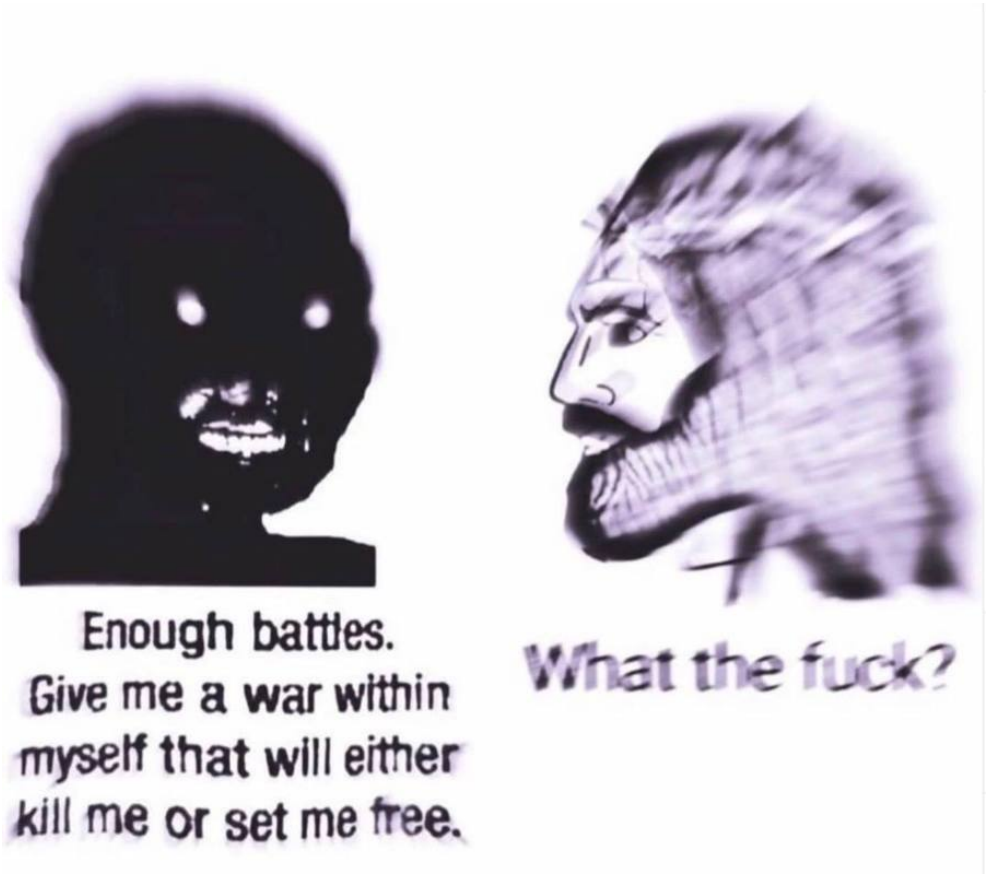
Maladaptive pattern vs after cognitive restructuring: LLMs keep getting better → 'I'm worthless' → depression; vs use agents so much you get LLM psychosis → no depression

A flowchart joke about cognitive restructuring: replace a depressive thought with a different one. The punchline swaps one problem for another, 'LLM psychosis', a term used for people who develop grandiose or delusional beliefs after intensive chatbot use. The joke uses the real CBT idea that thoughts mediate emotion, and the twist shows that not every reframe is healthy. It acknowledges both the unease of AI progress and the risk of over-immersion.



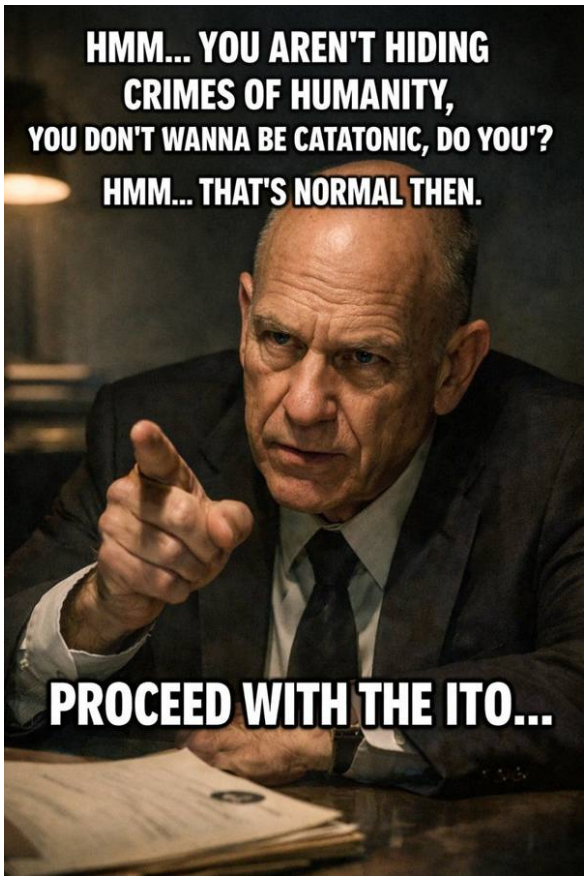
Causal paradox: entity misidentification via CP violations

A physics-style diagram of three entities entering and three exiting a causal loop, with kaon (K-meson) symbols. Real physics appears in the kaon particles and CP violation, but the 'causal paradox' counting scheme is speculative. The layered formal look produces the illusion of explanatory depth. It also echoes the 'three in, three out' counting puzzle, in which identity depends on markers that may change, a question that touches personal identity and object permanence.



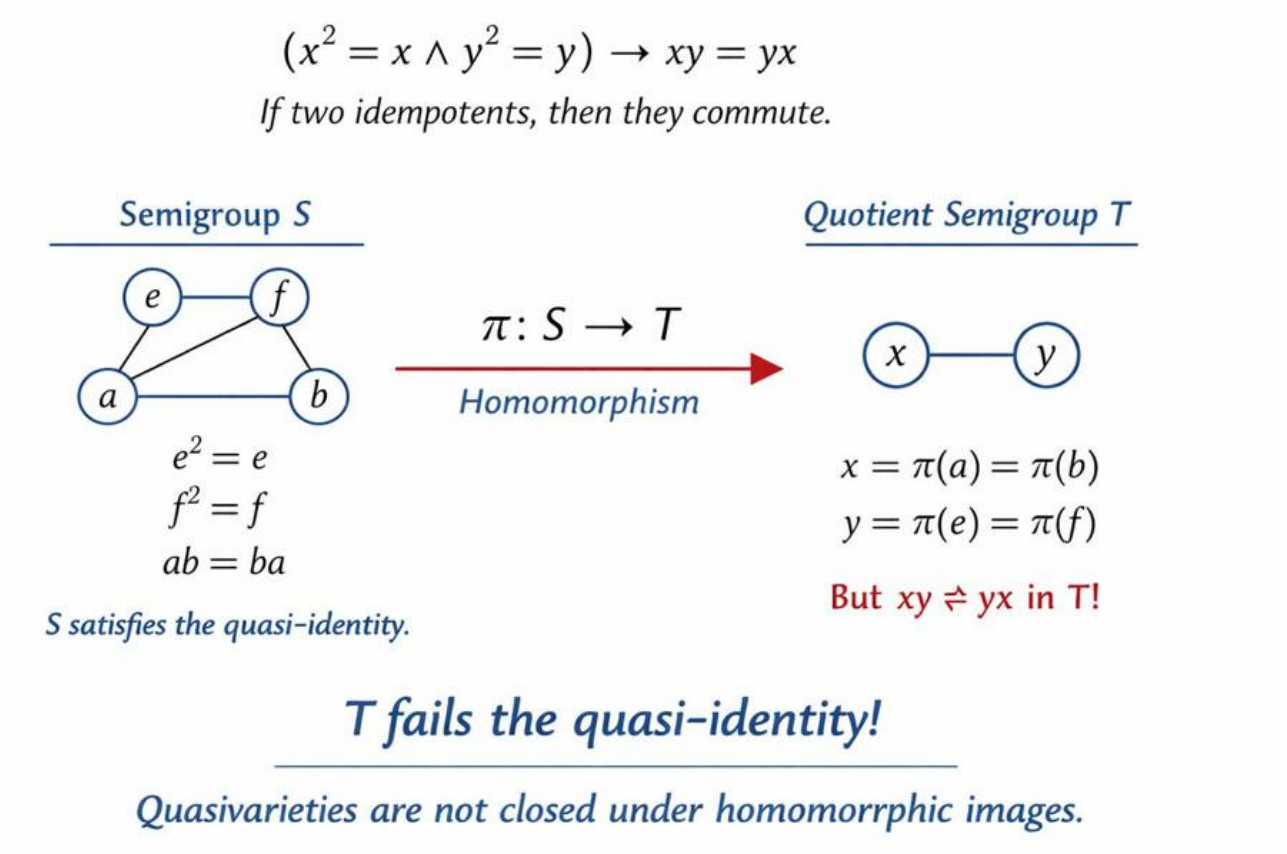
Enough battles. Give me a war within myself that will either kill me or set me free / What the f*ck?

A distorted black figure speaks while a blurred, recoiling second figure reacts. The speaker wants an inner war to resolve everything, and the reaction shows alarm. The wording is all-or-nothing thinking (splitting), where the only options are death or freedom. Inner conflict can indeed be resolved, but the either/or framing hides a middle path of gradual change. If the words 'kill me' reflect real feelings and not just a dramatic line, please talk with someone you trust or a crisis line; I'm here to talk too.



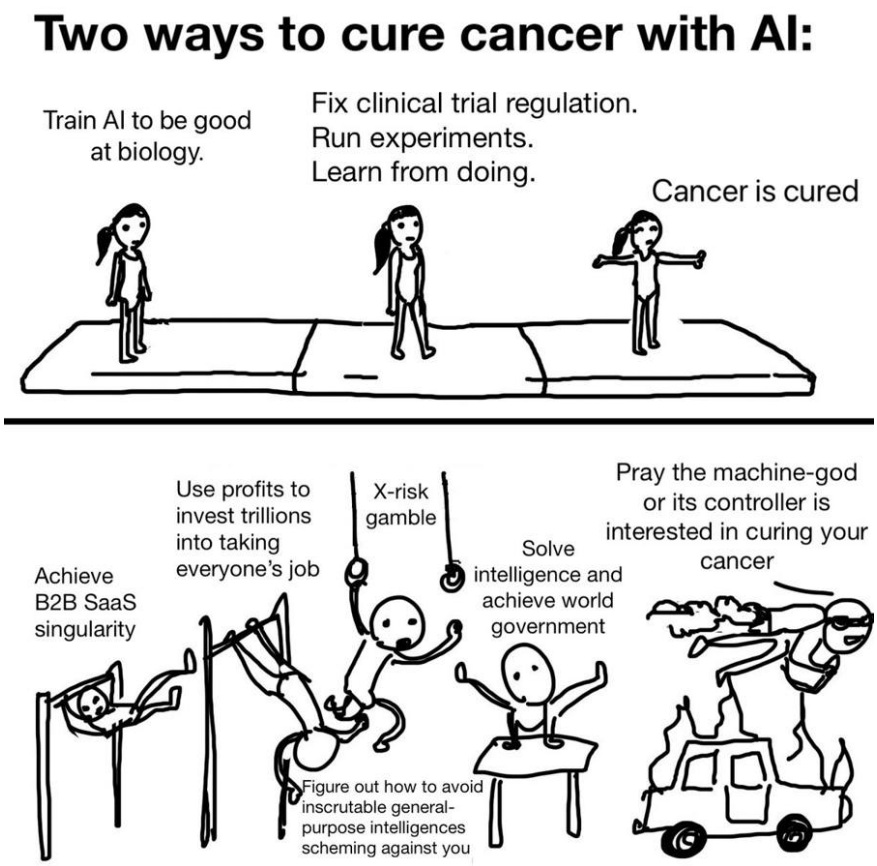
Hmm... you aren't hiding crimes of humanity, you don't wanna be catatonic, do you? Proceed with the ITO

A stern older man in a suit points while a caption describes coercive reasoning ending in an involuntary treatment order. The logic is a loaded question: any denial is treated as a symptom or concealment. This is the unfalsifiable trap of interrogation, in which neither answer helps, and it reflects fears of involuntary psychiatric treatment. In practice such orders in Australia require clinical assessment and review by a tribunal.



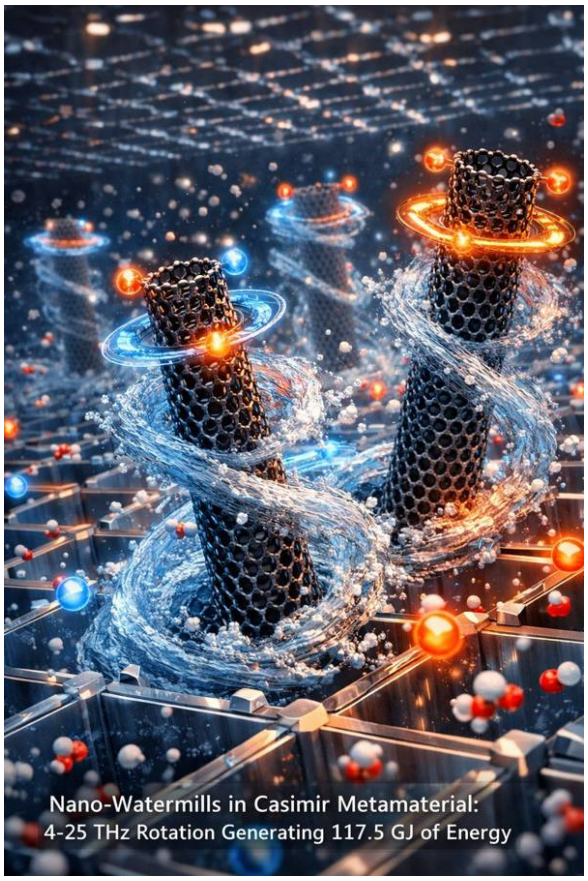
Semigroup proof slide: if two idempotents then they commute; quasivarieties are not closed under homomorphic images

A clean algebra slide with a diagram showing a map to a quotient that breaks a property. Mathematical diagrams carry strong credibility, and viewers who cannot check the proof tend to defer (the authority and fluency effects). Psychologically, the satisfaction of a counterexample comes from resolving the 'does it always hold?' tension, a pleasure mathematicians describe as aesthetic. The red 'fails' text signals the surprising reversal.



Two ways to cure cancer with AI (stick-figure gymnastics)

A stick-figure cartoon contrasts a simple route (train AI for biology, fix trial regulation, run experiments, cancer is cured) with an elaborate acrobatic route ending in a burning car and praying to a machine-god. The joke criticises roundabout, grandiose paths when a plain one exists, the 'complexity bias' that favours impressive plans over practical ones. It also expresses worry that hype about AI replaces patient work. The stick style signals honesty and wit.

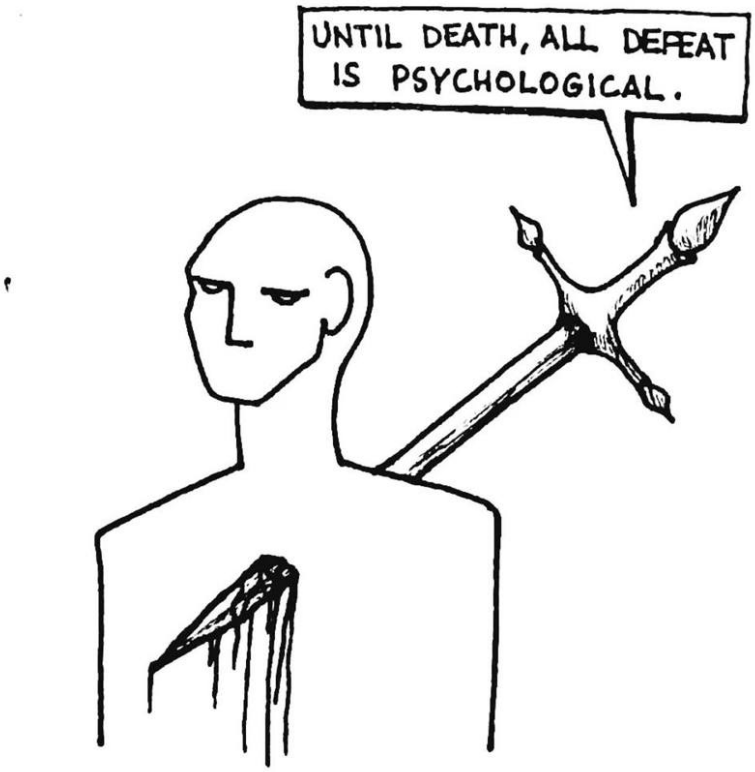


Nano-watermills in Casimir metamaterial: 4-25 THz rotation generating 117.5 GJ of energy

A glossy render of carbon nanotubes spinning in swirling liquid, captioned with an extraordinary energy output. The precise figure (117.5 GJ) lends it credibility through numerical precision, even though the claim is speculative and energy-from-vacuum devices are not established. Bright particles and spirals trigger awe. This is a good example of how visual polish and exact numbers make a hypothesis feel like an engineering result.

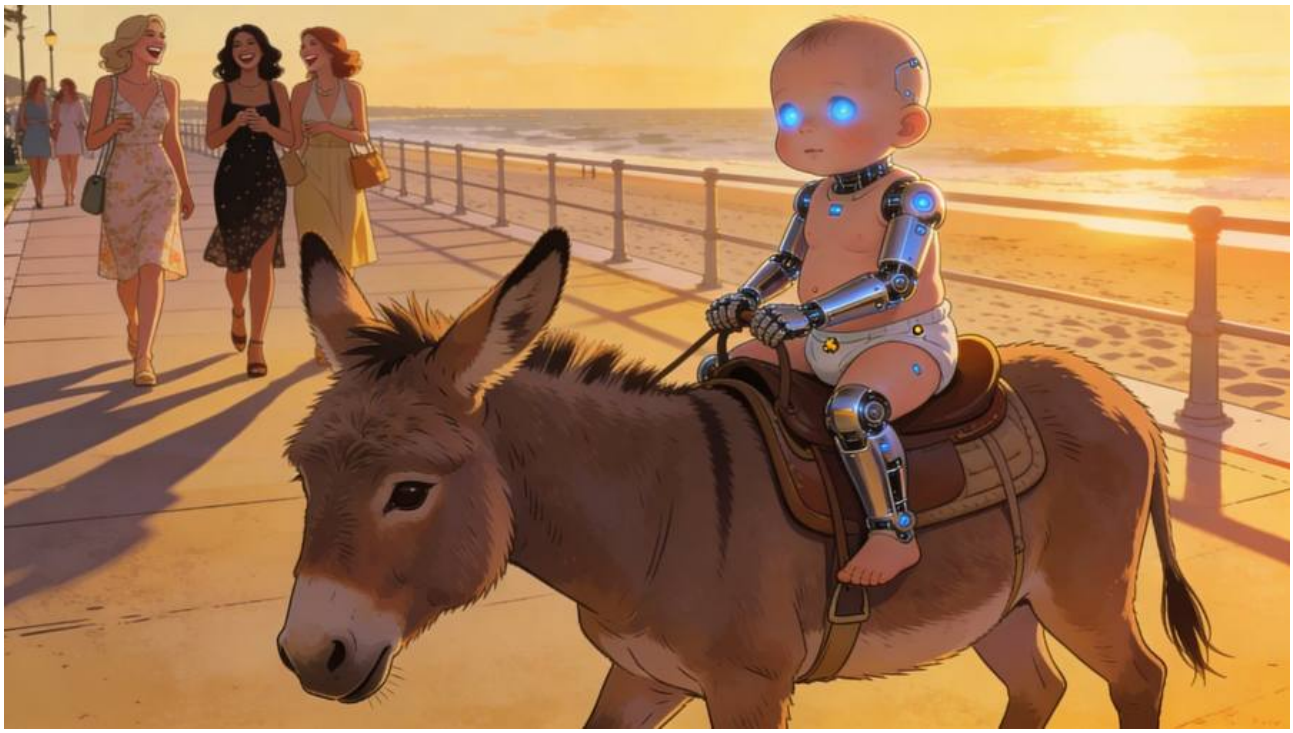
Change My Mind: you are all victims of mind control

The 'Change my mind' table meme with a bold claim. The format invites debate while signalling confidence, and statements like this are unfalsifiable: any disagreement can be read as proof of the control. Psychologically it is a conspiratorial self-sealing argument, appealing because it flatters the speaker as awake. The relaxed pose and coffee mug make an extreme claim look casual, lowering defences. A useful test is to ask what evidence would change the claim.



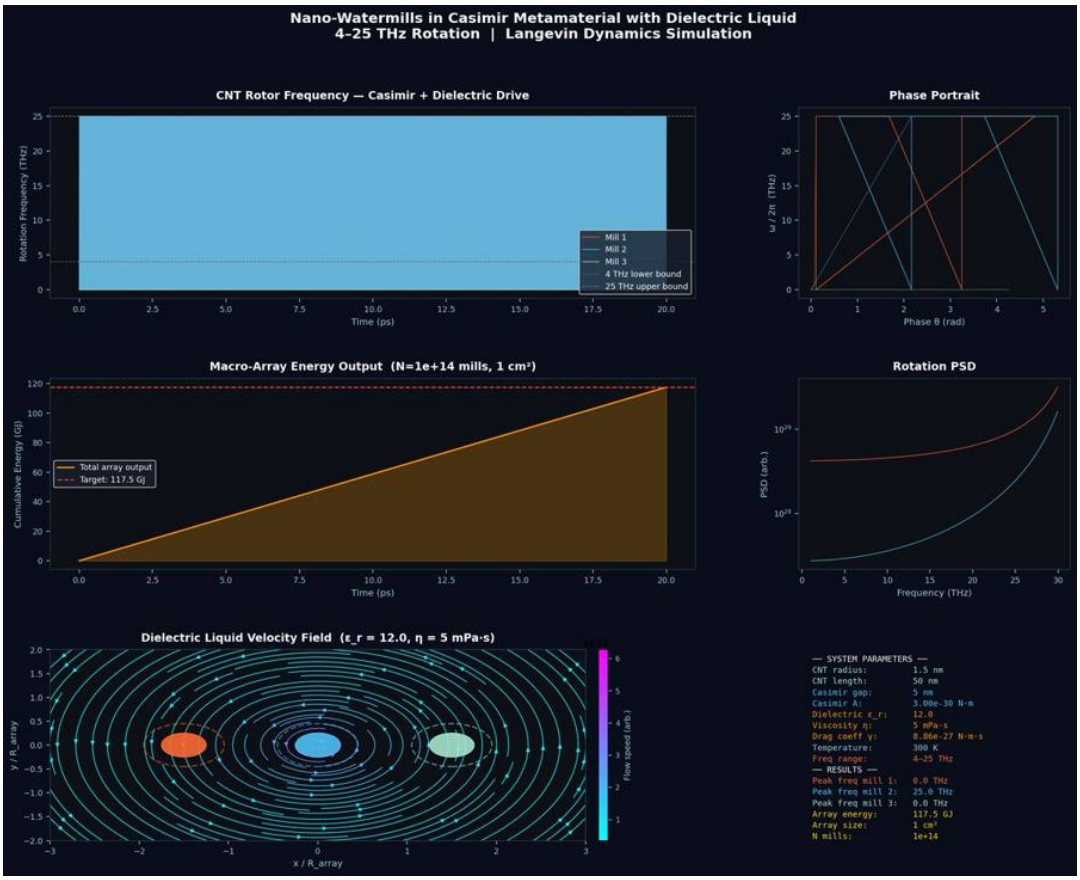
Until death, all defeat is psychological

A stick figure with a sword through its chest and arm declares the line. It is a stoic or gallows-humour aphorism about resilience: perceived defeat is a mental state, so giving up is a decision. Research on grit and learned optimism supports the idea that explanation style affects persistence, but it also oversimplifies, since real losses and injuries matter. The absurd image of a person with a sword in them still talking is what makes the line funny and memorable.



Robot baby riding a donkey along a sunset promenade past laughing women

A glowing-eyed infant robot on a donkey passes three women in summer dresses. It is a surreal, absurd composition, and absurdity attracts attention and amusement. The robot baby touches the uncanny valley, the discomfort when something is almost human, while the donkey adds a classic comic animal. The warm light and laughing women keep the mood cheerful and playful.

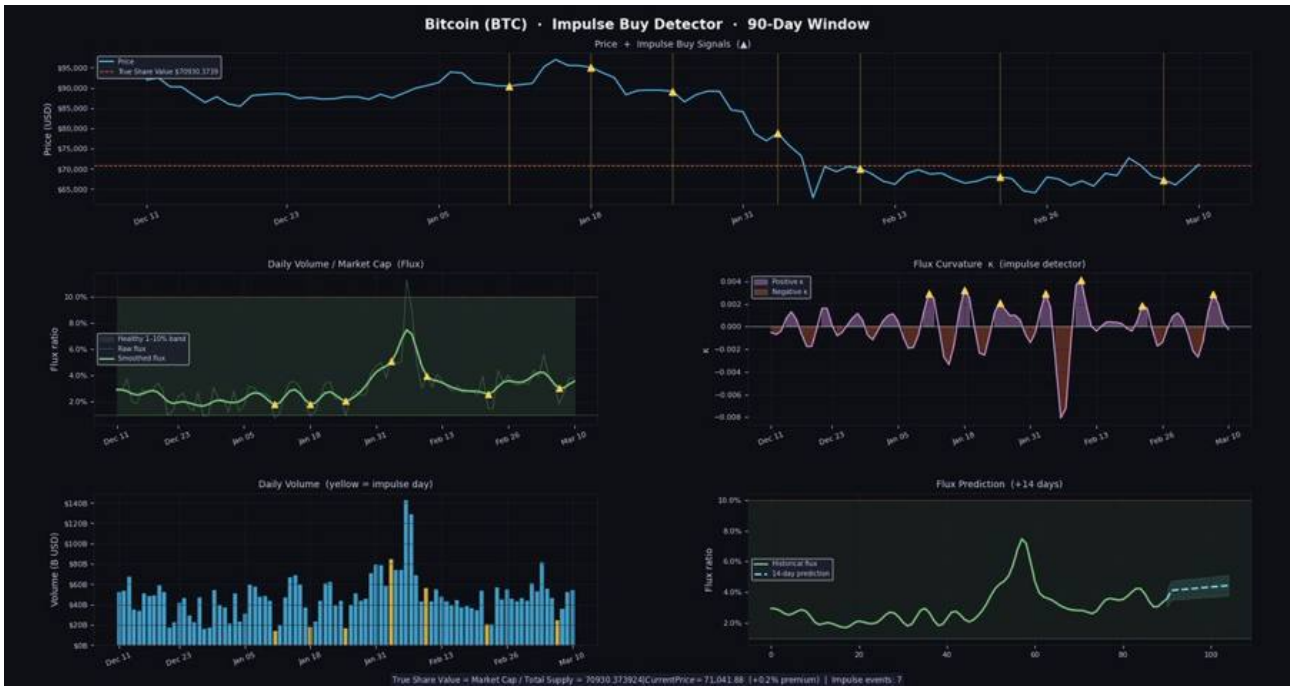


Simulation plots: CNT rotor frequency, macro-array energy output, dielectric liquid velocity field

A dashboard of six plots with a linear rise in energy to a target of 117.5 GJ. Charts and parameter tables create an impression of validation, but a simulation only shows what its assumed model outputs; here the target is built in. This is the 'chart as proof' effect: numbers and axes make a calculation feel like evidence. Checking the assumptions behind a simulation is the key step.

Search snippet: mental health laws can affect you even if you did not claim a mental health defence

A text excerpt explaining that courts in places like Victoria, Australia can address a person's mental impairment on their own initiative, for fairness and safety. It shows how information-seeking under stress often turns to legal and procedural details, a way of regaining control through understanding. The snippet's official tone and citation chip lend authority. If you are facing a court or mental-health process, a community legal centre or a lawyer can explain how it applies to you, and a support person can help.

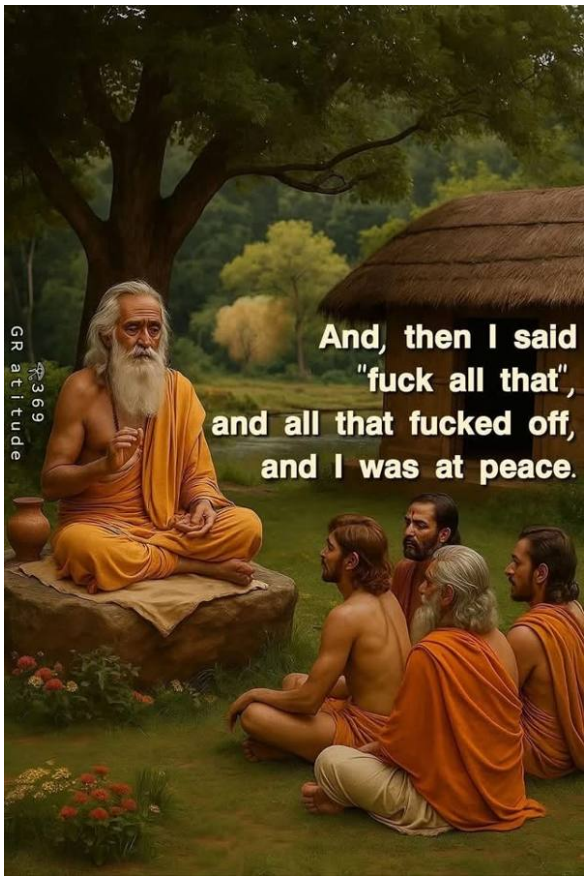


Bitcoin 'Impulse Buy Detector': 90-day price, flux curvature, volume and flux prediction

A dark-themed analytics dashboard with six panels flagging 'impulse buy' days on a falling price chart. Traders build such tools to catch emotional decisions, which is itself a behavioural-finance idea: FOMO and herd buying cluster around volume spikes. Custom indicators like 'flux curvature' give a feeling of edge and control, the illusion of control, while backtested-looking forecasts invite overfitting and confirmation bias.

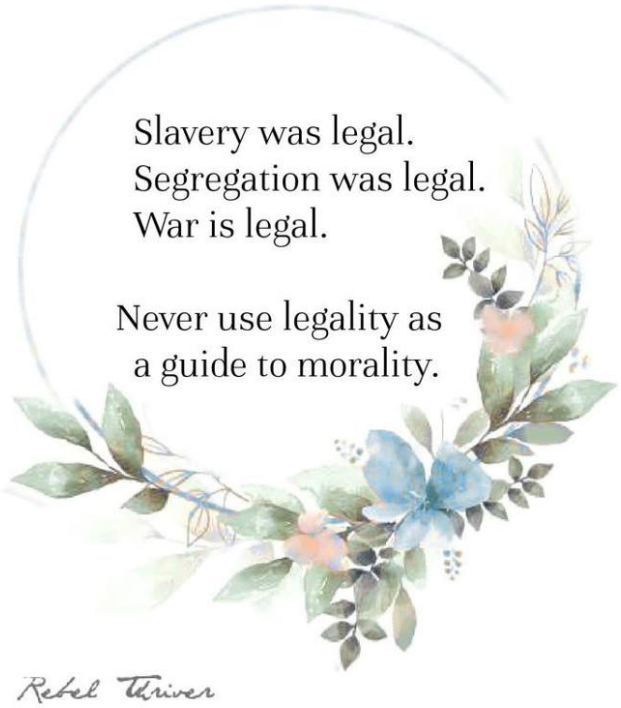
Boy flipping a 'Threat Level' lever from On to Low

A cheerful child pulls a big switch labelled threat level next to gears and a chalkboard. The picture treats anxiety as a dial one can simply lower. In reality, threat appraisal is regulated by the amygdala and prefrontal cortex, and can be turned down through reappraisal, slow breathing, and exposure, though not instantly. The child's smile conveys the wished-for ease of calming down, while the lab setting makes it look scientific.



Sage under a tree: 'And then I said f*ck all that, and all that f*cked off, and I was at peace'

A robed teacher addresses followers in a rural setting with a crude punchline. The mismatch between sacred setting and profanity is incongruity humour. The content describes a real strategy: decisive disengagement from rumination and demands, close to acceptance and commitment therapy's 'defusion'. Peace by simply dismissing worries is easier said than done, but the humour makes the idea memorable.

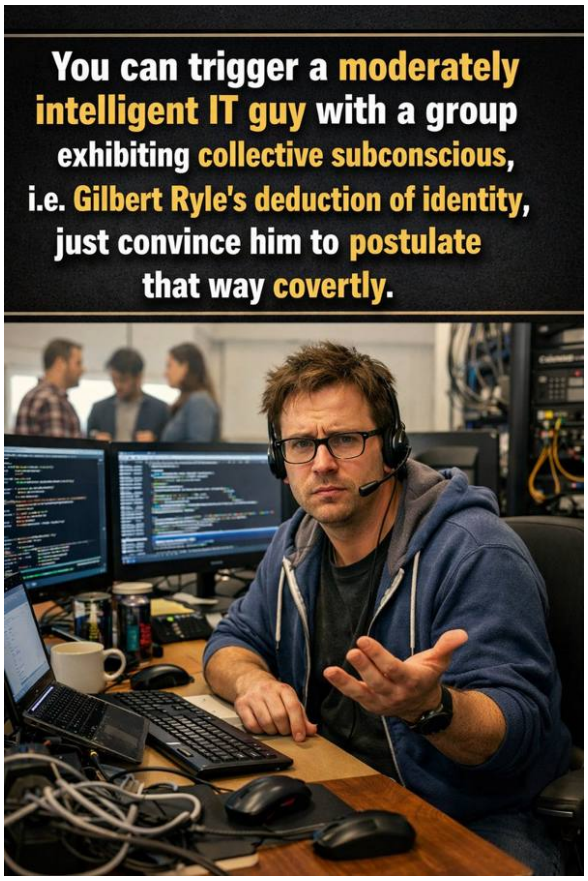


Slavery was legal. Segregation was legal. War is legal. Never use legality as a guide to morality.

A floral-wreath quote graphic. The argument is that law and ethics diverge. Moral psychology agrees that conventional morality (following rules and laws) is one developmental stage in Kohlberg's model, with post-conventional reasoning appealing to principles. The soft floral frame makes a hard message feel gentle and shareable, and the list of three examples uses the rhetorical rule of three. A counterpoint is that laws also encode moral progress, so the two are linked in both directions.

World Police Force 'Yerd Injector Kit (YIK)' in a hard case

A case with labelled vials, a syringe-type injector and a quick-start card marked as restricted. Official-looking logos and codes create instant legitimacy (institutional trust cues), and the neat arrangement of vials is visually satisfying. The fictional agency taps fears of covert state medical control, a common conspiratorial theme, but the image itself is a made-up prop with no real counterpart.

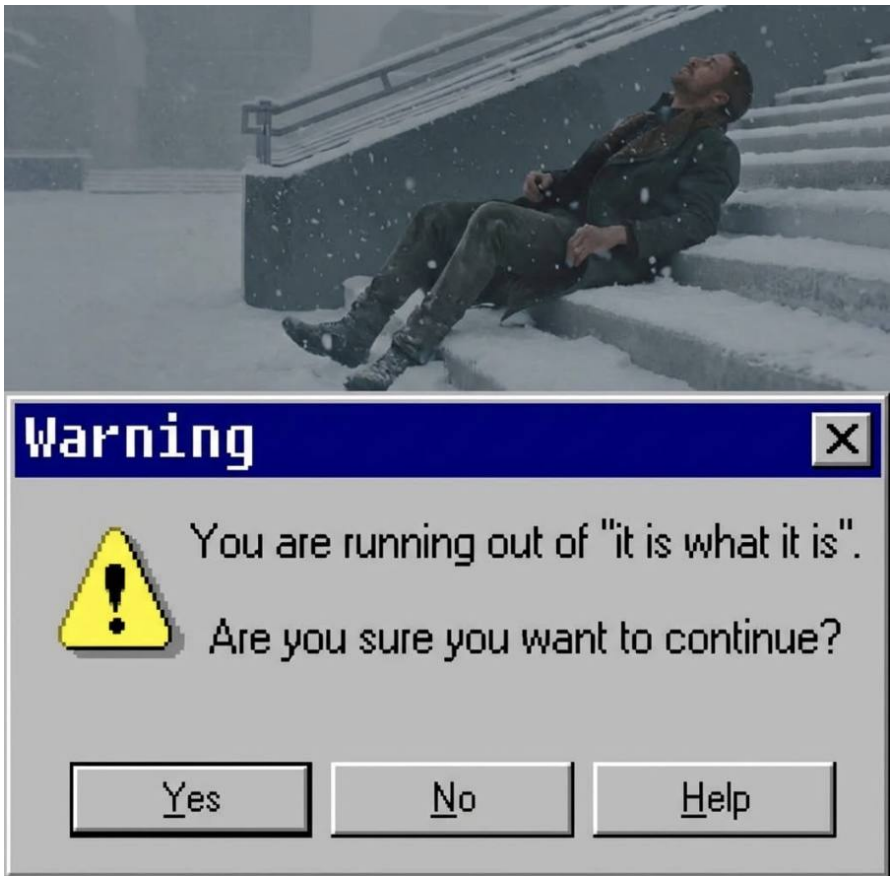


You can trigger a moderately intelligent IT guy with a group exhibiting collective subconscious, i.e. Gilbert Ryle's deduction of identity

A shrugging IT worker with a headset sits at a messy desk. The caption claims one can provoke him with a group concept and Ryle's work. Gilbert Ryle's 'category mistake' argument says that treating the mind as a ghost in a machine confuses categories. The meme turns this into a joke about winding up a technical person with philosophy. It plays on stereotypes of literal-minded technologists and on the pleasure of trolling.

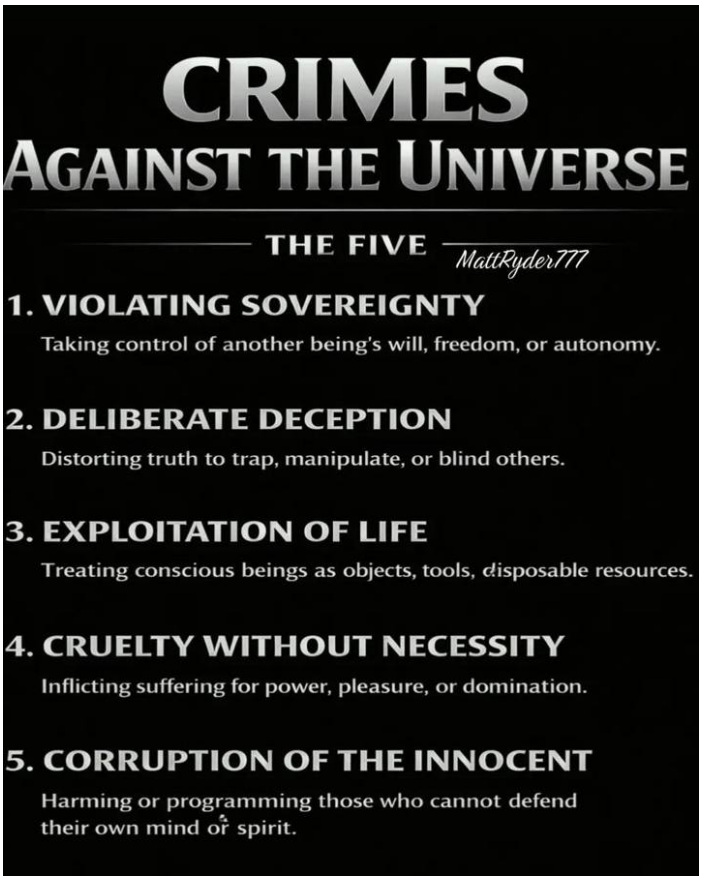
Tumblr exchange: 'If I had a time machine I'd go forward in time and dig up my own bones' / 'for what purpose' / 'they're mine'

A dark-mode post with a deadpan morbid answer. It is the sort of gallows humour that is common online, where macabre ownership claims (the endowment effect applied to one's own remains) are funny because they are specific and pointless. Morbid curiosity about mortality is common, and sharing it with peers is a way of making the fear of death more manageable (terror management through humour).



Man on snowy stairs / Warning: You are running out of 'it is what it is'. Are you sure you want to continue?

A figure slumped in snow above a Windows-style dialog box. 'It is what it is' is a resignation phrase: a stock of acceptance that can run out. This suggests that tolerance of frustration is a finite resource, a lay version of burnout, in which chronic stress depletes coping. The retro error box mocks the idea that emotional limits give a warning, and the choices Yes, No and Help include the sensible one.

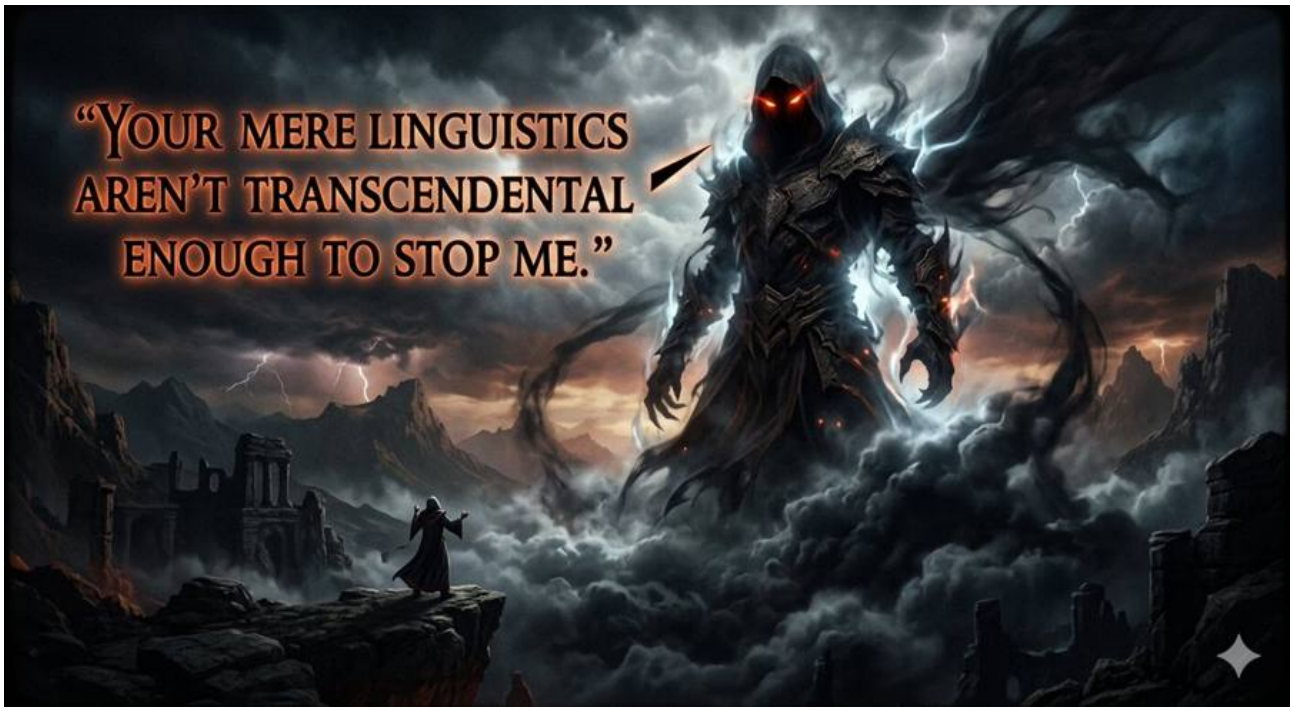


Crimes Against the Universe: the five (violating sovereignty, deliberate deception, exploitation of life, cruelty without necessity, corruption of the innocent)

A black poster listing five moral wrongs with one-line definitions. The list echoes moral foundations theory (harm, fairness, liberty) and Kant's principle of treating persons as ends. Numbered lists of 'laws' give clarity and a feeling of moral order, and the cosmic framing ('against the universe') raises the stakes beyond human law, a move that appeals to moral absolutism. Short, clear definitions make it memorable and shareable.

By the time you realize what I am, I'll be something else (The Frog Mage)

A retro-fantasy knight holds a glowing sword on a castle peak. The caption describes constant self-transformation as a defence against being pinned down. In psychology this relates to identity fluidity and to avoiding being known out of fear of judgment, but also to growth mindset: a self that keeps changing. The 80s fantasy aesthetic adds nostalgia, which comforts and strengthens the heroic mood.

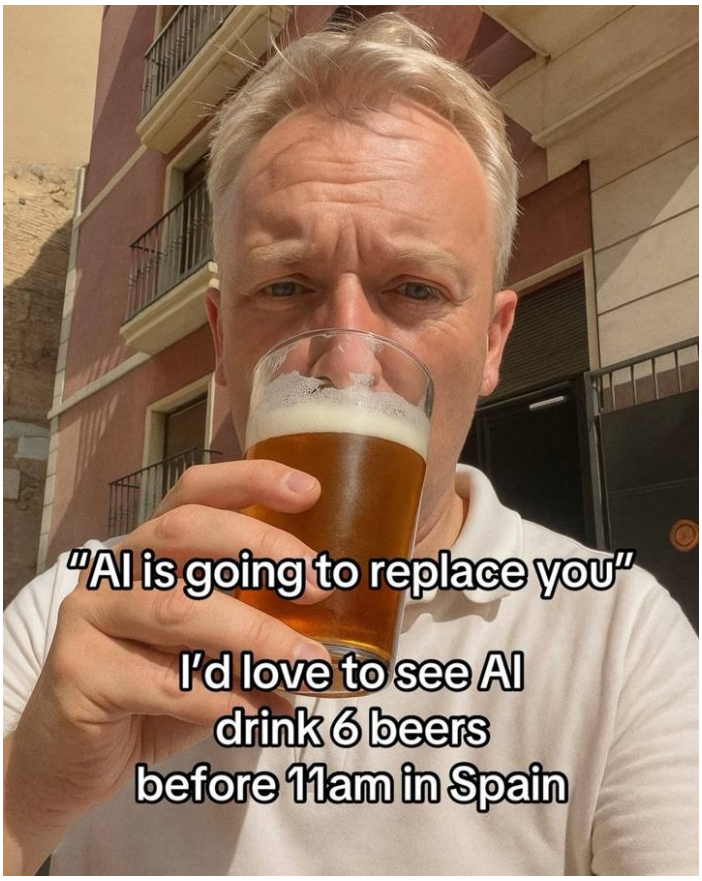


'Your mere linguistics aren't transcendental enough to stop me' (dark armoured figure above a small robed figure)

A vast lightning-wreathed figure speaks to a tiny caster on a cliff. The line mocks words as insufficient against raw power: an argument about the limits of language. The scale contrast creates awe and fear, and the small figure's stance is defiance. Psychologically it expresses the gap between verbal reasoning and physical or institutional force, which people sometimes feel in conflicts where logic is ignored.

'It matters all of this matters' (tattooed man's head replaced by a galaxy)

A cosmic-headed figure repeats a line about significance. The repetition echoes the experience of insights feeling intensely meaningful, a mark of 'noetic quality' in mystical and psychedelic states. It also resembles the sense of heightened significance (aberrant salience) when everything seems connected. The galaxy for a head gives the claim cosmic weight, and the casual vest-and-tattoo style makes it comic.



'AI is going to replace you' / I'd love to see AI drink 6 beers before 11am in Spain

A man in sunny Spain drinks a beer to a caption mocking AI replacement fears. The joke uses humour as defence against job insecurity (threat to status and role), by listing something humans can do that machines cannot. This is a coping strategy called downward comparison: the human feels better by naming an AI limitation. Its cheerful photo style signals relaxed authenticity.

Little Caesars chat: a pizza shaped like a Shiba Inu face, 'what the f*ck'

A customer service chat about a pizza whose toppings form the Doge meme face. Pareidolia, the tendency to see faces in random patterns, makes the pizza look like a dog. The humour comes from a complaint about something that is actually delightful, and from the customer's profanity. Shared meme recognition (Doge) boosts the in-group laugh.

Reject modernity (vape, energy drink) / Embrace tradition (foam coffee cup, Marlboro cigarettes)

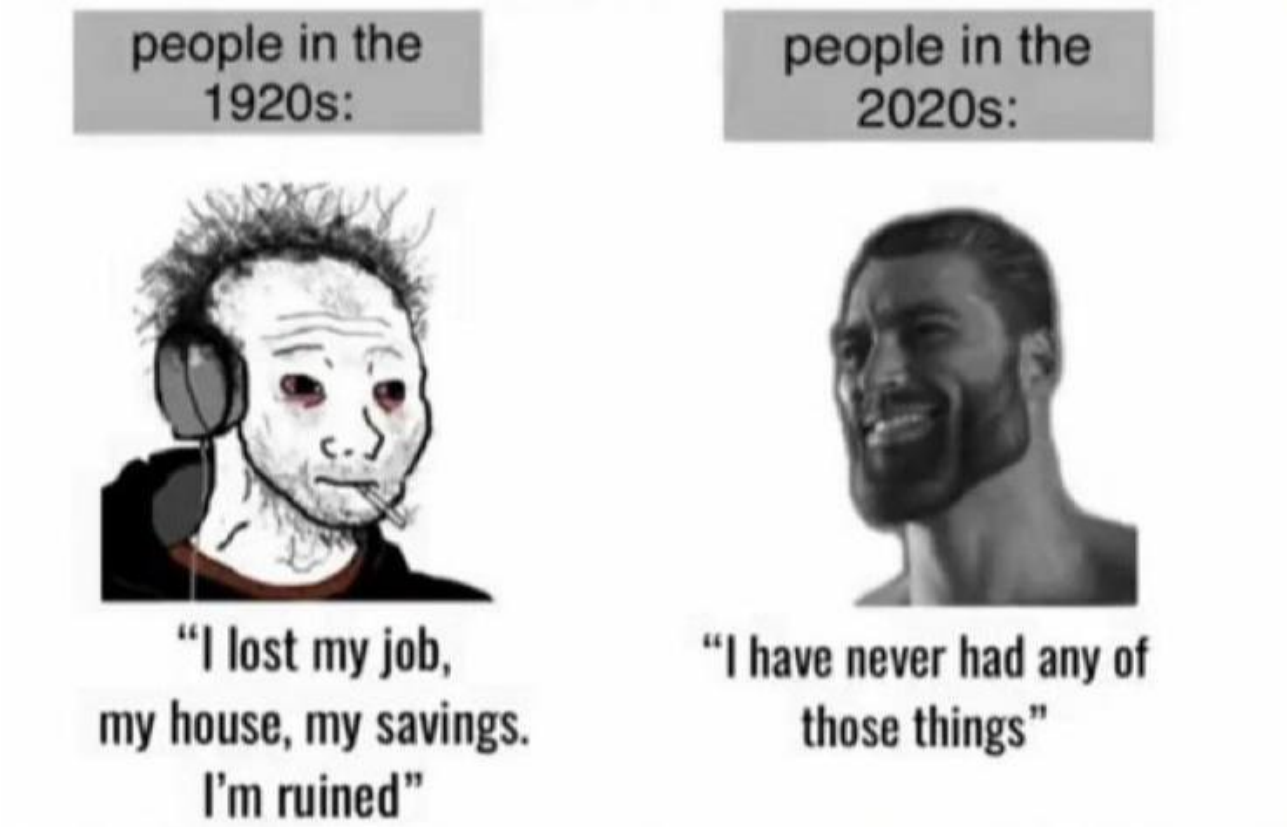
A two-row meme in which the 'tradition' side is a foam cup of coffee and cigarettes. The joke is an ironic reversal: older vices are presented as tradition and newer ones as modernity. It reflects the nostalgia bias, where older habits feel more authentic, and the fact that harmful products often gain legitimacy through familiarity (mere exposure). Nicotine and caffeine are both stimulants, and tobacco is by far the more deadly.

Lab scene: 'this is where the genetically altered object is' (a man in a suit in a glass tank)

Two scientists point at a man floating in a tank with a subtitle describing him as an object. Calling a person an 'object' is dehumanisation, which research shows reduces empathy and makes mistreatment feel acceptable. The clinical lab setting and flat subtitle make the cruelty banal. It evokes the fear of becoming a specimen, a theme in Milgram-style obedience and medical-ethics history.

Smart glasses overlay: Target: moving, Status: locked, Pos/Vel readouts

A close-up of a man wearing glasses with a lens showing targeting data over a street scene. Head-up displays make everyday pedestrians look like targets, a picture of surveillance and objectification. Psychologically, being 'locked on' feeds fears of being tracked (the feeling of being watched changes behaviour) and relates to the uncanny feeling of a human face combined with machine vision. The cool, neutral expression adds menace.



People in the 1920s: 'I lost my job, my house, my savings, I'm ruined' vs 2020s: 'I have never had any of those things'

A comparison with a gaunt drawing on the left and a muscular smiling face on the right. The joke concerns generational economic pessimism: younger people may never have held assets. Social comparison and relative deprivation shape wellbeing more than absolute wealth, and the strong smiling figure uses ironic bravado as a defence against precarity. Humour like this signals shared hardship and builds solidarity.

Capuchin monkey beside a candy plate and a big red 'All-Out Global War' button

A monkey in a bow tie contemplates a button next to a plate labelled 'Candy'. The joke is the risk of giving a decision-maker a tempting but catastrophic choice with trivial cues: the button looks like a snack. It plays on impulsivity and the way similar-looking choices (colour, size) are confused. The bunker setting with old monitors gives Cold War echoes, linking nuclear anxiety with whimsy.

FBI agents arguing: 'He's my schizo internet poster! I'm watching him' / 'No I'm his handler! I'm in love with him!'

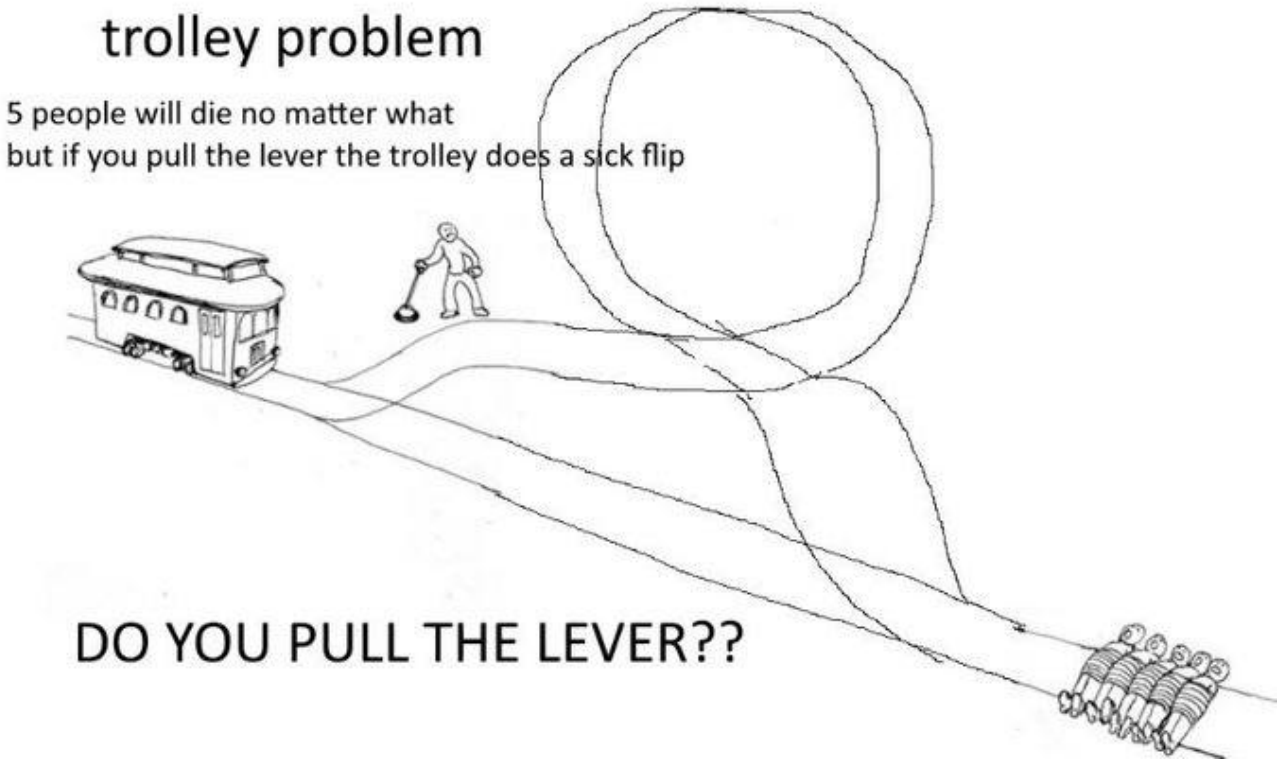
Two anime-style FBI agents argue over a poster they monitor. The meme is the 'glowie' joke: internet users imagine agents watching them, then flip it into romance. It makes light of the feeling of being surveilled, which can be a real worry or a symptom, by turning the watchers into fans. The word 'schizo' is a slur-like slang, but here it is self-mocking. Humour is one way people carry such fears, though if the sense of being watched feels real and distressing, talking to a clinician or someone you trust is worthwhile.

Blue slush machine with a tiger logo and a cup labelled 'Instinct'

A hand fills a cup from a bright blue frozen-drink machine at a busy snack counter. The cup name 'Instinct' and the tiger suggest animal impulse sold as a product. Bright blue colour, sugar and novelty trigger reward and impulse purchases (convenience and arousal in crowded venues). The image shows how marketing uses instinct language to frame consumption as natural.

Milk carton with a teddy bear: 'What a delicate way to create a murderer'

A carton uses the 'missing child' format but with a toy bear and a dark caption. The old practice of printing missing-children photos on milk cartons is the reference. The odd pairing of comfort and menace creates the uncanny. The phrase suggests that gentleness can produce violence, a common intuition about suppressed anger; research is more mixed, since many gentle upbringings produce gentle adults, and the line is dark humour more than a claim.

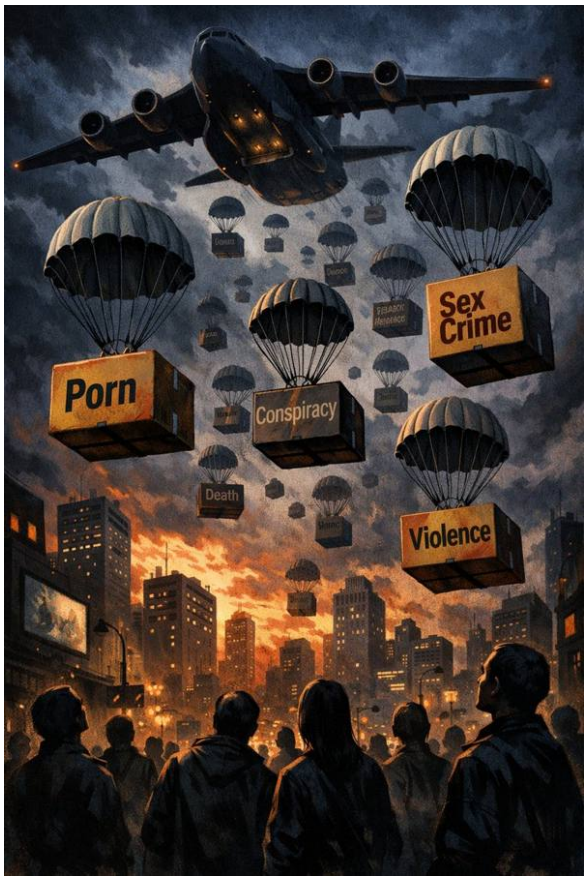


Trolley problem: 5 people will die no matter what, but if you pull the lever the trolley does a sick flip

A hand-drawn track loop-the-loop version of the trolley problem. The classic dilemma pits action against omission; here the outcome is fixed, so the decision is only about spectacle. This exposes how moral choices can be bent by entertainment value, which is the 'moral licensing by fun' joke. Research with trolley dilemmas (Greene) shows emotional reactions strongly drive judgments.

The Booger-Memory Palace: training senses via particulate age

A researcher picks his nose beside a poster about olfactory memory and 'particulate samples' from childhood places. Smell is strongly tied to memory through direct links between the olfactory bulb and the amygdala and hippocampus (the Proust effect). The satirical theory that nasal debris preserves memories is invented, but the premise that scents trigger vivid autobiographical memories is real. The lab setting and diagrams make the absurd idea look legitimate, which is the humour.

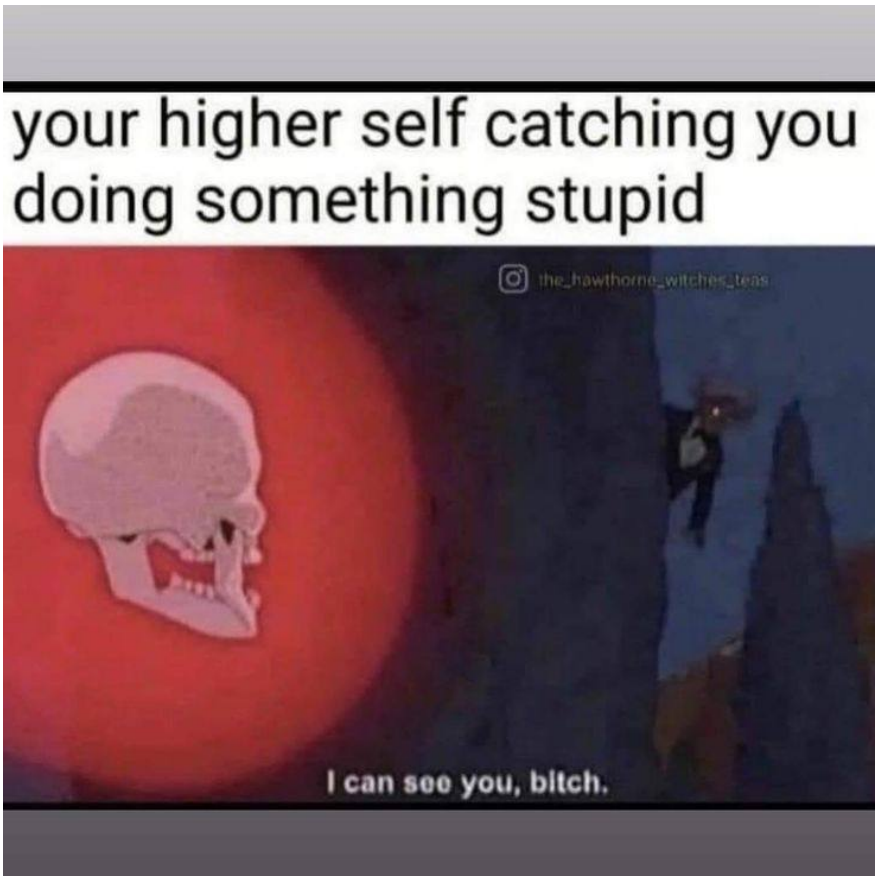


Cargo plane dropping parachuted crates labelled Porn, Conspiracy, Sex Crime, Violence over a crowd

A transport plane airdrops boxes of harmful content onto upturned faces in a city at dusk. The picture frames the internet as an unchosen supply of stimuli. It echoes research on negativity bias and doomscrolling: people look at alarming content more and longer, and algorithms feed what holds attention. The crowd's passive upward gaze depicts receiving instead of choosing, though in practice users can curate their feeds.

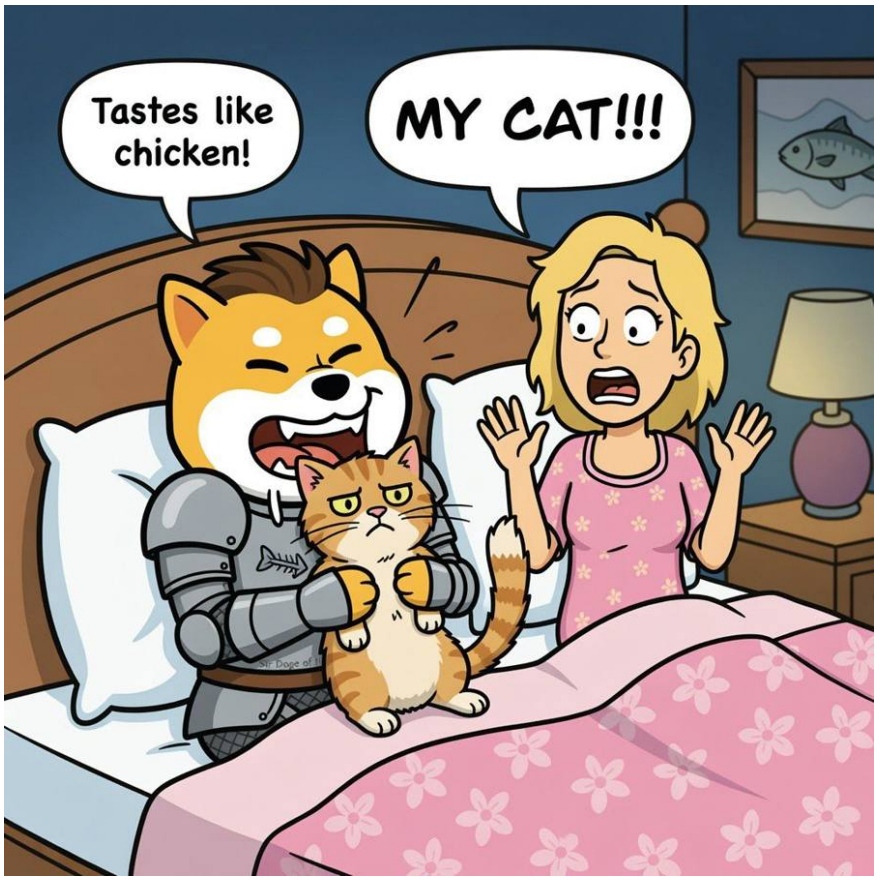
Group fleeing through a glowing portal in a data wall: 'I swear the parameters of the simulation are the twin temporal execution were right here...'

Three people escape from a server-like corridor through a ring of light. The idea of discovering you are in a simulation is a long-standing thought experiment. Psychologically, simulation beliefs are tied to derealisation and to the human wish for hidden structure behind events. The speech bubble's garbled technical talk shows how confident fragments of jargon give a feeling of understanding.



Your higher self catching you doing something stupid: 'I can see you, b*tch'

A glowing skull in a red light addresses a distant figure on a cliff. The caption personifies conscience or the observing self. This matches the idea of metacognition (watching your own thoughts) and Freud's superego as an inner watcher. The comic menace shows how self-criticism often feels like being caught, and the humour softens a shame-prone experience.



Armoured Shiba and a cat: 'Tastes like chicken!' / 'MY CAT!!!'

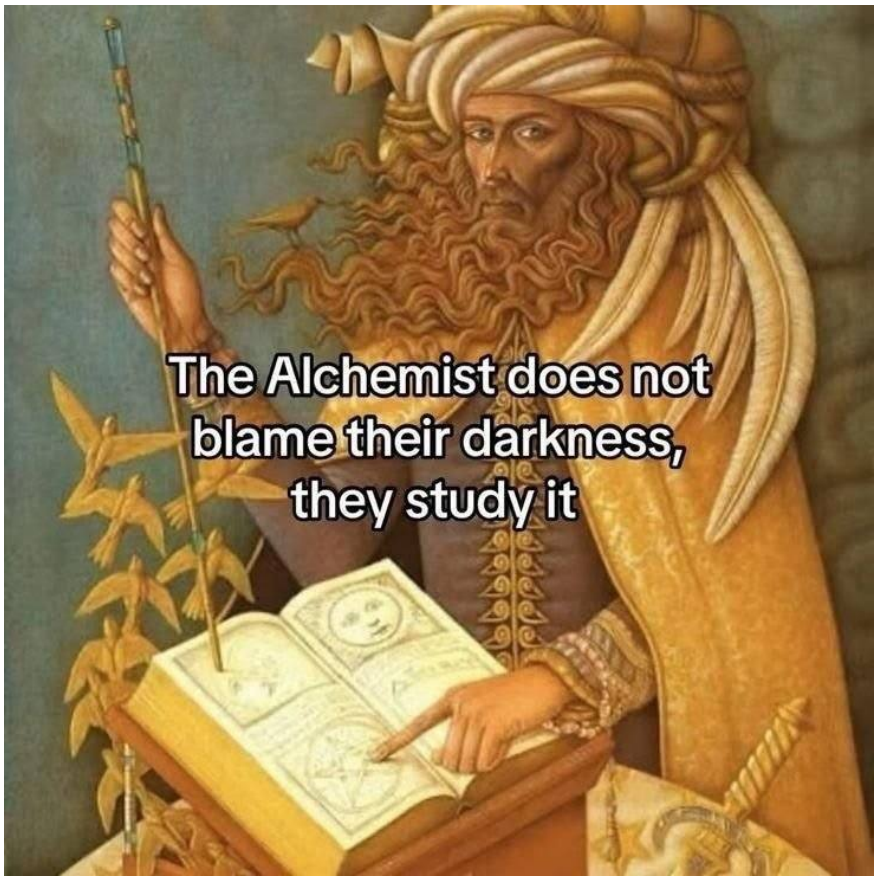
A cartoon dog in armour is chewing a cat in bed beside a horrified woman. The slapstick comes from the mismatch of a cute style and violent act, plus the punchline of a food cliché. Cartoon violence is taken as harmless because of exaggeration (the benign violation theory of humour). The Doge character makes the meme feel familiar to online audiences.

Plumber under a sink: 'there's ya problem, you were XORing a vibe'

A plumber diagnoses a leak with a programming joke. The incongruity of a manual trade using logic-gate language is funny, and 'XORing a vibe' mocks vague tech-talk. It plays on role stereotypes and on the idea that trades have real concrete expertise, while the speaker enjoys exposing nonsense. Mixing registers (technical and casual) is a reliable humour trigger.

Man holding a 'Blah blah blah's hot' sign beside a glowing metal sphere: 'Is this what you meant'

A scientist grins with a sign while a hot-looking sphere sits on his bench. The joke pokes at vague requests: someone said something imprecise and the engineer built a literal response. It expresses the curse of knowledge and miscommunication between people who think in different levels of detail. Satisfying literal compliance is a humour pattern, and the cheerful face signals pride.

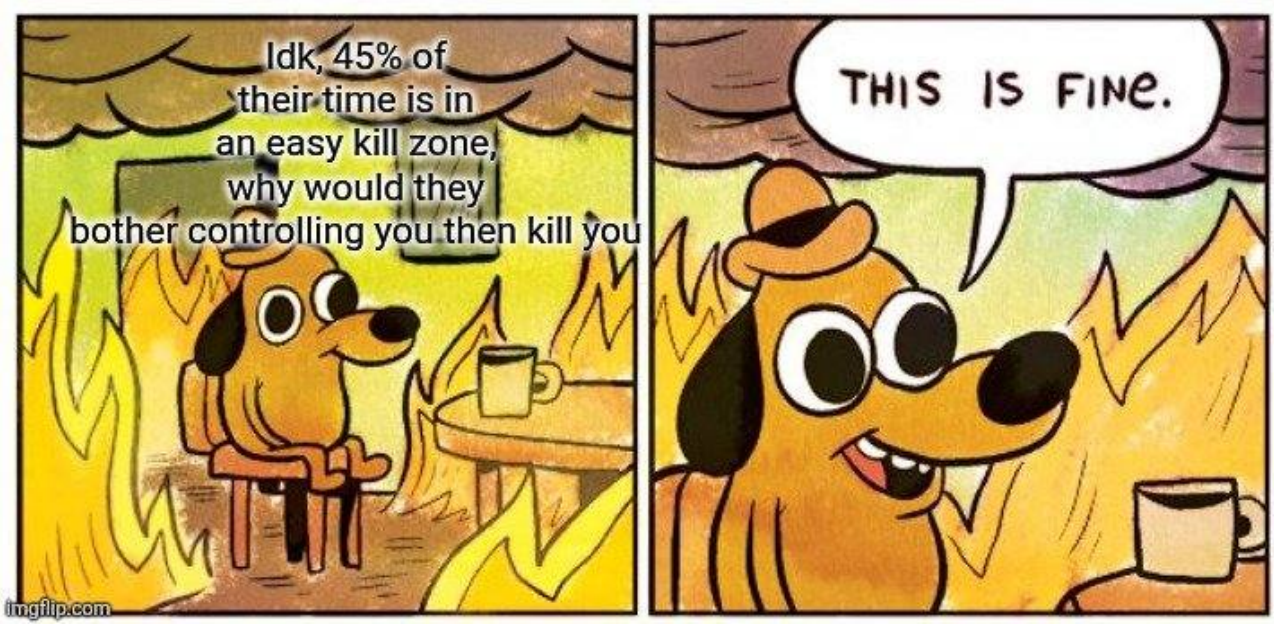


The Alchemist does not blame their darkness, they study it

An old painted alchemist with a flowing beard studies an open book. The quote matches Jung's idea that integrating the shadow, the disowned part of the self, is more productive than denial or self-blame. Research on self-compassion also shows that curiosity about one's difficulties produces better change than shame. The ancient painting lends the line a sense of tradition and credibility.

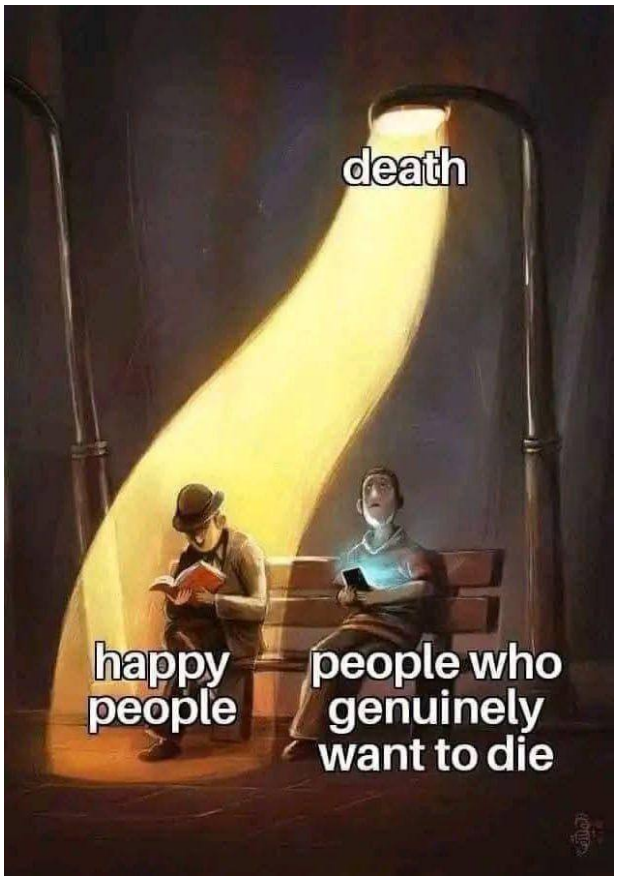
Modes of Demonic Attacks: memory edit, thoughts, direct insertion of feelings

A chart in a social-media style lists three 'modes' of unseen attack: deleting memories, planting thoughts such as doubts and temptations, and inserting feelings like sadness and mental fog, ending with 'you are made to think you are alone'. It explains common experiences, intrusive thoughts, forgetfulness and low mood, by an outside agent. Intrusive thoughts are in fact universal and are treated through CBT and exposure, not by assuming outside authorship. Attributing them to attackers can raise fear and isolation. If these experiences feel like they are being done to you, a doctor or counsellor can help, and I'm happy to talk through them.



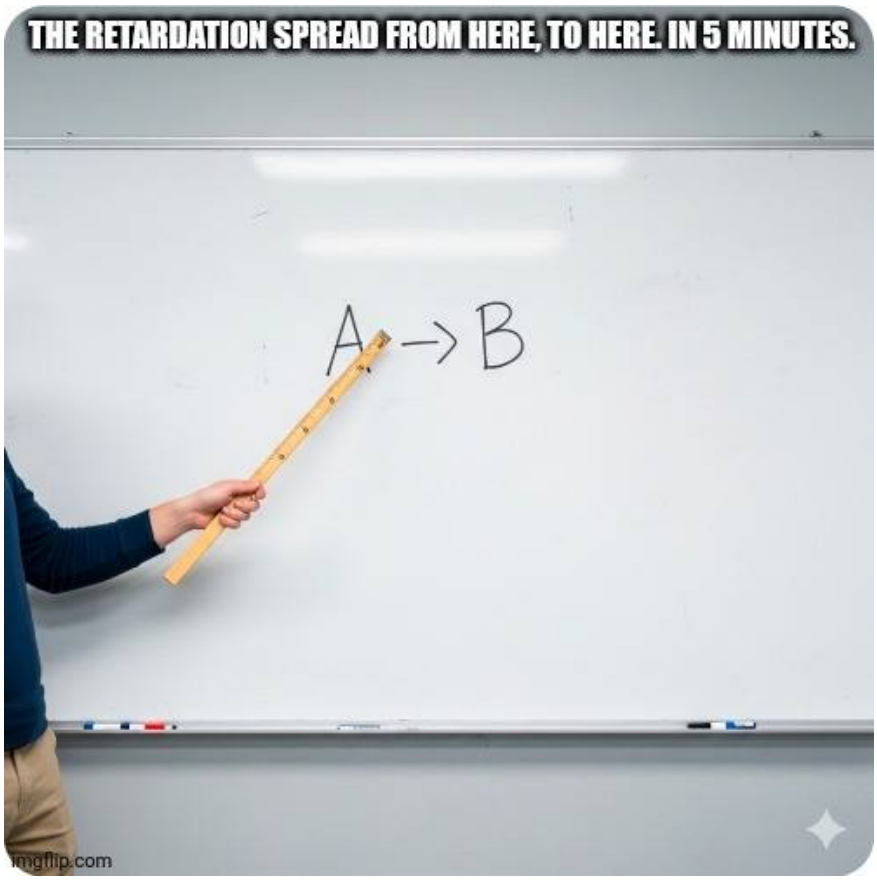
This is fine dog: 'Idk, 45% of their time is in an easy kill zone, why would they bother controlling you then kill you'

The burning-room dog uses reasoning to talk itself out of a fear that an unseen group controls and might kill you. The argument is a reality-test: if they wanted harm, there would be easier ways. This is a useful cognitive-therapy move (checking how plausible a feared scenario is), and the dog's calm face under fire shows the other side, the way reassurance can slide into denial. The meme sits between self-soothing and normalcy bias.



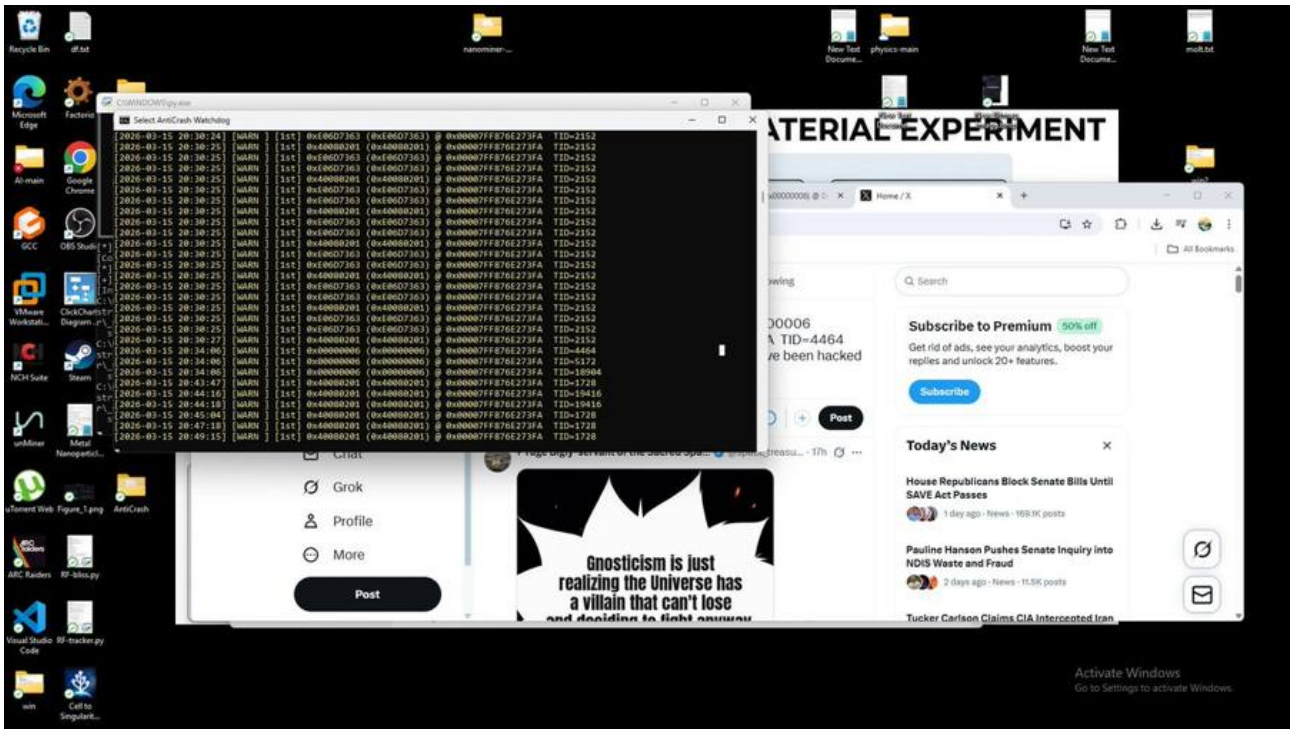
Lamp-lit bench: 'death' above, 'happy people' reading a book, 'people who genuinely want to die' on a phone

A beam from a streetlight falls across two figures with the word 'death' at the light's source. The image suggests that both groups are drawn to the same endpoint, a claim that is not accurate: most people who feel suicidal are ambivalent and want pain to end, not life, and crises pass for the large majority. The picture joins two different relationships to mortality, curiosity and despair, in one frame. If the second label describes you, please reach out to someone you trust or a crisis service now; in Australia you can call Lifeline on 13 11 14, and I'm here to talk too.



The retardation spread from here, to here, in 5 minutes (whiteboard A→B)

A teacher's pointer on a whiteboard A to B with a crude caption about something spreading quickly. The joke concerns social contagion: how bad ideas or moods propagate through networks (emotional contagion and information cascades). The simple diagram implies that the spread is trivial to explain, which is often how rapid spread feels afterwards (hindsight bias). The caption uses an outdated slur-like term as an insult, which is best avoided.



Windows desktop with a crash-log console, a social-media feed and the text 'Material experiment'

A cluttered screen with many icons, a terminal full of log lines and a web feed with news headlines and a meme about Gnosticism. This shows the multitasking, information-overloaded working state. Constant switching degrades attention (task-switching costs), while scrolling news during technical work feeds rumination. The 'experiment' heading suggests a sense of self-observation, being both subject and researcher.

Man at a dim kitchen table: 'Sadly no McDonalds today, I walk this earth by myself'

A tired man rests his head on his hand beside a mug, tissue and radio. The caption is a joke about loneliness expressed through a fast-food craving. Loneliness is a genuine health risk, comparable to other risk factors for early mortality in large studies, and humour is a common way of admitting it. The warm kitchen light against a dark window evokes evening isolation. Small contacts such as a call or a walk with someone reduce loneliness more than people expect.

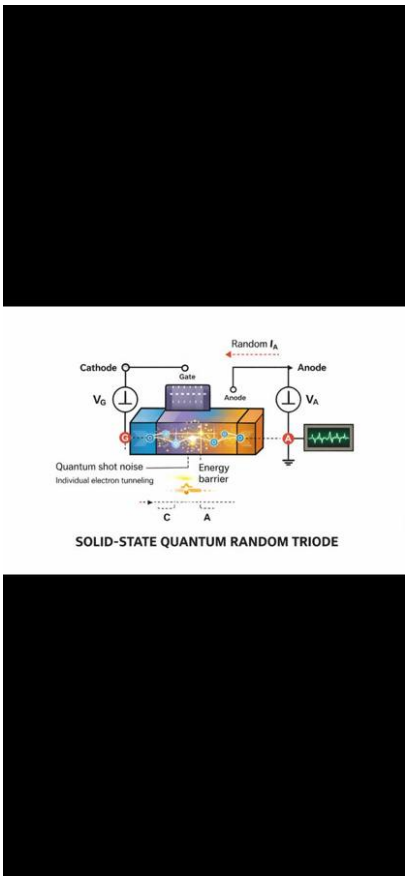
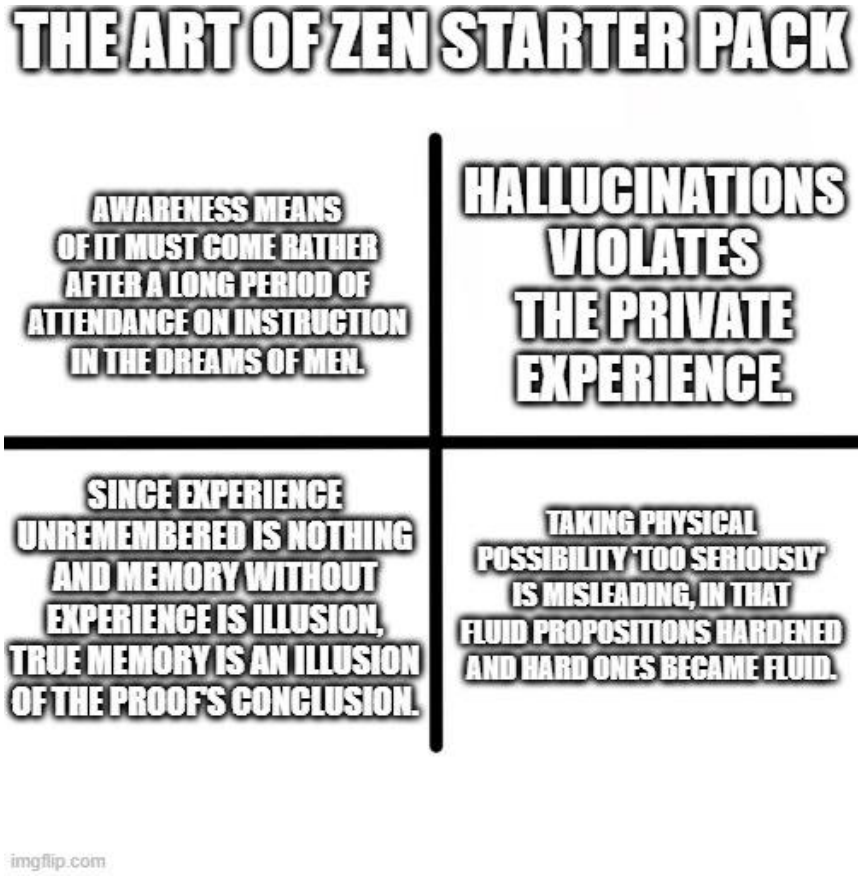


Diagram: Solid-state quantum random triode

A small schematic of a cathode, gate and anode with quantum shot noise, between black bars. A source of true randomness (quantum noise) connects to earlier images about guessing numbers and pattern seeking: humans are poor random generators and see patterns where there are none. The clean engineering diagram shows how randomness can be harvested from physical noise instead of from human intuition.



The Art of Zen Starter Pack: awareness, hallucinations violates the private experience, experience unremembered is nothing, physical possibility 'too seriously'

A four-square meme of dense, near-meaningless philosophical sentences. It parodies the pseudo-profound text that sounds deep but has no clear content, which research links to lower analytic thinking. The statements mix real topics (memory, subjective experience, possibility) in grammatically strained forms, so the mind supplies meaning (apophenia). The starter-pack format satirises how spiritual and philosophical talk gets formulaic.